

Timaeus

TIMAIOS

Plato

translated by David Horan

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17a

S: One, two, three... But my dear Timaeus, where is the fourth of our banqueters from yesterday¹ who will now provide the feast?

17a

T: Some illness has befallen him, Socrates, for he would not have missed this gathering deliberately.

ΣΩ. εἷς, δύο, τρεῖς· ὁ δὲ δὴ τέταρτος ἡμῖν, ὃ φίλε Τίμαιε, ποῦ τῶν χθὲς μὲν δαιτυμόνων, τὰ νῦν δὲ ἐστιατόρων; ΤΙ. ἀσθένειά τις αὐτῷ συνέπεσεν, ὃ Σώκρατες· οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἐκὼν τῆσδε ἀπελείπετο τῆς συνουσίας. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν σὸν τῶνδ' ἐργον καὶ τὸ ὑπὲρ τοῦ ἀπόντος ἀναπληροῦν μέρος;

17b

S: Then you and your friends here have the task of supplying the part of the absentee.

17b

T: Entirely so, and indeed we shall do our best not to be found wanting, since it would not be right if those of us who are left did not repay you lavishly when we were entertained with such fitting hospitality yesterday.

17b

S: Now, do you remember what I assigned you to speak about and what the topics were?

17b

T: We remember some of them, but since you are here you will remind us of the others. Better still, if it's not a problem for you, go over them again briefly from the beginning so that we can be more sure of them.

ΤΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν, καὶ κατὰ δύναμιν γε οὐδὲν ἐλλείψομεν· οὐδὲ γὰρ ἂν εἶη δίκαιον, χθὲς ὑπὸ σοῦ ξενισθέντας οἷς ἦν πρόπον ξενίοις, μὴ οὐ προθύμως σὲ τοὺς λοιποὺς ἡμῶν ἀνταφεστιᾶν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὔν μέμνησθε ὅσα ὑμῖν καὶ περὶ ὧν ἐπέταξα εἰπεῖν; ΤΙ. τὰ μὲν μεμνήμεθα, ὅσα δὲ μὴ, σὺ παρῶν ὑπομνήσεις· μᾶλλον δέ, εἰ μὴ τί σοι χαλεπὸν, ἐξ ἀρχῆς διὰ βραχέων πάλιν ἐπ' ἀνελθε αὐτά, ἵνα βεβαιωθῇ μᾶλλον παρ' ἡμῖν.

17c

S: So be it. I believe the discussions I was involved in yesterday were mainly concerned with the political system, what kind seemed best to me and what sort of men constitute it.

17c

T: And what you said, Socrates, seemed very reasonable to us all.

17c

S: Didn't we first separate people engaged in farming or any other skills within the citizen-body from the warrior class?

17c

T: Yes.

ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἔσται. χθές που τῶν ὑπ' ἐμοῦ ῥηθέντων λόγων περὶ πολιτείας ἦν τὸ κεφάλαιον οἷα τε καὶ ἐξ οἷων ἀνδρῶν ἀρίστη κατεφαίνεται ἄν μοι γενέσθαι. ΤΙ. καὶ μάλα γε ἡμῖν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ῥηθεῖσα πᾶσιν κατὰ νοῦν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τὸ τῶν γεωργῶν ὅσαι τε ἄλλαι τέχναι πρῶτον ἐν αὐτῇ χωρὶς διειλόμεθα ἀπὸ τοῦ γένους τοῦ τῶν προπολεμησόντων; ΤΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ κατὰ φύσιν δὴ δόντες τὸ καθ' αὐτὸν ἐκάστω

17d

S: And so, based upon their nature, we assigned each a single occupation appropriate to themselves, one skill to each. We said that those who must fight on behalf of everyone else were the only ones who should be guardians of the city. And if anyone from outside, or even from within, should proceed against it with ill intent, they should judge them gently if they were our own subjects and natural friends, and harshly if they encounter them in battle among our enemies.

πρόσφορον ἐν μόνον ἐπιτήδευμα, μίαν ἐκάστω τέχνην, τούτους οὖς πρὸ πάντων ἔδει πολεμεῖν, εἵπομεν ὡς ἄρ' αὐτοὺς δέοι φύλακας εἶναι μόνον τῆς πόλεως, εἴτε τις ἔξωθεν ἢ καὶ τῶν ἑνδοθεν ἰοὶ κακουργήσων, δικάζοντας μὲν πρῶως τοῖς

18a

T: Absolutely.

18a

S: Indeed, I think we said that something in the nature of the soul of the guardians must be both especially spirited but also philosophic at the same time so that it may be appropriately gentle or harsh to either party as required.

18a

T: Yes.

ἀρχομένοις ὑπ' αὐτῶν καὶ φύσει φίλοις οὖσιν, χαλεπούς δὲ ἐν ταῖς μάχαις τοῖς ἐντυγχάνουσιν τῶν ἐχθρῶν γιγνομένους. ΤΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. φύσιν γὰρ οἷμαί τινα τῶν φυλάκων τῆς ψυχῆς ἐλέγομεν ἅμα μὲν θυμοειδῆ, ἅμα δὲ φιλόσοφον δεῖν εἶναι διαφερόντως, ἵνα πρὸς ἑκατέρους δύναιντο ὀρθῶς πρᾶοι καὶ χαλεποὶ γίγνεσθαι. ΤΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δὲ τροφήν; ἄρ' οὐ γυμναστικῇ καὶ μουσικῇ μαθήμασιν τε ὅσα προσήκει τούτοις, ἐν ᾗπασι τεθράφθαι;

18b

S: What of their education? Aren't they to be educated in music and gymnastic and in all subjects proper to guardians?

18b

T: Entirely so.

18b

S: Yes, and it was said, I think, that those who have been educated in this way would never regard gold or silver or anything else as their own private possession, but, like soldiers who receive their guardians' pay from the people they protect, in measure appropriate to sound-minded men, they would spend it communally and live shared lives together, careful to ensure excellence in all their affairs whilst holding themselves aloof from other pursuits.

18b

T: We said all that too.

ΤΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. τοὺς δέ γε οὕτω τραφέντας ἐλέχθη που μήτε χρυσὸν μήτε ἄργυρον μήτε ἄλλο ποτὲ μηδὲν κτῆμα ἑαυτῶν ἴδιον νομίζειν δεῖν, ἀλλ' ὥς ἐπικούρους μισθὸν λαμβάνοντας τῆς φυλακῆς

παρὰ τῶν σωζομένων ὑπ' αὐτῶν, ὅσος σώφροσιν μέτριος, ἀναλίσκειν τε δὴ κοινῇ καὶ συνδιαιωμένους μετὰ ἀλλήλων ζῆν, ἐπιμέλειαν ἔχοντας ἀρετῆς διὰ παντός, τῶν ἄλλων ἐπιτηδευμάτων ἄγοντας σχολήν. ΤΙ. ἐλέχθη καὶ ταῦτα ταύτη.

18c

S: What is more, we also mentioned women, and said that their natures would be formed like the men's, and all the responsibilities would be allocated to all the women on a shared basis, whether they related to war or to everyday life.

18c

T: That too was stated.

18c

S: Now, what did we say about the procreation of children? Or is that easy to remember because what we said was so unusual? We proposed that all wives and children should be common to everybody, and we contrived that no one would ever recognise their own particular offspring, but they would all consider everyone else as their relatives, regarding them as brothers and sisters if they were within the appropriate age range, as parents and grandparents if they were older, and as children and grandchildren if they were younger.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὲν δὴ καὶ περὶ γυναικῶν ἐπεμνήσθημεν, ὡς τὰς φύσεις τοῖς ἀνδράσιν παραπλησίας εἶη συναρμοστέον, καὶ τὰ ἐπιτηδεύματα πάντα κοινὰ κατὰ τε πόλεμον καὶ κατὰ τὴν ἄλλην δίκαιαν δοτέον πάσαις. ΤΙ. ταύτη καὶ ταῦτα ἐλέγετο. ΣΩ. τί δὲ δὴ τὸ περὶ τῆς παιδοποιίας; ἢ τοῦτο μὲν διὰ τὴν ἀθήειαν τῶν λεχθέντων εὐμνημόνευτον, ὅτι κοινὰ τὰ τῶν γάμων καὶ τὰ τῶν παίδων πᾶσιν ἀπάντων ἐτίθεμεν, μηχανωμένους ὅπως μηδεὶς ποτε τὸ γεγεννημένον αὐτῶν ἰδίᾳ γνώσοιτο,

18d

T: Yes, and as you say, that is easy to remember.

18d

S: But, of course, you also recall how they were to be born with the most excellent natures possible. We said that the male and female

rulers must secretly arrange the marriage unions so that bad men and good men are assigned, by some lottery, exclusively to women of their own kind. No controversy would be created by this since they would assume that chance was responsible for the outcome.

18d

T: We remember.

18d

S: What is more, we actually said that the offspring of good people should be reared, whilst the offspring of bad people should be secretly handed over to another city. However, as they grow up, the rulers should be ever watchful to take the deserving ones back again, and let the undeserving ones among their own number take the place of those who have returned.

νομιούσιν δὲ πάντες πάντας αὐτοὺς ὁμογενεῖς, ἀδελφὰς μὲν καὶ ἀδελφοὺς ὅσοιπερ ἂν τῆς προεπούσης ἐντὸς ἡλικίας γίνωνται, τοὺς δ' ἔμπροσθεν καὶ ἄνωθεν γονέας τε καὶ γονέων προγόνους, τοὺς δ' εἰς τὸ κάτωθεν ἐκγόνους παῖδας τε ἐκγόνων; ΤΙ. ναί, καὶ ταῦτα εὐμνημόνευτα ἢ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ὅπως δὲ δὴ κατὰ δύναμιν εὐθὺς γίγνονται ὡς ἄριστοι τὰς φύσεις, ἃρ' οὐ μεμνήμεθα ὡς τοὺς ἄρχοντας ἔφαμεν καὶ τὰς ἀρχούσας δεῖν εἰς τὴν τῶν γάμων σύνερξιν λάθρα

18e

T: So we said.

18e

S: So, dear Timaeus, now that we have gone over the main points once more, have we now recounted exactly what was said yesterday or is there anything we still need to say because it was omitted?

μηχανᾶσθαι κλήροις τισὶν ὅπως οἱ κακοὶ χωρὶς οἱ τ' ἀγαθοὶ ταῖς ὁμοίαις ἐκάτεροι συλλήζονται, καὶ μή τις αὐτοῖς ἔχθρα διὰ ταῦτα γίγνηται, τύχην ἡγουμένοις αἰτίαν τῆς συλλήξεως; ΤΙ. μεμνήμεθα.

19a

T: Not at all, Socrates, these were the very things that were said.

19a

S: After all that we have recounted about the political system we have described, I would like you to hear the sort of feeling I have about it. Well, the feeling is something like this. It is as if someone who has seen beautiful animals, either in a picture or actually alive but remaining at rest, were to develop a desire to see them moving and also competing in a contest which seemed suited to their nature. I, too, feel just the same about the city we described. I would gladly listen to someone telling a story of contests the city engages in as it struggles against other cities, how it enters into war in the proper spirit and, in the conduct of the war, exhibits towards the various cities the qualities appropriate to its education and nurture both in its actions and negotiations, in what it does and in what it says. Now, in all this, Critias and Hermocrates, I have come to realise that I myself am quite unable to sing the praises of these men and this city adequately. In my own case, this is no wonder, but I have also come to have the same opinion of the poets, both ancient and modern. It is not that I disrespect poets as a class, but it is obvious to everyone that the imitative folk will imitate whatever they have been brought up in most easily and excellently. However, anything that lies outside their own upbringing is difficult for them to imitate well in action, and even more difficult in words.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ὅτι γε τὰ μὲν τῶν ἀγαθῶν θρεπτέον ἔφαμεν εἶναι, τὰ δὲ τῶν κακῶν εἰς τὴν ἄλλην λάθρα διαδοτέον πόλιν· ἐπαυξανομένων δὲ σκοποῦντας αἰεὶ τοὺς ἀξιούς· πάλιν ἀνάγειν δεῖν, τοὺς δὲ παρὰ σφίσιν ἀναξίους εἰς τὴν τῶν ἐπανιόντων χώραν μεταλλάττειν; ΤΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν δὴ διεληλύθαμεν ἤδη καθάπερ χθές, ὥς ἐν κεφαλαίοις πάλιν ἐπανελθεῖν, ἢ ποθοῦμεν ἔτι τι τῶν ῥηθέντων, ᾧ φίλε Γίμαιε, ὥς ἀπολειπόμενον; ΤΙ. οὐδαμῶς, ἀλλὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτ' ἦν τὰ λεχθέντα, ᾧ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀκούοιτ' ἂν ἥδη τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα περὶ τῆς πολιτείας ἣν διήλθομεν, οἷόν τι πρὸς αὐτὴν πεπονθὼς τυγχάνω. προσέοικεν δὲ δὴ τινὶ μοι τοιῷδε τὸ πάθος, οἷον εἴ τις ζῶα καλὰ που θεασάμενος, εἴτε ὑπὸ γραφῆς εἰργασμένα εἴτε καὶ ζῶντα ἀληθινῶς ἡσυχίαν δὲ ἄγοντα, εἰς ἐπιθυμίαν ἀφίκοιτο θεάσασθαι κινούμενά τε αὐτὰ καὶ τι τῶν τοῖς

σώμασιν δοκούντων προσήκειν κατὰ τὴν ἀγωνίαν ἀθλοῦντα ταῦτόν καὶ ἐγὼ πέπονθα πρὸς τὴν πόλιν ἣν διήλθομεν. ἡδέως γὰρ ἂν του λόγῳ διεξιόντος ἀκούσαιμ' ἂν ἄθλους οὓς πόλις ἀθλεῖ, τούτους αὐτὴν ἀγωνιζομένην πρὸς πόλεις ἄλλας, πρεπόντως εἷς τε πόλεμον ἀφικομένην καὶ ἐν τῷ πολεμεῖν τὰ προσήκοντα ἀποδιδούσαν τῇ παιδείᾳ καὶ τροφῇ κατὰ τε τὰς ἐν τοῖς ἔργοις πράξεις καὶ κατὰ τὰς ἐν τοῖς λόγοις διερμηνεύσεις πρὸς ἐκάστας τῶν πόλεων. ταῦτ' οὖν, ὦ Κριτία καὶ Ἑρμόκρατες, ἐμαυτοῦ μὲν αὐτὸς κατέγνωκα μή ποτ' ἂν δυνατὸς γενέσθαι τοὺς ἄνδρας καὶ τὴν πόλιν ἱκανῶς ἐγκωμιάσαι. καὶ τὸ μὲν ἐμὸν οὐδὲν θαυμαστόν· ἀλλὰ τὴν αὐτὴν δόξαν εἴληφα καὶ περὶ τῶν πάλαι γεγονότων καὶ περὶ τῶν νῦν ὄντων ποιητῶν, οὗτι τὸ ποιητικὸν ἀτιμάζων γένος, ἀλλὰ παντὶ δῆλον ὡς τὸ μιμητικὸν ἔθνος, οἷς ἂν ἐντραφῇ, ταῦτα μιμήσεται ῥᾶστα καὶ ἄριστα, τὸ δ' ἐκτὸς τῆς τροφῆς ἐκάστοις

19c

S: And I believe the sophists as a class, for their part, are very experienced in long speeches and other fineries. Yet, because they wander from city to city and have no city of their own, I fear that they may somehow misunderstand men who are at once both philosophers and statesmen, and all that such men would be able to do and say as they engage actively in war and fight battles or communicate verbally with others. What is left then is the class with your disposition, which, by nature and upbringing, possesses both characteristics simultaneously.

γινόμενον χαλεπὸν μὲν ἔργοις, ἔτι δὲ χαλεπώτερον λόγοις εὖ μιμεῖσθαι. τὸ δὲ τῶν σοφιστῶν γένος αὖ πολλῶν μὲν λόγων καὶ καλῶν ἄλλων μάλ' ἔμπειρον ἡγῆμαι, φοβοῦμαι δὲ μή πως, ἅτε πλανητὸν ὄν κατὰ πόλεις οἰκήσεις τε ἰδίας οὐδαμῇ διωκηκός, ἄστοχον ἅμα φιλοσόφων ἀνδρῶν ἧ καὶ πολιτικῶν, ὅς' ἂν οἶά τε ἐν πολέμῳ καὶ μάχαις πράττοντες ἔργῳ καὶ λόγῳ προσομιλοῦντες ἐκάστοις πράττοιεν καὶ λέγοιεν. ΣΩ. καταλέλειπται δὴ τὸ τῆς ὑμετέρας ἐξέως γένος,

20a

S: Indeed, Timaeus here is from Locri, the best governed city in Italy, and he is superior to any man there in property and family connections. He has been involved in the highest offices and honours of that city, and he has also, in my opinion, reached the very pinnacle in matters of philosophy. And I presume everyone in this city knows that Critias is no amateur in the matters we are discussing. As for Hermocrates, we must believe the many witnesses who say that he is competent in all these matters, both by nature and by his upbringing.

ἅμα ἀμφοτέρων φύσει καὶ τροφῇ μετέχον. Τίμαιός τε γὰρ ὅδε, εὐνομωτάτης ὦν πόλεως τῆς ἐν Ἰταλίᾳ Λοκρίδος, οὐσίᾳ καὶ γένει οὐδενὸς ὕστερος ὦν τῶν ἐκεῖ, τὰς μεγίστας μὲν ἀρχάς τε καὶ τιμὰς τῶν ἐν τῇ πόλει μετακεχείρισται, φιλοσοφίας δ' αὖ κατ' ἐμὴν δόξαν ἐπ' ἄκρον ἀπάσης ἐλήλυθεν. Κριτίαν δέ που πάντες οἱ τῇδε ἴσμεν οὐδενὸς ἰδιώτην ὄντα ὦν λέγομεν. τῆς δὲ Ἑρμοκράτους αὖ περὶ φύσεως καὶ τροφῆς, πρὸς ἅπαντα ταῦτ' εἶναι ἱκανὴν πολλῶν μαρτυρούντων

20b

S: Now, this is what I had in mind yesterday when you asked me to speak about the political system in general, so I agreed readily since I knew that no one would present a better account of the next topic than yourselves, if you were willing. Indeed, you are the only men today who could engage the city in some suitable war and display all the qualities appropriate to it. So when I had finished speaking on my assignment, I, in turn, assigned you the topics I am now describing. So, having considered this together among yourselves, you have now agreed to pay me back with a feast of words. Here I am then, adorned for the occasion, and more ready than anyone to receive your gift.

πιστευτέον. διὸ καὶ χθὲς ἐγὼ διανοούμενος, ὑμῶν δεομένων τὰ περὶ τῆς πολιτείας διελθεῖν, προθύμως ἐχαρίζομην, εἰδὼς ὅτι τὸν ἐξῆς λόγον οὐδένες ἂν ὑμῶν ἐθελόντων ἱκανώτερον ἀποδοῖεν—εἰς γὰρ πόλεμον πρόποντα καταστήσαντες τὴν πόλιν ἅπαντ' αὐτῇ τὰ προσήκοντα ἀποδοῖτ' ἂν μόνοι τῶν νῦν—εἰπὼν δὴ τὰπιταχθέντα

ἀντεπέταξα ὑμῖν ἃ καὶ νῦν λέγω. συνωμολογήσατ' οὖν κοινῇ
σκεψάμενοι πρὸς ὑμᾶς

20c

HE: Yes indeed, Socrates, just as Timaeus here says, we shall not be short of enthusiasm, nor have we any excuse whatsoever for not doing as you ask. Accordingly, we considered these very issues as soon as we left here yesterday and arrived at Critias' guest quarters where we are staying, and even before that, on the road. In fact, he told us a story which he heard long ago. Tell the story to Socrates now, Critias, so that he can help us decide whether it is relevant to our assignment or irrelevant.

αὐτοὺς εἰς νῦν ἀνταποδώσειν μοι τὰ τῶν λόγων ξένια, πάρειμί τε οὖν
δὴ κεκοσμημένος ἐπ' αὐτὰ καὶ πάντων ἐτοιμότητος ὦν δέχεσθαι. ΕΡ.
καὶ μὲν δὴ, καθάπερ εἶπεν Τίμαιος ὅδε, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὔτε ἐλλείψομεν
προθυμίας οὐδὲν οὔτε ἔστιν οὐδεμία πρόφασις ἡμῖν τοῦ μὴ δρᾶν ταῦτα·
ὥστε καὶ χθές, εὐθύς ἐνθὲνδε ἐπειδὴ παρὰ Κριτίαν πρὸς τὸν ξενῶνα οὔ
καὶ καταλύομεν ἀφικόμεθα, καὶ ἔτι πρότερον καθ' ὁδὸν αὐτὰ ταῦτ'
ἐσκοποῦμεν.

20d

CI: That's what I must do if our third companion, Timaeus, also agrees.

20d

T: I certainly agree.

20d

CI: Then listen, Socrates, to a story which is strange and yet entirely true, as Solon,² the wisest of the Seven Sages, once declared. He was a kinsman and close friend of our great-grandfather Dropides, as he himself also says many times in his poetry. Dropides then told it to Critias, our grandfather, and the old man, in turn, used to recount it to us. The story recounts that the ancient deeds of this city of ours were wonderful and great, but they have been obliterated by time and the destructions of humanity. It would be appropriate for us to recall one of these deeds now, the greatest of them all, in order to show our

gratitude to you and, at the same time, to praise the goddess rightly and truly on her festival,³ as though we were singing a hymn.

ὁδε οὖν ἡμῖν λόγον εἰσηγήσατο ἐκ παλαιᾶς ἀκοῆς ὃν καὶ νῦν λέγε, ὦ Κριτία, τῷδε, ἵνα συνδοκιμάσῃ πρὸς τὴν ἐπίταξιν εἴτ' ἐπιτήδειος εἴτε ἀνεπιτήδειός ἐστι. ΚΡ. ταῦτα χρὴ δρᾶν, εἰ καὶ τῷ τρίτῳ κοινωνῶ Τιμαίῳ συνδοκεῖ. ΤΙ. δοκεῖ μὴν. ΚΡ. ἄκουε δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες, λόγου μάλα μὲν ἀτόπου, παντάπασί γε μὴν ἀληθοῦς, ὡς ὁ τῶν ἐπὶ σοφώτατος

20e

S: That is all very well, but what was this ancient deed of this city of ours, a deed no longer mentioned, which Critias recounted on the authority of Solon as actual fact?

Σόλων ποτ' ἔφη. ἦν μὲν οὖν οἰκεῖος καὶ σφόδρα φίλος ἡμῖν Δρωπίδου τοῦ προπάππου, καθάπερ λέγει πολλαχοῦ καὶ αὐτὸς ἐν τῇ ποιήσει. ΚΡ. πρὸς δὲ Κριτίαν τὸν ἡμέτερον πάππον εἶπεν, ὡς ἀπεμνημόνευεν αὐτὸς πρὸς ἡμᾶς ὁ γέρων, ὅτι μεγάλα καὶ θαυμαστά τῆσδ' εἶη παλαιὰ ἔργα τῆς πόλεως ὑπὸ χρόνου καὶ φθορᾶς ἀνθρώπων ἠφανισμένα, πάντων δὲ ἐν μέγιστον,

21a

Ci: I'll tell you an ancient tale which I heard from a man no longer young. Indeed, Critias was then, as he said, already close to ninety years old, while I was, at the most, ten. It happened to be the children's day of the festival of Apaturia,⁴ and the traditional event of the festival was also held as usual for the children, at which our fathers arranged a recitation contest for us. Many poems by many poets were recited, but since Solon's poems were new at the time, many of the boys chanted them. One of the clansmen said – either because he believed it or even to pay a compliment to Critias – that he thought that Solon was the wisest of men in every respect, but also, in view of his poetry, the noblest of all poets. Then the old man – yes indeed, I remember it so vividly – was very pleased, and he smiled and said,

οὗ νῦν ἐπιμνησθεῖσιν πρέπον ἂν ἡμῖν εἴη σοί τε ἀποδοῦναι χάριν καὶ τὴν θεὸν ἅμα ἐν τῇ πανηγύρει δικαίως τε καὶ ἀληθῶς οἰόνπερ

ὕμνουντας ἐγκωμιάζειν. ΣΩ. εὖ λέγεις. ἀλλὰ δὴ ποῖον ἔργον τοῦτο Κριτίας οὐ λεγόμενον μὲν, ὡς δὲ πραχθὲν ὄντως ὑπὸ τῆσδε τῆς πόλεως ἀρχαῖον διηγέιτο κατὰ τὴν Σόλωνος ἀκοήν; ΚΡ. ἐγὼ φράσω, παλαιὸν ἀκηκοὺς λόγον οὐ νέου ἀνδρός. ἦν μὲν γὰρ δὴ τότε Κριτίας, ὡς ἔφη, σχεδὸν ἐγγὺς ἦδη τῶν ἐνενήκοντα ἐτῶν, ἐγὼ δὲ πη μάλιστα δεκέτης· ἡ δὲ Κουρεῶτις ἡμῖν οὕσα ἐτύγχανεν Ἀπατουρίων. τὸ δὲ τῆς ἐορτῆς σύνθηες ἐκάστοτε καὶ τότε συνέβη τοῖς παισίν· ἄθλα γὰρ ἡμῖν οἱ πατέρες ἔθεσαν ῥαψωδίας. πολλῶν μὲν οὖν δὴ καὶ πολλὰ ἐλέχθη ποιητῶν ποιήματα, ἅτε δὲ νέα κατ' ἐκείνους τὸν χρόνον ὄντα τὰ Σόλωνος πολλοὶ τῶν παίδων ᾔσαμεν. εἶπεν οὖν τις τῶν φρατέρων, εἴτε δὴ δοκοῦν αὐτῷ τότε εἴτε καὶ χάριν τινὰ τῷ Κριτίᾳ φέρων, δοκεῖν οἱ τά τε

21c

CI: "Amynder, if Solon had not treated poetry as a distraction but had worked at it as others do and completed the story which he brought here from Egypt, and had not been forced to neglect it due to the conflicts and the other problems he found here when he returned, then in my opinion neither Hesiod nor Homer nor any other poet would ever have been more famous than he."

21c

CI: "What was the story, Critias?" he asked.

21c

CI: "It concerns the greatest deed this city has ever performed," he replied. "It deserves to be its most renowned achievement, but through lapse of time and the destruction of those who were involved, the story has not survived here."

ἄλλα σοφώτατον γεγονέναι Σόλωνα καὶ κατὰ τὴν ποίησιν αὖ τῶν ποιητῶν πάντων ἐλευθεριώτατον. ὁ δὲ γέρων— σφόδρα γὰρ οὖν μέμνημαι—μάλα τε ἥσθη καὶ διαμειδιάσας εἶπεν· εἴ γε, ὦ Ἀμύνανδρε, μὴ παρέργῳ τῇ ποιήσει κατεχρήσατο, ἀλλ' ἐσπουδάκει καθάπερ ἄλλοι, τόν τε λόγον ὃν ἀπ' Αἰγύπτου δεῦρο ἠνέγκατο ἀπετέλεσεν, καὶ μὴ διὰ τὰς στάσεις ὑπὸ κακῶν τε ἄλλων ὅσα ἡὔρεν ἐνθάδε ἥκων ἠναγκάσθη

21d

C1: "Tell it from the beginning," he said. "What story did Solon tell, and how did he hear it and who told him it was true?"

καταμελήσαι, κατὰ γε ἐμὴν δόξαν οὔτε Ἡσίοδος οὔτε Ὀμηρος οὔτε ἄλλος οὐδείς ποιητὴς εὐδοκιμώτερος ἐγένετο ἂν ποτε αὐτοῦ. τίς δ' ἦν ὁ λόγος, ἧ δ' ὅς, ὦ Κριτία; ἧ περὶ μεγίστης, ἔφη, καὶ ὀνομαστοτάτης πασῶν δικαιοτάτ' ἂν πράξεως οὔσης, ἣν ἦδε ἡ πόλις ἔπραξε μὲν, διὰ δὲ χρόνον καὶ φθορὰν τῶν ἐργασαμένων οὐ διήρκεσε δεῦρο ὁ λόγος. λέγε ἐξ ἀρχῆς, ἧ δ' ὅς, τί τε καὶ πῶς καὶ παρὰ τίνων ὡς ἀληθῆ διακηκοὺς ἔλεγεν ὁ Σόλων.

21e

C1: "In the Egyptian Delta," Critias said "near where the stream of the Nile divides at its estuary, there is a region called the Saïtic, and the largest city of this region is Saïs. King Amasis came from there. The god who founded the city is called Neith in Egyptian, and those people say this is Athena in Greek. They are great lovers of Athens and they claim to be related to us in some way. In fact, Solon said that when he travelled there they held him in great respect. And what's more, on one occasion, when he put a question about ancient times to the priests with most experience of such matters, he discovered that, in a sense, neither he nor any other Greek whatsoever knows the slightest thing about them. Once, Solon wanted to draw them into a discussion about antiquity, so he began to relate the most ancient stories from Athens, about Phoroneus, who is said to be the first man, and about Niobe. And he went on to tell the story of the flood and how Deucalion and Pyrrha survived it,⁵ and the family histories of these people, and he tried to estimate the time periods by recalling the exact number of years since the events he described.

ἔστιν τις κατ' Αἴγυπτον, ἧ δ' ὅς, ἐν τῷ Δέλτα, περὶ ὃν κατὰ κορυφὴν σχίζεται τὸ τοῦ Νείλου ῥεῦμα Σαΐτικὸς ἐπικαλούμενος νομός, τούτου δὲ τοῦ νομοῦ μεγίστη πόλις Σαῖς—ὅθεν δὴ καὶ Ἀμασις ἦν ὁ βασιλεὺς—οἷς τῆς πόλεως θεὸς ἀρχηγός τίς ἐστιν, Αἰγυπτιστὶ μὲν τοῦνομα Νηίθ, Ἑλληνιστὶ δέ, ὡς ὁ ἐκείνων λόγος, Ἀθηναῖ· μάλα δὲ φιλαθῆναι καὶ

τινα τρόπον οἰκεῖοι τῶνδ' εἶναί φασιν. ΚΡ. οἳ δὴ Σόλων ἔφη πορευθεὶς σφόδρα τε γενέσθαι παρ' αὐτοῖς ἔντιμος,

22a

C1: "Then, one of the priests, who was a very old man, said, 'O Solon, Solon, you Greeks are ever children! There is no Greek who is an old man.' When he heard this, Solon asked: 'How can you say this?'

καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ παλαιὰ ἀνερωτῶν ποτε τοὺς μάλιστα περὶ ταῦτα τῶν ἱερέων ἐμπεύρους, σχεδὸν οὔτε αὐτὸν οὔτε ἄλλον Ἑλληνα οὐδένα οὐδὲν ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν εἰδότα περὶ τῶν τοιούτων ἀνευρεῖν. καὶ ποτε προαγαγεῖν βουλευθεὶς αὐτοὺς περὶ τῶν ἀρχαίων εἰς λόγους, τῶν τῆδε τὰ ἀρχαιότατα λέγειν ἐπιχειρεῖν, περὶ Φορωνέως τε τοῦ πρώτου λεχθέντος καὶ Νιόβης, καὶ μετὰ τὸν κατακλυσμὸν αὖ περὶ Δευκαλίωνος

22b

C1: "'You are all young in soul,' the priest said. 'Your souls do not possess a single doctrine heard of old, or any teaching grey with age. The reason is as follows. There have been, and will be, many destructions of humanity by various means, the most significant being by fire and water, the lesser kinds by myriad other means. In fact, you Athenians also have the story of how Phaethon, the child of the Sun, once harnessed his father's chariot, but because he was not able to drive it along the path of the Sun, he brought fire upon the Earth and was himself killed by a thunderbolt. Now, this is told in the form of a myth, but the truth is that there is an alteration of the motion of the heavenly bodies travelling around the Earth, and at regular long intervals destruction is wrought upon the Earth's surface by an enormous fire. When this happens, those who live in mountains or high places or dry places suffer greater destruction than maritime or river-dwelling folk.

καὶ Πύρρας ὡς διεγένοντο μυθολογεῖν, καὶ τοὺς ἐξ αὐτῶν γενεαλογεῖν, καὶ τὰ τῶν ἐτῶν ὅσα ἦν οἷς ἔλεγεν πειρᾶσθαι διαμνημονεύων τοὺς χρόνους ἀριθμεῖν· καὶ τινα εἰπεῖν τῶν ἱερέων εὖ μάλα παλαιόν· ὃ Σόλων, Σόλων, Ἑλληνες αἰεὶ παῖδες ἐστε, γέρων δὲ Ἑλλήν οὐκ ἔστιν.

ἀκούσας οὖν, πῶς τί τοῦτο λέγεις; φάναι. νέοι ἐστέ, εἰπεῖν, τὰς ψυχὰς πάντες· οὐδεμίαν γὰρ ἐν αὐταῖς ἔχετε δι' ἀρχαίαν ἀκοήν παλαιὰν δόξαν οὐδὲ μάθημα χρόνῳ πολὺν οὐδέν. τὸ δὲ τούτων αἴτιον τόδε. πολλὰ κατὰ πολλὰ φθοραὶ γεγόνασιν ἀνθρώπων καὶ ἔσονται, πυρὶ μὲν καὶ ὕδατι μέγισται, μυρίοις δὲ ἄλλοις ἕτεραι βραχύτεραι. τὸ γὰρ οὖν καὶ παρ' ὑμῖν λεγόμενον, ὥς ποτε Φαέθων Ἥλιου παῖς τὸ τοῦ πατρὸς ἄρμα ζεύξας διὰ τὸ μὴ δυνατὸς εἶναι κατὰ τὴν τοῦ πατρὸς ὁδὸν ἐλαύνειν τὰ τ' ἐπὶ γῆς συνέκαυσεν καὶ αὐτὸς κεραυνωθεὶς διεφθάρη, τοῦτο μύθου μὲν σχῆμα ἔχον λέγεται, τὸ δὲ

22d

C1: "The Nile, which is always our saviour, also saves us from this difficulty on such occasions by its rising. But whenever the gods flood the Earth with water to purify it, the shepherds and herdsmen in the mountains are saved, while those who dwell in your cities are swept out to sea by the rivers. However, in this land of ours, water does not pour down on the fields from above – not then, not ever – but on the contrary, it all comes up naturally from below. That's the reason why the records preserved here are said to be most ancient of all. The truth is that in all places where excess heat or cold do not prevent it, there is always a human race, sometimes in greater numbers, sometimes in lesser. And whatever events we hear about in your country or in ours, or anywhere else, that are somehow noble or significant or special in some other way, have all been written down in the temples here from ancient times and preserved.

ἀληθές ἐστι τῶν περὶ γῆν κατ' οὐρανὸν ἰόντων παράλλαξις καὶ διὰ μακρῶν χρόνων γιγνομένη τῶν ἐπὶ γῆς πυρὶ πολλῷ φθορά. τότε οὖν ὅσοι κατ' ὄρη καὶ ἐν ὑψηλοῖς τόποις καὶ ἐν ξηροῖς οἰκοῦσιν μᾶλλον διόλλυνται τῶν ποταμοῖς καὶ θαλάττῃ προσοικούντων· ἡμῖν δὲ ὁ Νεῖλος εἰς τε τᾶλλα σωτὴρ καὶ τότε ἐκ ταύτης τῆς ἀπορίας σώζει λυόμενος. ὅταν δ' αὖ θεοὶ τὴν γῆν ὕδασι καθαίροντες κατακλύζωσιν, οἱ μὲν ἐν τοῖς ὄρεσιν διασώζονται βουκόλοι νομῆς τε, οἱ δ' ἐν ταῖς παρ' ὑμῖν πόλεσιν εἰς τὴν θάλατταν ὑπὸ τῶν ποταμῶν φέρονται· κατὰ δὲ τήνδε χώραν οὔτε τότε οὔτε ἄλλοτε ἄνωθεν ἐπὶ τὰς ἀρούρας ὕδωρ

ἐπιρρεῖ, τὸ δ' ἐναντίον κάτωθεν πᾶν ἐπανιέναι πέφυκεν. ΚΡ. ὅθεν καὶ δι' ἃς αἰτίας τὰνθάδε σωζόμενα λέγεται παλαιότατα τὸ δὲ ἀληθές, ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς τόποις ὅπου μὴ χειμῶν ἐξαίσιος ἢ καὶ ὑμῶν ἀπείργει, πλέον, τότε δὲ ἔλαττον αἰεὶ γένος ἐστὶν ἀνθρώπων. ὅσα δὲ ἢ παρ' ὑμῖν ἢ τῇδε ἢ καὶ κατ' ἄλλον τόπον ὧν ἀκοῇ ἴσμεν, εἴ ποὺ τι καλὸν ἢ μέγα γέγονεν ἢ καὶ τινα διαφορὰν ἄλλην ἔχον, πάντα γεγραμμένα ἐκ παλαιοῦ τῇδ' ἐστὶν ἐν τοῖς ἱεροῖς καὶ σεσωσμένα· τὰ δὲ παρ' ὑμῖν καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἄρτι κατεσκευασμένα ἐκάστοτε τυγχάνει γράμμασι καὶ ἅπασιν ὁπόσων πόλεις δέονται, καὶ πάλιν δι' εἰωθότων ἐτῶν ὥσπερ νόσημα ἤκει φερόμενον αὐτοῖς ῥεῦμα οὐράνιον καὶ τοὺς ἀγραμμάτους

23b

C1: "But in the case of yourselves and the other cities, as soon as you have been equipped with writing and whatever else a city requires, every time, after the usual cycle of years, the flood from Heaven arrives once more, bearing down upon you like a plague, leaving only the illiterate and uncultured among you, so that you become like children all over again, with no knowledge of events of ancient times, either here or among yourselves. Take the genealogies you have just recounted about your own people, Solon. These are little better than children's stories. In the first place, you remember only one flood, though many occurred before that, and then you do not realise that the noblest and most excellent race in the history of humanity once lived in your own country. You and your entire city are descended from this race, from a small remnant of their seed, but you are unaware of this because, for many generations, those who survived left no written records when they died. But there was once a time, Solon, before the greatest ever destruction by water, when the city that is now Athens was better than any in war, and supremely well governed in every respect. Its deeds were reputed to have been the noblest, and the conduct of its affairs the fairest of any city we have heard of under Heaven.'

τε καὶ ἀμούσους ἔλιπεν ὑμῶν, ὥστε πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς οἷον νέοι γίγνεσθε, οὐδὲν εἰδότες οὔτε τῶν τῇδε οὔτε τῶν παρ' ὑμῖν, ὅσα ἦν ἐν τοῖς

παλαιοῖς χρόνοις. τὰ γοῦν νυνδὴ γενεαλογηθέντα, ὧ Σόλων, περὶ τῶν παρ' ὑμῖν ἃ διήλθες, παίδων βραχὺ τι διαφέρει μύθων, οἱ πρῶτον μὲν ἓνα γῆς κατακλυσμὸν μέμνησθε πολλῶν ἔμπροσθεν γεγονότων, ἔτι δὲ τὸ κάλλιστον καὶ ἄριστον γένος ἐπ' ἀνθρώπους ἐν τῇ χώρᾳ παρ' ὑμῖν οὐκ ἴστε γεγονός, ἐξ ὧν σύ τε καὶ πᾶσα ἡ πόλις ἔστιν τὰ νῦν ὑμῶν, περιλειφθέντος ποτὲ σπέρματος βραχέος, ἀλλ' ὑμᾶς λέληθεν διὰ τὸ τοὺς περιγενομένους ἐπὶ πολλὰς γενεὰς γράμμασιν τελευτᾶν ἀφώνους. ἦν γὰρ δὴ ποτε, ὧ Σόλων, ὑπὲρ τὴν μεγίστην φθορὰν ὕδασιν ἡ νῦν Ἀθηναίων οὖσα πόλις ἀρίστη πρὸς τε τὸν πόλεμον καὶ κατὰ πάντα εὐνομωτάτῃ διαφερόντως· ἥ κάλλιστα ἔργα καὶ πολιτεῖαι γενέσθαι λέγονται κάλλισται πασῶν ὁπόσων ὑπὸ

23d

Cr: "When he heard this, Solon said he was amazed, and in all earnestness he asked the priests to recount everything about the ancient citizens of Athens, precisely and in due order. The priest replied, 'No one will grudge you this, Solon, so I shall tell you the story for your sake and for the sake of your city, but especially in gratitude to the goddess who has adopted, nurtured and educated your city and ours. Your city was first by a thousand years, taking your seed from earth and Hephaestus, while our city here came later. The civilisation here is recorded in our sacred writings as being eight thousand years old. So I shall be giving you a brief overview of your citizens from nine thousand years ago, their laws, and the most splendid of the deeds they performed. But we shall go over everything in detail and due order some other time at leisure when we access the actual records.

τὸν οὐρανὸν ἡμεῖς ἀκοὴν παρεδεξάμεθα. ἀκούσας οὖν ὁ Σόλων ἔφη θαυμάσαι καὶ πᾶσαν προθυμίαν σχεῖν δεόμενος τῶν ἱερέων πάντα δι' ἀκριβείας οἱ τὰ περὶ τῶν πάλαι πολιτῶν ἐξῆς διελθεῖν. τὸν οὖν ἱερέα φάναι· φθόνος οὐδεὶς, ὧ Σόλων, ἀλλὰ σοῦ τε ἔνεκα ἐρῶ καὶ τῆς πόλεως ὑμῶν, μάλιστα δὲ τῆς θεοῦ χάριν, ἣ τὴν τε ὑμετέραν καὶ τήνδε ἔλαχεν καὶ ἔθρεψεν καὶ ἐπαίδευσεν, προτέραν μὲν τὴν παρ' ὑμῖν ἔτεσιν χιλίοις, ἐκ Γῆς τε καὶ Ἑφαίστου τὸ σπέρμα παραλαβοῦσα ὑμῶν, τήνδε δὲ ὑστέραν. τῆς δὲ ἐνθάδε διακοσμήσεως παρ' ἡμῖν ἐν τοῖς ἱεροῖς

γράμμασιν ὀκτακισχιλίων ἐτῶν ἀριθμὸς γέγραπται. περὶ δὴ τῶν ἐνακισχίλια γεγονότων ἔτη πολιτῶν σοι δηλώσω διὰ βραχέων νόμους, καὶ τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῖς ὃ κάλλιστον ἐπράχθη· ΚΡ. τὸ δ' ἀκριβὲς περὶ

24a

C1: "Now, compare your laws with ours, for you will find many examples of your ancient laws in operation here today. Firstly, the priestly class is kept apart from the others. Then, the class of manufacturers works by itself and does not mix with another, and the same applies to herdsmen, hunters and farmers. What's more, the warrior class here, I presume you have noticed, is kept apart from all the other classes, as they are enjoined by law to be concerned with nothing except military matters. And even the style of our armour is based on shields and spears which we were the first people in Asia to adopt, as the goddess instructed us in this, just as she first instructed you in your region.

πάντων ἐφεξῆς εἰς αὐθις κατὰ σχολὴν αὐτὰ τὰ γράμματα λαβόντες διέξιμεν. τοὺς μὲν οὖν νόμους σκοπεῖ πρὸς τοὺς τῆδε· πολλὰ γὰρ παραδείγματα τῶν τότε παρ' ὑμῖν ὄντων ἐνθάδε νῦν ἀνευρήσεις, πρῶτον μὲν τὸ τῶν ἱερέων γένος ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων χωρὶς ἀφωρισμένον, μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο τὸ τῶν δημιουργῶν, ὅτι καθ' αὐτὸ ἕκαστον ἄλλω δὲ οὐκ ἐπιμειγνόμενον δημιουργεῖ, τό τε τῶν νομέων καὶ τὸ τῶν θηρευτῶν τό τε

24b

C1: "Furthermore, I presume you observe the extent to which tradition in Egypt has been concerned, from the very outset, with wisdom and the Universe, discovering everything right down to prophecy and medicine for health by applying those divine considerations to human concerns, and mastering all other learning that derives from these. Now, this is, in fact, the overall structure and regulation which the goddess devised at the time she first founded your city, selecting the place in which you were born because she saw that the temperate climate there would produce the wisest men. Seeing that the goddess was a lover of war and a lover of wisdom, she

chose the place likely to produce men who were most akin to herself, and there she first founded a city where you dwelt, adopting such regulations as these. Indeed, you were even better regulated, having surpassed all other peoples in every kind of excellence, just as you would expect from a people born from and educated by the gods.

τῶν γεωργῶν. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ μάχιμον γένος ἤσθησαί που τῇδε ἀπὸ πάντων τῶν γενῶν κεχωρισμένον, οἷς οὐδὲν ἄλλο πλὴν τὰ περὶ τὸν πόλεμον ὑπὸ τοῦ νόμου προσετάχθη μέλειν· ἔτι δὲ ἡ τῆς ὀπλίσεως αὐτῶν σχέσις ἀσπίδων καὶ δοράτων, οἷς ἡμεῖς πρῶτοι τῶν περὶ τὴν Ἀσίαν ὠπλίσαμεθα, τῆς θεοῦ καθάπερ ἐν ἐκείνοις τοῖς τόποις παρ' ὑμῖν πρῶτοις ἐνδειξαμένης. τὸ δ' αὖ περὶ τῆς φρονήσεως, ὁρᾷς που τὸν νόμον τῇδε ὅσῃ ἐπιμέλειαν ἐποίησατο εὐθὺς κατ' ἀρχὰς περὶ τε τὸν κόσμον, ἅπαντα μέχρι μαντικῆς καὶ ἰατρικῆς πρὸς ὑγίειαν ἐκ τούτων θείων ὄντων εἰς τὰ ἀνθρώπινα ἀνευρών, ὅσα τε ἄλλα τούτοις ἔπεται μαθήματα πάντα κτησάμενος. ταύτην οὖν δὴ τότε σύμπασαν τὴν διακόσμησιν καὶ σύνταξιν ἡ θεὸς προτέρους ὑμᾶς διακοσμήσασα κατώκισεν, ἐκλεξαμένη τὸν τόπον ἐν ᾧ γεγέννησθε, τὴν εὐκρασίαν τῶν ὥρων ἐν αὐτῷ κατιδοῦσα, ὅτι φρονιμωτάτους ἄνδρας οἷσοι ἅτε οὖν φιλοπόλεμός

24d

C1: "Now, the numerous great deeds of your city that are recorded here are a wonder, but there is one which surpasses them all in importance and excellence. For our records tell how great a power it was that once surged forth from the Atlantic Ocean and proceeded violently against all of Europe and Asia at the same time, a power which your city stopped. In fact, the ocean in the area was navigable then, and there was an island in front of the strait which your people tell me they call the Pillars of Heracles.⁶ This island was bigger than Africa and Asia together, and it was possible in those days for travellers to get from there to the other islands, and from the islands to the entire adjacent continent which surrounds that real ocean. For these places that are inside the strait we are speaking of resemble a harbour

with a narrow entrance, but the ocean outside is a real ocean, and the land that surrounds it may truly and correctly be termed a continent.

τε καὶ φιλόσοφος ἡ θεὸς οὕσα τὸν προσφερεστάτους αὐτῇ μέλλοντα οἴσιν τόπον ἄνδρας, τοῦτον ἐκλεξαμένη πρῶτον κατῴκισεν. ὥκεῖτε δὴ οὖν νόμοις τε τοιοῦτοις χρώμενοι καὶ ἔτι μᾶλλον εὐνομούμενοι πάσῃ τε παρὰ πάντας ἀνθρώπους ὑπερβεβληκότες ἀρετῇ, καθάπερ εἰκὸς γεννήματα καὶ παιδεύματα θεῶν ὄντας. πολλὰ μὲν οὖν ὑμῶν καὶ μεγάλα ἔργα τῆς πόλεως τῇδε γεγραμμένα θαυμάζεται, πάντων μὴν ἐν ὑπερέχει μεγέθει καὶ ἀρετῇ λέγει γὰρ τὰ γεγραμμένα ὅσῃν ἡ πόλις ὑμῶν ἔπαυσέν ποτε δύναμιν ὕβρει πορευομένην ἅμα ἐπὶ πᾶσαν Εὐρώπην καὶ Ἀσίαν, ἔξωθεν ὀρμηθεῖσαν ἐκ τοῦ Ἀτλαντικοῦ πελάγους. ΚΡ. τότε γὰρ πορεύσιμον ἦν τὸ ἐκεῖ πέλαγος· νῆσον γὰρ πρὸ τοῦ στόματος εἶχεν ὃ καλεῖτε, ὡς φατε, ὑμεῖς Ἡρακλέους στήλας, ἡ δὲ νῆσος ἅμα Λιβύης ἦν καὶ Ἀσίας μείζων, ἐξ ἧς ἐπιβατὸν ἐπὶ τὰς ἄλλας νήσους τοῖς τότε ἐγίνετο πορευομένοις, ἐκ δὲ τῶν νήσων

25a

C1: "Now on this island of Atlantis, a great and wonderful kingly power was established which ruled the entire island, many other islands and part of the continent. What's more, even within the straits, they ruled Africa as far as Egypt, and Europe as far as Tuscany. This entire kingdom once constituted itself as one united force, and tried in a single onslaught to enslave your land and ours, and indeed the entire territory inside the strait. It was then, Solon, that the power of your city shone forth before all mankind in excellence and strength, as it stood pre-eminent above all in nobility of spirit, as well as skill in military affairs. For a time it led the forces of the Greeks, but when the others had given up, it had to stand alone facing extreme danger, triumphed over the invaders, set up a monument, saved from slavery those who had not yet been enslaved, and ungrudgingly freed all the others who dwell inside the Pillars of Heracles.

ἐπὶ τὴν καταντικρὺ πᾶσαν ἡπειρον τὴν περὶ τὸν ἀληθινὸν ἐκεῖνον πόντον. τάδε μὲν γάρ, ὅσα ἐντὸς τοῦ στόματος οὗ λέγομεν, φαίνεται

λιμήν στενόν τινα ἔχων εἴσπλουν· ἐκεῖνο δὲ πέλαγος ὄντως ἢ τε περιέχουσα αὐτὸ γῆ παντελῶς ἀληθῶς ὀρθότατ' ἂν λέγοιτο ἡπειρος. ἐν δὲ δὴ τῇ Ἀτλαντίδι νήσῳ ταύτῃ μεγάλη συνέστη καὶ θαυμαστὴ δύναμις βασιλέων, κρατοῦσα μὲν ἀπάσης τῆς νήσου, πολλῶν δὲ ἄλλων νήσων καὶ μερῶν τῆς ἡπείρου· πρὸς δὲ τούτοις ἔτι τῶν ἐντὸς τῇδε Λιβύης μὲν ἦρχον μέχρι πρὸς Αἴγυπτον, τῆς δὲ Εὐρώπης μέχρι Τυρρηνίας. αὕτη δὴ πᾶσα συναθροισθεῖσα εἰς ἓν ἡ δύναμις τὸν τε παρ' ὑμῖν καὶ τὸν παρ' ἡμῖν καὶ τὸν ἐντὸς τοῦ στόματος πάντα τόπον μιᾷ ποτὲ ἐπεχείρησεν ὀρμῇ δουλοῦσθαι. τότε οὖν ὑμῶν, ὦ Σόλων, τῆς πόλεως ἡ δύναμις εἰς ἅπαντας ἀνθρώπους διαφανῆς ἀρετῇ τε καὶ ῥώμῃ ἐγένετο· πάντων γὰρ προστάσα εὐψυχία καὶ τέχναις ὅσαι κατὰ πόλεμον,

25c

CI: "Sometime later there was a huge earthquake and deluge, and there came a single grievous day and night in which your entire warrior class was suddenly swallowed by the Earth, and the island of Atlantis, in like manner, sank beneath the sea and disappeared. Because of this, the sea in those parts has now become impassable and unnavigable, since it is blocked, just below the surface, by mud which was left by the island as it sank."

τὰ μὲν τῶν Ἑλλήνων ἡγουμένη, τὰ δ' αὕτη μονωθεῖσα ἐξ ἀνάγκης τῶν ἄλλων ἀποστάντων, ἐπὶ τοὺς ἐσχάτους ἀφικομένη κινδύνους, κρατήσασα μὲν τῶν ἐπιόντων τρόπαιον ἔστησεν, τοὺς δὲ μήπω δεδουλωμένους διεκώλυσεν δουλωθῆναι, τοὺς δ' ἄλλους, ὅσοι κατοικοῦμεν ἐντὸς ὄρων Ἡρακλείων, ἀφθόνως ἅπαντας ἡλευθέρωσεν. ὑστέρῳ δὲ χρόνῳ σεισμῶν ἐξαισίων καὶ κατακλυσμῶν γενομένων, μιᾶς

25d

CI: Now, Socrates, you have heard a shortened version of the account given by old Critias based on what Solon had heard. However, yesterday when you were talking about the political system and the men you mentioned, I was amazed to be reminded of the very details I have recounted just now, as I realised that, miraculously, by some chance, your account was in broad agreement with what Solon had

recounted. I was reluctant to say anything immediately, because it was a long time ago and I did not remember the story well enough. So I decided that I would first need to recollect everything properly for myself, and then tell the story. Accordingly, I quickly agreed to your assignments yesterday, being of the view that the biggest task in all such situations is to deliver a speech which fits the purpose, and that we were well equipped for this. So it was, as Hermocrates said, that as soon as I left here yesterday, I told these men the story I had remembered, and after I left them I went back over it during the night and remembered almost everything. Well, I tell you, as the saying goes, the lessons of childhood have an amazing grip on the memory. In fact, I do not know if I would be able to recall to memory everything I heard yesterday, and yet I would be completely surprised if any detail of that story which I heard so long ago has escaped me. I heard it with so much pleasure and delight at the time, and the old man taught me so enthusiastically because of my constant questioning, that it has become like burnt-in impressions of indelible writing abiding within me. And, in fact, I recounted these very details to our friends here first thing this morning so that they too would be well provided with stories to tell.

ἡμέρας καὶ νυκτὸς χαλεπῆς ἐπελθούσης, τό τε παρ' ὑμῖν μάχιμον πᾶν ἄθροον ἔδου κατὰ γῆς, ἥ τε Ἀτλαντὶς νῆσος ὡσαύτως κατὰ τῆς θαλάττης δῦσα ἠφανίσθη· διὸ καὶ νῦν ἄπορον καὶ ἀδιερεύνητον γέγονεν τοῦ κεῖ πέλαγος, πηλοῦ κάρτα βραχέος ἐμποδῶν ὄντος, ὃν ἡ νῆσος ἰζομένη παρέσχετο. τὰ μὲν δὴ ῥηθέντα, ὧ Σώκρατες, ὑπὸ τοῦ παλαιοῦ Κριτίου κατ' ἀκοὴν τὴν Σόλωνος, ὡς συντόμως εἰπεῖν, ἀκήκοας λέγοντος δὲ δὴ χθὲς σοῦ περὶ πολιτείας τε καὶ τῶν ἀνδρῶν οὓς ἔλεγες, ἐθαύμαζον ἀναμνησκόμενος αὐτὰ ἃ νῦν λέγω, κατανοῶν ὡς δαιμονίως ἔκ τινος τύχης οὐκ ἄπο σκοποῦ συνηνέχθης τὰ πολλὰ οἷς Σόλων εἶπεν. ΚΡ. οὐ μὴν ἐβουλήθην παραχρῆμα εἰπεῖν· διὰ χρόνου γὰρ οὐχ ἱκανῶς ἐμεμνήμην. ἐνενόησα οὖν ὅτι χρεὼν εἶη με πρὸς ἑμαυτὸν πρῶτον ἱκανῶς πάντα ἀναλαβόντα λέγειν οὕτως. ὅθεν ταχὺ συνωμολόγησά σοι τὰ ἐπιταχθέντα χθές, ἡγούμενος, ὅπερ ἐν ἅπασι τοῖς τοιοῖσδε μέγιστον

ἔργον, λόγον τινὰ πρέποντα τοῖς βουλήμασιν ὑποθέσθαι, τούτου μετρίως ἡμᾶς εὐπορήσειν. οὕτω δὴ, καθάπερ ὁδ' εἶπεν, χθές τε εὐθὺς ἐνθένδε ἀπὼν πρὸς τοῦσδε ἀνέφερον αὐτὰ ἀναμιμνησκόμενος, ἀπελθὼν τε σχεδὸν τι πάντα ἐπισκοπῶν τῆς νυκτὸς ἀνέλαβον. ὥς δὴ τοι, τὸ λεγόμενον, τὰ παίδων μαθήματα θαυμαστὸν ἔχει τι μνημεῖον. ἐγὼ γὰρ ἃ μὲν χθές ἤκουσα, οὐκ ἂν οἶδ' εἰ δυναίμην ἅπαντα ἐν μνήμῃ πάλιν λαβεῖν· ταῦτα δὲ ἃ πάμπολυν χρόνον διακῆκοα, παντάπασι θαυμάσαιμ' ἂν εἴ τί με αὐτῶν διαπέφευγεν. ἦν μὲν οὖν μετὰ πολλῆς ἡδονῆς καὶ

26c

CI: So, Socrates, I am now ready to explain the reason why I have related all this, not just in summary only, but in detail, just as I heard it. We shall now transpose the citizens and the city which you described to us yesterday as a myth to a true situation by locating that city here, as if it were our city, Athens, and those citizens whom you imagined, we shall declare to be our true ancestors whom the Egyptian priest described. The two stories will harmonise completely, and we shall strike no discordant note in declaring that your citizens are the Athenians of ancient times. Working together and with each taking a part, we shall all endeavour, as best we can, to present an appropriate response to the tasks you assigned us. Well then, Socrates, you must consider whether this account of ours accords with your intention, or we should look for another instead.

παιδιᾶς τότε ἀκουόμενα, καὶ τοῦ πρεσβύτου προθύμως με διδάσκοντος, ἅτ' ἐμοῦ πολλάκις ἐπανερωτῶντος, ὥστε οἷον ἐγκαύματα ἀνεκπλύτου γραφῆς ἔμμονά μοι γέγονεν· καὶ δὴ καὶ τοῖσδε εὐθὺς ἔλεγον ἔωθεν αὐτὰ ταῦτα, ἵνα εὐποροῖεν λόγων μετ' ἐμοῦ. νῦν οὖν, οὐπὲρ ἔνεκα πάντα ταῦτα εἴρηται, λέγειν εἰμὶ ἔτοιμος, ὃ Σώκρατες, μὴ μόνον ἐν κεφαλαίοις ἀλλ' ὥσπερ ἤκουσα καθ' ἕκαστον· τοὺς δὲ πολίτας καὶ τὴν πόλιν ἦν χθές ἡμῖν ὥς ἐν μύθῳ διήκιστα σύ, νῦν μετενεγκόντες ἐπὶ τάληθές δεῦρο θήσομεν ὥς ἐκείνην τήνδε οὔσαν, καὶ τοὺς πολίτας οὓς διεννοῦ φήσομεν ἐκείνους τοὺς ἀληθινούς εἶναι προγόνους ἡμῶν, οὓς ἔλεγεν ὁ ἱερεὺς. πάντως ἀρμόσουσι καὶ οὐκ ἀπασόμεθα λέγοντες

αὐτοὺς εἶναι τοὺς ἐν τῷ τότε ὄντας χρόνῳ. κοινῇ δὲ διαλαμβάνοντες ἅπαντες πειρασόμεθα τὸ πρέπον εἰς δύναμιν οἷς ἐπέταξας ἀποδοῦναι. σκοπεῖν οὖν δὴ χρή, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰ κατὰ νοῦν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν

26e

S: Why, Critias, what account would we choose in preference to this one, when it is so especially appropriate to the festival of the goddess because of its connection to her? And the fact that it is no invented story, but a true account, is all important, I presume. How and from where shall we ever find alternatives if we let these go? It's impossible. So you must speak, and good luck with it, while I must now remain quiet and take a turn at listening, in contrast to my speaking role yesterday.

οὗτος, ἢ τίνα ἔτ' ἄλλον ἀντ' αὐτοῦ ζητητέον. ΣΩ. καὶ τίν' ἄν, ὦ Κριτία, μᾶλλον ἀντὶ τούτου μεταλάβοιμεν, ὃς τῇ τε παρουσίᾳ τῆς θεοῦ θυσίᾳ διὰ τὴν οἰκειότητ' ἂν πρέποι μάλιστα, τό τε μὴ πλασθέντα μῦθον ἄλλ' ἀληθινὸν λόγον εἶναι πάμμεγά που. πῶς γὰρ καὶ πόθεν ἄλλους ἀνευρήσομεν ἀφέμενοι τούτων; οὐκ ἔστιν, ἀλλ' ἀγαθὴ τύχη χρή λέγειν μὲν ὑμᾶς, ἐμὲ δὲ ἀντὶ τῶν χθὲς λόγων νῦν

27a

C1: Behold the order of the feast we have arranged for you, Socrates. It seemed to us that Timaeus should speak first since he is the best astronomer among us, and has made it his principal task to understand the nature of the Universe. He will begin with the creation of the Universe and conclude with the nature of human beings. After this, I shall proceed as if I have received human beings from Timaeus created in his story, and from you some who have been specially educated, and bring them before us as if before judges, in accordance with Solon's account and his law, and make them citizens of this city of ours, since they are, in fact, the ancient Athenians whose disappearance was revealed by the record of the sacred writings. From then on they should be referred to as Athenians, our fellow citizens.

ἡσυχίαν ἄγοντα ἀντακούειν. ΚΡ. σκόπει δὴ τὴν τῶν ξενίων σοι διάθεσιν, ᾧ Σώκρατες, ἧ διέθεμεν. ἔδοξεν γὰρ ἡμῖν Τίμαιον μὲν, ἅτε ὄντα ἀστρονομικώτατον ἡμῶν καὶ περὶ φύσεως τοῦ παντὸς εἰδέναι μάλιστα ἔργον πεποιημένον, πρῶτον λέγειν ἀρχόμενον ἀπὸ τῆς τοῦ κόσμου γενέσεως, τελευτᾶν δὲ εἰς ἀνθρώπων φύσιν· ἐμὲ δὲ μετὰ τοῦτον, ὡς παρὰ μὲν τούτου δεδεγμένον ἀνθρώπους τῷ λόγῳ γεγονότας, παρὰ σοῦ δὲ πεπαιδευμένους διαφερόντως

27b

S: It seems that I am going to be repaid, fully and magnificently, with a feast of discourse. Apparently, it is your turn to speak next, Timaeus, once you have invoked the gods in the customary manner.

αὐτῶν τινας, κατὰ δὲ τὸν Σόλωνος λόγον τε καὶ νόμον εἰσαγαγόντα αὐτοὺς ὡς εἰς δικαστὰς ἡμᾶς ποιῆσαι πολίτας τῆς πόλεως τῆσδε ὡς ὄντας τοὺς τότε Ἀθηναίους, οὓς ἐμήνυσεν ἀφανεῖς ὄντας ἢ τῶν ἱερῶν γραμμάτων φήμη, τὰ λοιπὰ δὲ ὡς περὶ πολιτῶν καὶ Ἀθηναίων ὄντων ἤδη ποιεῖσθαι τοὺς λόγους. ΣΩ. τελέως τε καὶ λαμπρῶς ἔοικα ἀνταπολήψεσθαι τὴν τῶν λόγων ἐστίασιν. σὸν οὖν ἔργον λέγειν ἄν, ᾧ Τίμαιε, τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο, ὡς ἔοικεν, εἴη καλέσαντα κατὰ νόμον θεοῦς.

27c

T: Well, Socrates, that is just what anyone with even a little sound-mindedness does before they embark upon any undertaking, great or small. They always, I presume, call upon God. And we who are somehow going to make speeches about the Universe, how it has been generated or whether it is actually ungenerated, if we are not to go entirely astray, must call upon the gods and goddesses and pray that everything be spoken acceptably to them in particular, and less importantly, to ourselves. Now, let that be our invocation to the gods, but we must also invoke that which is ours so that you may learn easily, and I may expound my thoughts on the subjects before us as best I can.

ΤΙ. ἀλλ', ᾧ Σώκρατες, τοῦτό γε δὴ πάντες ὅσοι καὶ κατὰ βραχὺ σωφροσύνης μετέχουσιν, ἐπὶ παντὸς ὀρμῇ καὶ σμικροῦ καὶ μεγάλου πράγματος θεὸν αἰεὶ που καλοῦσιν· ἡμᾶς δὲ τοὺς περὶ τοῦ παντὸς

λόγους ποιῆσθαι πῃ μέλλοντας, ἢ γέγονεν ἢ καὶ ἀγενές ἐστιν, εἰ μὴ παντάπασι παραλλάττομεν, ἀνάγκη θεοὺς τε καὶ θεὰς ἐπικαλουμένους εὖχεσθαι πάντα κατὰ νοῦν ἐκείνοις μὲν μάλιστα, ἐπομένως

27d

T: In my opinion, we must certainly make this distinction first. What is 'that which always is' and has no becoming, and what is 'that which is always becoming' but never is? Now, the former, being ever the same, is comprehended by the activity of nous, together with an account, the latter by opinion, together with sense perception devoid of an account. It comes into being and passes away and never actually is. Again, all that comes into being must come into being from some cause, for it is impossible for anything to be generated without a cause. Now, whenever a craftsman, looking always to the unchanging, refers to something like this as his model, he will reproduce its form and character, and all that he fashions in this way will necessarily be beautiful, but if he looks to something that has come to be and uses a generated model, the product will not be beautiful.

δὲ ἡμῖν εἰπεῖν. καὶ τὰ μὲν περὶ θεῶν ταύτῃ παρακεκλήσθω· τὸ δ' ἡμέτερον παρακλητέον, ἢ ῥᾶσ' ἂν ὑμεῖς μὲν μάθοιτε, ἐγὼ δὲ ἢ διανοοῦμαι μάλιστα' ἂν περὶ τῶν προκειμένων ἐνδειξαίμην. ΤΙ. ἔστιν οὖν δὴ κατ' ἐμὴν δόξαν πρῶτον διαιρετέον τάδε· τί τὸ ὄν ἀεὶ, γένεσιν δὲ οὐκ ἔχον, καὶ τί τὸ γιγνόμενον μὲν ἀεὶ, ὄν δὲ οὐδέποτε; τὸ μὲν δὴ νοήσει μετὰ λόγου περιληπτόν, ἀεὶ κατὰ ταῦτά ὄν, τὸ δ' αὖ δόξῃ μετ' αἰσθήσεως ἀλόγου δοξαστόν, γιγνόμενον καὶ ἀπολλύμενον, ὄντως δὲ οὐδέποτε ὄν. πᾶν δὲ αὖ τὸ γιγνόμενον ὑπ' αἰτίου τινὸς ἐξ ἀνάγκης γίγνεσθαι· παντὶ γὰρ ἀδύνατον χωρὶς αἰτίου γένεσιν σχεῖν. ὅτου μὲν οὖν ἂν ὁ δημιουργὸς πρὸς τὸ κατὰ ταῦτά ἔχον βλέπων ἀεὶ, τοιοῦτῳ τινὶ προσχρῶμενος παραδείγματι, τὴν ἰδέαν καὶ δύναμιν αὐτοῦ ἀπεργάζηται, καλὸν ἐξ ἀνάγκης

28b

T: Now, there is something which must be considered first about the entire Heaven or Universe. In fact, let's call it by whatever name it most readily accepts. This is a fundamental question that must be

considered at the outset in relation to anything, whether it always was, with no beginning in generation, or whether it has come to be, having originated from some beginning. It has come to be, for it is both visible, tangible, and it has a body, and all such things are perceptible, and perceptibles are grasped by opinion and the senses, and, as we saw, come into being and are generated. What's more, we say that a thing which has come to be has, of necessity, come to be through some cause. Now, to discover the maker and father of this Universe is a task indeed, and, having discovered him, it is impossible to describe him to everyone.

οὕτως ἀποτελεῖσθαι πᾶν· οὗ δ' ἂν εἰς γεγονός, γεννητῷ παραδείγματι προσχρώμενος, οὐ καλόν. ὁ δὲ πᾶς οὐρανός — ἢ κόσμος ἢ καὶ ἄλλο ὅτι ποτὲ ὀνομαζόμενος μάλιστα ἂν δέχοιτο, τοῦθ' ἡμῖν ὠνομάσθω — σκεπτόν δ' οὖν περὶ αὐτοῦ πρῶτον, ὅπερ ὑπόκειται περὶ παντός ἐν ἀρχῇ δεῖν σκοπεῖν, πότερον ἦν αἰεί, γενέσεως ἀρχὴν ἔχων οὐδεμίαν, ἢ γέγονεν, ἀπ' ἀρχῆς τινος ἀρξάμενος. γέγονεν· ὁρατὸς γὰρ ἀπτός τέ ἐστιν καὶ σῶμα ἔχων, πάντα δὲ τὰ τοιαῦτα αἰσθητά, τὰ

28c

T: In any case, there is a question we must consider once more in relation to the Universe. With respect to which of the models did its artificer fashion it? Was it with respect to that which remains the same and unchanging, or with respect to a generated model? If, indeed, this Universe is beautiful and the craftsman is good, then clearly he looked towards the everlasting; otherwise, if that's not the case, although no one may legitimately say this, then he looked towards a model which has come to be. It is surely obvious to everyone that the model was everlasting, since the Universe is the most beautiful of created things, and the craftsman is the most excellent of causes. So, having come into being in this way, it has been made to resemble that which is comprehended by reason and intelligence, and remains the same. Furthermore, since this is the case, it is entirely necessary that this Universe be an image of something.

δ' αἰσθητά, δόξῃ περιληπτὰ μετ' αἰσθήσεως, γιγνόμενα καὶ γεννητὰ ἐφάνη. τῷ δ' αὖ γενομένῳ φαμέν ὑπ' αἰτίου τινὸς ἀνάγκην εἶναι γενέσθαι. ΤΙ. τὸν μὲν οὖν ποιητὴν καὶ πατέρα τοῦδε τοῦ παντὸς εὐρεῖν τε ἔργον καὶ εὐρόντα εἰς πάντας ἀδύνατον λέγειν· τότε δ' οὖν πάλιν ἐπισκεπτέον περὶ αὐτοῦ, πρὸς πότερον τῶν παραδειγμάτων ὁ τεκταινόμενος αὐτὸν ἀπηργάζετο, πότερον πρὸς τὸ κατὰ ταῦτα καὶ ὡσαύτως ἔχον ἢ πρὸς τὸ γεγονός. εἰ μὲν δὴ καλὸς ἐστὶν ὅδε ὁ κόσμος ὃ τε δημιουργὸς ἀγαθός, δῆλον ὡς πρὸς τὸ αἰδῖον ἔβλεπεν· εἰ δὲ ὁ μὴδ' εἰπεῖν τινὶ θέμις, πρὸς γεγονός. παντὶ δὴ σαφές ὅτι πρὸς τὸ αἰδῖον· ὁ μὲν γὰρ κάλλιστος τῶν γεγονότων, ὁ δ' ἄριστος τῶν αἰτίων. οὕτω δὴ γεγενημένος πρὸς τὸ λόγῳ καὶ φρονήσει περιληπτὸν καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχον δεδημιούργηται·

29b

T: Now, on every subject it is most important to begin at the natural beginning. So, there is a distinction we must make in relation to an image and its model. Accounts are also akin to the very subjects they expound, so accounts of anything stable and certain and discernible by nous will be fixed and unchanging, and such accounts must be irrefutable and incontrovertible, and insofar as this is possible, appropriate for accounts, they should not fall short of this. However, accounts of something copied from that model, something which is therefore a likeness, are likely accounts, and stand in a relation to the other accounts; as being is to becoming, so too is truth to belief. Therefore, don't be surprised, Socrates, if in many cases on numerous subjects such as the gods or the creation of the Universe, we prove unable to furnish accounts that are entirely and in every way consistent with themselves and exact. Indeed, if we can offer an account that is as likely as any other, we should be content, remembering that I who speak, and you who judge, possess a human nature, and so, accepting the likely story about these matters, it is appropriate to seek nothing beyond that.

τούτων δὲ ὑπαρχόντων αὐτῷ πᾶσα ἀνάγκη τόνδε τὸν κόσμον εἰκόνα τινὸς εἶναι. μέγιστον δὴ παντὸς ἄρξασθαι κατὰ φύσιν ἀρχήν. ὥδε οὖν περὶ τε

εἰκόνοσ καὶ περὶ τοῦ παραδείγματος αὐτῆς διοριστέον, ὥς ἄρα τοὺς λόγους, ὧν περ εἰσιν ἐξηγηταί, τούτων αὐτῶν καὶ συγγενεῖς ὄντας· τοῦ μὲν οὖν μονίμου καὶ βεβαίου καὶ μετὰ νοῦ καταφανοὺς μονίμους καὶ ἀμεταπτώτους—καθ’ ὅσον οἶόν τε καὶ ἀνελέγκτοις προσήκει λόγοις εἶναι καὶ ἀνικῆτοις, τούτου δεῖ μηδὲν ἐλλείπειν—τοὺς δὲ τοῦ πρὸς μὲν ἐκεῖνο ἀπεικασθέντος, ὄντος δὲ εἰκόνοσ εἰκότας ἀνὰ λόγον τε ἐκείνων ὄντας· ὅτι περ πρὸς γένεσιν οὐσία, τοῦτο πρὸς πίστιν ἀλήθεια. ἐὰν οὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες, πολλὰ πολλῶν πέρι, θεῶν καὶ τῆς τοῦ παντός γενέσεωσ, μὴ δυνατοὶ γινώμεθα πάντη πάντως αὐτοὺς ἑαυτοῖς ὁμολογουμένους λόγους καὶ ἀπηκριβωμένους ἀποδοῦναι, μὴ θαυμάσης· ἀλλ’ ἐὰν ἄρα μηδενὸς ἦττον παρεχόμεθα εἰκότας, ἀγαπᾶν χρή, μεμνημένους ὥς ὁ λέγων ἐγὼ

29d

S: Excellent, Timaeus. Indeed, as you say, we must accept it unreservedly. We have enthusiastically accepted the prelude from you in wonder, so please proceed now to the main theme.

29d

T: Well, let us state the reason why becoming and the Universe were constructed by the artificer.

ὕμεῖς τε οἱ κριταὶ φύσιν ἀνθρωπίνην ἔχομεν, ὥστε περὶ τούτων τὸν εἰκότα μῦθον ἀποδεχομένους πρέπει τούτου μηδὲν ἔτι πέρα ζητεῖν. ΣΩ. ἄριστα, ὦ Τίμαιε, παντάπασί τε ὥς κελεύεις ἀποδεκτέον· τὸ μὲν οὖν προοίμιον θαυμασίως ἀπεδεξάμεθά σου, τὸν δὲ δὴ νόμον ἡμῖν ἐφεξῆς πέραινε. ΤΙ. λέγωμεν δὴ δι’ ἣντινα αἰτίαν γένεσιν καὶ τὸ πᾶν

29e

T: He was good, and in the good no envy ever arises about anything, and being devoid of envy he desired that all things be as much like himself as possible. We would then be absolutely right to accept from men of understanding that this is the supreme source of becoming and of the Universe. For the god desired that all be good and, as far as possible, nothing be imperfect. He therefore took everything that was visible, which was not at rest but moving discordantly and randomly, and he led it from disorder to order, regarding order as entirely

superior to disorder. But it was not then, nor is it now, lawful for the supreme to enact anything except the supremely beautiful. So, on reflection, he discovered that in the realm of whatever is naturally visible, nothing that is made without nous is, on the whole, ever better than something which possesses nous, and furthermore, that nous cannot be present in anything in the absence of soul. Based on this reflection, having placed nous in soul, and soul in body, he constructed the Universe so that, once completed, it would naturally be as beautiful and excellent a piece of work as was possible. Accordingly, based upon the likely account, we must state that this Universe is a living creature with soul and nous that has, in truth, come into being through the providence of God.

τόδε ὁ συνιστὰς συνέστησεν. ἀγαθὸς ἦν, ἀγαθῷ δὲ οὐδεὶς περὶ οὐδενὸς οὐδέποτε ἐγγίγνεται φθόνος· τούτου δ' ἐκτὸς ὧν πάντα ὅτι μάλιστα ἐβουλήθη γενέσθαι παραπλήσια ἑαυτῷ. ΤΙ. ταύτην δὴ γενέσεως καὶ κόσμου μάλιστ' ἂν τις ἀρχὴν κυριωτάτην παρ' ἀνδρῶν φρονίμων ἀποδεχόμενος ὀρθότατα ἀποδέχοιτ' ἂν. βουλευθεὶς γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἀγαθὰ μὲν πάντα, φλαῦρον δὲ μηδὲν εἶναι κατὰ δύναμιν, οὕτω δὴ πᾶν ὅσον ἦν ὁρατὸν παραλαβὼν οὐχ ἡσυχίαν ἄγον ἀλλὰ κινούμενον πλημμελῶς καὶ ἀτάκτως, εἰς τάξιν αὐτὸ ἡγάγεν ἐκ τῆς ἀταξίας, ἡγησάμενος ἐκεῖνο τούτου πάντως ἄμεινον. θέμις δ' οὐτ' ἦν οὐτ' ἔστιν τῷ ἀρίστῳ δρᾶν ἄλλο πλὴν τὸ κάλλιστον· λογισάμενος οὖν ἠϋρίσκεν ἐκ τῶν κατὰ φύσιν ὁρατῶν οὐδὲν ἀνόητον τοῦ νοῦν ἔχοντος ὅλον ὅλου κάλλιον ἔσεσθαι ποτε ἔργον, νοῦν δ' αὖ χωρὶς ψυχῆς ἀδύνατον παραγενέσθαι τῷ. διὰ δὴ τὸν λογισμὸν τόνδε νοῦν μὲν ἐν ψυχῇ, ψυχὴν δ' ἐν σώματι συνιστὰς τὸ πᾶν συνετεκταίνετο, ὅπως ὅτι κάλλιστον εἴη κατὰ φύσιν ἄριστόν τε ἔργον ἀπειργασμένος. οὕτως οὖν δὴ κατὰ λόγον τὸν εἰκότα δεῖ λέγειν τόνδε τὸν κόσμον ζῶον ἔμψυχον ἔννουν τε τῇ ἀληθείᾳ διὰ τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ

30c

T: This being the case, we should go on to state the next topics. In the likeness of which of the living creatures did the maker construct the Universe? Let us not degrade it to something which, by nature, is a

part, for that is incomplete, and the likeness of something incomplete would never be beautiful. Instead, we propose that the Universe resembles, more than anything else, whatever all other species and classes of living beings, individually or on the basis of kinds, are parts of. In fact, that Universe contains within itself all living things that can be discerned by nous, just as this Universe contains us and all creatures which can be discerned by sight. The god wished the Universe to resemble the most beautiful and entirely perfect of all that nous perceives, so he constructed a single, visible, living creature containing within it all creatures that are by nature kindred to it.

γενέσθαι πρόνοιαν. τούτου δ' ὑπάρχοντος αὖ τὰ τούτοις ἐφεξῆς ἡμῖν λεκτέον, τίνι τῶν ζώων αὐτὸν εἰς ὁμοιότητα ὁ συνιστὰς συνέστησεν. τῶν μὲν οὖν ἐν μέρους εἶδει πεφυκότων μηδενὶ καταξιώσωμεν — ἀτελεῖ γὰρ εἰκοὸς οὐδέν ποτ' ἂν γένοιτο καλόν—οὗ δ' ἔστιν ἄλλα ζῶα καθ' ἓν καὶ κατὰ γένη μόρια, τούτῳ πάντων ὁμοιότατον αὐτὸν εἶναι τιθώμεν. τὰ γὰρ δὴ νοητὰ ζῶα πάντα ἐκεῖνο ἐν ἑαυτῷ περιλαβὼν ἔχει, καθάπερ ὅδε ὁ κόσμος ἡμᾶς ὅσα τε ἄλλα θρέμματα συνέστηκεν ὁρατά. ΤΙ. τῷ γὰρ τῶν νοουμένων καλλίστῳ καὶ κατὰ πάντα τελέῳ μάλιστα αὐτὸν ὁ θεὸς ὁμοιωσαὶ βουληθεὶς ζῶον ἐν ὁρατόν, πάνθ' ὅσα

31a

T: Have we been right to speak of one single Universe, or is it more correct to refer to many, indeed an unlimited number? If, in fact, it is to be crafted in accordance with the model, there will be one. For that which encompasses all living creatures discernible by nous could not ever be one of a pair. If it were so, an additional living being would be needed to embrace both of these, and the two would be parts of this living thing. It would then be more correct to say that the Universe resembles not the two creatures, but the creature which contains them both. Therefore, so that it would resemble the all-perfect creature in respect of its uniqueness, the maker, accordingly, did not make two or infinitely many universes; rather, this only begotten Heaven has come into existence, and it is one, and one it shall be hereafter.

αὐτοῦ κατὰ φύσιν συγγενῇ ζῶα ἐντὸς ἔχον ἑαυτοῦ, συνέστησε. πότερον οὖν ὀρθῶς ἕνα οὐρανὸν προσειρήκαμεν, ἢ πολλοὺς καὶ ἀπείρους λέγειν ἦν ὀρθότερον; ἕνα, εἴπερ κατὰ τὸ παράδειγμα δεδημιουργημένος ἔσται. τὸ γὰρ περιέχον πάντα ὁπόσα νοητὰ ζῶα μεθ' ἐτέρου δευτέρου οὐκ ἂν ποτ' εἴη· πάλιν γὰρ ἂν ἕτερον εἶναι τὸ περὶ ἐκείνῳ δέοι ζῶον, οὗ μέρος ἂν εἴτην ἐκείνῳ, καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἔτι ἐκείνοις ἄλλ' ἐκείνῳ τῷ περιέχοντι τόδ' ἂν ἀφωμοιωμένον λέγοιτο ὀρθότερον. ἵνα

31b

T: Now, whatever has come to be must have bodily form and be visible and tangible, but nothing could ever have become visible without fire, or tangible without something solid, nor solid without earth. Hence, as he began to construct the body of the Universe, God made it from fire and earth. Now, it is not possible for two things to be combined well on their own without a third, for some bond is required between the two to draw them together. The very best bond is that which, as much as possible, makes itself and the conjoined entities one, and it is proportion that, by nature, best accomplishes this. So, whenever the middle item of three numbers or volumes or power is such that the first is to the middle as the middle is to the last, and again, that the last is to the middle as the middle is to the first, then the middle becomes first and last, and the last and first for their part both become middles. Accordingly, it follows, of necessity, that they all turn out to be the same, and since they have all become the same as one another, they will all be one.⁷

οὖν τόδε κατὰ τὴν μόνωσιν ὅμοιον ἢ τῷ παντελεῖ ζῶῳ, διὰ ταῦτα οὔτε δύο οὔτ' ἀπείρους ἐποίησεν ὁ ποιῶν κόσμους, ἀλλ' εἷς ὅδε μονογενὴς οὐρανὸς γεγωνὶς ἔστιν καὶ ἔτ' ἔσται. σωματοειδὲς δὲ δὴ καὶ ὁρατὸν ἄπτὸν τε δεῖ τὸ γενόμενον εἶναι, χωρισθὲν δὲ πυρὸς οὐδὲν ἂν ποτε ὁρατὸν γένοιτο, οὐδὲ ἄπτὸν ἄνευ τινὸς στερεοῦ, στερεὸν δὲ οὐκ ἄνευ γῆς· ὅθεν ἐκ πυρὸς καὶ γῆς τὸ τοῦ παντὸς ἀρχόμενος συνιστάναι σῶμα ὁ θεὸς ἐποίει. δύο δὲ μόνῳ καλῶς συνίστασθαι τρίτου χωρὶς οὐ δυνατόν· δεσμὸν γὰρ ἐν μέσῳ δεῖ τινα ἀμφοῖν συναγωγὸν γίγνεσθαι. δεσμῶν δὲ κάλλιστος ὃς ἂν αὐτὸν καὶ τὰ συνδούμενα ὅτι μάλιστα ἐν

ποιῇ, τοῦτο δὲ πέφυκεν ἀναλογία κάλλιστα ἀποτελεῖν. ΤΙ. ὁπόταν γὰρ ἀριθμῶν τριῶν εἴτε ὄγκων εἴτε δυνάμεων ὠντινωτοῦν ἢ τὸ μέσον, ὅτιπερ τὸ πρῶτον πρὸς αὐτό, τοῦτο αὐτὸ πρὸς τὸ ἔσχατον, καὶ πάλιν αὖθις, ὅτι τὸ ἔσχατον πρὸς τὸ μέσον, τὸ μέσον πρὸς τὸ πρῶτον, τότε τὸ μέσον μὲν πρῶτον καὶ ἔσχατον γιγνόμενον, τὸ δ' ἔσχατον καὶ τὸ πρῶτον αὖ μέσα ἀμφοτέρω, πάνθ' οὕτως ἐξ ἀνάγκης τὰ αὐτὰ εἶναι συμβήσεται, τὰ αὐτὰ δὲ γενόμενα ἀλλήλοις ἔν πάντα ἔσται. εἰ μὲν οὖν ἐπίπεδον μὲν, βάθος δὲ μηδὲν ἔχον ἔδει γίγνεσθαι τὸ τοῦ παντὸς σῶμα, μία μεσότης ἂν ἐξήρκει

32b

T: So then, if the body of the Universe had to come into being having surface but no depth, a single mean would have sufficed to bind its constituents together with itself. But now, since it has a solid structure, and solids are never conjoined by one middle term but by two, God therefore placed water and air between fire and earth, and insofar as it was possible he arranged that they have the same proportion to one another, so that as fire is to air, air is to water, and as air is to water, water is to earth.⁸ These he bound together and constructed a visible and tangible Heaven. And, for these reasons and from such constituents as these – four in number – the body of the Universe was generated, having been harmonised by proportion and endowed from these with affection, so that having come to sameness with itself, it was rendered indissoluble by anyone except the one who conjoined it.

τά τε μεθ' αὐτῆς συνδεῖν καὶ ἑαυτήν, νῦν δὲ στερεοειδῇ γὰρ αὐτὸν προσῆκεν εἶναι, τὰ δὲ στερεὰ μία μὲν οὐδέποτε, δύο δὲ αἰεὶ μεσότητες συναρμόττουσιν· οὕτω δὴ πυρός τε καὶ γῆς ὕδωρ ἀέρα τε ὁ θεὸς ἐν μέσῳ θείς, καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα καθ' ὅσον ἦν δυνατόν ἀνὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον ἀπεργασάμενος, ὅτιπερ πῦρ πρὸς ἀέρα, τοῦτο ἀέρα πρὸς ὕδωρ, καὶ ὅτι ἀῆρ πρὸς ὕδωρ, ὕδωρ πρὸς γῆν, συνέδησεν καὶ συνεστήσατο οὐρανὸν ὁρατὸν καὶ ἀπτόν. καὶ διὰ ταῦτα ἕκ τε δὴ τούτων τοιούτων

32c

T: Now, the construction of the Universe actually consumed each one of these four elements entirely. For the artificer constructed it from all of the fire and water, and also the air and earth, not one part, or power, of any of them being left outside of it. He decided this for the following reasons: firstly so that it would be as whole and perfect a living being as possible, made from perfect parts; in addition to this, it was to be one, since there would be nothing left over from which something else of this kind could be generated. It was also to be free from old age and disease, as he realised that if a composite body is surrounded by heat or cold, or any powerful forces outside it, they attack it and bring it to an untimely end, and by inducing disease and old age they make it waste away.

καὶ τὸν ἀριθμὸν τεττάρων τὸ τοῦ κόσμου σῶμα ἐγεννήθη δι' ἀναλογίας ὁμολογήσαν, φιλίαν τε ἔσχεν ἐκ τούτων, ὥστε εἰς ταῦτόν αὐτῷ συνελθὸν ἄλυτον ὑπὸ τοῦ ἄλλου πλήν ὑπὸ τοῦ συνδήσαντος γενέσθαι. τῶν δὲ δὴ τεττάρων ἐν ὅλον ἕκαστον εἴληφεν ἢ τοῦ κόσμου σύστασις. ἐκ γὰρ πυρὸς παντὸς ὕδατός τε καὶ ἀέρος καὶ γῆς συνέστησεν αὐτὸν ὁ συνιστάς, μέρος οὐδὲν οὐδενὸς οὐδὲ δύνάμιν ἔξωθεν ὑπολιπών, τάδε διανοηθείς, πρῶτον μὲν ἵνα ὅλον ὅτι μάλιστα ζῶον τέλεον ἐκ τελέων τῶν μερῶν εἴη, ΤΙ. πρὸς δὲ τούτοις ἔν, ἅτε οὐχ ὑπολελειμμένων ἐξ ὧν ἄλλο τοιοῦτον γένοιτ' ἄν, ἔτι δὲ ἵν' ἀγήρων καὶ ἄνοσον ᾗ, κατανοῶν ὡς συστάτῳ σώματι θερμὰ καὶ ψυχρὰ καὶ πάνθ' ὅσα δυνάμεις ἰσχυρὰς ἔχει περιστάμενα ἔξωθεν καὶ προσπίπτοντα ἀκαίρως λύει καὶ νόσους γῆράς τε ἐπάγοντα φθίνειν ποιεῖ. διὰ δὲ τὴν αἰτίαν καὶ τὸν λογισμὸν τόνδε ἕνα ὅλον ὅλων ἐξ ἀπάντων τέλεον καὶ ἀγήρων καὶ ἄνοσον

33b

T: So, for this reason, and based upon this consideration, he fashioned it whole, composed of all these wholes – one, perfect, ageless and incorruptible – and he gave a shape to it that was appropriate and belonged to its nature. The shape, which contains all other shapes within itself, was appropriate for the living being that is going to embrace all other living beings within itself, so he turned it to make it circular, a spherical shape having all of its extremities equidistant from

its centre. This is the most perfect of all shapes and the one most uniform with itself, and uniformity he regarded as infinitely better than non-uniformity. And so, he polished it all smooth and round on the outside for many reasons.

αὐτὸν ἔτεκτῆνατο. σχῆμα δὲ ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ τὸ πρέπον καὶ τὸ συγγενές. τῷ δὲ τὰ πάντα ἐν αὐτῷ ζῶα περιέχειν μέλλοντι ζῳῷ πρέπον ἂν εἴη σχῆμα τὸ περιειληφὸς ἐν αὐτῷ πάντα ὁπόσα σχήματα διὸ καὶ σφαιροειδές, ἐκ μέσου πάντῃ πρὸς τὰς τελευτὰς ἴσον ἀπέχον, κυκλοτερές αὐτὸ ἔτορνεύσατο, πάντων τελεώτατον ὁμοιότατόν τε αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ σχημάτων, νομίσας μυρίῳ κάλλιον ὅμοιον ἀνομοίου. λείον δὲ δὴ κύκλῳ

33c

T: It had no need of eyes, for there was nothing to be seen outside it, nor hearing, for there was nothing to be heard. There was no air around about it which it needed to breathe, nor did it require any organ by which it might receive food into itself, or indeed expel it again once it had been digested. In fact, nothing went out or came in from anywhere, for there was nothing. Indeed, it was contrived by design so as to provide its own food from its own waste, and to experience everything within itself and enact everything by itself, because he who assembled it thought it would be better for it to be self-sufficient rather than being dependent on others. He did not think it necessary to attach hands to it when they were not needed to grasp with or to ward off anything, nor feet neither, nor any support to stand upon, for he assigned it a movement natural to its body, the most reasonable and intelligent of the seven kinds of motion. Accordingly, he caused it to move by revolving in a circle, leading it around in the same way, in the same place, within itself, and he took all the other six motions away and fashioned it without their wanderings.⁹ Seeing that it did not need feet for this circular motion, he brought it forth without legs or feet.

πάν ἔξωθεν αὐτὸ ἀπηκριβοῦτο πολλῶν χάριν. ὁμμάτων τε γὰρ ἐπεδεῖτο οὐδέν, ὁρατὸν γὰρ οὐδέν ὑπελείπετο ἔξωθεν, οὐδ' ἀκοῆς, οὐδὲ γὰρ ἀκουστόν· πνεῦμά τε οὐκ ἦν περιστὸς δεόμενον ἀναπνοῆς, οὐδ' αὖ τινος ἐπιδεὲς ἦν ὀργάνου σχεῖν ὥς τὴν μὲν εἰς ἑαυτὸ τροφήν δέξοιτο, τὴν δὲ πρότερον ἐξικμασμένην ἀποπέμψοι πάλιν. ἀπῆει τε γὰρ οὐδέν οὐδὲ προσῆειν αὐτῷ ποθεν—οὐδὲ γὰρ ἦν—αὐτὸ γὰρ ἑαυτῷ τροφήν τὴν ἑαυτοῦ φθίσιν παρέχον καὶ πάντα ἐν ἑαυτῷ καὶ ὑφ' ἑαυτοῦ πάσχον καὶ δρῶν ἐκ τέχνης γέγονεν· ἡγήσατο γὰρ αὐτὸ ὁ συνθεὶς αὐταρκες ὃν ἄμεινον ἔσσεσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ προσδεὲς ἄλλων. χειρῶν δέ, αἷς οὔτε λαβεῖν οὔτε αὖ τινα ἀμύνασθαι χρεῖα τις ἦν, μάτην οὐκ ὤετο δεῖν αὐτῷ προσάπτειν, οὐδὲ ποδῶν οὐδὲ ὅλως τῆς περὶ τὴν βάσιν

34a

T: This was the entire thinking of the god who is always about the god that was soon to be, and based on this thinking he made it smooth and uniform, everywhere equal from the centre, a complete perfect body composed of perfect bodies. He placed soul in the middle of it and stretched it through the entire body, and even covered the outside of the body with it, and established one single, solitary, round Heaven revolving in a circle. It was able, because of its excellence, to interact with itself, having no need of any other as it was acquaintance and friend enough to itself. For all these reasons, what he created was a blessed god.

ὑπηρεσίας. ΤΙ. κίνησιν γὰρ ἀπένειμεν αὐτῷ τὴν τοῦ σώματος οἰκείαν, τῶν ἐπὶ τὴν περὶ νοῦν καὶ φρόνησιν μάλιστα οὔσαν· διὸ δὴ κατὰ ταῦτ' ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ καὶ ἐν ἑαυτῷ περιαγαγὼν αὐτὸ ἐποίησε κύκλῳ κινεῖσθαι στρεφόμενον, τὰς δὲ ἐξ ἀπάσας κινήσεις ἀφεῖλεν καὶ ἀπλανὲς ἀπηργάσατο ἐκείνων. ἐπὶ δὲ τὴν περίοδον ταύτην ἅτ' οὐδέν ποδῶν δέον ἄσκελές καὶ ἄπουν αὐτὸ ἐγέννησεν. οὗτος δὴ πᾶς ὄντος αἰεὶ λογισμὸς θεοῦ περὶ τὸν ποτὲ ἐσόμενον θεὸν λογισθεὶς λεῖον καὶ ὁμαλὸν πανταχῇ τε ἐκ μέσου ἴσον καὶ ὅλον καὶ τέλεον ἐκ τελέων σωμάτων σῶμα ἐποίησεν· ψυχὴν δὲ εἰς τὸ μέσον αὐτοῦ θεὸς διὰ παντός τε ἔτεινεν καὶ ἔτι ἔξωθεν τὸ σῶμα αὐτῇ περιεκάλυπεν, καὶ κύκλῳ δὴ κύκλον στρεφόμενον οὐρανὸν ἓνα μόνον ἔρημον κατέστησεν, δι' ἀρετὴν δὲ

αὐτὸν αὐτῷ δυνάμενον συγγίγνεσθαι καὶ οὐδενὸς ἑτέρου προσδεόμενον, γνώριμον δὲ καὶ φίλον ἱκανῶς αὐτὸν αὐτῷ. διὰ πάντα δὴ ταῦτα εὐδαίμονα θεὸν αὐτὸν ἐγεννήσατο. τὴν δὲ δὴ ψυχὴν οὐχ ὥς νῦν ὑστέραν ἐπιχειροῦμεν λέγειν,

34c

T: But although we are now endeavouring to speak of the soul after our description of the body, the god did not, accordingly, contrive that the soul be younger, for when he combined them he would not have allowed the elder to be ruled by the younger. But we, with our accustomed degree of casualness, speak in this somewhat random fashion. In fact, he constructed the soul to be elder and prior to the body in birth and in excellence, its mistress and ruler.

οὕτως ἐμηχανήσατο καὶ ὁ θεὸς νεωτέραν—οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἄρχεσθαι πρεσβύτερον ὑπὸ νεωτέρου συνέρξας εἶασεν—ἀλλὰ πως ἡμεῖς πολὺ μετέχοντες τοῦ προστυχόντος τε καὶ εἰκῇ ταύτῃ πῃ καὶ λέγομεν, ὁ δὲ καὶ γενέσει καὶ ἀρετῇ προτέραν καὶ πρεσβυτέραν ψυχὴν σώματος ὥς δεσπότιν καὶ ἄρξουσιν ἀρξομένου

35a

T: He made the soul from the following constituents and in this manner. From being that is undivided and ever the same, and being which, by contrast, comes into existence apportioned to bodies, he formed a third intermediate form of being from both of them. From the nature of same and other, in like manner, he made a third intermediate form between their undivided form and their form as apportioned to bodies. He then took these three mixtures¹⁰ and mixed them all into one, and as the nature of other was difficult to mix, he blended it with same by force. Then, having mixed this, with the help of Being, and made one from the three, he apportioned this whole once more into as many parts as was fitting, each part being a mixture of same, other and being.

συνεστήσατο ἐκ τῶνδὲ τε καὶ τοιῶδε τρόπῳ. ΤΙ. τῆς ἀμερίστου καὶ αἰὶ κατὰ ταῦτὰ ἐχούσης οὐσίας καὶ τῆς αὖ περὶ τὰ σώματα γιγνομένης

μεριστῆς τρίτον ἐξ ἁμφοῖν ἐν μέσῳ συνεκεράσατο οὐσίας εἶδος, τῆς τε ταύτου φύσεως αὖ περί καὶ τῆς τοῦ ἑτέρου, καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα συνέστησεν ἐν μέσῳ τοῦ τε ἀμεροῦς αὐτῶν καὶ τοῦ κατὰ τὰ σώματα μεριστοῦ· καὶ τρία λαβὼν αὐτὰ ὄντα συνεκεράσατο εἰς μίαν πάντα ιδέαν, τὴν θατέρου φύσιν δύσμεικτον οὖσαν εἰς ταὐτὸν συναρμόττων βίᾳ.

35b

T: He began to divide it as follows. First, he separated one part from the entire; after this he separated a part double the first; and next a third, which was one-and-a-half times the second and three times the first; a fourth part, double the second; a fifth, three times the third; a sixth, eight times the first; and a seventh, twenty-seven times the first. After this, he filled up the double and triple intervals, cutting off further sections of the mixture and placing these in between them, so that in each interval there were two means – one exceeding its extremes and being exceeded by them by the same portion, the other exceeding one extreme and being exceeded by the other extreme by an equal number.¹¹ These connections gave rise to intervals of $3/2$, $4/3$ and $9/8$ between the previous intervals. All the $4/3$ intervals were filled up by the $9/8$ intervals, leaving a portion of each of them, and the interval associated with this remaining portion had the numerical relation $256/243$. What's more, the mixture from which these were cut was at that stage entirely used up in the process.

μειγνὺς δὲ μετὰ τῆς οὐσίας καὶ ἐκ τριῶν ποιησάμενος ἕν, πάλιν ὅλον τοῦτο μοίρας ὅσας προσῆκεν διένειμεν, ἐκάστην δὲ ἕκ τε ταύτου καὶ θατέρου καὶ τῆς οὐσίας μεμειγμένην. ἤρχετο δὲ διαιρεῖν ὧδε. μίαν ἀφεῖλεν τὸ πρῶτον ἀπὸ παντὸς μοῖραν, μετὰ δὲ ταύτην ἀφήρει διπλασίαν ταύτης, τὴν δ' αὖ τρίτην ἡμιολίαν μὲν τῆς δευτέρας, τριπλασίαν δὲ τῆς πρώτης, τετάρτην δὲ τῆς δευτέρας διπλῆν, πέμπτην δὲ τριπλῆν τῆς τρίτης, τὴν δ' ἕκτην τῆς πρώτης ὀκταπλασίαν, ἐβδόμην δ' ἑπτακαικεκοσιπλασίαν τῆς πρώτης· **ΤΙ.** μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα συνεπληροῦτο τὰ τε διπλάσια καὶ τριπλάσια διαστήματα, μοίρας ἔτι ἐκεῖθεν ἀποτέμνων καὶ τιθεὶς εἰς τὸ μεταξὺ τούτων, ὥστε ἐν ἐκάστῳ διαστήματι δύο εἶναι μεσότηας, τὴν μὲν ταὐτῷ μέρει τῶν ἄκρων

αὐτῶν ὑπερέχουσαν καὶ ὑπερεχομένην, τὴν δὲ ἴσῳ μὲν κατ' ἀριθμὸν ὑπερέχουσαν, ἴσῳ δὲ ὑπερεχομένην. ἡμιολίων δὲ διαστάσεων καὶ ἐπιτρίτων καὶ ἐπογδῶν γενομένων ἐκ τούτων τῶν δεσμῶν ἐν ταῖς πρόσθεν διαστάσεσιν, τῷ τοῦ ἐπογδοῦ διαστήματι τὰ ἐπίτριτα πάντα συνεπληροῦτο, λείπων αὐτῶν ἐκάστου μόριον, τῆς τοῦ μορίου ταύτης διαστάσεως λειφθείσης ἀριθμοῦ πρὸς ἀριθμὸν ἐχούσης τοὺς ὅρους ἕξ καὶ πεντήκοντα καὶ διακοσίων πρὸς τρία καὶ τετταράκοντα καὶ διακόσια. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ μειχθέν, ἕξ οὗ ταῦτα κατέτεμνεν, οὕτως ἤδη πᾶν κατανηλώκει. ταύτην οὖν τὴν σύστασιν πᾶσαν διπλὴν κατὰ μήκος σχίσας, μέσῃ πρὸς μέσῃ ἐκατέραν ἀλλήλαις οἷον χεῖ προσβαλὼν κατέκαμψεν

36c

T: He then cut this entire compound along its length into two, and situated the middles of each together like the letter χ (chi), bent each into a circle and attached each to itself and to the other one at the point opposite to where they overlap, included them in that kind of motion which turns around uniformly in the same place, and made one of the circles inner and the other outer. The outer movement he designated as the movement of same, the inner as the movement of other. He set the movement of same revolving sideways and to the right, and that of other diagonally and to the left, and he granted supremacy to the movement of same and similar, for he left it one and undivided. However, he divided the inner circle six times, producing seven circles based on the double and triple intervals, there being three of each. He commanded the circles to go in opposite directions to one another, three at similar speeds, four at speeds dissimilar to one another and to the other three, but their movements were proportional.

εἰς ἓν κύκλῳ, συνάψας αὐταῖς τε καὶ ἀλλήλαις ἐν τῷ καταντικρὺ τῆς προσβολῆς, καὶ τῇ κατὰ ταῦτα ἐν ταύτῳ περιανομένη κινήσει περίξ αὐτὰς ἔλαβεν, καὶ τὸν μὲν ἕξῳ, τὸν δ' ἐντὸς ἐποιεῖτο τῶν κύκλων. τὴν μὲν οὖν ἕξῳ φορὰν ἐπεφήμισεν εἶναι τῆς ταύτου φύσεως, τὴν δ' ἐντὸς

τῆς θατέρου. τὴν μὲν δὴ ταύτου κατὰ πλευρὰν ἐπὶ δεξιὰ περιήγαγεν, τὴν δὲ θατέρου κατὰ διάμετρον ἐπ' ἀριστερά, κράτος δ' ἔδωκεν τῇ

36d

T: When the entire construction of the soul had been completed in accordance with the reasoning of the one who constructed it, he then fashioned within it all that has bodily form, and having brought both together, he fastened them centre to centre. And soul, being woven entirely throughout the Heaven from centre to extremity, enfolding it in a complete circle on the outside and revolving in itself, initiated a divine beginning of unceasing and intelligent life for all time. Now, while the body of the Heaven had come into existence and was visible, soul, for its part, was invisible, partaking of reason and harmony, the best of created things created by the very best of all that is eternal and known by nous.

ταύτου καὶ ὁμοίου περιφορᾶ· μίαν γὰρ αὐτὴν ἄσχιτον εἶασεν, τὴν δ' ἐντὸς σχίσας ἑξαχῇ ἑπτὰ κύκλους ἀνίσους κατὰ τὴν τοῦ διπλασίου καὶ τριπλασίου διάστασιν ἐκάστην, οὐσῶν ἑκατέρων τριῶν, κατὰ τάναντία μὲν ἀλλήλοις προσέταξεν ἰέναι τοὺς κύκλους, τάχει δὲ τρεῖς μὲν ὁμοίως, τοὺς δὲ τέτταρας ἀλλήλοις καὶ τοῖς τρισὶν ἀνομοίως, ἐν λόγῳ δὲ φερομένους. ἐπεὶ δὲ κατὰ νοῦν τῷ συνιστάντι πᾶσα ἡ τῆς ψυχῆς σύστασις ἐγεγένητο, μετὰ τοῦτο πᾶν τὸ σωματοειδὲς ἐντὸς αὐτῆς ἔτεκταίνετο καὶ μέσον μέση συναγαγὼν προσήρμοσεν· ἡ δ' ἐκ μέσου πρὸς τὸν ἔσχατον οὐρανὸν πάντῃ διαπλακεῖσα κύκλῳ τε αὐτὸν ἔξωθεν περικαλύψασα, αὐτὴ ἐν αὐτῇ στρεφομένη, θεῖαν ἀρχὴν ἤρξατο ἀπαύστου καὶ ἔμφρονος βίου πρὸς τὸν σύμπαντα χρόνον. TI. καὶ τὸ μὲν δὴ σῶμα ὁρατὸν οὐρανοῦ γέγονεν, αὐτὴ δὲ ἀόρατος μὲν, λογισμοῦ δὲ μετέχουσα καὶ

37a

T: Now, since soul is blended from these three components (the natures of same, other and being), is divided and combined proportionally, and circles back upon itself, then whenever it touches upon something whose being is scattered, or something whose being is undivided, it is moved throughout its entire self, proclaims what precisely that is the

same as, and what it is different from, and also the sense, manner and occasion that each is so and is characterised as such, either in relation to things that come to be, or in relation to the unchanging and eternal. And the account which arises, being equally true, whether it concerns that which is other or same, is borne along without utterance or sound in that which is moved by itself. Whenever it arises concerning perceptible things, and the circle of other, running true, announces it through the entire soul, opinions and beliefs arise which are certain and true. But whenever, in contrast, it arises concerning the things of reason, and the circuit of same, running well, makes these things known, nous and knowledge are the necessary outcome. If anyone should ever say that these two arise in anything other than soul, he will be speaking entirely contrary to the truth.

ἀρμονίας ψυχῇ, τῶν νοητῶν αἰεὶ τε ὄντων ὑπὸ τοῦ ἀρίστου ἀρίστη γενομένη τῶν γεννηθέντων. ἅτε οὖν ἐκ τῆς ταυτοῦ καὶ τῆς θατέρου φύσεως ἕκ τε οὐσίας τριῶν τούτων συγκραθεῖσα μοιρῶν, καὶ ἀνὰ λόγον μερισθεῖσα καὶ συνδεθεῖσα, αὐτὴ τε ἀνακυκλουμένη πρὸς αὐτήν, ὅταν οὐσίαν σκεδαστὴν ἔχοντός τινος ἐφάπτηται καὶ ὅταν ἀμέριστον, λέγει κινουμένη διὰ πάσης ἑαυτῆς ὅτω τ' ἂν τι ταυτόν ᾗ καὶ ὅτου ἂν ἕτερον, πρὸς ὅτι τε μάλιστα καὶ ὅπη καὶ ὅπως καὶ ὁπότε συμβαίνει κατὰ τὰ γινόμενά τε πρὸς ἕκαστον ἕκαστα εἶναι καὶ πάσχειν καὶ πρὸς τὰ κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχοντα αἰεὶ. λόγος δὲ ὁ κατὰ ταυτόν ἀληθὴς γινόμενος περὶ τε θάτερον ὄν καὶ περὶ τὸ ταυτόν, ἐν τῷ κινουμένῳ ὑφ' αὐτοῦ φερόμενος ἄνευ φθόγγου καὶ ἡχῆς, ὅταν μὲν περὶ τὸ αἰσθητὸν γίγνηται καὶ ὁ τοῦ θατέρου κύκλος ὀρθὸς ἰὼν εἰς πᾶσαν αὐτοῦ τὴν ψυχὴν διαγγείλῃ, δόξαι καὶ πίστεις γίνονται βέβαιοι καὶ ἀληθεῖς,

37c

T: When the father who brought it into being realised it was moving and living, a delight created for the everlasting gods, he too was delighted, and in his rejoicing he decided to make it even more like its model. Now, since the model is an everlasting, living creature, he also undertook, accordingly, to render this Universe as much like that as possible. Now, in fact, the nature of the living creature was everlasting,

and it was not actually possible to completely impart eternity to the created entity, so he decided to make a moving image, and as he ordered the Heaven, he made an everlasting image of eternity abiding in unity, moving according to number, an image we have called time, for there were no days or nights, months or years, before the Heaven came to be. Then, at the same time as the Heaven was constructed, he arranged the creation of these. All of these are but parts of time and 'was' and 'will be' are forms of time which have been generated, although we do not notice this and apply these incorrectly to everlasting being. We do indeed say 'was', 'is' and 'will be', when 'is' alone is appropriate to it according to the true account, while it is more fitting to say 'was' and 'will be' of generation which unfolds in time, for both of these are movements. It does not belong to what is always the same and unmoving to become older or younger in the course of time, nor to have ever come into being, nor to have come into being now, nor to be about to exist in future. And, in general, nothing that generation attaches to motions in the sensory realm belongs to it, for these have come into being, forms of time, time which imitates eternity and revolves according to number. What's more, we even say such things as, "what has come to be 'is' what has come to be", and "what is coming to be 'is' coming to be", and again, "what will come to be 'is' what will come to be", and "what is not 'is' what is not", but none of these statements are accurate. Perhaps, though, it is not the right time now for a precise discussion of these issues.

ὅταν δὲ αὖ περὶ τὸ λογιστικὸν ἦ καὶ ὁ τοῦ ταύτου κύκλος εὐτροχος ὢν αὐτὰ μηνύσῃ, νοῦς ἐπιστήμη τε ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἀποτελεῖται· τούτῳ δὲ ἐν ᾧ τῶν ὄντων ἐγγίγνεσθον, ἅν ποτέ τις αὐτὸ ἄλλο πλὴν ψυχὴν εἴπῃ, πᾶν μᾶλλον ἢ τάληθές ἐρεῖ. ὥς δὲ κινηθὲν αὐτὸ καὶ ζῶν ἐνόησεν τῶν αἰδίων θεῶν γεγονὸς ἄγαλμα ὁ γεννήσας πατήρ, ἠγάσθη τε καὶ εὐφρανθεὶς ἔτι δὴ μᾶλλον ὅμοιον πρὸς τὸ παράδειγμα ἐπενόησεν ἀπεργάσασθαι. καθάπερ οὖν αὐτὸ τυγχάνει ζῶον αἰδίων ὄν, καὶ τόδε τὸ πᾶν οὕτως εἰς δύναμιν ἐπεχείρησε τοιοῦτον ἀποτελεῖν. ἡ μὲν οὖν τοῦ

ζώου φύσις ἐτύγχανεν οὔσα αἰώνιος, καὶ τοῦτο μὲν δὴ τῷ γεννητῷ παντελῶς προσάπτειν οὐκ ἦν δυνατόν· εἰκὼ δ' ἐπενόει κινητόν τινα αἰῶνος ποιῆσαι, καὶ διακοσμῶν ἅμα οὐρανὸν ποιεῖ μένοντος αἰῶνος ἐν ἐνὶ κατ' ἀριθμὸν ἰοῦσαν αἰώνιον εἰκόνα, τοῦτον δὲ δὴ χρόνον ὠνομάκαμεν. ἡμέρας γὰρ καὶ νύκτας καὶ μῆνας καὶ ἐνιαυτούς, οὐκ ὄντας πρὶν οὐρανὸν γενέσθαι, τότε ἅμα ἐκείνῳ συνισταμένῳ τὴν γένεσιν αὐτῶν μηχανᾶται· ταῦτα δὲ πάντα μέρη χρόνου, καὶ τό τ' ἦν τό τ' ἔσται χρόνου γεγονότα εἶδη, ἃ δὴ φέροντες λανθάνομεν ἐπὶ τὴν αἰδίδιον οὐσίαν οὐκ ὀρθῶς. ΤΙ. λέγομεν γὰρ δὴ ὡς ἦν ἔστιν τε καὶ ἔσται, τῇ δὲ τὸ ἔστιν μόνον κατὰ τὸν ἀληθῆ λόγον προσήκει, τὸ δὲ ἦν τό τ' ἔσται περὶ τὴν ἐν χρόνῳ γένεσιν ἰοῦσαν πρέπει λέγεσθαι—κινήσεις γάρ ἐστον, τὸ δὲ αἰεὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχον ἀκινήτως οὔτε πρεσβύτερον οὔτε νεώτερον προσήκει γίγνεσθαι διὰ χρόνου οὐδὲ γενέσθαι ποτὲ οὐδὲ γεγονέναι νῦν οὐδ' εἰς αὖθις ἔσεσθαι, τὸ παράπαν τε οὐδὲν ὅσα γένεσις τοῖς ἐν αἰσθήσει φερομένοις προσῆψεν, ἀλλὰ χρόνου ταῦτα αἰῶνα μιμουμένου καὶ κατ' ἀριθμὸν κυκλουμένου γέγονεν εἶδη—καὶ πρὸς τούτοις ἔτι τὰ τοιάδε,

38b

T: In any case, time came into being along with the heavens, so that having been generated simultaneously they would also be dissolved simultaneously, if they were ever dissolved, and it was based on the model of the eternal nature so that it would be as much like it as possible. For, indeed, the model is through all eternity, while the Heaven, for its part, having come into being, is, and will be, throughout all time.

τό τε γεγονὸς εἶναι γεγονὸς καὶ τὸ γιγνόμενον εἶναι γιγνόμενον, ἔτι τε τὸ γενησόμενον εἶναι γενησόμενον καὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν μὴ ὄν εἶναι, ὧν οὐδὲν ἀκριβὲς λέγομεν. περὶ μὲν οὖν τούτων τάχ' ἂν οὐκ εἴη καιρὸς πρέπων ἐν τῷ παρόντι διακριβολογεῖσθαι. χρόνος δ' οὖν μετ' οὐρανοῦ γέγονεν, ἵνα ἅμα γεννηθέντες ἅμα καὶ λυθῶσιν, ἅν ποτε λύσις τις αὐτῶν γίγνηται, καὶ κατὰ τὸ παράδειγμα τῆς διαιωνίας φύσεως, ἵν' ὡς ὁμοιότατος

38c

T: Based on such reasoning and consideration of the god about the creation of time, in order that time might come into being, the Sun, Moon and five other stars, which are called wanderers,¹² were generated to define and protect the numbers of time. Having made the bodies of each of these, the god placed them in the orbits in which the circuit of other was moving – seven bodies in seven orbits. The Moon he placed in the first orbit around the Earth, the Sun in the second above the Earth, the Morning Star too,¹³ and the one said to be sacred to Hermes¹⁴ he set moving in circles at an equal speed to the Sun, but allotted a power opposite to it so that Sun, Mercury and Venus alike overtake and are overtaken by one another. As for the other planets, if someone were to recount everything about them and the reasons he established them, the story, though a subsidiary one, would prove to be a greater task than our main undertaking. Indeed, all this may perhaps get proper attention later, at our leisure.

αὐτῷ κατὰ δύναμιν ἦ· τὸ μὲν γὰρ δὴ παράδειγμα πάντα αἰῶνά ἐστιν ὄν, ὁ δ' αὖ διὰ τέλους τὸν ἅπαντα χρόνον γεγονώς τε καὶ ὢν καὶ ἐσόμενος. ἐξ οὗν λόγου καὶ διανοίας θεοῦ τοιαύτης πρὸς χρόνου γένεσιν, ἵνα γεννηθῇ χρόνος, ἥλιος καὶ σελήνη καὶ πέντε ἄλλα ἄστρα, ἐπίκλην ἔχοντα πλανητά, εἰς διορισμὸν καὶ φυλακὴν ἀριθμῶν χρόνου γέγονεν· σώματα δὲ αὐτῶν ἐκάστων ποιήσας ὁ θεὸς ἔθηκεν εἰς τὰς περιφορὰς αἷς ἢ θατέρου περιόδου ἦειν, ἑπτὰ οὖσας ὄντα ἑπτὰ, σελήνην μὲν εἰς τὸν περὶ γῆν πρῶτον, ἥλιον δὲ εἰς τὸν δεύτερον ὑπὲρ γῆς, ἑωσφόρον δὲ καὶ τὸν ἱερὸν Ἑρμοῦ λεγόμενον εἰς τὸν τάχει μὲν ἰσόδρομον ἡλίῳ κύκλον ἰόντας, τὴν δὲ ἐναντίαν εἰληχότας αὐτῷ δύναμιν· ὅθεν καταλαμβάνουσιν τε καὶ καταλαμβάνονται κατὰ ταῦτα ὑπ' ἀλλήλων ἥλιός τε καὶ ὁ τοῦ Ἑρμοῦ καὶ ἑωσφόρος. τὰ δ' ἄλλα οἱ δὴ καὶ δι' αἷς αἰτίας ἰδρύσατο, εἴ τις ἐπεξίτοι πάσας, ὁ λόγος

38e

T: In any case, when each had occupied its own proper course as needed to help in the production of time, these bodies were bound with bonds of soul and became living creatures and learned their assigned duties, each moving in actual accord with the sideways

motion of the circuit of other, which revolves within the circuit of same and is ruled by it, some traversing a greater circle, some a lesser, those in the lesser circle revolving faster, those in the greater revolving more slowly. Due to the motion of same, those which went around fastest seemed to be overtaken by the slowest, though they actually overtook the slowest. For the movement of same, which is the swiftest of all motions, turned all their circles in a spiral due to their divided, and also opposite, forward motion, and it made that which moves away from itself most slowly seem closest to it in speed.

πάρεργος ὢν πλέον ἂν ἔργον ὢν ἔνεκα λέγεται παράσχοι. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν ἴσως τάχ' ἂν κατὰ σχολὴν ὕστερον τῆς ἀξίας τύχοι διηγήσεως. ΤΙ. ἐπειδὴ δὲ οὖν εἰς τὴν ἑαυτῷ πρέπουσαν ἕκαστον ἀφίκετο φορὰν τῶν ὅσα ἔδει συναπεργάζεσθαι χρόνον, δεσμοῖς τε ἐμψύχοις σώματα δεθέντα ζῶα ἐγεννήθη τό τε προσταχθὲν ἔμαθεν, κατὰ δὲ τὴν θατέρου φορὰν πλαγίαν οὔσαν, διὰ τῆς ταύτου φορᾶς ἰούσης τε καὶ κρατουμένης, τὸ μὲν μείζονα αὐτῶν, τὸ δ' ἐλάττω κύκλον ἰόν, θᾶπτον μὲν τὰ τὸν ἐλάττω, τὰ δὲ τὸν μείζω βραδύτερον περιήειν. τῇ δὲ ταύτου φορᾷ τὰ τάχιστα περιόντα ὑπὸ τῶν βραδύτερον ἰόντων ἐφαίνετο καταλαμβάνοντα καταλαμβάνεσθαι· πάντας γὰρ τοὺς κύκλους αὐτῶν στρέφουσα ἔλικά διὰ τὸ διχῇ κατὰ

39b

T: So that there might be some obvious measure of their relative slowness or swiftness, and so that the eight courses might proceed, the god kindled a light in the second of the orbits from the Earth, a light we now call the Sun, so that it would shine with all its might through the entire Heaven, and all deserving creatures would have a share in number, having learned it from the revolutions of same and similar. So this is how and these are the reasons why day and night, the revolution of the single most intelligent circuit, have come into being. However, when the Moon traverses its own circuit and overtakes the Sun, a month is generated, and whenever the Sun completes its own circuit, a year is generated. Men, save a few of them, have not understood the periods of the other planets, nor have they named

them, nor have they measured them against one another through numerical investigation. Consequently, they do not really understand that the numerous, complex and wonderfully intricate wanderings of these planets actually constitute time. Yet it is possible, nevertheless, to understand that the perfect number of time fulfils the perfect year, when the speeds with respect to one another belonging to all eight orbits are concluded simultaneously and they have attained completion as measured by the circuit of same, and similarly moving. So, based on these principles and for these reasons, the stars came into being, those which have their turnings and proceed through Heaven, so that this Universe might be as much like the perfect, intelligible creature as possible in its imitation of the eternal nature.

τὰ ἐναντία ἅμα προΐεναι τὸ βραδύτατα ἀπὸν ἀφ' αὐτῆς οὔσης ταχίστης ἐγγύτατα ἀπέφαιναν. ἵνα δ' εἷη μέτρον ἐναργές τι πρὸς ἄλληλα βραδυτῆτι καὶ τάχει καὶ τὰ περὶ τὰς ὀκτὼ φοράς πορεύοιτο, φῶς ὁ θεὸς ἀνῆψεν ἐν τῇ πρὸς γῆν δευτέρᾳ τῶν περιόδων, ὃ δὴ νῦν κεκλήκαμεν ἥλιον, ἵνα ὅτι μάλιστα εἰς ἅπαντα φαίνει τὸν οὐρανὸν μετὰσχοι τε ἀριθμοῦ τὰ ζῶα ὅσοις ἦν προσῆκον, μαθόντα παρὰ τῆς ταύτου καὶ ὁμοίου περιφορᾶς. νῦξ μὲν οὖν ἡμέρα τε γέγονεν οὕτως καὶ διὰ ταῦτα, ἡ τῆς μιᾶς καὶ φρονημωτάτης κυκλήσεως περίοδος· μείς δὲ ἐπειδὴν σελήνην περιελθοῦσα τὸν ἑαυτῆς κύκλον ἥλιον ἐπικαταλάβῃ, ἐνιαυτὸς δὲ ὁπότεν ἥλιος τὸν ἑαυτοῦ περιέλθῃ κύκλον. τῶν δ' ἄλλων τὰς περιόδους οὐκ ἐννενοηκότες ἄνθρωποι, πλὴν ὀλίγοι τῶν πολλῶν, οὔτε ὀνομάζουσιν οὔτε πρὸς ἄλληλα συμμετροῦνται σκοποῦντες ἀριθμοῖς, ὥστε ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐκ ἴσασι χρόνον ὄντα τὰς τούτων πλάνας, πλήθει μὲν ἀμηχάνῳ χρωμένας, πεποικιλμένας δὲ θαυμαστῶς· ἔστιν δ' ὅμως οὐδὲν ἥττον κατανοῆσαι δυνατόν ὡς ὁ γε τέλος ἀριθμὸς χρόνου τὸν τέλος ἐνιαυτὸν πληροῖ τότε, ὅταν ἀπασῶν τῶν ὀκτὼ περιόδων τὰ πρὸς ἄλληλα συμπερανθέντα τάχῃ σχῇ κεφαλὴν τῷ τοῦ ταύτου καὶ ὁμοίως ἰόντος ἀναμετρηθέντα κύκλῳ. κατὰ ταῦτα δὴ καὶ τούτων ἕνεκα ἐγεννήθη τῶν ἄστρον ὅσα δι' οὐρανοῦ πορευόμενα ἔσχεν τροπὰς, ἵνα τόδε

T: Now, in other respects, including the creation of time, the Universe was already fashioned very like the model it was imitating. However, it was still unlike it in one respect, as it did not yet contain, generated within itself, all the living creatures. He set about this remaining task by moulding the Universe towards the nature of the model. In the same way that nous beholds how many and what kind of forms are contained in that actual living being, he decided that this Universe too should possess such kinds as these, in such numbers. Now, there are four kinds, one the heavenly race of gods, another winged and airborne, a third type dwelling in water, and a fourth traversing dry land on foot.

ὥς ὁμοιότατον ἦ τῷ τελέῳ καὶ νοητῷ ζῳῷ πρὸς τὴν τῆς διαιωνίας μίμησιν φύσεως. καὶ τὰ μὲν ἄλλα ἤδη μέχρι χρόνου γενέσεως ἀπείργαστο εἰς ὁμοιότητα ὥπερ ἀπεικάζεται, τὸ δὲ μήπω τὰ πάντα ζῶα ἐντὸς αὐτοῦ γεγεννημένα περιειληφέναι, ταύτη ἔτι εἶχεν ἀνομοίως. τοῦτο δὴ τὸ κατάλοιπον ἀπηργάζετο αὐτοῦ πρὸς τὴν τοῦ παραδείγματος ἀποτυπούμενος φύσιν. ἥπερ οὖν νοῦς ἐνούσας ἰδέας τῷ ὃ ἔστιν ζῶον, οἷαί τε ἔνεισι καὶ ὅσαι, καθορᾷ, τοιαύτας καὶ τοσαύτας διενόηθη δεῖν καὶ τόδε σχεῖν. TI. εἰσὶν δὴ τέτταρες, μία μὲν οὐράνιον θεῶν γένος, ἄλλη δὲ

40a

T: The form of the divine race he made mostly from fire so that it would be the brightest and most beautiful to behold, and to make it resemble the Universe, he made it well rounded. He placed it in the intelligence of the dominant circuit to follow that path, and distributed it around the entire Heaven in a circle, to be a true adornment to it, embroidered over the whole. He assigned two movements to each, one an unchanging movement in the same place, always thinking to itself the same thoughts about the same things, the other a forward motion dominated by the revolutions of same and similar.¹⁵ They are devoid of the other five motions and are at rest, so that each of them may become as excellent as possible.¹⁶ From this cause, all the un-wandering stars have come into being – divine,

everlasting creatures which abide forever, revolving in the same way in the same place. But those that turn back and keep wandering in this fashion have come into being in the manner we described before. And Earth, our nurse, packed about the axis stretching through the Universe, he devised as guardian and artificer of night and day, the first and eldest of all the gods that have come into existence within the Heaven.

πτηνὸν καὶ ἀεροπόρον, τρίτη δὲ ἔνυδρον εἶδος, πεζὸν δὲ καὶ χερσαῖον τέταρτον. τοῦ μὲν οὖν θείου τὴν πλείστην ἰδέαν ἐκ πυρὸς ἀπηργάζετο, ὅπως ὅτι λαμπρότατον ἰδεῖν τε κάλλιστον εἶη, τῷ δὲ παντὶ προσεικάζων εὐκυκλον ἐποίει, τίθησιν τε εἰς τὴν τοῦ κρατίστου φρόνησιν ἐκείνῳ συνεπόμενον, νείμας περὶ πάντα κύκλῳ τὸν οὐρανόν, κόσμον ἀληθινὸν αὐτῷ πεποικιλμένον εἶναι καθ' ὅλον. κινήσεις δὲ δύο προσῆψεν ἐκάστῳ, τὴν μὲν ἐν ταύτῳ κατὰ ταῦτά, περὶ τῶν αὐτῶν αἰεὶ τὰ αὐτὰ ἑαυτῷ διανοομένῳ, τὴν δὲ εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν, ὑπὸ τῆς ταύτου καὶ ὁμοίου περιφορᾶς κρατουμένῳ· τὰς δὲ πέντε κινήσεις ἀκίνητον καὶ ἐστός, ἵνα ὅτι μάλιστα αὐτῶν ἕκαστον γένοιτο ὡς ἄριστον. ἐξ ἧς δὲ τῆς αἰτίας γέγονεν ὅσ' ἀπλανῆ τῶν ἄστρον ζῶα θεῖα ὄντα καὶ αἰδία καὶ κατὰ ταῦτά ἐν ταύτῳ στρεφόμενα αἰεὶ μένει· τὰ δὲ τρεπόμενα καὶ πλάνην τοιαύτην ἴσχοντα, καθάπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐρρήθη, κατ' ἐκεῖνα γέγονεν. γῆν δὲ τροφὸν μὲν ἡμετέραν, ἰλλομένην δὲ

40c

T: As for the dances of the gods themselves and their juxtapositions with one another, the backward revolutions of the circuits upon themselves and their advances which are in line with each other during conjunctions, and how many are behind and what each is hidden by, both from themselves and from us so that when they reappear they send terrors and portents of things to come to men who are not capable of reasoning..., to describe this without a visible model of the movements would be a vain task. Rather, we should be satisfied at that and let our discussions about the nature of the visible and generated gods come to an end.

τὴν περὶ τὸν διὰ παντὸς πόλον τεταμένον, φύλακα καὶ δημιουργὸν νυκτός τε καὶ ἡμέρας ἐμηχανήσατο, πρῶτην καὶ πρεσβυτάτην θεῶν ὅσοι ἐντὸς οὐρανοῦ γεγόνασιν. χορείας δὲ τούτων αὐτῶν καὶ παραβολὰς ἀλλήλων, καὶ περὶ τὰς τῶν κύκλων πρὸς ἑαυτοὺς ἐπανακυκλήσεις καὶ προχωρήσεις, ἔν τε ταῖς συνάψεσιν ὅποιοι τῶν θεῶν κατ' ἀλλήλους γιγνόμενοι καὶ ὅσοι καταντικρὺ, μεθ' οὔστινάς τε ἐπίπροσθεν ἀλλήλοις ἡμῖν τε κατὰ χρόνους οὔστινας ἕκαστοι κατακαλύπτονται καὶ πάλιν ἀναφαινόμενοι φόβους καὶ σημεία τῶν

40d

T: To describe and understand the origin of the other divinities is beyond us, so we must believe those who have already spoken and who claim to be the offspring of the gods, and presumably know their own ancestors very well. Now, it is impossible to disbelieve the children of gods even though they speak without any probable or compelling evidence; yet they speak as though they are describing family matters, so we should follow custom and believe them. Accordingly, let us accept their version of the generation of those gods and let us describe it. Ocean and Tethys were born children of Earth and Heaven, and from these were born Phorcys, Cronus and Rhea, and all their companions. From Cronus and Rhea came Zeus, Hera, and all those we know by report as their brothers and sisters, and a further generation born from these.

μετὰ ταῦτα γενησομένων τοῖς οὐ δυναμένοις λογίζεσθαι πέμπουσιν, τὸ λέγειν ἄνευ δι' ὅψεως τούτων αὐτῶν μιμημάτων μάταιος ἂν εἴη πόνος· ἀλλὰ ταῦτά τε ἱκανῶς ἡμῖν ταύτη καὶ τὰ περὶ θεῶν ὁρατῶν καὶ γεννητῶν εἰρημένα φύσεως ἔχέτω τέλος. περὶ δὲ τῶν ἄλλων δαιμόνων εἰπεῖν καὶ γνῶναι τὴν γένεσιν μεῖζον ἢ καθ' ἡμᾶς, πειστέον δὲ τοῖς εἰρηκόσιν ἔμπροσθεν, ἐκγόνοις μὲν θεῶν οὔσιν, ὡς ἔφασαν, σαφῶς δὲ που τοὺς γε αὐτῶν προγόνους εἰδόσιν· ἀδύνατον οὖν θεῶν παισὶν ἀπιστεῖν, καίπερ ἄνευ τε εἰκότων καὶ ἀναγκαίων ἀποδείξεων λέγουσιν, ἀλλ' ὡς οἰκεῖα φασκόντων ἀπαγγέλλειν ἐπομένους τῷ νόμῳ πιστευτέον. ΤΙ. οὕτως οὖν κατ' ἐκείνους ἡμῖν ἡ γένεσις περὶ τούτων τῶν θεῶν ἔχέτω καὶ λεγέσθω. Γῆς τε καὶ Οὐρανοῦ παῖδες Ὠκεανός τε

καὶ Τηθὺς ἐγενέσθην, τούτων δὲ Φόρκυς Κρόνος τε καὶ Ῥέα καὶ ὅσοι μετὰ

41a

T: In any case, when all the gods had come into being, both those who wander about conspicuously and the ones who appear only as often as they wish, he who had generated this Universe spoke to them and said, "Gods of gods, works of which I am the maker and father, what I have brought into being is indissoluble unless I so desire. Now, anything that is bound together can indeed be dissolved, but only bad would wish to dissolve something which has been beautifully harmonised and is in good order. Since you have come into being, you are not truly immortal or entirely indissoluble, and yet there is nothing which will dissolve you, nor will the fate of death befall you, because in my will you have an even greater and more powerful bond granted you than those by which you were bound together at birth. Therefore, understand the declaration I am now making to you. There are three types of mortal creatures yet to be created. If these are not brought into existence, the Heaven will be incomplete for it will not have within itself all types of creatures, and it must have these if it is to be complete in an adequate manner. But if they were brought into being and partook of life through my agency, they would be equal unto gods. Therefore, so that they may be mortal and this Universe truly universal, betake yourselves, as is natural to you, to the production of living creatures, imitating the power by which I brought you into being.

τούτων, ἐκ δὲ Κρόνου καὶ Ῥέας Ζεὺς Ἥρα τε καὶ πάντες ὅσους ἴσμεν ἀδελφοὺς λεγομένους αὐτῶν, ἔτι τε τούτων ἄλλους ἐκγόνους· ἐπεὶ δ' οὖν πάντες ὅσοι τε περιπολοῦσιν φανερώς καὶ ὅσοι φαίνονται καθ' ὅσον ἂν ἐθέλωσιν θεοὶ γένεσιν ἔσχον, λέγει πρὸς αὐτοὺς ὁ τότε τὸ πᾶν γεννήσας τάδε— θεοὶ θεῶν, ὧν ἐγὼ δημιουργὸς πατήρ τε ἔργων, δι' ἐμοῦ γεγόμενα ἅλута ἐμοῦ γε μὴ ἐθέλοντος. τὸ μὲν οὖν δὴ δεθὲν πᾶν λυτόν, τό γε μὴν καλῶς ἀρμοσθὲν καὶ ἔχον εὖ λύειν ἐθέλειν κακοῦ· δι' ἃ καὶ ἐπέιπερ γεγένησθε, ἀθάνατοι μὲν οὐκ ἐστὲ οὐδ' ἅλυτοι τὸ πάμπαν,

οὔτι μὲν δὴ λυθήσεσθῃ γε οὐδὲ τεύξεσθε θανάτου μοίρας, τῆς ἐμῆς βουλήσεως μερίζονος ἔτι δεσμοῦ καὶ κυριωτέρου λαχόντες ἐκείνων οἷς ὅτ' ἐγίγνεσθε συνεδεῖσθε. νῦν οὖν ὃ λέγω πρὸς ὑμᾶς ἐνδεικνύμενος, μάθετε. θνητὰ ἔτι γένη λοιπὰ τρία ἀγέννητα· τούτων δὲ μὴ γενομένων οὐρανὸς ἀτελὴς ἔσται· τὰ γὰρ ἅπαντ' ἐν αὐτῷ γένη ζῶων οὐχ ἕξει, δεῖ δέ, εἰ μέλλει τέλος ἰκανῶς εἶναι. δι' ἐμοῦ δὲ ταῦτα γενόμενα καὶ βίου μετασχόντα θεοῖς ἰσάζοιτ' ἄν· ἵνα οὖν θνητὰ τε ἢ τὸ τε πᾶν τόδε ὄντως ἅπαν ἦ, τρέπεσθε κατὰ φύσιν ὑμεῖς ἐπὶ τὴν τῶν ζῶων δημιουργίαν, μιμούμενοι τὴν ἐμὴν δύναμιν περὶ τὴν ὑμετέραν γένεσιν. καὶ καθ' ὅσον μὲν αὐτῶν ἀθανάτοις ὁμώνυμον εἶναι προσήκει, θεῖον λεγόμενον ἡγεμονοῦν τε ἐν αὐτοῖς τῶν ἀεὶ δίκη καὶ ὑμῖν ἐθελόντων ἔπεσθαι, σπείρας καὶ ὑπαρξάμενος

41d

T: "Now, I shall begin by sowing the seed and handing over to you the part of the creatures which rightly shares the same name as the immortals, the part which is called divine and which rules supreme in those who desire always to follow justice and yourselves. You must do the rest – make the living creatures by weaving the immortal with the mortal, give them birth, nourish them and make them grow, and when they perish, receive them back again."

41d

T: The maker of the Universe said this and went again to the mixing bowl in which he had previously mixed and blended the soul of the Universe. He poured in the remainder of the former mixture, blending it in somewhat the same manner, but it was no longer pure in the same way as before, but second or third in degree of purity. When he had compounded the entire, he divided it into souls equal in number with the stars, allocated each soul to its particular star, and, having mounted them as though in a chariot, he showed them the nature of the Universe and told them the laws of destiny: that the first birth would be arranged the same for everyone so that no one would be disadvantaged at his hands; that they should be dispersed to the instruments of time appropriate to each to grow as the most god-

revering of creatures; and the nature of humanity being twofold, the stronger would be the kind which should hereafter be called man. Once the souls were, of necessity, implanted in bodies, and there was a process of addition and removal of portions of their bodies, in the first place an innate sense perception would necessarily arise in all, produced from forceful impressions; second would be love mixed with pleasure and pain, and, in addition to these, fear and desire and all that follows in their train, and whatever stands in natural opposition to these. If they should conquer these they would live justly, but if conquered by them, unjustly. Whoever lived well during his assigned period of life would journey again to his native home, which is his kindred star, to live a happy life in conformity with his nature. But if he should fall short of this, he would transform into a woman's nature in his second birth. And if in this form he still does not desist from wrongdoing, as is the manner of his corruption so also is his transformation into an animal nature that resembles his evil tendency. He will not cease from these painful transformations until he draws into the circuit of same and similar that is within himself, the vast accretion composed of fire and water, earth and air, which has grown about him of late, has conquered its turbulence and irrationality by reason, and returns again to the form of his original and most excellent condition.

ἐγὼ παραδώσω· τὸ δὲ λοιπὸν ὑμεῖς, ἀθανάτω θνητὸν προσυφαίνοντες, ἀπεργάζεσθε ζῶα καὶ γεννᾶτε τροφήν τε διδόντες αὐξάνετε καὶ φθίνοντα πάλιν δέχεσθε. ταῦτ' εἶπε, καὶ πάλιν ἐπὶ τὸν πρότερον κρατῆρα, ἐν ᾧ τὴν τοῦ παντὸς ψυχὴν κεραννὺς ἔμισγεν, τὰ τῶν πρόσθεν ὑπόλοιπα κατεχεῖτο μίσγων τρόπον μὲν τινα τὸν αὐτόν, ἀκήρατα δὲ οὐκέτι κατὰ ταῦτα ὡσαύτως, ἀλλὰ δεύτερα καὶ τρίτα. συστήσας δὲ τὸ πᾶν διεῖλεν ψυχὰς ἰσαρίθμους τοῖς ἄστροις, ἔνειμέν θ' ἐκάστην πρὸς ἕκαστον, καὶ ἐμβιβάσας ὡς ἐς ὄχημα τὴν τοῦ παντὸς φύσιν ἔδειξεν, νόμους τε τοὺς εἰμαρμένους εἶπεν αὐταῖς, ὅτι γένεσις πρώτη μὲν ἔσοιτο τεταγμένη μία πᾶσιν, ἵνα μή τις ἐλαττοῖτο ὑπ' αὐτοῦ, δέοι δὲ σπαρείσας αὐτὰς εἰς τὰ προσήκοντα ἐκάσταις ἕκαστα ὄργανα

χρόνων φῦναι ζώων τὸ θεοσεβέστατον, διπλῆς δὲ οὔσης τῆς ἀνθρωπίνης φύσεως, τὸ κρεῖττον τοιοῦτον εἶη γένος ὃ καὶ ἔπειτα κεκλήσοιτο ἀνὴρ. ΤΙ. ὁπότε δὴ σώμασιν ἐμφυτευθεῖεν ἐξ ἀνάγκης, καὶ τὸ μὲν προσίοι, τὸ δ' ἀπίοι τοῦ σώματος αὐτῶν, πρῶτον μὲν αἰσθησιν ἀναγκαῖον εἶη μίαν πᾶσιν ἐκ βιαίων παθημάτων σύμφυτον γίγνεσθαι, δεύτερον δὲ ἡδονῇ καὶ λύπῃ μεμειγμένον ἔρωτα, πρὸς δὲ τούτοις φόβον καὶ θυμὸν ὅσα τε ἐπόμενα αὐτοῖς καὶ ὁπόσα ἐναντίως πέφυκε διεστηκότα ὧν εἰ μὲν κρατήσοιεν, δίκη βιώσονται, κρατηθέντες δὲ ἀδικία. καὶ ὁ μὲν εὖ τὸν προσήκοντα χρόνον βιούς, πάλιν εἰς τὴν τοῦ συννόμου πορευθεὶς οἴκησιν ἄστρου, βίον εὐδαίμονα καὶ συνήθη ἔξοι, σφαλεῖς δὲ τούτων εἰς γυναικὸς φύσιν ἐν τῇ δευτέρᾳ γενέσει μεταβαλοῖ μὴ παυόμενός τε ἐν τούτοις ἔτι κακίας, τρόπον ὃν κακύνοιτο, κατὰ τὴν ὁμοιότητα τῆς τοῦ τρόπου γενέσεως εἰς τινα τοιαύτην αἰὲ μεταβαλοῖ θήρειον φύσιν, ἀλλάττων τε οὐ πρότερον πόνων λήξοι, πρὶν τῇ ταυτοῦ καὶ ὁμοίου περιόδῳ τῇ ἐν αὐτῷ συνεπισπώμενος τὸν πολὺν ὄχλον καὶ ὕστερον προσφύντα ἐκ πυρὸς καὶ ὕδατος καὶ ἀέρος

42d

T: When he had prescribed all these laws for humans so that he would be blameless of their future evil doings, he sowed some of them in the Earth, some in the Moon, and some in the other instruments of time. But when the sowing was complete, he handed over the making of mortal bodies to the young gods, and, as well as that, the fashioning of all the parts of human souls that still had to be added, and all that goes along with them. And they were also to govern this mortal creature and guide it as beautifully and excellently as they could, unless it should become a source of evil to itself.

καὶ γῆς, θορυβώδη καὶ ἄλογον ὄντα, λόγῳ κρατήσας εἰς τὸ τῆς πρώτης καὶ ἀρίστης ἀφίκοιτο εἶδος ἔξω. διαθεσμοθετήσας δὲ πάντα αὐτοῖς ταῦτα, ἵνα τῆς ἔπειτα εἶη κακίας ἐκάστων ἀναίτιος, ἔσπειρεν τοὺς μὲν εἰς γῆν, τοὺς δ' εἰς σελήνην, τοὺς δ' εἰς τᾶλλα ὅσα ὄργανα χρόνου τὸ δὲ μετὰ τὸν σπóρον τοῖς νέοις παρέδωκεν θεοῖς σώματα πλάττειν θνητά, τό τ' ἐπίλοιπον, ὅσον ἔτι ἦν ψυχῆς ἀνθρωπίνης δέον

42e

T: He who had decreed all this remained as usual in his own accustomed state, and as he so remained, the children understood the direction of their father and obeyed it. They took from him the immortal beginning of the mortal creature, and imitating their own artificer, they borrowed portions of fire, earth, water and air from the Universe, intending to return these again. What they had taken they bonded together into a unity, not with the indissoluble bonds with which they themselves had been conjoined, but fusing them together with myriad tiny invisible pegs. Fashioning each body as a unity from all the elements, they bound the circuits of the immortal soul within the inflowing and out-flowing body. These orbits, which were bound within an enormous stream, neither dominated it nor were dominated by it, but they brought about and suffered violent motion. So the entire creature was moved, and it advanced, randomly and irrationally, in any way at all, exhibiting all six types of movement at once as it progressed forward and backward, and then right and left, down and up, as it went wandering in all six directions. The surge which poured in and gushed out and brought nutriment was mighty indeed, but greater yet was the disturbance to each wrought by all the impinging sensations when the body happened to collide with fire from something external and alien, or with a hard lump of earth or smooth sliding waters, or was carried away by a storm of winds borne by the air. And the movements caused by all these, being borne through the body, fell upon the soul. Indeed, on account of all this, such movements were called sensations thereafter and are still so called today.¹⁷ Furthermore, at that particular time these were the source of the greatest and most varied movement, and along with the constantly flowing stream they moved and shook the revolutions of the soul violently, completely blocked the revolution of same by flowing against it, and prevented it from ruling and proceeding. And what's more, they threw the revolution of other into confusion, turning each of the three double and triple intervals and the $3/2$, $4/3$ and $9/8$ middle terms and connections in all directions, and although they

could not be entirely undone save by their maker, they caused all manner of fractures and deformations of the circles so that they moved along, but barely holding themselves together, borne irrationally, sometimes in opposite directions, sometimes sideways, sometimes upside down.

προσγενέσθαι, τοῦτο καὶ πάνθ' ὅσα ἀκόλουθα ἐκείνοις ἀπεργασαμένους ἄρχειν, καὶ κατὰ δύναμιν ὅτι κάλλιστα καὶ ἄριστα τὸ θνητὸν διακυβερνᾶν ζῶον, ὅτι μὴ κακῶν αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ γίγνοιτο αἴτιον. καὶ ὁ μὲν δὴ ἅπαντα ταῦτα διατάξας ἔμενεν ἐν τῷ ἑαυτοῦ κατὰ τρόπον ἦθαι. ΤΙ. μένοντος δὲ νοήσαντες οἱ παῖδες τὴν τοῦ πατρὸς τάξιν ἐπέιθοντο αὐτῇ, καὶ λαβόντες ἀθάνατον ἀρχὴν θνητοῦ ζώου, μιμούμενοι τὸν σφέτερον δημιουργόν, πυρὸς καὶ γῆς ὕδατός τε καὶ ἀέρος ἀπὸ τοῦ κόσμου δανειζόμενοι μόρια ὡς ἀποδοθησόμενα πάλιν, εἰς ταῦτόν τὰ λαμβανόμενα συνεκόλλων, οὐ τοῖς ἀλύτοις οἷς αὐτοὶ συνείχοντο δεσμοῖς, ἀλλὰ διὰ σμικρότητα ἀοράτοις πυκνοῖς γόμφοις συντήκοντες, ἐν ἑξ ἀπάντων ἀπεργαζόμενοι σῶμα ἕκαστον, τὰς τῆς ἀθανάτου ψυχῆς περιόδους ἐνέδουν εἰς ἐπίρρυτον σῶμα καὶ ἀπόρρυτον. αἱ δ' εἰς ποταμὸν ἐνδεθεῖσαι πολὺν οὐτ' ἐκράτουν οὐτ' ἐκρατοῦντο, βία δὲ ἐφέροντο καὶ ἔφερον, ὥστε τὸ μὲν ὅλον κινεῖσθαι ζῶον, ἀτάκτως μὴν ὅπη τύχοι προιέναι καὶ ἀλόγως, τὰς ἑξ ἀπάσας κινήσεις ἔχον· εἷς τε γὰρ τὸ πρόσθε καὶ ὀπίσθεν καὶ πάλιν εἰς δεξιὰ καὶ ἀριστερὰ κάτω τε καὶ ἄνω καὶ πάντη κατὰ τοὺς ἑξ τόπους πλανώμενα προήειν. πολλοῦ γὰρ ὄντος τοῦ κατακλύζοντος καὶ ἀπορρέοντος κύματος ὃ τὴν τροφήν παρεῖχεν, ἔτι μείζω θόρυβον ἀπηργάζετο τὰ τῶν προσπιπτόντων παθήματα ἑκάστοις, ὅτε πυρὶ προσκρούσειε τὸ σῶμά τινος ἔξωθεν ἄλλοτρίῳ περιτυχὸν ἢ καὶ στερεῷ γῆς πάγῳ ὑγροῖς τε ὀλισθημασιν ὑδάτων, εἴτε ζάλη πνευμάτων ὑπὸ ἀέρος φερομένων καταληφθεῖη, καὶ ὑπὸ πάντων τούτων διὰ τοῦ σώματος αἱ κινήσεις ἐπὶ τὴν ψυχὴν φερόμεναι προσπίπτουσιν· αἱ δὴ καὶ ἔπειτα διὰ ταῦτα ἐκλήθησάν τε καὶ νῦν ἔτι αἰσθήσεις συνάπασαι κέκληνται. καὶ δὴ καὶ τότε ἐν τῷ παρόντι πλείστην καὶ μεγίστην παρεχόμεναι κίνησιν, μετὰ τοῦ ῥέοντος ἐνδελεχῶς ὀχετοῦ κινεῖσθαι καὶ σφοδρῶς σείουσιν τὰς τῆς ψυχῆς περιόδους, τὴν μὲν ταύτου παντάπασιν ἐπέδησαν ἐναντία αὐτῇ ῥέουσιν καὶ ἐπέσχον

ἄρχουσαν καὶ ἰοῦσαν, τὴν δ' αὖ θατέρου διέσεισαν, ὥστε τὰς τοῦ διπλασίου καὶ τριπλασίου τρεῖς ἑκατέρας ἀποστάσεις καὶ τὰς τῶν ἡμιολίων καὶ ἐπιτρίτων καὶ ἐπογδῶν μεσότηας καὶ συνδέσεις, ἐπειδὴ παντελῶς λυταὶ οὐκ ἦσαν πλὴν ὑπὸ τοῦ συνδήσαντος, πάσας μὲν

43e

T: Just as whenever someone is propped upside down, his head on the ground, his feet pressed against something, in that predicament what is right for the person will appear as left to his observers, and what is left for him will appear right for them. So when the circuits are undergoing this experience, and others like this, in an intense manner, whenever they happen upon something external of the class of same or of other, they then declare it to be same as something or other than something, in direct opposition to the truth, having become false and devoid of intelligence, without even one orbit ruling and leading among them at that time. Indeed, should some sense impressions, carried from outside to the orbits of the soul and impinging on them, draw the entire vessel of the soul along with them, then although the orbits seem to be dominating themselves, they are being dominated by the senses. And, indeed, because of all these experiences, the soul now, as in the beginning, becomes devoid of nous at first whenever it is bound within a mortal body. But whenever the stream which brings growth and nourishment lessens its influx, and the orbits become calm again, traverse their own paths and become more stable with the passing of time, then at that stage the orbits are kept in line with the course of the natural motion of each of the circles, they proclaim other and same correctly, and cause their possessor to become intelligent. And, indeed, if some right nurture should also play a role in his education, he becomes completely unblemished and sound, having escaped the worst possible disease. However, if he neglects this, he limps his way through life and returns once more to Hades, incomplete and devoid of intelligence.

στρέψαι στροφάς, πάσας δὲ κλάσεις καὶ διαφθοράς τῶν κύκλων ἐμποιεῖν, ὅσαχῆπερ ἦν δυνατόν, ὥστε μετ' ἀλλήλων μόγις

συνεχομένας φέρεσθαι μέν, ἀλόγως δὲ φέρεσθαι, τοτὲ μὲν ἀντίας, ἄλλοτε δὲ πλαγίας, τοτὲ δὲ ὑπτίας· οἷον ὅταν τις ὑπτίος ἐρείσας τὴν κεφαλὴν μὲν ἐπὶ γῆς, τοὺς δὲ πόδας ἄνω προσβαλὼν ἔχη πρὸς τινι, τότε ἐν τούτῳ τῷ πάθει τοῦ τε πάσχοντος καὶ τῶν ὁρώντων τὰ τε δεξιὰ ἀριστερὰ καὶ τὰ ἀριστερὰ δεξιὰ ἐκατέροις τὰ ἐκατέρων φαντάζεται. ΤΙ. ταὐτὸν δὴ τοῦτο καὶ τοιαῦτα ἕτερα αἱ περιφοραὶ πάσχουσαι σφοδρῶς, ὅταν τέ τῳ τῶν ἔξωθεν τοῦ ταύτου γένους ἢ τοῦ θατέρου περιτύχωσιν, τότε ταὐτόν τῳ καὶ θάτερόν του τὰναντία τῶν ἀληθῶν προσαγορεύουσαι ψευδεῖς καὶ ἀνόητοι γεγόνασιν, οὐδεμία τε ἐν αὐταῖς τότε περίοδος ἄρχουσα οὐδ' ἡγεμών ἐστίν· αἷς δ' ἂν ἔξωθεν αἰσθήσεις τινὲς φερόμεναι καὶ προσπεσοῦσαι συνεπισπάσωνται καὶ τὸ τῆς ψυχῆς ἅπαν κύτος, τόθ' αὐταὶ κρατούμεναι κρατεῖν δοκοῦσι. καὶ διὰ δὴ ταῦτα πάντα τὰ παθήματα νῦν κατ' ἀρχάς τε ἄνους ψυχὴ γίγνεται τὸ πρῶτον, ὅταν εἰς σῶμα ἐνδεθῇ θνητόν. ὅταν δὲ τὸ τῆς αὔξης καὶ τροφῆς ἔλαττον ἐπὶ ῥεῦμα, πάλιν δὲ αἱ περίοδοι λαμβανόμεναι γαλήνης τὴν ἑαυτῶν ὁδὸν ἴωσι καὶ καθιστῶνται μᾶλλον ἐπιόντος τοῦ χρόνου, τότε ἤδη πρὸς τὸ κατὰ φύσιν ἰόντων σχῆμα ἐκάστων τῶν κύκλων αἱ περιφοραὶ κατευθυνόμεναι, τό τε θάτερον καὶ τὸ ταὐτὸν προσαγορεύουσαι κατ' ὀρθόν, ἔμφρονα τὸν ἔχοντα αὐτὰς γιγνόμενον ἀποτελοῦσιν. ἂν μὲν οὖν δὴ καὶ συνεπιλαμβάνηται τις ὀρθὴ τροφὴ παιδεύσεως,

44c

T: Of course, this all happens later on. However, we must deal more precisely with the issues before us now, and issues prior to these concerning the generation of the body part by part, and of the soul too, and the reasons and intentions of the gods in producing them. This we must recount in detail, holding to the most likely account and proceeding on that basis.

ὁλόκληρος ὑγίης τε παντελῶς, τὴν μεγίστην ἀποφυγὼν νόσον, γίγνεται καταμελήσας δέ, χολὴν τοῦ βίου διαπορευθεὶς ζωὴν, ἀτελὴς καὶ ἀνόητος εἰς Αἴδου πάλιν ἔρχεται. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν ὕστερά ποτε γίγνεται· περὶ δὲ τῶν νῦν προτεθέντων δεῖ διελθεῖν ἀκριβέστερον, τὰ δὲ πρὸ τούτων, περὶ σωμάτων κατὰ μέρη τῆς γενέσεως καὶ περὶ ψυχῆς, δι' ἧς τε αἰτίας καὶ προνοίας γέγονε θεῶν, τοῦ μάλιστα

44d

T: Now, there are two divine revolutions which imitate the round shape of the Universe, which is spherical, and they bound these within a spherically shaped body which we now call the head. It is our most divine part, and it rules over all else within us, and to this the gods granted the entire body which they had assembled to be its servant, realising that it would be involved in every kind of motion that would ever be. They gave this chariot and means of transport to the head so that it would not go rolling about the Earth with its various hills and hollows, unable to get over the one or out of the other. On account of this, the body is tall and has grown four flexible and extensible limbs devised by the god for conveyance. Assisted and supported by these, the body is capable of traversing all terrains, bearing aloft the dwelling place of that most divine and sacred part of us. So that is how and why legs and feet have been attached to everyone. And regarding the front of the body as nobler and more fitted for leadership than the rear, the gods assigned most of our movement to be in that direction. So it was necessary for the front of the human body to be distinct and different. Therefore, they first put the face in position on that particular side of the vessel of the head, affixed onto it the organs for complete providence of the soul, and assigned the role of leadership to that natural front.

εἰκότος ἀντεχομένοις, οὕτω καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα πορευομένοις διεξιτέον. τὰς μὲν δὴ θείας περιόδους δύο οὔσας, τὸ τοῦ παντὸς σχῆμα ἀπομιμησάμενοι περιφερὲς ὄν, εἰς σφαιροειδὲς σῶμα ἐνέδησαν, τοῦτο δὲ νῦν κεφαλὴν ἐπονομάζομεν, ὃ θειότατόν τέ ἐστιν καὶ τῶν ἐν ἡμῖν πάντων δεσποτοῦν· ᾧ καὶ πᾶν τὸ σῶμα παρέδωκεν ὑπηρεσίαν αὐτῷ συναθροίσαντες θεοί, κατανοήσαντες ὅτι πασῶν ὅσαι κινήσεις ἔσονται μετέχουσι. ἵν' οὖν μὴ κυλινδούμενον ἐπὶ γῆς ὕψη τε καὶ βάθη παντοδαπὰ ἐχούσης ἀποροῖ τὰ μὲν ὑπερβαίνειν, ἔνθεν δὲ ἐκβαίνειν, ὄχημα αὐτῷ τοῦτο καὶ εὐπορίαν ἔδωκεν· τι. ὅθεν δὴ μήκος τὸ σῶμα ἔσχεν, ἐκτατά τε κῶλα καὶ καμπτὰ ἔφυσεν τέτταρα θεοῦ μηχανησαμένου πορείαν, οἷς ἀντιλαμβανόμενον καὶ ἀπεριειδόμενον διὰ πάντων τόπων πορεύεσθαι

δυνατὸν γέγονε, τὴν τοῦ θειοτάτου καὶ ἱερωτάτου φέρον οἴκησιν ἐπάνωθεν ἡμῶν. σκέλη μὲν οὖν χειρὲς τε αὐτῇ καὶ διὰ ταῦτα προσέφυ πᾶσιν· τοῦ δ' ὀπισθεν τὸ πρόσθεν τιμιώτερον καὶ ἀρχικώτερον νομίζοντες θεοὶ αὐτῇ τὸ πολὺ τῆς πορείας ἡμῖν ἔδωσαν. ἔδει δὲ διωρισμένον ἔχειν καὶ ἀνόμοιον τοῦ σώματος τὸ πρόσθεν ἄνθρωπον. διὸ πρῶτον μὲν περὶ τὸ τῆς κεφαλῆς κύτος, ὑποθέντες αὐτόσε τὸ πρόσωπον, ὄργανα ἐνέδησαν

45b

T: The first of the organs fabricated were light-bearing eyes which they fixed in place for the following reason: they contrived to create a body from fire which does not burn but provides a gentle light, kindred to the light of each day. So they caused the pure fire within us, which is brother of this light of day, to flow through the eyes, and they compressed the whole eye, but especially the centre, to be smooth and dense so as to retain all the coarser fire and filter through only this kind of pure fire by itself. Then, if ever there is daylight surrounding this stream of vision, like meets with like, joins together and establishes a single kindred body along a straight line from the eyes to wherever the stream from within is obstructed by the outside objects on which it impinges.

τούτῳ πάσῃ τῇ τῆς ψυχῆς προνοίᾳ, καὶ διέταξαν τὸ μετέχον ἡγεμονίας τοῦτ' εἶναι, τὸ κατὰ φύσιν πρόσθεν· τῶν δὲ ὀργάνων πρῶτον μὲν φωσφόρα συνετεκλήναντο ὄμματα, τοιαῦδε ἐνδήσαντες αἰτία. τοῦ πυρὸς ὅσον τὸ μὲν κάειν οὐκ ἔσχε, τὸ δὲ παρέχειν φῶς ἡμερον, οἰκεῖον ἐκάστης ἡμέρας, σῶμα ἐμηχανήσαντο γίνεσθαι. τὸ γὰρ ἐντὸς ἡμῶν ἀδελφὸν ὃν τούτου πῦρ εἰλικρινὲς ἐποίησαν διὰ τῶν ὀμμάτων ρεῖν λεῖον καὶ πυκνὸν ὅλον μὲν, μάλιστα δὲ τὸ μέσον συμπλήσαντες

45c

T: Because the entire body is similar, the effects are similar throughout. So once this body of light touches something or is touched by something, it transmits motions from these through the entire body as far as the soul and furnishes perception, and we call this 'seeing'. But when the kindred fire goes away at night, the stream of

vision is cut off, for when it travels out into something dissimilar it is altered and extinguished, no longer merging with the adjacent air since it contains no fire. So it stops seeing, and, what's more, it becomes an inducement to sleep. For the eyelids, devised by the gods as the natural protector of vision, confine the power of that fire within whenever these are closed. This dissolves and equalises the inner movements, and once these are calmed, peace arises, and when there is great peace there falls an almost dreamless sleep. However, if any significant movements of any sort remain in any location, they produce images which are like these movements in type and quantity, images which are copied within and are remembered externally upon awakening.

τῶν ὁμμάτων, ὥστε τὸ μὲν ἄλλο ὅσον παχύτερον στέγειν πᾶν, τὸ τοιοῦτον δὲ μόνον αὐτὸ καθαρὸν διηθεῖν. ὅταν οὖν μεθημερινὸν ἦ φῶς περὶ τὸ τῆς ὀψεως ῥεῦμα, τότε ἐκπίπτον ὅμοιον πρὸς ὅμοιον, συμπαγὲς γενόμενον, ἐν σῶμα οἰκειωθὲν συνέστη κατὰ τὴν τῶν ὁμμάτων εὐθυωρίαν, ὅπηπερ ἂν ἀντερείδῃ τὸ προσπίπτον ἔνδοθεν πρὸς ὃ τῶν ἔξω συνέπεσεν. ὁμοιοπαθεὶς δὴ δι' ὁμοιότητα πᾶν γενόμενον, ὅτου τε ἂν αὐτό ποτε ἐφάπτηται καὶ ὃ ἂν ἄλλο ἐκείνου, τούτων τὰς κινήσεις διαδιδὼν εἰς ἅπαν τὸ σῶμα μέχρι τῆς ψυχῆς αἰσθησιν παρέσχετο ταύτην ἣ δὴ ὁρᾶν φαμεν. ἀπελθόντος δὲ εἰς νύκτα τοῦ συγγενοῦς πυρὸς ἀποτέμνεται· πρὸς γὰρ ἀνόμοιον ἐξιδὼν ἀλλοιοῦται τε αὐτὸ καὶ κατασβέννυται, συμφυὲς οὐκέτι τῷ πλησίον ἀέρι γιγνόμενον, ἅτε πῦρ οὐκ ἔχοντι. παύεται τε οὖν ὁρῶν, ἔτι τε ἐπαγωγὸν ὕπνου γίγνεται· σωτηρίαν γὰρ ἦν οἱ θεοὶ τῆς ὀψεως ἐμηχανήσαντο, τὴν τῶν βλεφάρων φύσιν, ὅταν ταῦτα συμμύσῃ, καθείργνυσιν τὴν τοῦ πυρὸς ἐντὸς δύναμιν, ἣ δὲ διαχεῖ τε καὶ ὁμαλύνει τὰς ἐντὸς κινήσεις, ὁμαλυνθεισῶν δὲ ἡσυχία γίγνεται, γενομένης δὲ πολλῆς μὲν ἡσυχίας βραχυόνειρος ὕπνος ἐμπίπτει, ΤΙ. καταλειφθεισῶν δὲ τινων κινήσεων μειζόνων, οἶαι καὶ ἐν οἷς ἂν τόποις λείπωνται,

46a

T: Now, there is no particular difficulty in understanding the production of images in mirrors or anything smooth and reflective.

For all such images necessarily make their appearance from the communion of the inner and outer fire with one another, and then, whenever this in turn unites on the smooth surface and is transformed in different ways, and the fire from the reflected face coalesces with the fire of sight on the smooth and bright surface, left then appears to be right because opposite parts of the beam of sight make contact with the corresponding parts in a manner contrary to the normal manner of contact. However, right appears as right and left as left whenever light changes side in the process of merging. This happens when the smooth surface of the mirrors is raised on each side, and the right part of the beam of sight is repelled to the left and the left to the right. When the same mirror is turned lengthwise to the face, it makes all appear upside down by repelling the bottom of the beam to the top, and the top to the bottom.

τοιαῦτα καὶ τοσαῦτα παρέσχοντο ἀφομοιωθέντα ἐντὸς ἔξω τε ἐγερθεῖσιν ἀπομνημονευόμενα φαντάσματα. τὸ δὲ περὶ τὴν τῶν κατόπτρων εἰδωλοποιῖαν καὶ πάντα ὅσα ἐμφανῇ καὶ λεῖα, κατιδεῖν οὐδὲν ἔτι χαλεπόν. ἐκ γὰρ τῆς ἐντὸς ἐκτὸς τε τοῦ πυρὸς ἐκατέρου κοινωνίας ἀλλήλοις, ἐνός τε αὖ περὶ τὴν λειότητα ἐκάστοτε γενομένου καὶ πολλαχῇ μεταρρυθμισθέντος, πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἐμφαίνεται, τοῦ περὶ τὸ πρόσωπον πυρὸς τῷ περὶ τὴν ὄψιν πυρὶ περὶ τὸ λεῖον καὶ λαμπρὸν συμπαγοῦς γιγνομένου. δεξιὰ δὲ φαντάζεται τὰ ἀριστερά, ὅτι τοῖς ἐναντίοις μέρεσιν τῆς ὀψεως περὶ τἀναντία μέρη γίγνεται ἐπαφή παρὰ τὸ καθεστὸς ἔθος τῆς προσβολῆς δεξιὰ δὲ τὰ δεξιὰ καὶ τὰ ἀριστερὰ ἀριστερὰ τούναντίον, ὅταν μεταπέσῃ συμπηγνύμενον ᾧ συμπήγνυται φῶς,

46c

T: Now, all these are contributory causes which the god employs as servants in perfecting the most excellent form that is possible. But they are regarded by most people not as contributory causes, but as the cause of everything – cooling and heating, solidifying and melting, and all such processes. Yet these are unable to think or reason to any end. For we must declare that among things that are, it belongs to soul

alone to acquire nous, and this is invisible, while fire, water, earth and air are all visible bodies. And the lover of nous and knowledge first needs to investigate the causes which belong to the intelligent nature, and secondly, those causes which are moved by others, and of necessity become a source of motion to other objects. We too should act in accordance with these principles. We must, indeed, describe both types of causes, yet distinguish those which, in consort with nous, are artificers of beauty and good from those which, being bereft of intelligence, consistently bring about randomness and disorder.

τοῦτο δέ, ὅταν ἡ τῶν κατόπτρων λειότης, ἔνθεν καὶ ἔνθεν ὕψη λαβοῦσα, τὸ δεξιὸν εἰς τὸ ἀριστερὸν μέρος ἀπόσῃ τῆς ὀψεως καὶ θάτερον ἐπὶ θάτερον. κατὰ δὲ τὸ μῆκος στραφὲν τοῦ προσώπου ταῦτόν τοῦτο ὑπτίον ἐποίησεν πᾶν φαίνεσθαι, τὸ κάτω πρὸς τὸ ἄνω τῆς αὐγῆς τό τ' ἄνω πρὸς τὸ κάτω πάλιν ἀπῶσαν. ταῦτ' οὖν πάντα ἔστιν τῶν συναιτίων οἷς θεὸς ὑπηρετοῦσιν χρῆται τὴν τοῦ ἀρίστου κατὰ τὸ δυνατόν ἰδέαν ἀποτελῶν· δοξάζεται δὲ ὑπὸ τῶν πλείστων οὐ συναιτία ἀλλὰ αἷτια εἶναι τῶν πάντων, ψύχοντα καὶ θερμαίνοντα πηγνύντα τε καὶ διαχέοντα καὶ ὅσα τοιαῦτα ἀπεργαζόμενα. λόγον δὲ οὐδένα οὐδὲ νοῦν εἰς οὐδὲν δυνατὰ ἔχειν ἐστίν. τῶν γὰρ ὄντων ᾧ νοῦν μόνῳ κτᾶσθαι προσήκει, λεκτέον ψυχὴν—τοῦτο δὲ ἀόρατον, πῦρ δὲ καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ γῆ καὶ ἀήρ σώματα πάντα ὀρατὰ γέγονεν—τὸν δὲ νοῦ καὶ ἐπιστήμης ἐραστὴν ἀνάγκη τὰς τῆς ἔμφρονος φύσεως αἰτίας πρώτας

46e

T: Let that be enough about the ancillary, contributory causes for which the eyes have been assigned the power they now possess. However, along with this we must also state the greatest of their beneficial effects, the reason the god gave them to us. According to my account, sight is responsible for the greatest benefit to us, because not one of the accounts we are relating about the Universe would ever have been spoken without seeing the stars or the Sun or the Heaven. But now that day and night have been seen, months and the annual cycle too, and equinoxes and solstices, number has been devised, and the concept of time and the investigation of the nature of the Universe

have been given to us. From this we have acquired philosophy in general, and no greater good has ever or will ever come to mortal creatures as a gift from the gods than this. So I declare this to be the greatest good of eyes. As for the other lesser sights, why should we praise benefits for which someone who is no philosopher, weeping in vain,¹⁸ might lament if he lost the sight of them? Rather, let us declare for the following reasons that sight is the cause of this benefit. Sight was invented and bestowed upon us by the god so that we, beholding the revolutions of nous in the Heaven, could apply them to the orbits of thinking within ourselves, for these, though troubled, are kindred to those untroubled revolutions. And, indeed, by learning these thoroughly and properly in accord with their nature, we could stabilise the wandering motions within ourselves by imitating the entirely stable orbits of the god. And in the case of sound and of hearing, the account is the same; they were bestowed by the gods for the same reasons and with the same intentions as they gave sight. Indeed, speech too was instituted for these very purposes, and it contributes the greatest portion thereto, and so too does any music which works through sound and hearing, and is given for the sake of harmony. Harmony, whose movements are kindred to the orbits in our own soul, has been given by the Muses to those who resort to them intelligently, not for the irrational pleasure thought to be so useful nowadays, but as an ally against the inharmonious orbit of the soul which has arisen in us, to bring it to order and concord with itself. Rhythm, too, was given to us for the same reasons, by the same gods, as an aid, because of the unmeasured condition and lack of grace which, for the most part, prevails in us.

μεταδιώκειν, ὅσαι δὲ ὑπ' ἄλλων μὲν κινουμένων, ἕτερα δὲ κατὰ ἀνάγκης κινούντων γίνονται, δευτέρας. ποιητέον δὴ κατὰ ταῦτα καὶ ἡμῖν· λεκτέα μὲν ἀμφοτέρα τὰ τῶν αἰτιῶν γένη, χωρὶς δὲ ὅσαι μετὰ νοῦ καλῶν καὶ ἀγαθῶν δημιουργοὶ καὶ ὅσαι μονωθεῖσαι φρονήσεως τὸ τυχὸν ἄτακτον ἐκάστοτε ἐξεργάζονται. ΤΙ. τὰ μὲν οὖν τῶν ὁμμάτων συμμεταίτια πρὸς τὸ σχεῖν τὴν δύναμιν ἣν νῦν εἴληχεν εἰρήσθω· τὸ δὲ

μέγιστον αὐτῶν εἰς ὠφελίαν ἔργον, δι' ὃ θεὸς αὐθ' ἡμῖν δεδωρηται, μετὰ τοῦτο ῥητέον. ὅψις δὴ κατὰ τὸν ἐμὸν λόγον αἰτία τῆς μεγίστης ὠφελίας γέγονεν ἡμῖν, ὅτι τῶν νῦν λόγων περὶ τοῦ παντὸς λεγομένων οὐδεὶς ἂν ποτε ἐρρήθη μήτε ἄστρα μήτε ἥλιον μήτε οὐρανὸν ἰδόντων. νῦν δ' ἡμέρα τε καὶ νύξ ὀφθεῖσθαι μῆνές τε καὶ ἐνιαυτῶν περίοδοι καὶ ἰσημερία καὶ τροπαὶ μεμηχανῆνται μὲν ἀριθμόν, χρόνου δὲ ἔννοιαν περὶ τε τῆς τοῦ παντὸς φύσεως ζήτησιν ἔδωσαν· ἐξ ὧν ἐπορισάμεθα φιλοσοφίας γένος, οὗ μείζον ἀγαθὸν οὐτ' ἦλθεν οὔτε ἥξει ποτὲ τῷ θνητῷ γένει δωρηθὲν ἐκ θεῶν. λέγω δὴ τοῦτο ὁμμάτων μέγιστον ἀγαθόν· τᾶλλα δὲ ὅσα ἐλάττω τί ἂν ὑμνοῖμεν, ὧν ὁ μὴ φιλόσοφος τυφλωθεὶς ὁδυρόμενος ἂν θρηνοῖ μάτην; ἀλλὰ τούτου λεγέσθω παρ' ἡμῶν αὕτη ἐπὶ ταῦτα αἰτία, θεὸν ἡμῖν ἀνευρεῖν δωρήσασθαι τε ὅψιν, ἵνα τὰς ἐν οὐρανῷ τοῦ νοῦ κατιδόντες περιόδους χρῆσάμεθα ἐπὶ τὰς περιφορὰς τὰς τῆς παρ' ἡμῖν διανοήσεως, συγγενεῖς ἐκείναις οὔσας, ἀταράκτοις τεταραγμένας, ἐκμαθόντες δὲ καὶ λογισμῶν κατὰ φύσιν ὀρθότητος μετασχόντες, μιμούμενοι τὰς τοῦ θεοῦ πάντως ἀπλανεῖς οὔσας, τὰς ἐν ἡμῖν πεπλανημένας καταστησαίμεθα. φωνῆς τε δὴ καὶ ἀκοῆς πέρι πάλιν ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος, ἐπὶ ταῦτά τῶν αὐτῶν ἕνεκα παρὰ θεῶν δεδωρησθαι. λόγος τε γὰρ ἐπ' αὐτὰ ταῦτα τέτακται, τὴν μεγίστην συμβαλλόμενος εἰς αὐτὰ μοῖραν, ὅσον τ' αὖ μουσικῆς φωνῇ χρήσιμον πρὸς ἀκοὴν ἕνεκα ἀρμονίας ἐστὶ δοθέν. ἡ δὲ ἀρμονία, συγγενεῖς ἔχουσα φορὰς ταῖς ἐν ἡμῖν τῆς ψυχῆς περιόδοις, τῷ μετὰ νοῦ προσχρωμένῳ Μούσαις οὐκ ἐφ' ἡδονὴν ἄλογον καθάπερ νῦν εἶναι δοκεῖ χρήσιμος, ἀλλ' ἐπὶ τὴν γεγονυῖαν ἐν ἡμῖν ἀνάρμοστον ψυχῆς περίοδον εἰς κατακόσμησιν καὶ συμφωνίαν ἑαυτῇ σύμμαχος ὑπὸ Μουσῶν δέδοται· καὶ ῥυθμὸς αὖ διὰ τὴν ἄμετρον ἐν ἡμῖν καὶ χαρίτων

47e

T: Now, everything we have said so far, with few exceptions, has expounded the productions of nous.¹⁹ However, we must also set alongside it an account of what comes into being through Necessity. For the generation of this Universe originated indeed in a mixture produced from the combination of Necessity and nous. Nous ruled over Necessity by persuading it to lead most of what comes into being

towards the very best. And so, this Universe was constructed in this way and on these principles in the beginning, through the subjugation of Necessity by intelligent persuasion. Therefore, if anyone is to state truly how the Universe came into being, based on these principles, he must include also the form of the wandering cause and how it is naturally involved. So, we should retrace our steps once more, and, adopting a different and appropriate fresh starting point from these themselves, we must now begin again from the beginning, based on these factors just as we did before.

ἐπιδεᾶ γιγνομένην ἐν τοῖς πλείστοις ἔξιν ἐπίκουρος ἐπὶ ταῦτα ὑπὸ τῶν αὐτῶν ἐδόθη. τὰ μὲν οὖν παρεληλυθότα τῶν εἰρημένων πλὴν βραχέων ἐπιδέδεικται τὰ διὰ νοῦ δεδημιουργημένα· δεῖ δὲ καὶ τὰ δι' ἀνάγκης γιγνόμενα τῷ λόγῳ παραθέσθαι. ΤΙ. μεμειγμένη γὰρ οὖν ἡ τοῦδε τοῦ κόσμου γένεσις ἐξ ἀνάγκης τε καὶ νοῦ συστάσεως ἐγεννήθη· νοῦ δὲ ἀνάγκης ἄρχοντος τῷ πείθειν αὐτὴν τῶν γιγνομένων τὰ πλεῖστα ἐπὶ τὸ βέλτιστον ἄγειν, ταύτη κατὰ ταῦτά τε δι' ἀνάγκης ἡττωμένης ὑπὸ πειθοῦς ἔμφρονος οὕτω κατ' ἀρχὰς συνίστατο τόδε τὸ πᾶν. εἴ τις οὖν ἦ γέγονεν κατὰ ταῦτα ὄντως ἔρεϊ, μεικτέον καὶ τὸ τῆς πλανωμένης εἶδος αἰτίας, ἥ φέρειν πέφυκεν· ὧδε οὖν πάλιν

48b

T: We should look to the nature itself of fire and water, and also air and earth, before the generation of the Heaven and the condition they were in prior to that. For, to this day, no one has yet disclosed their origin, but we speak as if we know what precisely fire and each of the others is – proposing that they are the principles and letters of the Universe – when to a man of even a little intelligence it is probably not appropriate even to liken them to syllables. So let our statement on the matter be as follows: we should not speak now of the beginning of all things, or the beginnings, or the way we think about them, for no other reason than the difficulty of presenting our opinions based upon the present manner of exposition. Nor should you believe that I need to address this topic, nor would I, for my part, be able to persuade myself that I would be right in attempting to burden myself with such

a task. So, paying special heed to our initial statement about the capability of the likely accounts, I shall endeavour to give an account no less likely than before – indeed, more so – from the beginning about each and everything.

ἀναχωρητέον, καὶ λαβοῦσιν αὐτῶν τούτων προσήκουσαν ἑτέραν ἀρχὴν αὐθις αὖ, καθάπερ περὶ τῶν τότε νῦν οὕτω περὶ τούτων πάλιν ἀρκετόν ἀπ' ἀρχῆς. τὴν δὴ πρὸ τῆς οὐρανοῦ γενέσεως πυρὸς ὕδατος τε καὶ ἀέρος καὶ γῆς φύσιν θεατέον αὐτὴν καὶ τὰ πρὸ τούτου πάθη· νῦν γὰρ οὐδεὶς πω γένεσιν αὐτῶν μεμήνυκεν, ἀλλ' ὥς εἰδόσιν πῦρ ὅτι ποτέ ἐστιν καὶ ἕκαστον αὐτῶν λέγομεν ἀρχὰς αὐτὰ τιθέμενοι στοιχεῖα τοῦ παντός, προσῆκον αὐτοῖς οὐδ' ἂν ὥς ἐν συλλαβῆς εἴδουσιν μόνον εἰκότως ὑπὸ τοῦ καὶ βραχὺ φρονοῦντος ἀπεικασθῆναι. νῦν δὲ οὖν τό γε παρ' ἡμῶν ὧδε ἐχέτω· τὴν μὲν περὶ ἀπάντων εἶτε ἀρχὴν εἶτε ἀρχὰς εἶτε ὅπη δοκεῖ τούτων περὶ τὸ νῦν οὐ ῥητέον, δι' ἄλλο μὲν οὐδέν, διὰ δὲ τὸ χαλεπὸν εἶναι κατὰ τὸν παρόντα τρόπον τῆς διεξόδου δηλῶσαι τὰ δοκοῦντα, μήτ' οὖν ὑμεῖς οἴεσθε δεῖν ἐμὲ λέγειν, οὐτ' αὐτὸς αὖ πείθειν ἑμαυτὸν εἶην ἂν δυνατὸς ὥς ὀρθῶς ἐγχειροῖμ' ἂν τοσοῦτον ἐπιβαλλόμενος ἔργον· τὸ δὲ κατ' ἀρχὰς ῥηθὲν διαφυλάττων, τὴν τῶν εἰκότων λόγων δύναμιν, πειράσομαι μηδενὸς ἧττον εἰκότα, μᾶλλον δέ, καὶ ἔμπροσθεν ἀπ' ἀρχῆς περὶ ἐκάστων καὶ συμπάντων λέγειν. θεὸν δὴ καὶ νῦν ἐπ' ἀρχῇ τῶν λεγομένων σωτήρα ἐξ ἀτόπου καὶ ἀήτους διηγήσεως πρὸς τὸ τῶν εἰκότων δόγμα διασώζειν ἡμᾶς

48e

T: Clearly we should now begin again, once we have called upon the god, our saviour, at the very outset of our deliberations, to see us safely out of an unusual and unaccustomed exposition to the doctrine of things probable. In any case, our fresh start concerning the Universe should be more elaborate than before, for we distinguished two forms then, but now we must present a third kind. Two were sufficient for our previous descriptions, one designated as a sort of a model discernible by nous and ever the same, while the second was a copy of the model, involved in becoming, and visible. We did not distinguish a third kind at the time as we thought it enough to have these two, but

now the argument seems to compel us to try to manifest a difficult and obscure form in words. What should we understand its power and nature to be? This in particular – it is the receptacle of all coming into being, like its nurse.

ἐπικαλεσάμενοι πάλιν ἀρχώμεθα λέγειν. ἡ δ' οὖν αὖθις ἀρχὴ περὶ τοῦ παντὸς ἔστω μειζόνως τῆς πρόσθεν διηρημένη· τότε μὲν γὰρ δύο εἶδη διειλόμεθα, νῦν δὲ τρίτον ἄλλο γένος ἡμῖν δηλωτέον. ΤΙ. τὰ μὲν γὰρ δύο ἱκανὰ ἦν ἐπὶ τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν λεχθεῖσιν, ἐν μὲν ὡς παραδείγματος εἶδος ὑποτεθέν, νοητὸν καὶ ἀεὶ κατὰ ταῦτ' ὄν, μίμημα δὲ

49a

T: Now, although the truth has been spoken, a clearer statement about it is still required, but it is difficult to do so, particularly because it is necessary for the sake of this to raise a preliminary problem about fire and its accompaniments. It is difficult in the case of each of these to state what sort should actually be called water rather than fire, and what sort should be referred to as anything in particular rather than as everything individually, in such a manner as to employ language which is trustworthy and certain. How, then, may we speak about them in a likely manner, and in what way, and what can we say about them when faced with this problem? First, we see what we now call water being condensed and becoming stones and earth, or so we think, and when melted or dispersed, the same substance in turn becomes wind and air, and air when burned becomes fire. When this is combined once more and the fire is extinguished, it returns again to the form of air, and air comes together again, becomes dense and forms cloud and mist, and by compacting these even more we get flowing water, and from water we go on to get earth and stones. And their coming into being appears to be a cycle where they interchange with one another in this way.

παραδείγματος δεύτερον, γένεσιν ἔχον καὶ ὁρατόν. τρίτον δὲ τότε μὲν οὐ διειλόμεθα, νομίσαντες τὰ δύο ἔξιν ἱκανῶς· νῦν δὲ ὁ λόγος ἔοικεν εἰσαναγκάζειν χαλεπὸν καὶ ἀμυδρὸν εἶδος ἐπιχειρεῖν λόγοις

ἐμφανίσαι. τίν' οὖν ἔχον δύναμιν καὶ φύσιν αὐτὸ ὑποληπτέον; τοιάνδε μάλιστα πάσης εἶναι γενέσεως ὑποδοχὴν αὐτὴν οἷον τιθήνην. εἴρηται μὲν οὖν τάληθές, δεῖ δὲ ἐναργέστερον εἰπεῖν περὶ αὐτοῦ, χαλεπὸν δὲ ἄλλως τε καὶ διότι προαπορηθῆναι περὶ πυρὸς καὶ τῶν μετὰ πυρὸς ἀναγκαῖον τούτου χάριν· τούτων γὰρ εἰπεῖν ἕκαστον ὅποιον ὄντως ὕδωρ χρὴ λέγειν μᾶλλον ἢ πῦρ, καὶ ὅποιον ὅτιοῦν μᾶλλον ἢ καὶ ἅπαντα καθ' ἕκαστόν τε, οὕτως ὥστε τινὶ πιστῷ καὶ βεβαίῳ χρῆσασθαι λόγῳ, χαλεπόν. πῶς οὖν δὴ τοῦτ' αὐτὸ καὶ πῇ καὶ τί περὶ αὐτῶν εἰκότως διαπορηθέντες ἂν λέγοιμεν; πρῶτον μὲν, ὃ δὴ νῦν ὕδωρ ὠνομάκαμεν, πηγνύμενον ὡς δοκοῦμεν λίθους καὶ γῆν γιγνόμενον ὀρῶμεν, τηκόμενον δὲ καὶ διακρινόμενον αὖ ταῦτόν τοῦτο πνεῦμα καὶ ἀέρα, συγκαυθέντα δὲ ἀέρα πῦρ, ἀνάπαλιν δὲ συγκριθέν καὶ κατασβεσθέν εἰς ἰδέαν τε ἀπὸν αὐθις ἀέρος πῦρ, καὶ πάλιν ἀέρα συνιόντα καὶ πυκνούμενον νέφος καὶ ὁμίχλην, ἐκ δὲ τούτων ἔτι μᾶλλον συμπιλουμένων ῥέον ὕδωρ, ἐξ ὕδατος δὲ γῆν καὶ λίθους αὐθις, κύκλον τε οὕτω διαδιδόντα εἰς ἄλληλα, ὡς φαίνεται, τὴν γένεσιν. οὕτω δὴ τούτων οὐδέποτε

49d

T: Accordingly, since none of these ever appears the same, which of them can a person firmly assert to be 'this something or other' and not something else, without embarrassing himself? It is not possible, and by far the most cautious approach when making assertions about these is to speak as follows: whatever we observe continually becoming in different ways at different times – fire, for instance – we should consistently refer to²⁰ not as 'this' but as 'like this'; and we should not refer to water as 'this' but always as 'such as this'; nor ever refer to anything else as something possessing fixity by using the terms 'this' and 'that' and presume that we are pointing to anything. For they take flight and do not wait for the 'this' and the 'that' and the 'thereby', and whatever expressions indicate that they are constant. So we should not use these terms about them, but in relation to each of them, and all of them together, we should describe them as 'such as this, ever recurring alike'. And, indeed, we should call fire that which is such as

this throughout, and so for all things that involve coming into being. But we should refer only to that in which each of these makes its appearance and into which each dissolves again thereafter, by using the terms 'this' and 'that'. However, anything with some sort of quality, be it hot or white, or any of the opposites, or anything derived from these, should be referred to by none of these terms.

τῶν αὐτῶν ἐκάστων φανταζομένων, ποῖον αὐτῶν ὡς ὃν ὀτιοῦν τοῦτο καὶ οὐκ ἄλλο παγίως δισχυριζόμενος οὐκ αἰσχυνεῖται τις ἐαυτόν; οὐκ ἔστιν, ἀλλ' ἀσφαλέστατα μακρῶ περὶ τούτων τιθεμένους ὧδε λέγειν· αἰεὶ ὁ καθορῶμεν ἄλλοτε ἄλλη γιγνόμενον, ὡς πῦρ, μὴ τοῦτο ἀλλὰ τὸ τοιοῦτον ἐκάστοτε προσαγορεύειν πῦρ, μηδὲ ὕδωρ τοῦτο ἀλλὰ τὸ τοιοῦτον αἰεὶ, μηδὲ ἄλλο ποτὲ μηδὲν ὥς τινα ἔχον βεβαιότητα, ὅσα δεικνύντες τῷ ῥήματι τῷ τόδε καὶ τοῦτο προσχρώμενοι δηλοῦν ἡγούμεθα τι· φεύγει γὰρ οὐχ ὑπομένον τὴν τοῦ τόδε καὶ τοῦτο καὶ τὴν τῷδε καὶ πᾶσαν ὅση μόνιμα ὡς ὄντα αὐτὰ ἐνδείκνυται φάσις. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μὲν ἕκαστα μὴ λέγειν, τὸ δὲ τοιοῦτον αἰεὶ περιφερόμενον ὁμοιον ἐκάστου πέρι καὶ συμπάντων οὕτω καλεῖν, καὶ δὴ καὶ πῦρ τὸ διὰ παντός τοιοῦτον, καὶ ἅπαν ὅσον περ ἂν ἔχη γένεσιν· ΤΙ. ἐν ᾧ δὲ ἐγγιγνόμενα αἰεὶ ἕκαστα αὐτῶν φαντάζεται καὶ πάλιν ἐκεῖθεν ἀπόλλυται,

50a

T: But I must make an effort to explain this anew even more clearly. Indeed, if someone, having moulded all manner of shapes out of gold, were to keep on remoulding each shape into all the others without stopping, and someone were to point to one of them and ask what it is in truth, the safest answer is gold. But the triangle, and all the other shapes arising in it, we should never refer to as 'these' as if they were things that are, for they change even as we make the assertion. Rather, we should be content if they deign to accept the cautious designation 'such as this'. Then we must also give the same account of the nature of the recipient of all these bodies; we must assert that it is always the same, since it never departs at all from its own capacity. For it is always receiving everything, but it never adopts a shape similar to the things which enter into it in any way at all. There it lies, the natural recipient

of all impressions, moved and shaped by the things that enter it, seeming to change from time to time because of these. What enters it and leaves it are imitations of the things that are always, modelled upon them in some manner which is hard to describe and extraordinary, which we shall deal with on another occasion.

μόνον ἐκεῖνο αὖ προσαγορεύειν τῷ τε τοῦτο καὶ τῷ τόδε προσχρωμένους ὀνόματι, τὸ δὲ ὁποιοῦν τι, θερμὸν ἢ λευκὸν ἢ καὶ ὀτιοῦν τῶν ἐναντίων, καὶ πάνθ' ὅσα ἐκ τούτων, μηδὲν ἐκεῖνο αὖ τούτων καλεῖν. ἔτι δὲ σαφέστερον αὐτοῦ περὶ προθυμητέον αὐθις εἰπεῖν. εἰ γὰρ πάντα τις σχήματα πλάσας ἐκ χρυσοῦ μηδὲν μεταπλάττων παύοιτο ἕκαστα εἰς ἅπαντα, δεικνύντος δὴ τινος αὐτῶν ἔν καὶ ἐρομένου τί ποτ' ἐστί, μακρῷ πρὸς ἀλήθειαν ἀσφαλέστατον εἰπεῖν ὅτι χρυσός, τὸ δὲ τρίγωνον ὅσα τε ἄλλα σχήματα ἐνεγίγνετο, μηδέποτε λέγειν ταῦτα ὡς ὄντα, ἃ γε μεταξὺ τιθεμένου μεταπίπτει, ἀλλ' ἐὰν ἄρα καὶ τὸ τοιοῦτον μετ' ἀσφαλείας ἐθέλῃ δέχεσθαί τινος, ἀγαπᾶν. ὁ αὐτὸς δὲ λόγος καὶ περὶ τῆς τὰ πάντα δεχομένης σώματα φύσεως. ταῦτόν αὐτὴν ἀεὶ προσρητέον· ἐκ γὰρ τῆς ἑαυτῆς τὸ παράπαν οὐκ ἐξίσταται δυνάμειως —δέχεται τε γὰρ ἀεὶ τὰ πάντα, καὶ

50c

T: Leaving that aside, we must now conceive of three kinds: that which comes into being; that in which it comes into being; and the original, in the likeness of which that which comes into being grows. What's more, it is appropriate to liken the recipient to a mother, the original to a father, and the nature arising between these to an offspring. And we must also understand that if the recipient of impressions is to display all the varieties of embellishment, this entity in which the impressions will be set would need to be well prepared, and this will not occur unless it is devoid of all of those characteristics which it is about to receive from elsewhere. For if it were similar to anything that entered it, then whenever something of an opposite or completely different nature entered and was received, the receptacle would present a bad likeness as its own feature would intrude. Therefore, that which receives all forms into itself must also be devoid of all qualities,

just as skilled perfumers contrive firstly to do just this, making the oil which will receive the scents as odourless as possible. And whoever turns his hand to moulding shapes in some soft material allows no shape at all to be present beforehand, but they even it out first, and render it as smooth as possible. In the same way, it is fitting that whatever will continually, throughout its entire self, receive the likenesses of all that is known by nous, and is always, should also be naturally devoid of all forms. So, then, the mother and receptacle of what is generated, visible and in every respect perceptible, should not be called earth or air or fire or water, or anything that they produce or that from which they arise. Yet, we shall not deceive ourselves if we say it is an invisible and shapeless form, all-receiving, participating in a most baffling way in that which can be known by nous, and hard to understand. Insofar as it is possible to arrive at its nature from our previous deliberations, it would be most correct to describe it as follows: the part that has become fiery appears at the same time as fire, the moistened part as water, and as earth and air also, to the extent that it receives imitations of these.

μορφὴν οὐδεμίαν ποτὲ οὐδενὶ τῶν εἰσιόντων ὁμοίαν εἴληφεν οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς· ἐκμαγεῖον γὰρ φύσει παντὶ κεῖται, κινούμενον τε καὶ διασηματιζόμενον ὑπὸ τῶν εἰσιόντων, φαίνεται δὲ δι' ἐκεῖνα ἄλλοτε ἄλλοιόν—τὰ δὲ εἰσιόντα καὶ ἐξιόντα τῶν ὄντων ἀεὶ μιμήματα, τυπωθέντα ἀπ' αὐτῶν τρόπον τινὰ δύσφραστον καὶ θαυμαστόν, ὃν εἰς αὐθις μέτιμεν. ἐν δ' οὖν τῷ παρόντι χρή γένῃ διανοηθῆναι τριττά, τὸ μὲν γιγνόμενον, τὸ δ' ἐν ᾧ γίγνεται, τὸ δ' ὅθεν ἀφομοιούμενον φύεται τὸ γιγνόμενον. καὶ δὴ καὶ προσεικάσαι πρέπει τὸ μὲν δεχόμενον μητρί, τὸ δ' ὅθεν πατρί, τὴν δὲ μεταξὺ τούτων φύσιν ἐκγόνῳ, νοῆσαί τε ὡς οὐκ ἂν ἄλλως, ἐκτυπώματος ἔσσεσθαι μέλλοντος ἰδεῖν ποικίλου πάσας ποικιλίας, τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἐν ᾧ ἐκτυπούμενον ἐνίσταται γένοιτ' ἂν παρεσκευασμένον εὔ, πλὴν ἄμορφον ὃν ἐκείνων ἀπασῶν τῶν ἰδεῶν ὅσας μέλλοι δέχεσθαι ποθεν. ὅμοιον γὰρ ὃν τῶν ἐπεισιόντων τινὶ τὰ τῆς ἐναντίας τὰ τε τῆς τὸ παράπαν ἄλλης φύσεως ὁπότ' ἔλθοι δεχόμενον κακῶς ἂν ἀφομοιοῖ, τὴν αὐτοῦ παρεμφαῖνον ὄψιν. διὸ καὶ

πάντων ἐκτὸς εἰδῶν εἶναι χρεὼν τὸ τὰ πάντα ἐκδεχόμενον ἐν αὐτῷ
γένῃ, καθάπερ περὶ τὰ ἀλείμματα ὅποσα εὐώδη τέχνη μηχανῶνται
πρῶτον τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ὑπάρχον, ποιοῦσιν ὅτι μάλιστα ἀώδη τὰ δεξόμενα
ὕγρα τὰς ὀσμάς· ὅσοι τε ἐν τισιν τῶν μαλακῶν σχήματα ἀπομάττειν
ἐπιχειροῦσι, τὸ παράπαν σχῆμα οὐδὲν ἔνδηλον ὑπάρχειν ἑῷσι,
προομαλύναντες δὲ ὅτι λειότατον ἀπεργάζονται. ΤΙ. ταῦτὸν οὖν καὶ τῷ
τὰ τῶν πάντων αἰεὶ τε ὄντων κατὰ πᾶν ἑαυτοῦ πολλάκις ἀφομοιώματα
καλῶς μέλλοντι δέχεσθαι πάντων ἐκτὸς αὐτῷ προσήκει πεφυκέναι τῶν
εἰδῶν. διὸ δὴ τὴν τοῦ γεγονότος ὁρατοῦ καὶ πάντως αἰσθητοῦ μητέρα
καὶ ὑποδοχὴν μήτε γῆν μήτε ἀέρα μήτε πῦρ μήτε ὕδωρ λέγωμεν, μήτε
ὅσα ἐκ τούτων μήτε ἐξ ὧν ταῦτα γέγονεν· ἀλλ' ἀνόρατον εἰδός τι καὶ
ἄμορφον, πανδεχές, μεταλαμβάνον

51b

T: And yet, we must investigate this further through argument by making distinctions about these. Is there such a thing as fire just by itself, and everything that we constantly refer to in this way, each as things in themselves? Or is it only what we look at, and anything else we perceive through the body, that possesses this sort of truth, and is there nothing else besides these in any sense whatsoever? And do we speak idly every time we declare that there is a form of each, discernible by nous? Is this, in the end, nothing but a word? Now, it would be appropriate neither to dismiss the present issue by asserting that this is how matters stand without any deliberation or judgement, nor should we insert another lengthy, secondary topic into an already lengthy discourse. Yet, if it proved possible to make a significant distinction quite briefly, that would be most appropriate to our purpose. So, I cast my own vote as follows: if nous and true opinion indeed represent two kinds, then, definitively, there are these forms, just by themselves, incapable of being perceived by our senses, known by nous alone. However, if, as it appears to some, true opinion does not differ at all from nous, then by contrast, everything that we perceive by means of the body must be designated as most certain. Well, we must declare that these are two, because they have arisen independently and

have dissimilar characteristics. One of them is engendered through instruction, the other through persuasion; one always arises along with a true account, while the other is devoid of an account; and one is unmoved by persuasion, while the other is amenable to persuasion. Indeed, all men may be said to partake of opinion, but only the gods and some small class of humanity partake of nous.

δὲ ἀπορώτατά πη τοῦ νοητοῦ καὶ δυσαλωτότατον αὐτὸ λέγοντες οὐ ψευσόμεθα. καθ' ὅσον δ' ἐκ τῶν προειρημένων δυνατόν ἐφικνεῖσθαι τῆς φύσεως αὐτοῦ, τῇδ' ἂν τις ὀρθότατα λέγοι· πῦρ μὲν ἐκάστοτε αὐτοῦ τὸ πεπυρωμένον μέρος φαίνεσθαι, τὸ δὲ ὑγρὰνθὲν ὕδωρ, γῆν τε καὶ ἀέρα καθ' ὅσον ἂν μιμήματα τούτων δέχεται. λόγῳ δὲ δὴ μᾶλλον τὸ τοιόνδε διοριζομένους περὶ αὐτῶν διασκεπτέον· ἄρα ἔστιν τι πῦρ αὐτὸ ἐφ' ἑαυτοῦ καὶ πάντα περὶ ὧν αἰεὶ λέγομεν οὕτως αὐτὰ καθ' αὐτὰ ὄντα ἕκαστα, ἢ ταῦτα ἅπερ καὶ βλέπομεν, ὅσα τε ἄλλα διὰ τοῦ σώματος αἰσθανόμεθα, μόνα ἐστὶν τοιαύτην ἔχοντα ἀλήθειαν, ἄλλα δὲ οὐκ ἔστι παρὰ ταῦτα οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς, ἀλλὰ μάτην ἐκάστοτε εἶναι τί φαμεν εἶδος ἐκάστου νοητόν, τὸ δ' οὐδὲν ἄρ' ἦν πλὴν λόγος; οὔτε οὖν δὴ τὸ παρὸν ἄκριτον καὶ ἀδίκαστον ἀφέντα ἄξιον φάναι δισχυριζόμενον ἔχειν οὕτως, οὔτ' ἐπὶ λόγου μήκει πάρεργον ἄλλο μῆκος ἐπεμβλητέον· εἰ δέ τις ὅρος ὀρισθεὶς μέγας διὰ βραχέων φανείη, τοῦτο μάλιστα ἐγκαιριώτατον γένοιτ' ἂν. ὧδε οὖν τήν γ' ἐμὴν αὐτὸς τίθεμαι ψῆφον. εἰ μὲν νοῦς καὶ δόξα ἀληθῆς ἐστων δύο γένη, παντάπασιν εἶναι καθ' αὐτὰ ταῦτα, ἀναίσθητα ὑφ' ἡμῶν εἶδη, νοούμενα μόνον· εἰ δ', ὥς τιςιν φαίνεται, δόξα ἀληθῆς νοῦ διαφέρει τὸ μηδέν, πάνθ' ὁπόσ' αὖ διὰ τοῦ σώματος αἰσθανόμεθα θετέον βεβαιότατα. δύο δὲ λεκτέον ἐκείνω, διότι χωρὶς γεγόνατον ἀνομοίως τε ἔχεται. τὸ μὲν γὰρ αὐτῶν διὰ διδαχῆς, τὸ δ' ὑπὸ πειθοῦς ἡμῖν ἐγγίγνεται· καὶ τὸ μὲν αἰεὶ μετ' ἀληθοῦς λόγου, τὸ δὲ ἄλογον· καὶ τὸ μὲν ἀκίνητον πειθοῖ, τὸ δὲ μεταπειστόν· καὶ τοῦ μὲν πάντα ἄνδρα μετέχειν φατέον, νοῦ δὲ θεοῦς, ἀνθρώπων δὲ γένος βραχύ τι. TI. τούτων δὲ οὕτως ἐχόντων

52a

T: Since this is how matters stand, we must agree that the form which is always the same is one, ungenerated, undecaying, neither receiving

anything into itself from anywhere else, nor entering into anything else anywhere, invisible and imperceptible. Nous has been assigned the task of investigating this. The second bears the same name as that and is similar thereto – perceptible, generated, constantly being moved, coming into being in some location, then perishing out of that place once more. It is apprehended by opinion accompanied by sense perception. The third kind is space, which is always, not accepting destruction, providing a basis for everything that comes into being, itself apprehended without involving the senses by some spurious reasoning difficult to believe in. This, indeed, we look towards and we engage in dreams, declaring that whatever is must presumably be in some location and occupy some space, and whatever is not, somehow either on Earth or in Heaven, is nothing. On account of this dreaming, we become unable, on awakening, to make these distinctions and others akin to them, even in relation to the unsleeping and truly subsisting nature, and to state the truth that in the case of an image, since it does not itself even possess the very thing it has been fashioned after, but always bears an appearance belonging to something else, it is appropriate for these reasons that it come into being in something different, clinging onto being in some way or other lest it be absolutely nothing. However, in support of what actually is, the precise and true account states that as long as one thing is different from another, neither can ever come into being in the other so that they simultaneously become one and the same, and two.

ὁμολογητέον ἔν μὲν εἶναι τὸ κατὰ ταυτὰ εἶδος ἔχον, ἀγέννητον καὶ ἀνώλεθρον, οὔτε εἰς ἑαυτὸ εἰσδεχόμενον ἄλλο ἄλλοθεν οὔτε αὐτὸ εἰς ἄλλο ποι ἰόν, ἀόρατον δὲ καὶ ἄλλως ἀναίσθητον, τοῦτο δὲ δὴ νόησις εἴληχεν ἐπισκοπεῖν· τὸ δὲ ὁμώνυμον ὁμοίον τε ἐκείνῳ δεύτερον, αἰσθητόν, γεννητόν, πεφορημένον αἰεὶ, γιγνόμενόν τε ἔν τινι τόπῳ καὶ πάλιν ἐκεῖθεν ἀπολλύμενον, δόξῃ μετ' αἰσθήσεως περιληπτόν· τρίτον δὲ αὖ γένος ὃν τὸ τῆς χώρας αἰεὶ, φθορὰν οὐ προσδεχόμενον, ἔδραν δὲ παρέχον ὅσα ἔχει γένεσιν πᾶσιν, αὐτὸ δὲ μετ' ἀναισθησίας ἀπτὸν λογισμῷ τινι νόθῳ, μόγις πιστόν, πρὸς δὲ δὴ καὶ ὄνειροπολοῦμεν

βλέποντες καί φαμεν ἀναγκαῖον εἶναί που τὸ ὄν ἅπαν ἔν τινι τόπῳ καὶ κατέχον χώραν τινά, τὸ δὲ μήτ' ἐν γῇ μήτε που κατ' οὐρανὸν οὐδὲν εἶναι. ταῦτα δὴ πάντα καὶ τούτων ἄλλα ἀδελφὰ καὶ περὶ τὴν αὐπνον καὶ ἀληθῶς φύσιν ὑπάρχουσαν ὑπὸ ταύτης τῆς ὀνειρώξεως οὐ δυνατοὶ γιγνόμεθα ἐγερθέντες διοριζόμενοι τάληθές λέγειν, ὥς εἰκόνι μὲν, ἐπεὶ περ οὐδ' αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἐφ' ᾧ γέγονεν ἑαυτῆς ἐστίν, ἐτέρου δέ τινος ἀεὶ φέρεται φάντασμα, διὰ ταῦτα ἐν ἐτέρῳ προσήκει τινὶ γίγνεσθαι, οὐσίας ἀμωσγέπως ἀντεχομένην, ἢ μηδὲν τὸ παράπαν αὐτὴν εἶναι, τῷ δὲ ὄντως ὄντι βοηθὸς ὁ δι' ἀκριβείας ἀληθοῦς λόγος, ὥς ἕως ἄν τι τὸ μὲν ἄλλο ᾧ, τὸ δὲ ἄλλο, οὐδέτερον ἐν οὐδετέρῳ ποτὲ γενόμενον

52d

T: So let this concisely argued account be the one that receives my vote. There is being, space and becoming, these three, even before the Heaven comes into being. And yet the nurse of becoming, rendered watery and fiery, and receiving the forms of earth and air and adopting whatever other characteristics are a consequence of these, presents a variegated appearance. And because of being filled with powers that are neither similar nor equally balanced, no part of it is equally balanced. Rather, being swayed irregularly in all directions, it is shaken by those powers, and, as it moves, it in turn shakes them once more. And as they move, borne continually in one direction or another, they are separated, just like materials shaken and sifted by sieves and instruments for purifying grain; the dense and heavy components go one way, while the loose and light components are carried to a different place and settle there. The four kinds were then shaken in this way by the receptacle, itself moving like an instrument for shaking, separating the most dissimilar as far apart as possible from one another, while forcing the most similar together into the same place. And so it was that these different kinds each occupied a distinct space, even before the Universe organised from them had come into being. Indeed, prior to this they all behaved in an irrational and unmeasured manner. However, when the Universe was brought to order, fire, water, earth and air did possess some traces of themselves,

and yet they were entirely in the sort of state that anything is likely to be in when god is absent from it. Such being their nature at the time, the god first gave them a structure by means of forms and numbers. Let this, above all, be our constant assertion: the god constructed them to be as beautiful and excellent as possible, but this was not their previous condition. But now I must attempt to show you the structure of each of them, and their origin, by means of an unfamiliar account. And yet, since you have been involved in the courses of education that I must draw upon to demonstrate my assertion, you will follow me.

ἐν ἅμα ταῦτόν καὶ δύο γενήσεσθον. οὗτος μὲν οὖν δὴ παρὰ τῆς ἐμῆς ψήφου λογισθεὶς ἐν κεφαλαίῳ δεδόσθω λόγος, ὃν τε καὶ χώραν καὶ γένεσιν εἶναι, τρία τριχῇ, καὶ πρὶν οὐρανὸν γενέσθαι· τὴν δὲ δὴ γενέσεως τιθήνην ὑγραιομένην καὶ πυρουμένην καὶ τὰς γῆς τε καὶ ἀέρος μορφὰς δεχομένην, καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα τούτοις πάθη συνέπεται πάσχουσιν, παντοδαπὴν μὲν ἰδεῖν φαίνεσθαι, διὰ δὲ τὸ μῆθ' ὁμοίων δυνάμεων μήτε ἰσορρόπων ἐμπύμπλασθαι κατ' οὐδὲν αὐτῆς ἰσορροπεῖν, ἀλλ' ἀνωμάλως πάντῃ ταλαντούμενην σειέσθαι μὲν ὑπ' ἐκείνων αὐτήν, κινουμένην δ' αὖ πάλιν ἐκεῖνα σείειν· ΤΙ. τὰ δὲ κινούμενα ἄλλα ἄλλοσε ἀεὶ φέρεσθαι διακρινόμενα, ὥσπερ τὰ ὑπὸ τῶν πλοκάνων τε καὶ ὀργάνων τῶν περὶ τὴν τοῦ σίτου κάθαρσιν σειόμενα καὶ ἀνικμώμενα τὰ μὲν πυκνὰ καὶ βαρέα ἄλλῃ, τὰ δὲ μανὰ καὶ κοῦφα εἰς ἐτέραν ἵζει φερόμενα ἔδραν· τότε οὕτω τὰ τέτταρα γένη σειόμενα ὑπὸ τῆς δεξαμενῆς, κινουμένης αὐτῆς οἷον ὀργάνου σεισμὸν παρέχοντος, τὰ μὲν ἀνομοιοτάτα πλεῖστον αὐτὰ ἀφ' αὐτῶν ὀρίζειν, τὰ δὲ ὁμοιοτάτα μάλιστα εἰς ταῦτόν συνωθεῖν, διὸ δὴ καὶ χώραν ταῦτα ἄλλα ἄλλην ἴσχειν, πρὶν καὶ τὸ πᾶν ἐξ αὐτῶν διακοσμηθὲν γενέσθαι. καὶ τὸ μὲν δὴ πρὸ τούτου πάντα ταῦτ' εἶχεν ἀλόγως καὶ ἀμέτρως· ὅτε δ' ἐπεχειρεῖτο κοσμεῖσθαι τὸ πᾶν, πῦρ πρῶτον καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ γῆν καὶ ἀέρα, ἔχνη μὲν ἔχοντα αὐτῶν ἅττα, παντάπασί γε μὴν διακείμενα ὥσπερ εἰκὸς ἔχειν ἅπαν ὅταν ἀπῇ τινος θεός, οὕτω δὴ τότε πεφυκότα ταῦτα πρῶτον διεσχηματίσατο εἶδεσί τε καὶ ἀριθμοῖς. τὸ δὲ ἥ δυνατόν ὡς κάλλιστα ἄριστά τε ἐξ οὐχ οὕτως ἐχόντων τὸν θεὸν αὐτὰ συνιστάναι, παρὰ πάντα

ἡμῖν ὡς αἰὲ τοῦτο λεγόμενον ὑπαρχέτω· νῦν δ' οὖν τὴν διάταξιν αὐτῶν ἐπιχειρητέον ἐκάστων καὶ γένεσιν

53c

T: Now, in the first place, fire and earth, water and air are bodies, as is obvious to everyone I presume, and the form of every body also possesses depth. And it is absolutely necessary that depth, in turn, be contained by a flat surface, and any straight-sided flat surface is constructed from triangles. All triangles originate from two triangles, each of which possesses a single right angle while the others are acute. One of them has half a right angle on either side, divided by equal sides, while in the other case the portions of the right angle are unequal, apportioned by unequal sides.²¹ So, proceeding on the basis of the likely account, accompanied by necessity, we propose this as the origin of fire and the other bodies, but any origins still higher than these god knows, and so do any men who are dear to him. So we need to state what the most beautiful bodies would be, four in number, dissimilar to one another, and yet capable of arising from one another in some cases when they are broken apart. For once we accomplish this, we are in possession of the truth concerning the generation of earth and fire and whatever lies between them in a proportion. Indeed, we shall not concede to anyone that there are visible bodies more beautiful than these anywhere, each based upon a single kind.

ἀήθει λόγῳ πρὸς ὑμᾶς δηλοῦν, ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἐπεὶ μετέχετε τῶν κατὰ παιδείουσιν ὁδῶν δι' ὧν ἐνδείκνυσθαι τὰ λεγόμενα ἀνάγκη, συνέψεσθε. πρῶτον μὲν δὴ πῦρ καὶ γῆ καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ ἀήρ ὅτι σώματά ἐστι, δῆλόν που καὶ παντί· τὸ δὲ τοῦ σώματος εἶδος πᾶν καὶ βάθος ἔχει. τὸ δὲ βάθος αὖ πᾶσα ἀνάγκη τὴν ἐπίπεδον περιειληφέναι φύσιν· ἡ δὲ ὀρθὴ τῆς ἐπιπέδου βάσεως ἐκ τριγώνων συνέστηκεν. τὰ δὲ τρίγωνα πάντα ἐκ δυοῖν ἄρχεται τριγώνοις, μίαν μὲν ὀρθὴν ἔχοντος ἐκατέρου γωνίαν, τὰς δὲ ὀξείας· ὧν τὸ μὲν ἕτερον ἐκατέρωθεν ἔχει μέρος γωνίας ὀρθῆς πλευραῖς ἴσαις διηρημένης, τὸ δ' ἕτερον ἀνίσοις ἄνισα μέρη νενημημένης. ταύτην δὴ πυρὸς ἀρχὴν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων σωμάτων ὑποτιθέμεθα κατὰ τὸν μετ' ἀνάγκης εἰκότα λόγον πορευόμενοι· τὰς δ'

ἔτι τούτων ἀρχὰς ἄνωθεν θεὸς οἶδεν καὶ ἀνδρῶν ὃς ἂν ἐκείνῳ φίλος ᾗ. δεῖ δὴ λέγειν ποῖα κάλλιστα σώματα γένοιτ' ἂν τέτταρα, ἀνόμοια μὲν ἑαυτοῖς, δυνατὰ δὲ ἐξ ἀλλήλων αὐτῶν ἅττα διαλυόμενα γίγνεσθαι· τούτου γὰρ τυχόντες ἔχομεν τὴν ἀλήθειαν γενέσεως περὶ γῆς τε καὶ πυρὸς τῶν τε ἀνὰ λόγον ἐν μέσῳ. τότε γὰρ οὐδενὶ συγχωρησόμεθα, καλλίῳ τούτων ὀρώμενα σώματα εἶναί που καθ' ἑνὸς γένος ἕκαστον ὄν. τοῦτ' οὖν προθυμητέον, τὰ διαφέροντα κάλλει σωμάτων τέτταρα γένη συναρμόσασθαι καὶ φάναι τὴν τούτων ἡμᾶς φύσιν ἱκανῶς εἰληφέναι.

54a

T: So we must be eager to construct the four types of bodies that excel in beauty, and to declare that we have sufficiently understood their nature. In the case of the pair of triangles, there is only one type of isosceles triangle but an unlimited number of scalenes. Therefore, we must proceed to select the most beautiful from this unlimited number if we intend to begin methodically. Yet if anyone can declare that he has chosen something more beautiful for the construction of these bodies, he will be victorious, not as an enemy but as a friend. And so, passing over the others, we propose one of the numerous triangles as the most beautiful, the one from which the equilateral triangle is constructed as a third. The explanation for this is a longer story, but if anyone refutes this and discovers that it is not the case, the prize is his, as a friend.

ΤΙ. τοῖν δὴ δυοῖν τριγώνοις τὸ μὲν ἰσοσκελὲς μίαν εἴληχεν φύσιν, τὸ δὲ πρόμηκες ἀπεράντους· προαιρετέον οὖν αὖ τῶν ἀπείρων τὸ κάλλιστον, εἰ μέλλομεν ἄρξασθαι κατὰ τρόπον. ἂν οὖν τις ἔχη κάλλιον ἐκλεξάμενος εἰπεῖν εἰς τὴν τούτων σύστασιν, ἐκεῖνος οὐκ ἐχθρὸς ὢν ἀλλὰ φίλος κρατεῖ· τιθέμεθα δ' οὖν τῶν πολλῶν τριγώνων κάλλιστον ἓν, ὑπερβάντες τᾶλλα, ἐξ οὗ τὸ ἰσόπλευρον τρίγωνον ἐκ τρίτου συνέστηκεν.

54b

T: So we shall select two triangles from which the bodies of fire and of the others have been devised. One is the isosceles, while the other has a long side that is always triple the short side when they are squared.

However, something stated earlier in an imprecise manner should now be made more definite, for when it appeared that the four kinds all underwent generation from one another and into one another, the appearances were incorrect. The four kinds do indeed arise from the triangles we selected, and while three are constructed from the one that has unequal sides, the fourth one alone is constructed from the isosceles. So it is not possible for them all to be generated from one another when they are broken apart so that a few large kinds are produced from numerous smaller kinds and vice versa. Only three of them can do this because they arise naturally from a single triangle, and, by breaking up the larger bodies, numerous smaller bodies can be formed from the same triangles as the bodies take on the shapes appropriate to themselves. Then again, the small bodies, when dispersed into their constituent triangles, would give rise to another large single form once they constitute a single number belonging to a single volume.

διότι δέ, λόγος πλείων· ἀλλὰ τῷ τοῦτο ἐλέγξαντι καὶ ἀνευρόντι δὴ οὕτως ἔχον κεῖται φίλια τὰ ἄλλα. προηρήσθω δὴ δύο τρίγωνα ἐξ ὧν τό τε τοῦ πυρὸς καὶ τὰ τῶν ἄλλων σώματα μεμηχάνηται, τὸ μὲν ἰσοσκελές, τὸ δὲ τριπλὴν κατὰ δύναμιν ἔχον τῆς ἐλάττονος τὴν μείζω πλευρὰν αἰεί. τὸ δὲ πρόσθεν ἀσαφῶς ῥηθὲν νῦν μᾶλλον διοριστεόν. τὰ γὰρ τέτταρα γένη δι' ἀλλήλων εἰς ἄλληλα ἐφαίνετο πάντα γένεσιν ἔχειν, οὐκ ὀρθῶς φανταζόμενα γίγνεται μὲν γὰρ ἐκ τῶν τριγώνων ὧν προηρήμεθα γένη τέτταρα, τρία μὲν ἐξ ἑνὸς τοῦ τὰς πλευρὰς ἀνίσους ἔχοντος, τὸ δὲ τέταρτον ἐν μόνον ἐκ τοῦ ἰσοσκελοῦς τριγώνου συναρμοσθέν. οὐκ οὖν δυνατόν πάντα εἰς ἄλληλα διαλυόμενα ἐκ πολλῶν σμικρῶν ὀλίγα μεγάλα καὶ τοῦναντίον γίνεσθαι, τὰ δὲ τρία οἷόν τε· ἐκ γὰρ ἑνὸς ἅπαντα πεφυκότες λυθέντων τε τῶν μειζόνων πολλὰ σμικρὰ ἐκ τῶν αὐτῶν συστήσεται, δεχόμενα τὰ προσήκοντα ἑαυτοῖς σχήματα, καὶ σμικρὰ ὅταν αὖ πολλὰ κατὰ

54d

T: Now, that is enough said about their generation from one another. Next, we should explain what the form of each of them is like and the

numbers that come together to constitute it. Now, we begin with the construction of the first and smallest form. Its element of composition is the triangle having its hypotenuse double the shortest side in length. If a pair of such triangles is placed along a diagonal, and this is done three times, with the diagonals and the short sides fixed to the same point as though it were a centre, then from these, six in number, a single equilateral triangle is produced. And when four equilateral triangles are combined based on three flat angles coming together, a single solid angle is produced, the one that comes next after the most obtuse of flat angles.²² And when four such solid angles have been completed, the first solid form that apportions the entire surface of a sphere into equal and similar parts is constructed.²³

τὰ τρίγωνα διασπαρῆ, γενόμενος εἷς ἀριθμὸς ἑνὸς ὄγκου μέγα ἀποτελέσειεν ἂν ἄλλο εἶδος ἕν. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν λελέχθω περὶ τῆς εἰς ἄλληλα γενέσεως· οἷον δὲ ἕκαστον αὐτῶν γέγονεν εἶδος καὶ ἐξ ὧν συμπεσόντων ἀριθμῶν, λέγειν ἂν ἐπόμενον εἴη. ἄρξει δὴ τό τε πρῶτον εἶδος καὶ σμικρότατον συνιστάμενον, στοιχεῖον δ' αὐτοῦ τὸ τὴν ὑποτείνουσιν τῆς ἐλάττονος πλευρᾶς διπλασίαν ἔχον μήκει· σύνδυο δὲ τοιούτων κατὰ διάμετρον συντιθεμένων καὶ τρις τοῦτου

54e

T: The second is composed of the same triangles but arranged into eight equilateral triangles which produce a single solid angle from four flat angles, and when six solid angles like this have been generated, the second solid form is, in turn, brought to completion. The third is composed of one hundred and twenty of the elemental triangles combined together. It has twelve solid angles, each bounded by five flat equilateral triangles, and twenty faces consisting of equilateral triangles. Now, this elemental triangle was released from duty once it had produced these three forms, and the isosceles triangle then produced the fourth kind when it was assembled in groups of four, with their right angles joining at the centre to form a single equilateral quadrangle.²⁴ And six such surfaces when brought together produced eight solid angles, each consisting of three flat right angles,

and the shape of the assembled body was the cube with its six flat equilateral quadrangular faces. One construction still remained, the fifth, and God used this in order to embroider shapes upon the Universe.²⁵

γενομένου, τὰς διαμέτρους καὶ τὰς βραχείας πλευρὰς εἰς ταὐτὸν ὡς κέντρον ἔρεισάντων, ἐν ἰσόπλευρον τρίγωνον ἐξ ἑξ τὸν ἀριθμὸν ὄντων γέγονεν. ΤΙ. τρίγωνα δὲ ἰσόπλευρα συνιστάμενα τέτταρα κατὰ σύντρεῖς ἐπιπέδους γωνίας μίαν στερεὰν γωνίαν ποιεῖ, τῆς ἀμβλυτάτης τῶν ἐπιπέδων γωνιῶν ἐφεξῆς γεγонуῖαν· τοιούτων δὲ ἀποτελεσθαισῶν τεττάρων πρῶτον εἶδος στερεόν, ὅλου περιφεροῦς διανεμητικὸν εἰς ἴσα μέρη καὶ ὅμοια, συνίσταται. δεύτερον δὲ ἐκ μὲν τῶν αὐτῶν τριγώνων, κατὰ δὲ ἰσόπλευρα τρίγωνα ὁκτῶ συστάντων, μίαν ἀπεργασαμένων στερεὰν γωνίαν ἐκ τεττάρων ἐπιπέδων· καὶ γενομένων ἑξ τοιούτων τὸ δεύτερον αὐτῷ σῶμα οὕτως ἔσχεν τέλος. τὸ δὲ τρίτον ἐκ δις ἐξήκοντα τῶν στοιχείων συμπαγόντων, στερεῶν δὲ γωνιῶν δώδεκα, ὑπὸ πέντε ἐπιπέδων τριγώνων ἰσοπλεύρων περιεχομένης ἐκάστης, εἴκοσι βάσεις ἔχον ἰσοπλεύρους τριγώνους γέγονεν. καὶ τὸ μὲν ἕτερον ἀπήλλακτο τῶν στοιχείων ταῦτα γεννήσαν, τὸ δὲ ἰσοσκελὲς τρίγωνον ἐγέννα τὴν τοῦ τετάρτου φύσιν, κατὰ τέτταρα συνιστάμενον, εἰς τὸ κέντρον τὰς ὀρθὰς γωνίας συνάγον, ἐν ἰσόπλευρον τετράγωνον ἀπεργασάμενον· ἑξ δὲ τοιαῦτα

55c

T: Now, suppose someone considering all this with due measure were to become perplexed over whether we should say there are an unlimited number of universes or that there is some limit. He would regard the opinion that the number is unlimited as belonging to someone who is actually inexperienced on issues about which he should be experienced, but, on the other hand, the question of whether it is in truth ever appropriate to say that there is naturally one universe or five, if he were to stop there, would provide more reasonable grounds for perplexity. Now, our approach, based upon the likely account, reveals that it is by nature a single god, but someone

else, in view of some other considerations, may form different opinions.

συμπαγέντα γωνίας ὁκτώ στερεὰς ἀπετέλεσεν, κατὰ τρεῖς ἐπιπέδους ὀρθὰς συναρμοσθείσης ἐκάστης· τὸ δὲ σχῆμα τοῦ συστάντος σώματος γέγονεν κυβικόν, ἔξ ἐπιπέδους τετραγώνους ἰσοπλευροῦς βάσεις ἔχον. ἔτι δὲ οὔσης συστάσεως μιᾶς πέμπτης, ἐπὶ τὸ πᾶν ὁ θεὸς αὐτῇ κατεχρήσατο ἐκεῖνο διαζωγραφῶν. ἃ δὴ τις εἰ πάντα λογιζόμενος ἐμμελῶς ἀποροῖ πότερον ἀπείρους χρή κόσμους εἶναι λέγειν ἢ πέρας ἔχοντας, τὸ μὲν

55d

T: Now, we should dismiss this fellow and allocate the four types that have been generated to fire, earth, water and air. So let's assign the cubic form to earth, since earth is the most immobile of the four types and it is the most malleable of bodies, so it is especially necessary that this be the sort that has the most stable bases. And of the two triangles we proposed at the outset, a base made from the one with equal sides is naturally more stable than a base made from the one with unequal sides; and in the case of the equal-sided surfaces constructed from either triangle, the square is necessarily more resistant to motion than the equilateral triangle, both as a whole and according to its parts. Therefore, we shall preserve the likely account by assigning this form to earth, and of those that remain the hardest to move is assigned to water, the easiest to move to fire, and the intermediate kind to air. Again, the smallest body is assigned to fire, the largest to water, and the intermediate to air; and the sharpest again to fire, the second sharpest to air, and the third sharpest to water. Now, in all these cases, the one that has the fewest bases is necessarily the most mobile by nature, since it is the most incisive and the sharpest of them all in every respect, and also the lightest since it is composed of the fewest identical parts. The second lies in second place based on these same factors, while the third lies in third place.

ἀπείρους ἡγήσαιτ' ἂν ὄντως ἀπείρου τινὸς εἶναι δόγμα ὧν ἔμπειρον χρεὼν εἶναι, πότερον δὲ ἓνα ἢ πέντε αὐτοὺς ἀληθείᾳ πεφυκότας λέγειν ποτὲ προσήκει, μᾶλλον ἂν ταύτῃ στὰς εἰκότως διαπορήσαι. τὸ μὲν οὖν δὴ παρ' ἡμῶν ἓνα αὐτὸν κατὰ τὸν εἰκότα λόγον πεφυκότα μηνύει θεόν, ἄλλος δὲ εἰς ἄλλα πη βλέψας ἕτερα δοξάσει. καὶ τοῦτον μὲν μεθετέον, τὰ δὲ γεγονότα νῦν τῷ λόγῳ γένη διανείμωμεν εἰς πῦρ καὶ γῆν καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ ἀέρα. γῆ μὲν δὴ τὸ κυβικὸν εἶδος δῶμεν· ἀκίνητοτάτη γὰρ τῶν τεττάρων γενῶν γῆ καὶ τῶν σωμάτων πλαστικωτάτη, μάλιστα δὲ ἀνάγκη γεγονέναι τοιοῦτον τὸ τὰς βάσεις ἀσφαλεστάτας ἔχον· βάσις δὲ ἢ τε τῶν κατ' ἀρχὰς τριγώνων ὑποτεθέντων ἀσφαλεστέρα κατὰ φύσιν ἢ τῶν ἴσων πλευρῶν τῆς τῶν ἀνίσων, τό τε ἐξ ἐκατέρου συντεθὲν ἐπίπεδον ἰσοπλευρον ἰσοπλεύρου τετράγωνον τριγώνου κατὰ τε μέρη καὶ καθ' ὅλον στασιμωτέρως ἐξ ἀνάγκης βέβηκεν. ΤΙ. διὸ γῆ μὲν τοῦτο ἀπονέμοντες τὸν εἰκότα λόγον διασώζομεν, ὕδατι δ' αὖ τῶν λοιπῶν τὸ δυσκίνητότατον εἶδος, τὸ δ' εὐκίνητότατον πυρί, τὸ δὲ μέσον ἀέρι· καὶ τὸ μὲν σμικρότατον σῶμα πυρί, τὸ δ' αὖ μέγιστον ὕδατι, τὸ δὲ μέσον ἀέρι· καὶ τὸ μὲν ὀξύτατον αὖ πυρί, τὸ δὲ δεύτερον ἀέρι, τὸ δὲ τρίτον ὕδατι. ταῦτ' οὖν δὴ πάντα, τὸ μὲν ἔχον ὀλιγίστας βάσεις εὐκίνητότατον ἀνάγκη πεφυκέναι, τμητικώτατόν τε

56b

T: So, in accordance with the correct and likely account, let the solid form that constitutes a pyramid be the element and seed of fire, and we may say that the second in order of generation belongs to air, and the third to water. Now, we need to realise that these are all so small that an individual particular of each kind is invisible to us due to its extreme smallness, and yet, when a large number are aggregated together, their bulks are visible. As for the proportions associated with their multiplicity, movements, and their other capacities, insofar as the nature of Necessity allowed under willing persuasion, we must realise that God fitted them together entirely in due proportion once he had precisely perfected them in this comprehensive manner.

καὶ ὀξύτατον ὃν πάντῃ πάντων, ἔτι τε ἐλαφρότατον, ἐξ ὀλιγίστων συνεστὸς τῶν αὐτῶν μερῶν· τὸ δὲ δεύτερον δευτέρως τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτ'

ἔχειν, τρίτως δὲ τὸ τρίτον. ἔστω δὴ κατὰ τὸν ὀρθὸν λόγον καὶ κατὰ τὸν εἰκότα τὸ μὲν τῆς πυραμίδος στερεὸν γεγονός εἶδος πυρὸς στοιχεῖον καὶ σπέρμα· τὸ δὲ δεύτερον κατὰ γένεσιν εἴπωμεν ἄερος, τὸ δὲ τρίτον ὕδατος. πάντα οὖν δὴ ταῦτα δεῖ διανοεῖσθαι σμικρὰ οὕτως, ὥς καθ' ἓν ἕκαστον μὲν τοῦ γένους ἑκάστου διὰ σμικρότητα οὐδὲν ὀρώμενον ὑφ' ἡμῶν, συναθροισθέντων δὲ πολλῶν τοὺς ὄγκους αὐτῶν ὀρᾶσθαι· καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ τῶν ἀναλογιῶν περί τε τὰ πλήθη καὶ τὰς κινήσεις καὶ τὰς ἄλλας δυνάμεις πανταχῇ τὸν θεόν, ὅπῃπερ ἡ τῆς ἀνάγκης ἔκοῦσα πεισθεῖσα τε φύσις ὑπέεικεν, ταύτῃ πάντῃ δι' ἀκριβείας ἀποτελεσθεῖσιν ὑπ' αὐτοῦ συνηρμόσθαι ταῦτα ἀνά λόγον. ἐκ δὴ πάντων ὧνπερ τὰ γένη προειρήκαμεν ὧδ' ἂν κατὰ

56d

T: Now, from all that we have said earlier about the kinds, they would be most likely to behave as follows. Earth, on encountering fire and being broken apart by its sharpness – regardless of whether it is in fire itself when it gets broken up, or in a mass of air or water – would travel along until such time as it somehow meets up with its own parts, which, once fitted together with themselves, become earth again, for they could never have adopted any other form. Water, when broken apart either by fire or air, is capable of combining to constitute one body of fire and two of air, while the components of air, when a single portion is broken up, would become two bodies of fire. And again, when a little fire is surrounded by a lot of air or water, or even by some earth, and is in motion within them, does battle, gets defeated and is shattered, two bodies of fire combine into a single figure of air. And if air is defeated and broken in pieces, one whole figure of water will be compounded from two and a half of air.

τὸ εἶκος μάλιστ' ἂν ἔχοι. γῆ μὲν συντυγχάνουσα πυρὶ διαλυθεῖσά τε ὑπὸ τῆς ὀξύτητος αὐτοῦ φέροιτ' ἄν, εἴτ' ἐν αὐτῷ πυρὶ λυθεῖσα εἴτ' ἐν ἄερος εἴτ' ἐν ὕδατος ὄγκῳ τύχοι, μέχριπερ ἂν αὐτῆς πῃ συντυχόντα τὰ μέρη, πάλιν συναρμοσθέντα αὐτὰ αὐτοῖς, γῆ γένοιτο—οὐ γὰρ εἰς ἄλλο γε εἶδος ἔλθοι ποτ' ἄν—ὑδωρ δὲ ὑπὸ πυρὸς μερισθέν, εἴτε καὶ ὑπ' ἄερος, ἐγχωρεῖ γίγνεσθαι συστάντα ἐν μὲν πυρὸς σῶμα, δύο δὲ ἄερος· τὰ δὲ

ἀέρος τμήματα ἐξ ἑνὸς μέρους διαλυθέντος δύ' ἂν γενοίσθην σώματα πυρός. καὶ πάλιν, ὅταν ἀέρι πῦρ ὕδασίν τε ἢ τινι γῇ περιλαμβανόμενον ἐν πολλοῖς ὀλίγον, κινούμενον ἐν φερομένοις, μαχόμενον καὶ νικηθὲν καταθραυσθῇ, δύο πυρὸς σώματα εἰς ἓν συνίστασθον εἶδος ἀέρος· καὶ κρατηθέντος ἀέρος κερματισθέντος τε ἐκ δυοῖν ὅλοιν καὶ ἡμίσεος ὕδατος εἶδος ἐν ὅλον ἔσται συμπαγές. ΤΙ. ὧδε γὰρ δὴ λογισώμεθα αὐτὰ πάλιν, ὡς ὅταν ἐν πυρὶ λαμβανόμενον τῶν

57a

T: In fact, we may consider them again as follows. Whenever one of the other types is surrounded by fire and is cut by its sharp corners and edges, it stops being cut once it recombines into the nature of fire. For in each case, a kind that is the same and similar is unable to effect any change in or be affected by anything that is the same as itself and has similar characteristics. However, as long as it transforms into something else, as a lesser contesting against a stronger, its dissolution is unceasing. And furthermore, whenever a few smaller units, being surrounded by many that are larger, are broken apart and quenched, then, if they recombine and adopt the form of the dominant units, their quenching ceases and air arises from fire, or water from air. But if, as they are going in this direction, one of the other kinds comes upon them and attacks them, there is no end to their dissolution until they are either completely broken up by the pressure and take flight towards their kindred, or they are overcome, and out of the multiplicity constitute a unit like unto their conqueror and abide thereafter as its neighbour. And, indeed, during these processes they all exchange their locations, for although the vast bulk of each kind is set apart in its own place because of the motion of the receptacle, those that are in the process of becoming unlike themselves, but like others, are borne by the shaking towards the place belonging to the kinds they are becoming like.

ἄλλων ὑπ' αὐτοῦ τι γένος τῇ τῶν γωνιῶν καὶ κατὰ τὰς πλευρὰς ὀξύτητι τέμνηται, συστὰν μὲν εἰς τὴν ἐκείνου φύσιν πέπαιται τεμνόμενον—τὸ γὰρ ὅμοιον καὶ ταῦτόν αὐτῷ γένος ἕκαστον οὔτε τινὰ μεταβολὴν

ἐμποιῆσαι δυνατόν οὔτε τι παθεῖν ὑπὸ τοῦ κατὰ ταῦτα ὁμοίως τε ἔχοντος—ἕως δ' ἂν εἰς ἄλλο τι γιγνόμενον ἦττον ὃν κρείττονι μάχεται, λυόμενον οὐ παύεται. τὰ τε αὖ σμικρότερα ὅταν ἐν τοῖς μείζουσιν πολλοῖς περιλαμβανόμενα ὀλίγα διαθραυόμενα κατασβεννύηται, συνίστασθαι μὲν ἐθέλοντα εἰς τὴν τοῦ κρατοῦντος ἰδέαν πέπαιται κατασβεννύμενα γίγνεται τε ἐκ πυρὸς ἀήρ, ἐξ ἀέρος ὕδωρ· ἐὰν δ' εἰς ταῦτα ἦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων τι συνιὼν γενῶν μάχεται, λυόμενα οὐ παύεται, πρὶν ἢ παντάπασιν ὠθούμενα καὶ διαλυθέντα ἐκφύγῃ πρὸς τὸ συγγενές, ἢ νικηθέντα, ἐν ἐκ πολλῶν ὅμοιον τῷ κρατήσαντι γενόμενον, αὐτοῦ σύνοικον μείνῃ. καὶ

57c

T: Now, it is through such causes as these that the unmixed and primary bodies have arisen, and yet the different types that exist within the forms of these four must be attributed to the construction of the two elementals. This initially produced a triangle in each case that was not of one size only; rather, some were smaller, some larger, and the number of different sizes corresponded to the number of different types among the four kinds. And so, as they combine with themselves and one another, their diversity is unlimited, a diversity that must be contemplated by anyone who intends to have recourse to the likely account in relation to natural phenomena.

δὴ καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα τὰ παθήματα διαμείβεται τὰς χώρας ἅπαντα· διέστηκεν μὲν γὰρ τοῦ γένους ἐκάστου τὰ πλήθη κατὰ τόπον ἴδιον διὰ τὴν τῆς δεχομένης κίνησιν, τὰ δὲ ἀνομοιούμενα ἐκάστοτε ἑαυτοῖς, ἄλλοις δὲ ὁμοιούμενα, φέρεται διὰ τὸν σεισμὸν πρὸς τὸν ἐκείνων οἷς ἂν ὁμοιωθῇ τόπον. ὅσα μὲν οὖν ἄκρατα καὶ πρῶτα σώματα διὰ τοιούτων αἰτιῶν γέγονεν· τὸ δ' ἐν τοῖς εἶδεσιν αὐτῶν ἕτερα ἐμπεφυκέναι γένῃ τὴν ἐκατέρου τῶν στοιχείων αἰτιατέον σύστασιν,

57d

T: Now, if there is not some agreement on the origin of motion and rest and the manner in which they arise, our subsequent reasoning would be much impeded. And although something has been said about them already, the following should still be added. Where there is

uniformity, motion is never inclined to arise. For it is difficult, impossible really, that there be something moved without that which moves it, or for something to be a mover without something that is moved. In the absence of these there is no movement, yet it is impossible for them ever to be uniform. So, accordingly, we should always propose that there is rest in uniformity, and motion in non-uniformity. And, furthermore, the cause of the non-uniform nature is inequality.

μὴ μόνον ἐν ἑκατέραν μέγεθος ἔχον τὸ τρίγωνον φυτεῦσαι κατ' ἀρχάς, ἀλλ' ἐλάττω τε καὶ μείζω, τὸν ἀριθμὸν δὲ ἔχοντα τοσοῦτον ὅσαπερ ἂν ᾗ τὰν τοῖς εἴδεσι γένη. διὸ δὴ συμμειγνύμενα αὐτὰ τε πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα τὴν ποικιλίαν ἐστὶν ἄπειρα ἥς δὴ δεῖ θεωροὺς γίγνεσθαι τοὺς μέλλοντας περὶ φύσεως εἰκότι λόγῳ χρῆσεσθαι. κινήσεως οὖν στάσεώς τε πέρι, τίνα τρόπον καὶ μεθ' ὧντινων γίγνεσθον, εἰ μὴ τις διομολογήσεται, πόλλ' ἂν εἴη

57e

T: We have, indeed, described the origin of inequality, but we have not said precisely why there is not a cessation of their motion and mutual interchange once each of the four has been separated according to their kinds. We shall resume our account of this topic now. Since the circuit of the Universe encompasses these four kinds, and, being circular, is also inclined by nature to revert towards itself, it compresses them all and tends to allow no empty space to remain. Therefore, fire has indeed penetrated everything else to the greatest extent, air to the second greatest extent since it is by nature second in degree of fineness, and so on for all the others. For those formed from the largest components leave the most empty space in their structure, while the smallest leave the least. So the coming together, or compression, forces the smaller into the spaces in the larger. Now, when the smaller are placed alongside the larger and the lesser split the greater apart, or the larger force the lesser to combine, they are all borne in one direction or another towards their own locations, for as each changes in size, it also changes the position of the location that

belongs to it. In this way, and on account of all this, the generation of non-uniformity is always preserved, and it continually produces the unceasing alteration of these bodies, now and in the future.

ἐμποδὼν τῷ κατόπισθεν λογισμῷ. τὰ μὲν οὖν ἤδη περὶ αὐτῶν εἴρηται, πρὸς δ' ἐκείνοις ἔτι τάδε, ἐν μὲν ὁμαλότητι μηδέποτε ἐθέλιν κίνησιν ἐνεῖναι. τὸ γὰρ κινήσμενον ἄνευ τοῦ κινήσοντος ἢ τὸ κινήσον ἄνευ τοῦ κινήσομένου χαλεπὸν, μᾶλλον δὲ ἀδύνατον, εἶναι· κίνησις δὲ οὐκ ἔστιν τούτων ἀπόντων, ταῦτα δὲ ὁμαλὰ εἶναι ποτε ἀδύνατον. ΤΙ. οὕτω δὴ στάσις μὲν ἐν ὁμαλότητι, κίνησις δὲ εἰς ἀνωμαλότητα ἀεὶ τιθώμεν· αἰτία δὲ ἀνισότης αὖ τῆς ἀνωμάλου φύσεως. ἀνισότητος δὲ γένεσις μὲν διεληλύθαμεν· πῶς δέ ποτε οὐ κατὰ γένη διαχωρισθέντα ἕκαστα πέπαιται τῆς δι' ἀλλήλων κινήσεως καὶ φορᾶς, οὐκ εἵπομεν. ὥδε οὖν πάλιν ἐροῦμεν. ἢ τοῦ παντὸς περίοδος, ἐπειδὴ συμπεριέλαβεν τὰ γένη, κυκλοτερὴς οὔσα καὶ πρὸς αὐτὴν πεφυκυῖα βούλεσθαι συνιέναι, σφίγγει πάντα καὶ κενὴν χώραν οὐδεμίαν ἐᾷ λείπεσθαι. διὸ δὴ πῦρ μὲν εἰς ἅπαντα διελήλυθε μάλιστα, ἀήρ δὲ δεύτερον, ὡς λεπτότητι δεύτερον ἔφυ, καὶ τᾶλλα ταύτη· τὰ γὰρ ἐκ μεγίστων μερῶν γεγονότα μεγίστην κενότητα ἐν τῇ συστάσει παραλέλοιπεν, τὰ δὲ σμικρότατα ἐλαχίστην. ἢ δὴ τῆς πλήσεως σύνοδος τὰ σμικρὰ εἰς τὰ τῶν μεγάλων διάκενα συνωθεῖ. σμικρῶν οὖν παρὰ μεγάλα τιθεμένων καὶ τῶν ἐλαττόνων τὰ μείζονα διακρινόντων, τῶν δὲ μειζόνων ἐκεῖνα συγκρινόντων, πάντ' ἄνω κάτω μεταφέρεται πρὸς τοὺς ἑαυτῶν τόπους·

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T: As well as this, we need to realise also that numerous types of fire exist, flame for instance, and also that which is emitted by flame which does not burn and yet provides light to the eyes, and also that which remains in the glowing embers when the flame is extinguished. The same goes for air, the brightest is referred to as ether, the murkiest as mist and darkness, and there are other forms without names, generated through the inequality of the triangles. The forms of water are first divided in two, one form of it is liquid, the other liquefiable. Now, the liquid form, because it partakes of the kinds of water that are small and unequal, is readily moved, either just by itself or by

something else, due to the non-uniformity and the characteristic associated with its shape. However, the one composed of large and uniform kinds is more immobile than the liquid, and since it is rendered solid by its uniformity, it is heavy. Yet if it is penetrated and broken apart by fire, it loses its uniformity, and once this is undone it is more inclined towards motion, and once it becomes mobile it is extended out upon the earth under the pressure of the surrounding air. Each of these processes has acquired a name. 'Melting' is the disintegration of the bulk, and 'flowing' is the spreading upon the earth. But when the fire is expelled from there again, it does not emerge into a void; the surrounding air is pressurised, and it compresses the still mobile liquid mass into the positions that belonged to fire, thus mixing it together with itself. And once this is compressed it acquires its uniformity again, and since fire, the artificer of its non-uniformity, has withdrawn, it reverts to sameness with itself. Being quit of fire is termed 'cooling', while the contraction that follows its departure is termed 'being in a solid state'.

μεταβάλλον γὰρ τὸ μέγεθος ἕκαστον καὶ τὴν τόπων μεταβάλλει στάσιν. οὕτω δὴ διὰ ταῦτά τε ἡ τῆς ἀνωμαλότητος διασφζομένη γένεσις αἰεὶ τὴν αἰεὶ κίνησιν τούτων οὔσαν ἐσομένην τε ἐνδελεχῶς παρέχεται. μετὰ δὴ ταῦτα δεῖ νοεῖν ὅτι πυρὸς τε γένη πολλά γέγονεν, οἷον φλόξ τό τε ἀπὸ τῆς φλογὸς ἀπιόν, ὃ κάει μὲν οὔ, φῶς δὲ τοῖς ὅμμασιν παρέχει, τό τε φλογὸς ἀποσβεσθείσης ἐν τοῖς διαπύροις καταλειπόμενον αὐτοῦ· κατὰ ταῦτά δὲ αἶρος, τὸ μὲν εὐαγέστατον ἐπίκλην αἰθὴρ καλούμενος, ὃ δὲ θολερώτατος ὁμίχλη τε καὶ σκότος, ἕτερά τε ἀνώνυμα εἶδη, γεγονότα διὰ τὴν τῶν τριγώνων ἀνισότητα. τὰ δὲ ὕδατος διχῇ μὲν πρῶτον, τὸ μὲν ὑγρόν, τὸ δὲ χυτὸν γένος αὐτοῦ. τὸ μὲν οὖν ὑγρὸν διὰ τὸ μετέχον εἶναι τῶν γενῶν τῶν ὕδατος ὅσα σμικρά, ἀνίσων ὄντων, κινητικὸν αὐτὸ τε καθ' αὐτὸ καὶ ὑπ' ἄλλου διὰ τὴν ἀνωμαλότητα καὶ τὴν τοῦ σχήματος ἰδέαν γέγονεν· τὸ δὲ ἐκ μεγάλων καὶ ὁμαλῶν στασιμώτερον μὲν ἐκείνου καὶ βαρὺ πεπηγὸς ὑπὸ ὁμαλότητός ἐστιν, ὑπὸ δὲ πυρὸς εἰσιόντος καὶ διαλύοντος αὐτὸ τὴν ὁμαλότητα ἀποβάλλει, ταύτην δὲ ἀπολέσαν μετίσχει μᾶλλον κινήσεως, γενόμενον δὲ

εὐκίνητον, ὑπὸ τοῦ πλησίον ἀέρος ὠθούμενον καὶ κατατεινόμενον ἐπὶ γῆν, τήκεσθαι μὲν τὴν τῶν ὄγκων καθαίρεσιν, ῥοὴν δὲ τὴν κατάτασιν ἐπὶ γῆν ἐπωνυμίαν ἐκατέρου τοῦ πάθους ἔλαβεν. ΤΙ. πάλιν δ' ἐκπίπτοντος αὐτόθεν τοῦ πυρός, ἅτε οὐκ εἰς κενὸν ἐξιόντος, ὠθούμενος ὁ πλησίον ἀὴρ εὐκίνητον ὄντα ἔτι τὸν ὕγρον ὄγκον εἰς τὰς τοῦ πυρὸς ἔδρας συνωθῶν αὐτὸν αὐτῷ συμμείγνυσιν· ὁ δὲ συνωθούμενος ἀπολαμβάνων τε τὴν ὁμαλότητα πάλιν, ἅτε τοῦ τῆς ἀνωμαλότητος δημιουργοῦ πυρὸς ἀπιόντος, εἰς ταῦτόν αὐτῷ καθίσταται. καὶ τὴν μὲν τοῦ πυρὸς ἀπαλλαγὴν ψῦξιν, τὴν δὲ σύνοδον ἀπελθόντος ἐκείνου πεπηγὸς εἶναι γένος προσερρήθη. τούτων δὴ πάντων

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T: Now, of all these liquefiable kinds of water, as we have called them, the most dense arises from the finest and most uniform components. It is of one form only, glistening and yellow in colour, a most revered possession – gold, filtered through rock and solidified, while the offspring of gold, which is very hard and black due to its density, is called adamant. The kind whose parts bear the closest resemblance to gold has more forms than one. In density, it is in a way more dense than gold and it contains a small, fine portion of earth, and so it is harder, yet in another way it is lighter since it contains larger interstices within itself. This compound is copper, one form of the bright and solid types of water. But as the two components of the mixture age, they separate from one another again, and the earth that is in the mixture appears on the surface and is called rust.

ὅσα χυτὰ προσείπομεν ὕδατα, τὸ μὲν ἐκ λεπτοτάτων καὶ ὁμαλωτάτων πυκνότατον γιγνόμενον, μονοειδὲς γένος, στίλβοντι καὶ ξανθῷ χρώματι κοινωθέν, τιμαλφέστατον κτῆμα χρυσοῦς ἡθημένος διὰ πέτρας ἐπάγῃ χρυσοῦ δὲ ὄζος, διὰ πυκνότητα σκληρότατον ὃν καὶ μελανθέν, ἀδάμας ἐκλήθη. τὸ δ' ἐγγὺς μὲν χρυσοῦ τῶν μερῶν, εἶδη δὲ πλείονα ἐνὸς ἔχον, πυκνότητι δέ, τῇ μὲν χρυσοῦ πυκνότερον ὄν, καὶ γῆς μόριον ὀλίγον καὶ λεπτὸν μετασχόν, ὥστε σκληρότερον εἶναι, τῷ

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T: It should no longer be a complex matter to work out the features of the other substances of this kind whilst adhering to the structure of likely stories. In this regard, whenever someone, for the sake of relaxation, laying aside discussions concerning things that always are, gives consideration to likely accounts concerned with becoming, and derives a pleasure he will not later regret, he would be introducing a measured and sensible pastime into his life. So, having indulged in this just now, dealing with the same issues, we shall proceed with the likely accounts that follow this in due order in the following way. Water that is mixed with fire and is fine and liquid is called liquid due to its motion and the course it takes as it rolls along the ground. Now, it is also soft because its bases are yielding, being less stable than those of earth, and whenever it separates off from fire and air, and is on its own, it becomes more uniform and is compressed into itself by the emerging substances, and it is solidified in this way. When this happens to it well above the earth it is hail, when on the earth it is ice, and when it happens to a lesser extent and it is still half-solidified, it is snow when above the earth, and when it is compacted from dew upon the earth it is called frost.

δὲ μεγάλα ἐντὸς αὐτοῦ διαλείμματα ἔχειν κουφότερον, τῶν λαμπρῶν πηκτῶν τε ἐν γένος ὑδάτων χαλκὸς συσταθεὶς γέγονεν· τὸ δ' ἐκ γῆς αὐτῷ μειχθέν, ὅταν παλαιουμένῳ διαχωρίζησθον πάλιν ἀπ' ἀλλήλων, ἐκφανὲς καθ' αὐτὸ γιγνόμενον ἰὸς λέγεται. τᾶλλα δὲ τῶν τοιούτων οὐδὲν ποικίλον ἔτι διαλογίσασθαι τὴν τῶν εἰκότων μύθων μεταδιώκοντα ἰδέαν· ἦν ὅταν τις ἀναπαύσεως ἔνεκα τοὺς περὶ τῶν ὄντων ἀεὶ καταθέμενος λόγους, τοὺς γενέσεως περὶ διαθεώμενος εἰκότας ἀμεταμέλητον ἡδονὴν κτᾶται, μέτριον ἂν ἐν τῷ βίῳ παιδιὰν καὶ φρόνιμον ποιοῖτο. ταύτῃ δὴ καὶ τὰ νῦν ἐφέντες τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο τῶν αὐτῶν περὶ τὰ ἐξῆς εἰκότα δίμεν τῇδε. τὸ πυρὶ μεμειγμένον ὕδωρ, ὅσον λεπτὸν ὑγρὸν τε διὰ τὴν κίνησιν καὶ τὴν ὁδὸν ἦν κυλινδούμενον ἐπὶ γῆς ὑγρὸν λέγεται, μαλακὸν τε αὖ τῷ τὰς βάσεις ἦττον ἐδραίους οὔσας ἢ τὰς γῆς ὑπεΐκειν, τοῦτο ὅταν πυρὸς ἀποχωρισθὲν ἄερος τε μονωθῇ,

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T: Now, most types of water are mixed with one another, and because this category in general is filtered through the plants of the earth, they are called juices. Although each involves dissimilarity on account of the intermixtures, and while the differences give rise to numerous kinds that are nameless, four types containing fire are particularly evident and these have received names: wine, that can heat the soul as well as the body; an oily sort that is smooth and splits the beam of sight and so appears glittering and bright to behold – resin, castor oil, oil itself and any others with the same capacity. There is one that can relax the passageways of the mouth back to their natural condition, and by this capacity furnishes sweetness; it is generally referred to as honey. The last kind corrodes the flesh by burning; it is a foamy sort secreted from all other juices and it is called sour-juice.

γέγονεν μὲν ὁμαλώτερον, συνέωσται δὲ ὑπὸ τῶν ἐξιόντων εἰς αὐτό, παγέν τε οὕτως τὸ μὲν ὑπὲρ γῆς μάλιστα παθὼν ταῦτα χάλαζα, τὸ δ' ἐπὶ γῆς κρύσταλλος, τὸ δὲ ἦττον, ἡμιπαγές τε ὃν ἔτι, τὸ μὲν ὑπὲρ γῆς αὖ χιών, τὸ δ' ἐπὶ γῆς συμπαγὲν ἐκ δρόσου γενόμενον πάχνη λέγεται. ΤΙ. τὰ δὲ δὴ πλεῖστα ὕδατων εἶδη μεμειγμένα ἀλλήλοις—σύμπαν μὲν τὸ γένος, διὰ τῶν ἐκ γῆς φυτῶν ἡθημένα, χυμοὶ λεγόμενοι—διὰ δὲ τὰς μείξεις ἀνομοιότητα ἕκαστοι σχόντες τὰ μὲν ἄλλα πολλὰ ἀνώνυμα γένη παρέσχοντο, τέτταρα δὲ ὅσα ἔμπυρα εἶδη, διαφανῇ μάλιστα γενόμενα, εἴληφεν ὀνόματα αὐτῶν, τὸ μὲν τῆς ψυχῆς μετὰ τοῦ σώματος θερμαντικὸν οἶνος, τὸ δὲ λεῖον καὶ διακριτικὸν ὄψεως διὰ ταῦτά τε ἰδεῖν λαμπρὸν καὶ στίλβον λιπαρὸν τε φανταζόμενον ἐλαιηρὸν εἶδος, πίττα καὶ κίκι καὶ ἔλαιον αὐτὸ ὅσα τ' ἄλλα τῆς αὐτῆς δυνάμεως ὅσον δὲ διαχυτικὸν

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T: As for the forms of earth, that which is filtered through water becomes a strong material in the following manner. Whenever the water that is mixed in with it is broken up in the commingling process, it transforms into the figure of air, and once it has become air it rises up to its own region, but there isn't a void above them, so the

air in the vicinity is pressurised. And since it is heavy, it presses down and pours around the mass of earth, squeezes it intensely and compresses it into the positions from which the newly formed air had arisen. And earth, when compressed by air, constitutes stone that is indissoluble in water. The superior kind composed of equal and uniform parts is transparent, while the opposite applies to the inferior kind. The one from which all the moisture has been forced out by the rapid action of fire, and is a more brittle compound than the other, is the kind to which we have given the name 'potters' clay'. And on occasion, when some moisture is left behind and the earth has been melted by fire and then cooled down, the black-coloured substance constitutes [lava] stone. Similarly, there are two more that are extracted from the mixture containing a great deal of water. They are composed of finer particles of earth and are salty, and being semi-solid they are soluble once more in water. One is soda, which can cleanse us of oil and earth, while the other is salt, which blends well in the interactions associated with sense perception of the mouth, and, according to tradition, is beloved of the gods. The compounds of both earth and water that can be dissolved by fire but not by water are compacted in that way for the following reason. A mass of earth is not broken up by fire or air, since their particles are naturally smaller than the structure of its interstices. So they pass through the considerable open spaces without exertion, leaving the earth undissolved and rendering it indissoluble. However, since the particles of water are naturally larger, they make their way through by force, loosening the earth and breaking it apart. So earth that is not forcibly solidified in this way is dissolved only by water, yet when it has been so solidified, it is dissolved by nothing but fire, for no way is left for anything to enter it except fire.

μέχρι φύσεως τῶν περὶ τὸ στόμα συνόδων, ταύτῃ τῇ δυνάμει γλυκύτητα παρεχόμενον, μέλι τὸ κατὰ πάντων μάλιστα πρόσρημα ἔσχεν, τὸ δὲ τῆς σαρκὸς διαλυτικὸν τῷ κάειν, ἀφρῶδες γένος, ἐκ πάντων ἀφορισθὲν τῶν χυμῶν, ὅπως ἐπωνομάσθη. γῆς δὲ εἶδη, τὸ μὲν

ἡθημένον διὰ ὕδατος τοιῶδε τρόπῳ γίνεται σῶμα λίθινον. τὸ συμμιγὲς ὕδωρ ὅταν ἐν τῇ συμμείξει κοπῇ, μετέβαλεν εἰς ἀέρος ἰδέαν· γενόμενος δὲ ἀήρ εἰς τὸν ἑαυτοῦ τόπον ἀναθεῖ. κενὸν δ' ὑπερεῖχεν αὐτῶν οὐδέν· τὸν οὖν πλησίον ἔωσεν ἀέρα. ὁ δὲ ἅτε ὦν βαρὺς, ὥσθεις καὶ περιχυθεὶς τῷ τῆς γῆς ὄγκῳ, σφόδρα ἔθλιψεν συνέωσέν τε αὐτὸν εἰς τὰς ἔδρας ὅθεν ἀνήει ὁ νέος ἀήρ· συνωσθεῖσα δὲ ὑπὸ ἀέρος ἀλύτως ὕδατι γῇ συνίσταται πέτρα, καλλίων μὲν ἢ τῶν ἴσων καὶ ὁμαλῶν διαφανῆς μερῶν, αἰσχίων δὲ ἢ ἐναντία. τὸ δὲ ὑπὸ πυρὸς τάχους τὸ νοτερόν πᾶν ἐξαπασθὲν καὶ κραυρότερον ἐκείνου συστάν, ὧ γένει κέραμον ἐπωνομάκαμεν, τοῦτο γέγονεν· ἔστιν δὲ ὅτε νοτίδος ὑπολειφθείσης χυτὴ γῇ γενομένη διὰ πυρὸς ὅταν ψυχθῇ, γίνεται τὸ μέλαν χρῶμα ἔχον λίθος. τῷ δ' αὖ κατὰ ταῦτα μὲν ταῦτα ἐκ συμμείξεως ὕδατος ἀπομονομένῳ πολλοῦ, λεπτοτέρων δὲ ἐκ γῆς μερῶν ἀλμυρῷ τε ὄντε, ἡμιπαγῇ γενομένῳ καὶ λυτῷ πάλιν ὑφ' ὕδατος, τὸ μὲν ἐλαίου καὶ γῆς καθαρτικὸν γένος λίτρον, τὸ δ' εὐάρμοστον ἐν ταῖς κοινωνίαις

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T: Water, for its part, when compressed with extreme force, is dispersed by fire alone, but if the force of compression is weaker, it is dispersed by both fire and air. Air acts upon the interstices, fire upon the elemental triangles. And when air is forcibly solidified, nothing dissolves it except by acting upon its elemental triangles, and when the solidification is not forceful, only fire can break it apart.

ταῖς περὶ τὴν τοῦ στόματος αἴσθησιν ἁλῶν κατὰ λόγον νόμου θεοφιλὲς σῶμα ἐγένετο. τὰ δὲ κοινὰ ἐξ ἀμφοῖν ὕδατι μὲν οὐ λυτά, πυρὶ δέ, διὰ τὸ τοιόνδε οὕτω συμπήγνυται. γῆς ὄγκους πῦρ μὲν ἀήρ τε οὐ τήκει· τῆς γὰρ συστάσεως τῶν διακένων αὐτῆς σμικρομερέστερα πεφυκότα, διὰ πολλῆς εὐρυχωρίας ἰόντα, οὐ βιαζόμενα, ἄλυτον αὐτὴν ἔασαντα ἄτηκτον παρέσχεν· τὰ δὲ ὕδατος ἐπειδὴ μείζω πέφυκεν μέρη, βίαιον ποιούμενα τὴν διέξοδον, λύοντα αὐτὴν τήκει. TI. γῆν

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T: In the case of the mixed bodies composed of earth and water, as long as water occupies its interstices and these are forcibly pressed together, the particles of water arriving from outside, having no way of

entering, flow around it leaving the entire mass intact. Yet the particles of fire entering the interstices of the water and acting upon it – fire acting on water as water acted upon earth – constitute the sole causes whereby the compound body is broken apart and flows. Some of these, the entire category associated with glass and any stones that we call liquefiable, happen to have less water than earth. Others – all materials that are wax-like or useful as incense – have, for their part, more water.

μὲν γὰρ ἀσύστατον ὑπὸ βίας οὕτως ὕδωρ μόνον λύει, συνεστηκυῖαν δὲ πλὴν πυρὸς οὐδέν· εἴσοδος γὰρ οὐδενὶ πλὴν πυρὶ λέλειπται. τὴν δὲ ὕδατος αὖ σύνοδον τὴν μὲν βιαιοτάτην πῦρ μόνον, τὴν δὲ ἀσθενεστέραν ἀμφοτέρα, πῦρ τε καὶ ἀήρ, διαχεῖτον, ὁ μὲν κατὰ τὰ διάκενα, τὸ δὲ καὶ κατὰ τὰ τρίγωνα· βία δὲ ἀέρα συστάντα οὐδὲν λύει πλὴν κατὰ τὸ στοιχεῖον, ἀβίαστον δὲ κατατῆκει μόνον πῦρ. τὰ δὲ τῶν συμμείκτων ἐκ γῆς τε καὶ ὕδατος σωμάτων, μέχριπερ ἂν ὕδωρ αὐτοῦ τὰ τῆς γῆς διάκενα καὶ βία συμπεπιλημένα κατέχη, τὰ μὲν ὕδατος ἐπiónτα ἔξωθεν εἴσοδον οὐκ ἔχοντα μέρη περιρρέοντα τὸν ὅλον ὄγκον ἀτηκτον εἶασεν, τὰ δὲ πυρὸς εἰς τὰ τῶν ὑδάτων διάκενα εἰσιόντα, ὅπερ ὕδωρ γῆν, τοῦτο πῦρ ἀέρα ἀπεργαζόμενα, τηχθέντι τῷ κοινῷ σώματι ῥεῖν μόνα αἴτια συμβέβηκεν· τυγχάνει δὲ ταῦτα ὄντα, τὰ μὲν ἔλαττον ἔχοντα ὕδατος ἢ γῆς, τό τε περὶ τὴν ὕαλον γένος

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T: Although the variegated forms originating from the commonalities in the shapes and their transformations into one another have been presented quite well at this stage, we should nevertheless attempt to indicate the causes by which the characteristics they possess have arisen. Firstly, the characteristics we are discussing throughout must be perceptible, even though the origin of flesh and its accompaniments, and of the mortal part of soul, have not yet been described. In fact, it is not possible for these to be adequately discussed without reference to those characteristics that are amenable to sense perception, or to discuss the characteristics without reference to the senses, while it is nigh impossible to treat of both at the same time. So,

we should first make assumptions about one or the other of them, and then return to those assumptions hereafter. So, let us initially make an assumption about whatever is relevant to body and soul, so that, having described the various kinds we may next speak of their qualities.

ἅπαν ὅσα τε λίθων χυτὰ εἶδη καλεῖται, τὰ δὲ πλέον ὕδατος αὖ, πάντα ὅσα κηροειδῇ καὶ θυμιατικὰ σώματα συμπήγνυται. καὶ τὰ μὲν δὴ σχήμασι κοινωνίαις τε καὶ μεταλλαγαῖς εἰς ἄλληλα πεποικιλμένα εἶδη σχεδὸν ἐπιδέδεικται· τὰ δὲ παθήματα αὐτῶν δι' ἃς αἰτίας γέγονεν πειρατέον ἐμφανίζειν. πρῶτον μὲν οὖν ὑπάρχειν αἴσθησιν δεῖ τοῖς λεγομένοις αἰεὶ, σαρκὸς δὲ καὶ τῶν περὶ σάρκα γένεσιν, ψυχῆς τε ὅσον θνητόν, οὕτω διεληλύθαμεν· τυγχάνει δὲ οὔτε ταῦτα χωρὶς τῶν περὶ τὰ παθήματα ὅσα αἰσθητικά οὔτ' ἐκεῖνα ἄνευ τούτων δυνατὰ ἱκανῶς λεχθῆναι, τὸ δὲ ἅμα σχεδὸν οὐ δυνατόν. ὑποθετέον δὴ πρότερον θάτερα, τὰ δ' ὑποτεθέντα ἐπάνιμεν αὐθις. ἵνα οὖν ἐξῆς τὰ παθήματα λέγεται τοῖς γένεσιν, ἔστω πρότερα ἡμῖν τὰ περὶ σῶμα καὶ ψυχὴν ὄντα. πρῶτον μὲν οὖν ἥ πῦρ θερμὸν λέγομεν, ἴδωμεν ὧδε σκοποῦντες, τὴν διάκρισιν καὶ τομὴν αὐτοῦ περὶ τὸ σῶμα ἡμῶν γιγνομένην

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T: Now, let's first look at why we refer to fire as hot by considering the splitting and cutting we notice it bringing about in our bodies. Indeed, we all perceive that the effect is a piercing one, yet we must deduce the fineness of the edges, the sharpness of the angles, the smallness of the particles and the rapidity of its motion, all of which render it intense and incisive, always cutting acutely into whatever it encounters. We deduce this by remembering the origin of its shape, whereby this substance and no other, by splitting our bodies and cutting them up minutely, is likely to provide the characteristic we now call heat and its name too.²⁶ Although what is opposite to these is obvious, it deserves to be described anyway. Now, when the liquids consisting of larger particles surrounding the body make their way in, they force the smaller particles out, but are unable to settle into the positions thus vacated. They compress the moisture within us, rendering it

immobile and solid due to the uniformity and the pressure, whereas it had previously been non-uniform and mobile. But anything that is unnaturally contracted naturally resists the process by pushing back in the opposite direction. This resistance and shaking is called shuddering or shivering, while the entire effect as a whole, and that which brings it about, has the name 'cold'. 'Hard' designates anything to which our flesh yields, while 'soft' designates anything which yields to the flesh, and they are also designated in this way with respect to one another. Whatever rests upon a small base tends to yield, and whatever is constituted of square bases is the most rigid form, since it is established firmly, and anything compressed to an extreme density would also be especially resistant.

ἐννοηθέντες. ὅτι μὲν γὰρ ὁξύ τι τὸ πάθος, πάντες σχεδὸν αἰσθανόμεθα· ΤΙ. τὴν δὲ λεπτότητα τῶν πλευρῶν καὶ γωνιῶν ὁξύτητα τῶν τε μορίων σμικρότητα καὶ τῆς φορᾶς τὸ τάχος, οἷς πᾶσι σφοδρὸν ὄν καὶ τομὸν ὁξέως τὸ προστυχὸν αἰεὶ τέμνει, λογιστέον ἀναμνησκομένοις τὴν τοῦ σχήματος αὐτοῦ γένεσιν, ὅτι μάλιστα ἐκείνη καὶ οὐκ ἄλλη φύσις διακρίνουσα ἡμῶν κατὰ σμικρά τε τὰ σώματα κερματίζουσα τοῦτο ὃ νῦν θερμὸν λέγομεν εἰκότως τὸ πάθημα καὶ τοῦνομα παρέσχεν. τὸ δ' ἐναντίον τούτων κατάδηλον μὲν, ὅμως δὲ μηδὲν ἐπιδεῖς ἔστω λόγου. τὰ γὰρ δὴ τῶν περὶ τὸ σῶμα ὑγρῶν μεγαλομερέστερα εἰσιόντα, τὰ σμικρότερα ἐξωθοῦντα, εἰς τὰς ἐκείνων οὐ δυνάμενα ἔδρας ἐνδῦναι, συνωθοῦντα ἡμῶν τὸ νοτερόν, ἐξ ἀνωμάλου κεκινημένου τε ἀκίνητον δι' ὁμαλότητα καὶ τὴν σύνωσιν ἀπεργαζόμενα πῆγνυσιν· τὸ δὲ παρὰ φύσιν συναγόμενον μάχεται κατὰ φύσιν αὐτὸ ἑαυτὸ εἰς τοῦναντίον ἀπωθοῦν. τῇ δὴ μάχῃ καὶ τῷ σεισμῷ τούτῳ τρόμος καὶ ῥίγος ἐτέθη, ψυχρόν τε τὸ πάθος ἅπαν τοῦτο καὶ τὸ δρῶν αὐτὸ ἔσχεν ὄνομα. σκληρόν δέ, ὅσοις ἂν ἡμῶν ἡ σὰρξ ὑπέικη, μαλακὸν δέ, ὅσα ἂν τῇ σαρκί· πρὸς ἀλλήλα τε οὕτως. ὑπέικει δὲ ὅσον ἐπὶ σμικροῦ βαίνει· τὸ δὲ ἐκ

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T: The nature of heavy and light may be presented most clearly by considering them along with the expressions 'up' and 'down'. Indeed, it is not at all correct to regard the Universe as naturally divided into

two distinct opposite regions; 'down' being the one towards which anything with any bodily bulk is borne; 'up' being the direction in which everything moves against its will. For since the entire Heaven has a spherical form, any extremities are situated at an equal distance from the centre, and these by nature must be extremities in the same way, while the centre, being situated at an equal distance from all the extremities, must be regarded as being in the opposite position to all of them. Now, since the world is naturally like this, which of the locations we have described may be designated as 'up' or 'down' without being regarded, quite rightly, as using a name that is not appropriate? For the central location within it is not rightly described as either 'up' or 'down'. No, it is just in the centre, while the periphery is obviously not the centre, nor does any part thereof differ in its relationship to the centre, nor to any of the points on the opposite side. But what sort of opposing names may be applied to something that is similar in every respect, and in what way might it be properly described? Indeed, even if a solid body were equipoised at the centre of the Universe, it would never be borne towards any particular extremity since they are all similar in every respect. No, even if someone were to proceed around it in a circle, repeatedly standing with his feet in opposite situations, he would refer to the same point on it as both 'up' and 'down'. Indeed, as we said just now, the whole is spherical in form, so it is not sensible to describe one location as 'up' and another as 'down'. As for the origin of these names and the actual circumstances to which they apply, by reason of which we are accustomed to refer to the entire Universe by dividing it in this way, these issues we must agree upon by making the following supposition. Suppose someone in the region of the Universe that is assigned predominantly to fire, where most of it gathers and towards which it is borne, were to stand up there and had the ability to take portions of fire, place them on a scale and weigh them, raising the beam and dragging the fire forcibly into the dissimilar region of air, a lesser quantity of fire obviously would be forced more easily than a greater.

For if two things are raised aloft by a single effort, the lesser must presumably go along with the force to a greater extent, and the greater to a lesser extent as it resists the process. So, the large volume is said to be heavy and to be borne downwards, while the small one is said to be light and borne upwards.

τετραγώνων ὃν βάσεων, ἅτε βεβηκὸς σφόδρα, ἀντιτυπώτατον εἶδος, ὅτι τε ἂν εἰς πυκνότητα συνιὼν πλείστην ἀντίτονον ἢ μάλιστα. βαρὺ δὲ καὶ κοῦφον μετὰ τῆς τοῦ κάτω φύσεως ἄνω τε λεγομένης ἐξεταζόμενον ἂν δηλωθεῖ σαφέστατα. φύσει γὰρ δὴ τινὰς τόπους δύο εἶναι διειληφότας διχῇ τὸ πᾶν ἐναντίους, τὸν μὲν κάτω, πρὸς ὃν φέρεται πάνθ' ὅσα τινὰ ὄγκον σώματος ἔχει, τὸν δὲ ἄνω, πρὸς ὃν ἀκουσίως ἔρχεται πᾶν, οὐκ ὀρθὸν οὐδαμῇ νομίζειν· τοῦ γὰρ παντὸς οὐρανοῦ σφαιροειδοῦς ὄντος, ὅσα μὲν ἀφεστῶτα ἴσον τοῦ μέσου γέγονεν ἔσχατα, ὁμοίως αὐτὰ χρὴ ἔσχατα πεφυκέναι, τὸ δὲ μέσον τὰ αὐτὰ μέτρα τῶν ἐσχάτων ἀφεστηκὸς ἐν τῷ καταντικρὺ νομίζειν δεῖ πάντων εἶναι. τοῦ δὲ κόσμου ταύτῃ πεφυκότης, τί τῶν εἰρημένων ἄνω τις ἢ κάτω τιθέμενος οὐκ ἐν δίκῃ δόξει τὸ μηδὲν προσῆκον ὄνομα λέγειν; ὁ μὲν γὰρ μέσος ἐν αὐτῷ τόπος οὔτε κάτω πεφυκῶς οὔτε ἄνω λέγεσθαι δίκαιος, ἀλλ' αὐτὸ ἐν μέσῳ· ὁ δὲ περίξ οὔτε δὴ μέσος οὔτ' ἔχων διάφορον αὐτοῦ μέρος ἕτερον θατέρου μᾶλλον πρὸς τὸ μέσον ἢ τι τῶν καταντικρῦ. τοῦ δὲ ὁμοίως πάντῃ πεφυκότης ποῖα τις ἐπιφέρων ὀνόματα αὐτῷ ἐναντία καὶ πῇ καλῶς ἂν ἡγοῖτο λέγειν; TI. εἰ γάρ τι καὶ στερεὸν εἴη κατὰ μέσον τοῦ παντὸς ἰσοπαλές, εἰς οὐδὲν ἂν ποτε τῶν ἐσχάτων ἐνεχθεῖ διὰ τὴν πάντῃ ὁμοιότητα αὐτῶν· ἀλλ' εἰ καὶ περὶ αὐτὸ πορεύοιτο τις ἐν κύκλῳ, πολλάκις ἂν στὰς ἀντίπους ταύτῃ αὐτοῦ κάτω καὶ ἄνω προσείποι. τὸ μὲν γὰρ ὅλον, καθάπερ εἴρηται νυνδὴ, σφαιροειδὲς ὃν, τόπον τινὰ κάτω, τὸν δὲ ἄνω λέγειν ἔχειν οὐκ ἔμφρονος· ὅθεν δὲ ὠνομάσθη ταῦτα καὶ ἐν οἷς ὄντα εἰθίσμεθα δι' ἐκεῖνα καὶ τὸν οὐρανὸν ὅλον οὕτω διαιρούμενοι

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T: Well, we need to discover ourselves doing the very same thing in our own region. Indeed, when we stand upon the earth, weighing earthy substances and sometimes earth itself, we are dragging them

forcibly and contrary to nature into the dissimilar region of air. In both cases they cling to their own kindred, but the smaller bulk co-operates with the compulsion more easily and is first to follow it into the dissimilar region. Accordingly, we refer to it as 'light', and the region into which we compel it as 'up', and the characteristics opposite to these as 'heavy' and 'down'. Consequently, these must behave differently relative to one another because the vast bulk of the four types occupy regions opposite to one another. Indeed, on comparing what is light in one region with light in the opposite region, heavy with heavy, down with down, and up with up, all sorts of direct or indirect oppositions and differences relative to one another will be discovered, some present, some coming into being. However, there is one factor to be kept in mind in all of these cases. The course towards what is kindred to each renders whatever transverse it, heavy, and the region into which something like this is borne, down. The other terms are applied to those that take the other course. So, let's declare that these are the explanations of those characteristics. As for roughness and smoothness, I presume that anyone would be able to discern their causes and relate them to someone else, for one is produced by hardness combined with non-uniformity, and the other by uniformity combined with density.

λέγειν, ταῦτα διομολογητέον ὑποθεμένοις τάδε ἡμῖν. εἴ τις ἐν τῷ τοῦ παντός τόπῳ καθ' ὃν ἡ τοῦ πυρὸς εἴληχε μάλιστα φύσις, οὗ καὶ πλεῖστον ἂν ἡθροισμένον εἴη πρὸς ὃ φέρεται, ἐπεμβὰς ἐπ' ἐκεῖνο καὶ δύναμιν εἰς τοῦτο ἔχων, μέρη τοῦ πυρὸς ἀφαιρῶν ἰσταίη τιθεὶς εἰς πλάστιγγας, αἴρων τὸν ζυγὸν καὶ τὸ πῦρ ἔλκων εἰς ἀνόμοιον ἀέρα βιαζόμενος δῆλον ὡς τοῦλαττόν που τοῦ μείζονος ῥᾶον βιάται· ῥώμη γὰρ μιᾷ δυοῖν ἅμα μετεωριζόμενοι τὸ μὲν ἔλαττον μᾶλλον, τὸ δὲ πλεόν ἦττον ἀνάγκη που κατατεινόμενον συνέπεσθαι τῇ βίᾳ, καὶ τὸ μὲν πολὺ βαρὺ καὶ κάτω φερόμενον κληθῆναι, τὸ δὲ σμικρὸν ἐλαφρὸν καὶ ἄνω. ταῦτόν δὲ τοῦτο δεῖ φωρᾶσαι δρῶντας ἡμᾶς περὶ τόνδε τὸν τόπον. ἐπὶ γὰρ γῆς βεβῶτες γεώδη γένη διιστάμενοι, καὶ γῆν ἐνίστε αὐτήν, ἔλκομεν εἰς ἀνόμοιον ἀέρα βία καὶ παρὰ φύσιν, ἀμφοτέρω τοῦ

συγγενοῦς ἀντεχόμενα, τὸ δὲ σμικρότερον ῥᾶον τοῦ μείζονος βιαζομένοις εἰς τὸ ἀνόμοιον πρότερον συνέπεται· κοῦφον οὖν αὐτὸ προσειρήκαμεν, καὶ τὸν τόπον εἰς ὃν βιαζόμεθα, ἄνω, τὸ δ' ἐναντίον τούτοις πάθος βαρὺ καὶ κάτω. ταῦτ' οὖν δὴ διαφόρως ἔχειν αὐτὰ πρὸς αὐτὰ ἀνάγκη διὰ τὸ τὰ πλήθη τῶν γενῶν τόπον ἐναντίον ἄλλα ἄλλοις κατέχειν—τὸ γὰρ ἐν ἐτέρῳ κοῦφον ὃν τόπῳ τῷ κατὰ τὸν ἐναντίον τόπον ἐλαφρῷ καὶ τῷ βαρεῖ τὸ βαρὺ τῷ τε κάτω τὸ κάτω καὶ τὸ ἄνω τῷ ἄνω πάντ' ἐναντία καὶ πλάγια καὶ πάντως διάφορα πρὸς ἄλληλα ἀνευρεθήσεται γιγνόμενα καὶ ὄντα—τόδε γε μὴν ἔν τι διανοητέον περὶ πάντων αὐτῶν, ὡς ἡ μὲν πρὸς τὸ συγγενὲς ὁδὸς ἐκάστοις οὔσα βαρὺ μὲν τὸ φερόμενον ποιεῖ, τὸν δὲ τόπον εἰς ὃν τὸ τοιοῦτον φέρεται, κάτω, τὰ δὲ τούτοις ἔχοντα ὡς ἐτέρως θάτερα. περὶ δὴ τούτων αὖ τῶν παθημάτων ταῦτα αἵτια εἰρήσθω. ΤΙ. λείου δ' αὖ καὶ τραχέος παθήματος αἰτίαν πᾶς που κατιδὼν καὶ ἐτέρῳ δυνατὸς ἂν εἴη λέγειν· σκληρότης γὰρ ἄνωμαλότητι μειχθεῖσα, τὸ δ'

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T: The most significant remaining issue concerning the experiences shared by the entire body is the cause of the pleasures and the pains in those processes we have already described, and in any cases where sense perceptions acquired through our body parts are also accompanied by pains and pleasures in the parts themselves. Now, we should come to an understanding of the causes of any effect, perceptible or imperceptible, by recollecting the distinction we made earlier between the mobile and the immobile nature. Yes, anything we intend to discover must be pursued in this way. Whenever an impression, even a slight one, is made upon anything that is mobile by nature, it is transmitted around, one part bringing about the same effect upon the next until it reaches the thinking and proclaims the characteristics of whatever made that impression. While in the opposite case, where the object is unmoving, there is no outward motion, and the object alone is affected without moving anything else in its vicinity, so that the initial impression is not transmitted from one part to another, does not move into the living creature in its

entirety, and renders the impression imperceptible. These considerations apply to bone and hair and any other predominantly earthy parts of our bodies, while the previous considerations apply mainly to parts concerned with sight and hearing because of the significant function of fire and air within them.

όμαλότης πυκνότητι παρέχεται. μέγιστον δὲ καὶ λοιπὸν τῶν κοινῶν περὶ ὅλον τὸ σῶμα παθημάτων τὸ τῶν ἡδέων καὶ τῶν ἀλγεινῶν αἴτιον ἐν οἷς διεληλύθαμεν, καὶ ὅσα διὰ τῶν τοῦ σώματος μορίων αἰσθήσεις κεκτημένα καὶ λύπας ἐν αὐτοῖς ἡδονάς θ' ἅμα ἐπομένας ἔχει. ὧδ' οὖν κατὰ παντὸς αἰσθητοῦ καὶ ἀναισθήτου παθήματος τὰς αἰτίας λαμβάνωμεν, ἀναμιμνησκόμενοι τὸ τῆς εὐκινήτου τε καὶ δυσκινήτου φύσεως ὅτι διειλόμεθα ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν· ταύτη γὰρ δὴ μεταδιωκτέον πάντα ὅσα ἐπινοοῦμεν ἐλεῖν. τὸ μὲν γὰρ κατὰ φύσιν εὐκίνητον, ὅταν καὶ βραχὺ πάθος εἰς αὐτὸ ἐμπίπτη, διαδίδωσιν κύκλῳ μόρια ἕτερα ἑτέροις ταῦτὸν ἀπεργαζόμενα, μέχριπερ ἂν ἐπὶ τὸ φρόνιμον ἐλθόντα ἐξαγγεῖλη τοῦ ποιήσαντος τὴν δύναμιν· τὸ δ' ἐναντίον ἐδραῖον ὃν κατ' οὐδένα τε κύκλον ἰὸν πάσχει μόνον,

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T: Now, we should think about pleasure and pain as follows. When a sudden, forceful impression contrary to our nature is made upon us, it is painful, while the sudden return once more to the natural condition is pleasant. Any impression that is gentle and gradual is imperceptible, but the opposite goes for the opposite impressions. Anything that happens easily is undoubtedly perceptible, and yet it does not involve pain or pleasure – experiences associated with the beam of sight itself, for instance, which, as we said previously, constitutes a body that coalesces with our own in the daytime. For cuts and burns, and whatever else the beam of light undergoes, do not produce pain or pleasure either when it returns once more to the same configuration. Yet there are significant and detailed sense impressions corresponding to whatever affects it, and to anything that it impinges upon or comes into contact with, for there is no force whatsoever involved in its dispersal or reconstitution. However, bodies composed of larger

particles yield with difficulty to whatever acts upon them, transmit the effects throughout their entirety, and involve pleasures and pains; pains when they are being altered from their normal state, pleasures when they are being established once more in their original condition. In cases where they undergo gradual depletion and emptying but the refilling is sudden and extensive, the emptying process is imperceptible and the filling process is perceptible, and this induces no pains in the mortal part of the soul, only enormous pleasures. An obvious example is our experience of pleasant odours. But cases in which they are suddenly altered from their usual condition, and re-established only gradually and with difficulty in their own original state, bring about outcomes completely opposite to the previous cases. This is evident in circumstances in which the body is cut or burned.

ἄλλο δὲ οὐ κινεῖ τῶν πλησίον, ὥστε οὐ διαδιδόντων μορίων μορίοις ἄλλων ἄλλοις τὸ πρῶτον πάθος ἐν αὐτοῖς ἀκίνητον εἰς τὸ πᾶν ζῶον γενόμενον ἀναίσθητον παρέσχεν τὸ παθόν. ταῦτα δὲ περί τε ὅστ᾽ αἰσθάνονται τὰς τρίχας ἐστὶν καὶ ὅσ' ἄλλα γήϊνα τὸ πλεῖστον ἔχομεν ἐν ἡμῖν μόρια· τὰ δὲ ἔμπροσθεν περὶ τὰ τῆς ὀψέως καὶ ἀκοῆς μάλιστα, διὰ τὸ πυρὸς αἶρος τε ἐν αὐτοῖς δύναμιν ἐνεῖναι μεγίστην. τὸ δὲ τῆς ἡδονῆς καὶ λύπης ὧδε δεῖ διανοεῖσθαι· τὸ μὲν παρὰ φύσιν καὶ βίαιον γιγνόμενον ἀθρόον παρ' ἡμῖν πάθος ἀλγυνόν, τὸ δ' εἰς φύσιν ἀπὸν πάλιν ἀθρόον ἡδύ, τὸ δὲ ἡρέμα καὶ κατὰ σμικρὸν ἀναίσθητον, τὸ δ' ἐναντίον τούτοις ἐναντίως. τὸ δὲ μετ' εὐπετείας γιγνόμενον ἅπαν αἰσθητὸν μὲν ὅτι μάλιστα, λύπης δὲ καὶ ἡδονῆς οὐ μετέχον, οἷον τὰ περὶ τὴν ὄψιν αὐτὴν παθήματα, ἢ δὲ σῶμα ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐρρήθη καθ' ἡμέραν συμφυῆς ἡμῶν γίνεσθαι. ταύτη γὰρ τομαὶ μὲν καὶ καύσεις καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα πάσχει λύπας οὐκ ἐμποιοῦσιν, οὐδὲ ἡδονὰς πάλιν ἐπὶ ταῦτόν ἀπιούσης εἶδος, μέγισται δὲ αἰσθήσεις καὶ σαφέσταται καθ' ὅτι τ' ἂν πάθῃ καὶ ὅσων ἂν αὐτὴ πη προσβαλοῦσα ἐφάπτηται· βία γὰρ τὸ ἀάπαν οὐκ ἔνι τῇ διακρίσει τε αὐτῆς καὶ συγκρίσει. ΤΙ. τὰ δ' ἐκ μειζόνων μερῶν σώματα μόγις εἴκοντα τῷ δρῶντι, διαδιδόντα δὲ εἰς ὅλον τὰς κινήσεις, ἡδονὰς ἴσχει καὶ λύπας, ἀλλοτριούμενα μὲν λύπας, καθιστάμενα δὲ εἰς τὸ αὐτὸ πάλιν ἡδονάς. ὅσα δὲ κατὰ σμικρὸν τὰς ἀποχωρήσεις ἑαυτῶν καὶ

κενώσεις εἴληφεν, τὰς δὲ πληρώσεις ἀθρόας καὶ κατὰ μέγала, κενώσεως μὲν ἀναίσθητα, πληρώσεως δὲ αἰσθητικὰ γιγνόμενα, λύπας μὲν οὐ παρέχει τῷ θνητῷ τῆς ψυχῆς, μεγίστας δὲ ἡδονάς· ἔστιν δὲ ἔνδηλα περὶ τὰς εὐωδίας. ὅσα δὲ ἀπαλλοτριοῦται μὲν ἀθρόα, κατὰ σμικρὰ δὲ μόγισ τε εἰς ταῦτόν

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T: Although the experiences common to the body as a whole and any names bestowed upon whatever produces them have been described fairly well, we should still attempt to explain, if we can somehow do so, what happens in various parts of our bodies, the associated effects, and furthermore the causes involved in their production. First, we should clarify as best we can whatever we omitted from our earlier discussion about tastes – namely, the particular experiences that involve the tongue. These experiences appear to originate, as indeed do most others, from certain constrictions and expansions, and, additionally, they rely more than the others upon roughness and smoothness. For any earth particles that enter in around the veins that act like probes for the tongue, extending as far as the heart, fall upon the moist, soft flesh, get dissolved, constrict the veins and dry them up. These appear harsh to us if they are particularly rough, dry if they are less rough. But anything that cleanses these veins, and anything that rinses the region of the tongue, is referred to as bitter when it exceeds the measure of its activity so that it attacks and melts away the substance of the tongue itself. Soda has this sort of effect, while those that are milder than soda and exercise their cleansing effect in due measure appear salty to us and more agreeable in the absence of that bitter roughness. Those which combine with the heat of the mouth and are rendered smooth become inflamed along with it, and in turn burn the very thing that warmed them up. Then, being carried upwards by their lightness towards the sense organs in the head, they cut apart whatever they impinge upon, and because they possess these powers, all such substances are called pungent. Those particles that have become thin through decay sink down into the narrow veins and are

duly proportioned to particles of earth and air that are in there already, so that they set them moving around one another and stir them up. Being stirred up, they form an enclosure, and as one kind of particle sinks into another they produce hollows stretched around the particles that enter. So when a hollow of moisture, earthy or pure, is stretched about air, it forms watery vessels of air. Those enveloped by pure water are transparent and are called bubbles, while in cases where the moisture is earthy so that it moves and rises in a mass, we use the terms foaming and fermentation, and that which causes these experiences is called acid.

πάλιν ἑαυτοῖς καθίσταται, τούναντίον τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν πάντα ἀποδίδωσιν· ταῦτα δ' αὖ περὶ τὰς καύσεις καὶ τομὰς τοῦ σώματος γιγνόμενά ἐστιν κατάδηλα. καὶ τὰ μὲν δὴ κοινὰ τοῦ σώματος παντὸς παθήματα, τῶν τ' ἐπωνυμιῶν ὅσαι τοῖς δρῶσιν αὐτὰ γεγόνασι, σχεδὸν εἴρηται· τὰ δ' ἐν ἰδίῳις μέρεσιν ἡμῶν γιγνόμενα, τὰ τε πάθη καὶ τὰς αἰτίας αὖ τῶν δρώντων, πειρατέον εἰπεῖν, ἄν πῃ δυνώμεθα. πρῶτον οὖν ὅσα τῶν χυμῶν περὶ λέγοντες ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἀπελίπομεν, ἴδια ὄντα παθήματα περὶ τὴν γλῶτταν, ἐμφανιστέον ἢ δυνατόν. φαίνεται δὲ καὶ ταῦτα, ὥσπερ οὖν καὶ τὰ πολλά, διὰ συγκρίσεών τε τινῶν καὶ διακρίσεων γίνεσθαι, πρὸς δὲ αὐταῖς κεχρηῆσθαι μᾶλλον τι τῶν ἄλλων τραχύτησί τε καὶ λειότησιν. ὅσα μὲν γὰρ εἰσιόντα περὶ τὰ φλέβια, οἷόνπερ δοκίμια τῆς γλώττης τεταμένα ἐπὶ τὴν καρδίαν, εἰς τὰ νοτερά τῆς σαρκὸς καὶ ἀπαλὰ ἐμπίπτοντα γήϊνα μέρη κατατηκόμενα συνάγει τὰ φλέβια καὶ ἀποξηραίνει, τραχύτερα μὲν ὄντα στρυφνά, ἥττον δὲ τραχύνοντα αὐστηρὰ φαίνεται· τὰ δὲ τούτων τε ῥυπτικά καὶ πᾶν τὸ περὶ τὴν γλῶτταν ἀποπλύνοντα, πέρα μὲν τοῦ μετρίου τοῦτο δρῶντα καὶ προσεπιλαμβανόμενα ὥστε ἀποτήκειν αὐτῆς τῆς φύσεως, οἷον ἢ τῶν λίτρων δύναιμις, πικρὰ πάνθ' οὕτως ὠνόμασται, τὰ δὲ ὑποδεέστερα τῆς λιτρώδους ἕξεως ἐπὶ τὸ μέτριόν τε τῇ ῥύψει χρώμενα ἀλυκὰ ἄνευ πικρότητος τραχείας καὶ φίλα μᾶλλον ἡμῖν φαντάζεται. ΤΙ. τὰ δὲ τῇ τοῦ στόματος θερμότητι κοινωνήσαντα καὶ λεαινόμενα ὑπ' αὐτοῦ, συνεκπυρούμενα καὶ πάλιν αὐτὰ ἀντικαίοντα τὸ διαθερμῆναν, φερόμενά τε ὑπὸ κουφότητος ἄνω πρὸς τὰς τῆς κεφαλῆς αἰσθήσεις,

τέμνοντά τε πάνθ' ὁπόσοις ἂν προσπίπτῃ, διὰ ταύτας τὰς δυνάμεις δριμέα πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐλέχθη. τὸ δὲ αὖ τῶν προλεπτυσμένων μὲν ὑπὸ σηπεδόνος, εἰς δὲ τὰς στενὰς φλέβας ἐνδυσόμενων, καὶ τοῖς ἐνοῦσιν αὐτόθι μέρεσιν γεώδεσιν καὶ ὅσα ἀέρος συμμετρίαν ἔχοντα, ὥστε κινήσαντα περὶ ἄλληλα ποιεῖν κυκᾶσθαι, κυκώμενα δὲ περιπίπτειν τε καὶ εἰς ἕτερα ἐνδυσόμενα ἕτερα κοῖλα ἀπεργάζεσθαι περιτεινόμενα τοῖς εἰσιούσιν— ἃ δὴ νοτίδος περὶ ἀέρα κοίλης περιταθείσης, τοτὲ μὲν γεώδους, τοτὲ δὲ καὶ καθαρᾶς, νοτερὰ ἀγγεῖα ἀέρος, ὕδατα κοῖλα περιφερῇ τε γενέσθαι, καὶ τὰ μὲν τῆς καθαρᾶς διαφανεῖς περιστῆναι κληθείσας ὄνομα πομφόλυγας, τὰ δὲ τῆς γεώδους ὁμοῦ κινουμένης τε καὶ αἰρομένης ζέσιν τε καὶ ζύμωσιν ἐπίκλιν λεχθῆναι—τὸ δὲ τούτων αἴτιον τῶν παθημάτων ὃξὺ προσρηθῆναι. σύμπασιν δὲ τοῖς περὶ ταῦτα εἰρημένοις

66c

T: An effect opposite to all those we have been describing is produced by an opposite cause. Whenever the configuration of the particles entering into liquids has a natural affinity with the normal condition of the tongue, smoothes it out and covers over its roughness, contracts the parts that have been unnaturally dilated, relaxes those that have been unnaturally constricted and settles them all as much as possible into their natural condition, anything of this sort constitutes a pleasant and agreeable remedy for those violent experiences, and is called sweet.

πάθος ἐναντίον ἀπ' ἐναντίας ἐστὶ προφάσεως· ὁπόταν ἡ τῶν εἰσιόντων σύστασις ἐν ὑγροῖς, οἰκεῖα τῇ τῆς γλώττης ἔξει πεφυκυῖα, λεαίνῃ μὲν ἐπαλείφουσα τὰ τραχυνθέντα, τὰ δὲ παρὰ φύσιν συνεστῶτα ἢ κεχυμένα τὰ μὲν συνάγῃ, τὰ δὲ χαλᾷ, καὶ πάνθ' ὅτι μάλιστα ἰδρύῃ κατὰ φύσιν, ἡδὺ καὶ προσφιλὲς παντὶ πᾶν τὸ τοιοῦτον ἴαμα τῶν βιαίων παθημάτων γιγνόμενον κέκληται γλυκύ.

66d

T: Well, that is enough on this topic. Now, in the case of the power that belongs to the nostrils there are no distinct forms, for all of the smells are half-breeds and no single form proves to possess symmetry

corresponding to any smell. Rather, the veins within us that are involved in these processes are more narrowly constructed than the kinds of particle belonging to earth and water, and are wider than those of fire and air, so no one has ever perceived a scent from any of these four. No, odour arises from the moistening, decaying, liquefaction or evaporation of substances. Indeed, odours arise at the intermediate stage when water is being transformed into air or air into water, and they are all smoke or mist. The one proceeding from air to water is mist, while the one proceeding from water to air is smoke. Therefore, all odours are less dense than water and yet more dense than air. This is most evident when someone impedes the inward breath and then draws his breath forcibly, for when he does this no accompanying odour whatsoever is filtered through, and the breath alone enters in, devoid of odours. Now, the varieties of scents fall into two categories which are without names, and consist neither of numerous forms nor of a simple few. Rather, we should speak only of an immediate, distinct, twofold division into the pleasant and the painful: one roughens and does violence to the entire vessel that lies between our navel and the top of our head, while the other soothes this same region and lovingly restores it once more to its natural condition.

καὶ τὰ μὲν ταύτη ταῦτα περὶ δὲ δὴ τὴν τῶν μυκτῆρων δύναμιν, εἶδη μὲν οὐκ ἔνι. τὸ γὰρ τῶν ὁσμῶν πᾶν ἡμιγενές, εἶδει δὲ οὐδενὶ συμβέβηκεν συμμετρία πρὸς τό τινα σχεῖν ὁσμήν· ἀλλ' ἡμῶν αἱ περὶ ταῦτα φλέβες πρὸς μὲν τὰ γῆς ὕδατος τε γένη στενότεραι συνέστησαν, πρὸς δὲ τὰ πυρὸς ἀέρος τε εὐρύτεραι, διὸ τούτων οὐδεὶς οὐδενὸς ὁσμῆς πώποτε ἦσθετό τις, ἀλλὰ ἢ βρεχομένων ἢ σηπομένων ἢ τηκομένων ἢ θυμιομένων γίνονται τιων. μεταβάλλοντος γὰρ ὕδατος εἰς ἀέρα ἀέρος τε εἰς ὕδωρ ἐν τῷ μεταξύ τούτων γεγόνασιν, εἰσὶν τε ὁσμαὶ σύμπασαι καπνὸς ἢ ὁμίχλη, τούτων δὲ τὸ μὲν ἐξ ἀέρος εἰς ὕδωρ ἰὸν ὁμίχλη, τὸ δὲ ἐξ ὕδατος εἰς ἀέρα καπνός· ὅθεν λεπτότεραι μὲν ὕδατος, παχύτεραι δὲ ὁμαὶ σύμπασαι γεγόνασιν ἀέρος. ΤΙ. δηλοῦνται δὲ ὅποταν τινὸς ἀντιφραχθέντος περὶ τὴν ἀναπνοὴν ἄγῃ τις βία τὸ πνεῦμα

εἰς αὐτόν· τότε γὰρ ὁσμή μὲν οὐδεμία συνδιηθεῖται, τὸ δὲ πνεῦμα τῶν ὁσμῶν ἐρημωθὲν αὐτὸ μόνον

67a

T: The third part of sense perception within us, the one concerned with hearing, should be investigated, and the causes of the experiences associated therewith should be stated. Now, we may propose, in general, that sound is an impact transmitted by the air through the ears, brain and blood as far as the soul, and that hearing is the motion produced by this, a motion beginning in the head and ending in the region around the liver. If the motion is rapid the sound is high-pitched, if slow it is low-pitched, if it is uniform the sound is even and smooth, and in the opposite case it is harsh. If the motion is extensive, the sound is loud, and in the opposite case it is faint. However, the factors involved in the concord of sound must be dealt with in later deliberations.

ἔπεται. δὴ οὖν ταῦτα ἀνώνυμα τὰ τούτων ποικίλματα γέγονεν, οὐκ ἐκ πολλῶν οὐδὲ ἀπλῶν εἰδῶν ὄντα, ἀλλὰ διχῇ τό θ' ἡδὺ καὶ τὸ λυπηρὸν αὐτόθι μόνω διαφανῇ λέγεσθον, τὸ μὲν τραχὺνόν τε καὶ βιαζόμενον τὸ κύτος ἅπαν, ὅσον ἡμῶν μεταξὺ κορυφῆς τοῦ τε ὀμφαλοῦ κεῖται, τὸ δὲ ταῦτόν τοῦτο καταπραῦνον καὶ πάλιν ἧ πέφυκεν ἀγαπητῶς ἀποδιδόν. τρίτον δὲ αἰσθητικὸν ἐν ἡμῖν μέρος ἐπισκοποῦσιν τὸ περὶ τὴν ἀκοήν, δι' ἃς αἰτίας τὰ περὶ αὐτὸ συμβαίνει παθήματα, λεκτέον. ὅλως μὲν οὖν φωνὴν θῶμεν τὴν δι' ὥτων ὑπ' αἵρος ἐγκεφάλου τε καὶ αἵματος μέχρι ψυχῆς πληγὴν διαδιδομένην, τὴν δὲ ὑπ' αὐτῆς κίνησιν, ἀπὸ τῆς κεφαλῆς μὲν ἀρχομένην, τελευτῶσαν δὲ περὶ τὴν τοῦ ἥπατος ἔδραν, ἀκοήν· ὅση δ' αὐτῆς ταχεῖα, ὀξεῖαν, ὅση δὲ βραδυτέρα, βαρυτέραν· τὴν δὲ ὁμοίαν ὁμαλὴν τε καὶ λεῖαν, τὴν δὲ ἐναντίαν τραχεῖαν·

67c

T: Well, there remains a fourth kind of sense perception, and it is necessary to subdivide this since enormous variations are included within it, which we refer to collectively as colour, a flame emanating from bodies, having particles proportionate to the beam of sight so as to bring about perception. And in the earlier accounts the causes that

generated the visual beam were simply stated. Therefore, it would be most reasonable and appropriate to present a suitable account dealing with colours as follows. Particles borne from the various objects and impinging upon the beam of sight may be smaller, larger, or indeed equal in size to the particles belonging to the visual beam itself. Now, those that are equal in size are imperceptible, and, indeed, we say they are transparent. The larger and the smaller constrict the beam in one case, and disperse it in the other, and these are related to the particles that warm and cool the flesh, the astringent ones associated with the tongue, and those we referred to as pungent due to their warming effect. White and black constitute identical experiences to these, but in a different medium, and for these reasons the phenomena appear different. Therefore, they should be referred to accordingly – that which disperses the beam of sight is white, and its opposite is black. And when the more rapid motion belonging to a different kind of fire impinges upon the beam of sight and disperses it right up to the eyes, forcibly compressing and cutting the very passageways of the eyes themselves, it causes a volume of fire and water, which we call a tear, to pour out of them. This more acute motion, being itself fire, encounters fire coming from the opposite direction which leaps out as if coming from a flash of lightning, while the incoming fire is being extinguished in the moisture, and in this turmoil a whole variety of colours is generated. We refer to the effect as dazzling, and we call whatever brings this about bright and glistening.

μεγάλην δὲ τὴν πολλήν, ὅση δὲ ἐναντία, σμικράν. τὰ δὲ περὶ συμφωνίας αὐτῶν ἐν τοῖς ὕστερον λεχθησομένοις ἀνάγκη ρηθῆναι. τέταρτον δὲ λοιπὸν ἔτι γένος ἡμῖν αἰσθητικόν, ὃ διελέσθαι δεῖ συχνὰ ἐν ἑαυτῷ ποικίλματα κεκτημένον, ἃ σύμπαντα μὲν χροᾶς ἐκαλέσαμεν, φλόγα τῶν σωμάτων ἐκάστων ἀπορρέουσιν, ὅψει σύμμετρα μόρια ἔχουσιν πρὸς αἴσθησιν· ὅψεως δ' ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν αὐτὸ περὶ τῶν αἰτίων τῆς γενέσεως ἐρρήθη. τῇδ' οὖν τῶν χρωμάτων περί μάλιστα εἰκὸς πρόπει τ' ἂν ἐπεικεῖ λόγῳ διεξελεῖν· τὰ φερόμενα ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων μόρια ἐμπίπτοντά τε εἰς τὴν ὄψιν τὰ μὲν ἐλάττω, τὰ δὲ μείζω, τὰ δ' ἴσα τοῖς

αὐτῆς τῆς ὄψεως μέρεσιν εἶναι· τὰ μὲν οὖν ἴσα ἀναίσθητα, ἃ δὴ καὶ διαφανῇ λέγομεν, τὰ δὲ μείζω καὶ ἐλάττω, τὰ μὲν συγκρίνοντα, τὰ δὲ διακρίνοντα αὐτήν, τοῖς περὶ τὴν σάρκα θερμοῖς καὶ ψυχροῖς καὶ τοῖς περὶ τὴν γλῶτταν στρυφνοῖς, καὶ ὅσα θερμαντικὰ ὄντα δριμύα ἐκαλέσαμεν, ἀδελφὰ εἶναι, τὰ τε λευκὰ καὶ τὰ μέλανα, ἐκείνων παθήματα γεγονότα ἐν ἄλλῳ γένει τὰ αὐτά, φανταζόμενα δὲ ἄλλα διὰ ταύτας τὰς αἰτίας. TI. οὕτως οὖν αὐτὰ προσρητέον· τὸ μὲν διακριτικὸν τῆς ὄψεως λευκόν, τὸ δ' ἐναντίον αὐτοῦ μέλαν, τὴν δὲ ὀξυτέραν φορὰν καὶ γένους πυρὸς ἑτέρου προσπίπτουσαν καὶ διακρίνουσαν τὴν ὄψιν μέχρι τῶν ὁμμάτων, αὐτάς τε τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν τὰς διεξόδους

68a

T: The kind of fire that is intermediate between these other two is not glistening, despite reaching the moisture of the eyes and mixing with it, and the beam of fire shining through the moisture with which it is mixed produces a blood colour that we call red. Bright mixed with red and white becomes orange, but it would not be sensible to state the extent of the measure involved in these, even if we knew it, since we would not be even moderately capable of proposing any necessity or any likely account thereof. And yet, red mixed with black and white is purple, or it is violet whenever these components are burned and more black is mixed in with them. Orange arises from a mixture of yellow and grey, while grey comes from white and black, and ochre from white mixed with yellow. White mixed with bright and steeped in an intense black produces a dark blue colour, and dark blue mixed with white is light blue, while orange mixed with black is green. As for the other colours, it is fairly obvious from these examples what mixtures they should be attributed to if we are to preserve our likely account. Yet if someone were to put these matters to the test through practical investigation, he would be acting in ignorance of the distinction between human and divine nature. God has sufficient knowledge and power to combine the many into one, and then again, to separate the one into many, but no human being is now, or ever shall be, adequate to either of these undertakings.

βία διωθοῦσαν καὶ τήκουσαν, πῦρ μὲν ἀθρόον καὶ ὕδωρ, ὃ δάκρυον καλοῦμεν, ἐκείθεν ἐκχέουσιν, αὐτὴν δὲ οὖσαν πῦρ ἐξ ἐναντίας ἀπαντῶσαν, καὶ τοῦ μὲν ἐκπηδῶντος πυρὸς οἷον ἀπ' ἀστραπῆς, τοῦ δ' εἰσιόντος καὶ περὶ τὸ νοτερόν κατασβεβννυμένου, παντοδαπῶν ἐν τῇ κυκλήσει ταύτῃ γιγνομένων χρωμάτων, μαρμαρυγὰς μὲν τὸ πάθος προσείπομεν, τὸ δὲ τοῦτο ἀπεργαζόμενον λαμπρόν τε καὶ στίλβον ἐπωνομάσαμεν. τὸ δὲ τούτων αὖ μεταξὺ πυρὸς γένος, πρὸς μὲν τὸ τῶν ὁμμάτων ὑγρὸν ἀφικνούμενον καὶ κεραννύμενον αὐτῷ, στίλβον δὲ οὐ τῇ δὲ διὰ τῆς νοτίδος αὐγῇ τοῦ πυρὸς μειγνυμένου χρῶμα ἔναιμιον παρασχομένη, τοῦνομα ἐρυθρὸν λέγομεν. λαμπρόν τε ἐρυθρῷ λευκῷ τε μειγνύμενον ξανθὸν γέγονεν· τὸ δὲ ὅσον μέτρον ὅσοις, οὐδ' εἴ τις εἰδείῃ, νοῦν ἔχει τὸ λέγειν, ὧν μήτε τινὰ ἀνάγκην μήτε τὸν εἰκότα λόγον καὶ μετρίως ἂν τις εἰπεῖν εἴη δυνατός. ἐρυθρὸν δὲ δὴ μέλανι λευκῷ τε κραθὲν ἀλουργόν· ὄρφνινον δέ, ὅταν τούτοις μεμειγμένοις καυθεῖσιν τε μᾶλλον συγκραθῇ μέλαν. πυρρὸν δὲ ξανθοῦ τε καὶ φαιοῦ κράσει γίγνεται, φαιὸν δὲ λευκοῦ τε καὶ μέλανος, τὸ δὲ ὥχρον λευκοῦ ξανθῷ μειγνυμένου. λαμπρῷ δὲ λευκὸν συνελθὸν καὶ εἰς μέλαν κατακορὲς ἐμπεσὸν κυανοῦν χρῶμα ἀποτελεῖται, κυανοῦ δὲ λευκῷ κεραννυμένου γλαυκόν, πυρροῦ δὲ μέλανι πράσιον. τὰ δὲ ἄλλα ἀπὸ τούτων σχεδὸν δῆλα αἷς ἂν ἀφομοιούμενα μείξεσιν διασφῶζοι τὸν εἰκότα μῦθον. εἰ δέ τις τούτων ἔργῳ σκοπούμενος βάσανον λαμβάνοι, τὸ τῆς ἀνθρωπίνης καὶ θείας φύσεως ἡγνοηκῶς ἂν εἴη διάφορον, ὅτι θεὸς μὲν τὰ πολλὰ εἰς ἓν συγκεραννύναι καὶ πάλιν ἐξ ἑνὸς εἰς πολλὰ διαλύειν ἱκανῶς ἐπιστάμενος ἅμα καὶ δυνατός, ἀνθρώπων δὲ οὐδεὶς οὐδέτερον τούτων ἱκανὸς οὔτε ἔστι νῦν οὔτε εἰς αὐθὶς ποτε ἔσται.

68e

T: So, at this stage, all these have developed in this way out of necessity. The artificer of the most beautiful and best of whatever comes into being took these over when he was bringing the self-sufficient and perfect god to birth, employing the causes associated with these as subservient, while he himself fashioned the good in whatever comes into being. Therefore, we should distinguish two kinds of cause, one necessary, the other divine, and we should seek the

divine in all things for the sake of attaining a life that is as happy as our nature will admit. And we should seek the necessary for the sake of the divine, reckoning that without these necessities, those divine objects, our serious concern, are incapable of being discerned on their own, nor can they be apprehended or shared in at all.

ταῦτα δὴ πάντα τότε ταύτῃ πεφυκότα ἐξ ἀνάγκης ὁ τοῦ καλλίστου τε καὶ ἀρίστου δημιουργὸς ἐν τοῖς γιγνομένοις παρελάμβανεν, ἥνικα τὸν αὐτάρκη τε καὶ τὸν τελεώτατον θεὸν ἐγέννα, χρώμενος μὲν ταῖς περὶ ταῦτα αἰτίαις ὑπηρετούσαις, τὸ δὲ εὖ τεκταινόμενος ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς γιγνομένοις αὐτός. ΤΙ. διὸ δὴ χρὴ δύο αἰτίας εἶδη διορίζεσθαι, τὸ μὲν ἀναγκαῖον, τὸ δὲ θεῖον, καὶ τὸ μὲν θεῖον ἐν ᾗπασιν ζητεῖν

69a

T: Now that the two kinds of cause have been duly separated and lie before us like materials for a carpenter, we must weave the remaining account together from these two. Let's briefly go back again to the beginning, proceed quickly from there to the stage we have just arrived at, and attempt to give a conclusion to our story at that stage, a crown befitting all that has gone before. Indeed, just as we said at the outset, these were all in a disorderly state when the god engendered symmetry in each of them, each in relation to itself and all in relation to one another, to the extent that, and in the manner that, it was possible for them to be proportionate and symmetrical. For at that time nothing had a share in these proportions save by chance, and there was nothing at all worthy of being called by the names we now use, such as fire or water or any of the others. Rather, he first set all of these in order, then constructed this Universe from them, a single living being containing within itself all living beings, both mortal and immortal. He himself became the artificer of the divine beings and he commanded his own offspring to undertake the creation of the mortals. And they, imitating their father, received the immortal beginning of soul, then fashioned a mortal body in a globe around it and bestowed the entire body as its vehicle, and also built another form of soul in the body – the mortal form. This contains fearsome,

necessary experiences within itself; first, there are pleasures, the greatest lure to evil; then, there are pains, taking flight from the good; there is also rashness, and fear, two unintelligent advisers; anger that is so hard to appease; and hope, so easily led astray. Mixing these together with irrational sense perception, and a love that will turn its hand to anything, they compounded the mortal kind of soul in a necessary manner. And fearing that these might pollute the divine part, unless this was absolutely unavoidable, they housed the mortal part of soul separately from that in a different dwelling place in the body, by constructing an isthmus and a boundary between the head and the chest, the neck, which they put in place so as to keep them separated.

κτήσεως ἔνεκα εὐδαίμονος βίου, καθ' ὅσον ἡμῶν ἡ φύσις ἐνδέχεται, τὸ δὲ ἀναγκαῖον ἐκείνων χάριν, λογιζόμενον ὡς ἄνευ τούτων οὐ δυνατὰ αὐτὰ ἐκεῖνα ἐφ' οἷς σπουδάζομεν μόνα κατανοεῖν οὐδ' αὖ λαβεῖν οὐδ' ἄλλως πως μετασχεῖν. ὅτ' οὖν δὴ τὰ νῦν οἷα τέκτοσιν ἡμῖν ὕλη παράκειται τὰ τῶν αἰτίων γένη διυλισμένα, ἐξ ὧν τὸν ἐπίλοιπον λόγον δεῖ συνυφανθῆναι, πάλιν ἐπ' ἀρχὴν ἐπανέλθωμεν διὰ βραχέων, ταχὺ τε εἰς ταῦτον πορευθῶμεν ὅθεν δεῦρο ἀφικόμεθα, καὶ τελευτὴν ἤδη κεφαλὴν τε τῷ μύθῳ πειρώμεθα ἀρμόττουσαν ἐπιθεῖναι τοῖς πρόσθεν. ὥσπερ γὰρ οὖν καὶ κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐλέχθη, ταῦτα ἀτάκτως ἔχοντα ὁ θεὸς ἐν ἐκάστῳ τε αὐτῷ πρὸς αὐτὸ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα συμμετρίας ἐνεποίησεν, ὅσας τε καὶ ὅπη δυνατόν ἦν ἀνάλογα καὶ σύμμετρα εἶναι. τότε γὰρ οὔτε τούτων, ὅσον μὴ τύχη, τι μετεῖχεν, οὔτε τὸ παράπαν ὀνομάσαι τῶν νῦν ὀνομαζομένων ἀξιόλογον ἦν οὐδέν, οἷον πῦρ καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ εἴ τι τῶν ἄλλων· ἀλλὰ πάντα ταῦτα πρῶτον διεκόσμησεν, ἔπειτ' ἐκ τούτων πᾶν τόδε συνεστήσατο, ζῶον ἐν ζῳᾷ ἔχον τὰ πάντα ἐν ἑαυτῷ θνητὰ ἀθάνατά τε. καὶ τῶν μὲν θείων αὐτὸς γίγνεται δημιουργός, τῶν δὲ θνητῶν τὴν γένεσιν τοῖς ἑαυτοῦ γεννήμασιν δημιουργεῖν προσέταξεν. οἱ δὲ μιμούμενοι, παραλαβόντες ἀρχὴν ψυχῆς ἀθάνατον, τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο θνητὸν σῶμα αὐτῇ περιετόρνενυσαν ὀχημά τε πᾶν τὸ σῶμα ἔδωσαν ἄλλο τε εἶδος ἐν αὐτῷ ψυχῆς προσωκοδόμουν τὸ θνητόν, δεινὰ καὶ ἀναγκαῖα ἐν ἑαυτῷ παθήματα ἔχον, πρῶτον μὲν ἡδονήν, μέγιστον κακοῦ δέλεαρ,

ἔπειτα λύπας, ἀγαθῶν φυγὰς, ἔτι δ' αὖ θάρρος καὶ φόβον, ἄφρονε συμβούλῳ, θυμὸν δὲ δυσπαραμύθητον, ἐλπίδα δ' εὐπαραγωγὸν αἰσθήσει δὲ ἀλόγῳ καὶ ἐπιχειρητῇ παντὸς ἔρωτι συγκερασάμενοι ταῦτα, ἀναγκαίως τὸ θνητὸν γένος συνέθεσαν. καὶ διὰ ταῦτα δὴ σεβόμενοι μαινέειν τὸ θεῖον, ὅτι μὴ πᾶσα ἦν ἀνάγκη, χωρὶς ἐκείνου κατοικίζουσιν εἰς

69e

T: Then they fastened the mortal kind of soul within the chest, or thorax as we call it, and since one part of this is naturally better and another part worse, they built the vessel of the thorax, making a division therein as if they were separating the men's quarters from the women's by placing the midriff as a barrier between the two. Then they housed the part of the soul that partakes of courage and spirit, the part that is fond of victory, closer to the head between the midriff and the neck, so that it could hearken to reason, and share with it the task of forcibly restraining the tribe of desires on occasions when they would not willingly consent in any way to obey the injunction of reason issuing from the Acropolis. So, in the sentry house they situated the heart, a knot of veins and a fountain for the blood that is borne relentlessly through all the limbs. Consequently, whenever the force of spirit boils up because reason proclaims that some unjust action is affecting them from the outside, or even from the internal desires, every sensible part of the body rapidly becomes aware of the exhortations and threats communicated through all the narrow veins, heeds them and follows them unreservedly, and, accordingly, the very best part is allowed to rule among them all.

ἄλλην τοῦ σώματος οἴκησιν τὸ θνητόν, ἰσθμόν καὶ ὄρον διοικοδομήσαντες τῆς τε κεφαλῆς καὶ τοῦ στήθους, αὐχένα μεταξὺ τιθέντες, ἴν' εἴη χωρίς. ἐν δὴ τοῖς στήθεσιν καὶ τῷ καλουμένῳ θώρακι τὸ τῆς ψυχῆς θνητὸν γένος ἐνέδουν. ΤΙ. καὶ ἐπειδὴ τὸ μὲν ἄμεινον αὐτῆς, τὸ δὲ χεῖρον ἐπεφύκει, διοικοδομοῦσι τοῦ θώρακος αὖ τὸ κύτος, διορίζοντες οἷον γυναικῶν, τὴν δὲ ἀνδρῶν χωρὶς οἴκησιν, τὰς φρένας διάφραγμα εἰς τὸ μέσον αὐτῶν τιθέντες. τὸ μετέχον οὖν τῆς ψυχῆς

ἀνδρείας καὶ θυμοῦ, φιλόνικον ὄν, κατώκισαν ἐγγυτέρω τῆς κεφαλῆς μεταξύ τῶν φρενῶν τε καὶ αὐχένος, ἵνα τοῦ λόγου κατήκοον ὄν κοινῇ μετ' ἐκείνου βίᾳ τὸ τῶν ἐπιθυμιῶν κατέχοι γένος, ὁπότ' ἐκ τῆς ἀκροπόλεως τῷ τ' ἐπιτάγματι καὶ λόγῳ μηδαμῇ πείθεσθαι ἐκὸν ἐθέλοι· τὴν δὲ δὴ καρδίαν ἅμμα τῶν φλεβῶν καὶ πηγὴν τοῦ περιφερομένου κατὰ πάντα τὰ μέλη σφοδρῶς αἵματος εἰς τὴν δορυφορικὴν οἴκησιν κατέστησαν, ἵνα, ὅτε ζέσειεν τὸ τοῦ θυμοῦ μένος, τοῦ λόγου παραγγείλαντος ὥς τις ἄδικος περὶ αὐτὰ γίγνεται πρᾶξις ἔξωθεν ἢ καὶ τις ἀπὸ τῶν ἔνδοθεν ἐπιθυμιῶν, ὁξέως διὰ πάντων τῶν στενωπῶν πᾶν ὅσον αἰσθητικὸν ἐν τῷ σώματι, τῶν τε παρακελεύσεων καὶ ἀπειλῶν αἰσθανόμενον, γίγνοιτο ἐπήκοον καὶ ἔποιτο πάντη, καὶ τὸ βέλτιστον οὕτως ἐν αὐτοῖς

70c

T: Considering the pounding of the heart, due to expectation of terrors or the awakening of spirit, and anticipating that this sort of swelling of the spirited parts was going to arise through fire, they devised a protection for the heart by implanting the structure of the lung. First and foremost this is soft and bloodless, and it also has cavities bored through it like a sponge so that it may receive air and liquid, have a cooling effect, and provide respite and ease amid the burning heat. Accordingly, they cut the channels of the windpipe as far as the lungs, and wrapped the lungs around the heart like a buffer so that when spirit bursts forth within the heart, it would pound against something yielding and be relieved, and being less troubled it would be more able to join with spirit in the service of reason.

πᾶσιν ἡγεμονεῖν ἔω. τῇ δὲ δὴ πηδήσει τῆς καρδίας ἐν τῇ τῶν δεινῶν προσδοκίᾳ καὶ τῇ τοῦ θυμοῦ ἐγέρσει, προγιγνώσκοντες ὅτι διὰ πυρὸς ἢ τοιαύτη πᾶσα ἔμελλεν οἴδησις γίνεσθαι τῶν θυμουμένων, ἐπικουρίαν αὐτῇ μηχανώμενοι τὴν τοῦ πλεύμονος ἰδέαν ἐνεφύτευσαν, πρῶτον μὲν μαλακὴν καὶ ἄναιμον, εἴτα σήραγγας ἐντὸς ἔχουσας οἷον σπόγγου κατατετρημένας, ἵνα τό τε πνεῦμα καὶ τὸ πῶμα δεχομένη,

70d

T: As for the part of the soul that is desirous of food and drink, and whatever else is held to be lacking on account of the nature of the body, that part they housed in between the midriff and the boundary near the navel, occupying the entire region, building there a sort of feeding trough for the nourishment of the body. And there they tethered this part, like a conjoined wild beast that needed to be nourished if there was ever going to be a mortal race. So they allocated this location to it so that, grazing constantly at the feeding trough, housed as far away as possible from the part that deliberates, producing the least possible commotion and noise, it would allow the supreme part to deliberate in peace about what best serves the individual and the entire community. And they realised that it was not going to understand reason, and even if it were somehow to attain some appreciation thereof, it would not be in its nature to be concerned about any words, but would be utterly enchanted night and day by images and phantoms. God, seeking to exploit this particular weakness, assembled the structure of the liver and placed it in that very dwelling place, arranging that it be dense, smooth and bright, possessing both sweetness and bitterness. It was intended that the power belonging to the concepts emanating from nous, moving in the liver as if in a mirror that receives impressions and produces visible images, would strike fear into the appetitive part. So, whenever this power makes use of a kindred portion of the liver's bitterness, bears down upon it strongly and threateningly, and rapidly spreads the bitterness over the entire liver, it projects bilious colours, contracts it and makes it all shrivelled and rough. What's more, it also bends the lobe of the liver from its proper state, constricts it, blocks and closes its ducts and apertures, and brings about pain and nausea. And yet, when some breath of gentleness emanating from mind paints pictures of an opposite sort, it provides respite from the bitterness by refusing to set in motion or even to touch the nature that is opposite to itself. Then, making use of the very sweetness that is natural to the liver, it restores all its parts to their proper, smooth and free condition, and renders the

part of the soul housed in the region of the liver kind and gentle, spending the hours of night in due measure by having recourse to prophecy whilst sleeping, since it does not have a share in reason or intelligence.

ψύχουσα, ἀναπνοὴν καὶ ῥαστώνην ἐν τῷ καύματι παρέχοι· διὸ δὴ τῆς ἀρτηρίας ὀχετοὺς ἐπὶ τὸν πλεύμονα ἔτεμον, καὶ περὶ τὴν καρδίαν αὐτὸν περιέστησαν οἷον μάλαγμα, ἵν' ὁ θυμὸς ἡνίκα ἐν αὐτῇ ἀκμάζοι, πηδῶσα εἰς ὑπεῖκον καὶ ἀναψυχομένη, πονοῦσα ἦττον, μᾶλλον τῷ λόγῳ μετὰ θυμοῦ δύναιτο ὑπηρετεῖν. τὸ δὲ δὴ σίτων τε καὶ ποτῶν ἐπιθυμητικὸν τῆς ψυχῆς καὶ ὅσων ἔνδειαν διὰ τὴν τοῦ σώματος ἴσχει φύσιν, τοῦτο εἰς τὸ μεταξὺ τῶν τε φρενῶν καὶ τοῦ πρὸς τὸν ὀμφαλὸν ὄρου κατώκισαν, οἷον φάτνην ἐν ἅπαντι τούτῳ τῷ τόπῳ τῇ τοῦ σώματος τροφῇ τεκτηνάμενοι καὶ κατέδησαν δὴ τὸ τοιοῦτον ἐνταῦθα ὡς θρέμμα ἄγριον, τρέφειν δὲ συνημμένον ἀναγκαῖον, εἴπερ τι μέλλοι ποτὲ θνητὸν ἔσεσθαι γένος. ΤΙ. ἵν' οὖν αἰεὶ νεμόμενον πρὸς φάτνην καὶ ὅτι πορρωτάτῳ τοῦ βουλευομένου κατοικοῦν, θόρυβον καὶ βοὴν ὡς ἐλαχίστην παρέχον, τὸ κράτιστον καθ' ἡσυχίαν περὶ τοῦ πᾶσι κοινῇ καὶ ἰδίᾳ συμφέροντος ἐῷ βουλευέσθαι, διὰ ταῦτα ἐνταῦθ' ἔδοσαν αὐτῷ τὴν τάξιν. εἰδότες δὲ αὐτὸ ὡς λόγου μὲν οὔτε συνήσειν ἔμελλεν, εἴ τέ πη καὶ μεταλαμβάνοι τινὸς αὐτῶν αἰσθήσεως, οὐκ ἔμφυτον αὐτῷ τὸ μέλειν τινῶν ἔσοιτο λόγων, ὑπὸ δὲ εἰδῶλων καὶ φαντασμάτων νυκτός τε καὶ μεθ' ἡμέραν μάλιστα ψυχαγωγήσοιτο, τούτῳ δὴ θεὸς ἐπιβουλεύσας αὐτῷ τὴν ἥπατος ιδέαν συνέστησε καὶ ἔθηκεν εἰς τὴν ἐκείνου κατοίκησιν, πυκνὸν καὶ λεῖον καὶ λαμπρὸν καὶ γλυκὺ καὶ πικρότητα ἔχον μηχανησάμενος, ἵνα ἐν αὐτῷ τῶν διανοημάτων ἡ ἐκ τοῦ νοῦ φερομένη δύναμις, οἷον ἐν κατόπτρῳ δεχομένῳ τύπους καὶ κατιδεῖν εἰδῶλα παρέχοντι, φοβοῖ μὲν αὐτό, ὅποτε μέρει τῆς πικρότητος χρωμένη συγγενεῖ, χαλεπὴ προσενεχθεῖσα ἀπειλῇ, κατὰ πᾶν ὑπομειγνύσα ὀξέως τὸ ἥπαρ, χολώδη χρώματα ἐμφαίνοι, συνάγουσά τε πᾶν ῥυσὸν καὶ τραχὺ ποιοῖ, λοβὸν δὲ καὶ δοχὰς πύλας τε τὸ μὲν ἐξ ὀρθοῦ κατακάμπτουςα καὶ συσπῶσα, τὰ δὲ ἐμφράττουςα συγκλείουσά τε, λύπας καὶ ἄσας παρέχοι, καὶ ὅτ' αὖ τὰναντία φαντάσματα ἀποζωγραφοῖ πρᾶτότητός τις ἐκ διανοίας ἐπίπνοια, τῆς μὲν πικρότητος

ἡσυχίαν παρέχουσα τῷ μήτε κινεῖν μήτε προσάπτεσθαι τῆς ἐναντίας ἑαυτῇ φύσεως ἐθέλειν, γλυκύτητι δὲ τῇ κατ' ἐκεῖνο συμφύτῳ πρὸς αὐτὸ χρωμένῃ καὶ πάντα

71d

T: Indeed, those who fashioned us, remembering the injunction of their father when he directed them to make the mortal race as excellent as possible, even corrected the degenerate part of us in this way by establishing the prophetic power in the liver so that it would have some contact with truth. And there is sufficient indication that God has bestowed prophecy upon unintelligent humanity from the fact that no one in possession of nous attains to God-inspired true prophecy, but only someone whose power of intelligence is fettered in sleep or who is disturbed by disease or some frenzy. Rather, it is the role of the intelligent person to recollect and reflect upon the utterances from the prophetic or frenzied state, waking or dreaming, and upon any visions that were seen, and to decide by reasoning how and for whom these all indicate some present, past or future good or evil. However, it is not a task for the person who still remains in the prophetic state to judge the visions and utterances originating from himself. No, it has been well stated of old that it belongs only to the sound-minded person to know himself and do what is his own. Hence, it is the custom to set a group of interpreters as judges over the God-inspired prophecies, interpreters whom some refer to as prophets in their own right, being totally unaware that these people are interpreters of the enigmatic utterances or visions, and may not rightly be called prophets, but interpreters of those who engage in prophecy.

ὁρθὰ καὶ λεῖα αὐτοῦ καὶ ἐλεύθερα ἀπευθύνουσα, ἰλεῶν τε καὶ εὐήμερον ποιοῖ τὴν περὶ τὸ ἦπαρ ψυχῆς μοῖραν κατωκισμένην, ἔν τε τῇ νυκτὶ διαγωγὴν ἔχουσαν μετρίαν, μαντεία χρωμένῃν καθ' ὕπνον, ἐπειδὴ λόγου καὶ φρονήσεως οὐ μετεῖχε. μεμνημένοι γὰρ τῆς τοῦ πατρὸς ἐπιστολῆς οἱ συστήσαντες ἡμᾶς, ὅτε τὸ θνητὸν ἐπέστελλεν γένος ὡς ἄριστον εἰς δύναμιν ποιεῖν, οὕτω δὲ κατορθοῦντες καὶ τὸ φαῦλον

ἡμῶν, ἵνα ἀληθείας πῃ προσάπτοιτο, κατέστησαν ἐν τούτῳ τὸ μαντεῖον. ἱκανὸν δὲ σημεῖον ὡς μαντικὴν ἀφροσύνη θεὸς ἀνθρωπίνῃ δέδωκεν· οὐδεὶς γὰρ ἔννους ἐφάπτεται μαντικῆς ἐνθέου καὶ ἀληθοῦς, ἀλλ' ἢ καθ' ὕπνον τὴν τῆς φρονήσεως πεδηθεὶς δύναμιν ἢ διὰ νόσον, ἢ διὰ τινα ἐνθουσιασμόν παραλλάξας. ΤΙ. ἀλλὰ συννοῆσαι μὲν ἔμφρονος τὰ τε ῥηθέντα ἀναμνησθέντα ὄναρ ἢ ὕπαρ ὑπὸ τῆς μαντικῆς τε καὶ ἐνθουσιαστικῆς φύσεως, καὶ ὅσα ἂν φαντάσματα ὀφθῇ, πάντα λογισμῷ διελέσθαι ὅπῃ τι σημαίνει καὶ ὅτῳ μέλλοντος ἢ παρελθόντος ἢ παρόντος κακοῦ ἢ ἀγαθοῦ· τοῦ δὲ μανέντος ἔτι τε ἐν τούτῳ μένοντος οὐκ ἔργον τὰ φανέντα καὶ φωνηθέντα ὑφ' ἑαυτοῦ κρίνειν, ἀλλ' εὖ καὶ πάλαι λέγεται τὸ πράττειν καὶ γινῶναι τὰ τε αὐτοῦ καὶ ἑαυτὸν σώφρονα μόνῳ προσήκειν. ὅθεν δὴ καὶ τὸ τῶν προφητῶν γένος ἐπὶ

72b

T: So then, it is for the sake of prophecy that the liver has a nature of this sort and is located in the place we have described, and, while each creature is still alive, such an organ as this retains more vivid indications, but when deprived of life it becomes blind and its prophecies are too obscure to indicate anything definite. Furthermore, it is for the sake of the liver, in order to keep it always bright and clean, that the organ next to it has the composition it has and is positioned to the left, like a cloth supplied for a mirror, always lying ready by its side. So, whenever any impurities arise in the region of the liver due to bodily diseases, they are all purified and absorbed by the loose texture of the spleen, since its fabric is porous and devoid of blood. Accordingly, as it fills up with impurities, it waxes large and it festers, but then again, once the body has been purified, it reduces in size and subsides to its former condition.

ταῖς ἐνθέοις μαντείαις κριτὰς ἐπικαθιστάναι νόμος· οὓς μάντεις αὐτοὺς ὀνομάζουσιν τινες, τὸ πᾶν ἡγνοηκότες ὅτι τῆς δι' αἰνιγμῶν οὗτοι φήμης καὶ φαντάσεως ὑποκριταί, καὶ οὗτι μάντεις, προφηται δὲ μαντευσόμενων δικαιοτάτα ὀνομάζοιεντ' ἄν. ἢ μὲν οὖν φύσις ἥπατος διὰ ταῦτα τοιαύτη τε καὶ ἐν τόπῳ ᾧ λέγομεν πέφυκε, χάριν μαντικῆς· καὶ ἔτι μὲν δὴ ζῶντος ἐκάστου τὸ τοιοῦτον σημεῖα ἐναργέστερα ἔχει,

στερηθὲν δὲ τοῦ ζῆν γέγονε τυφλὸν καὶ τὰ μαντεῖα ἀμυδρότερα ἔσχεν τοῦ τι σαφὲς σημαίνειν. ἡ δ' αὖ τοῦ γείτονος αὐτῷ σύστασις καὶ ἔδρα σπλάγχχνου γέγονεν ἐξ ἀριστερᾶς χάριν ἐκείνου, τοῦ παρέχειν αὐτὸ λαμπρὸν αἰεὶ καὶ καθαρὸν, οἷον κατόπτρῳ παρεσκευασμένον καὶ ἔτοιμον αἰεὶ παρακείμενον ἐκμαγεῖον. διὸ δὴ καὶ ὅταν τινὲς ἀκαθαρσαὶ γίνωνται διὰ νόσους σώματος περὶ τὸ ἥπαρ, πάντα ἡ σπληνὸς καθαίρουσα αὐτὰ δέχεται μανότης, ἅτε κοίλου καὶ ἀναίμου ὑφανθέντος·

72d

T: As for the soul, the extent to which it is mortal and the extent to which it is divine, and how, in what company, and for what reasons these two parts are housed separately, we could only ever insist that what we have asserted is true if God were to confirm it. But we should dare to assert, even at this stage, that what has been said is likely, and will prove more so on further investigation, so let that be our statement. Well, the topic that follows from these should be pursued on the same basis. This concerns the manner in which the rest of the body came into being. It would be most appropriate to attribute its construction to reasoning of the following sort. The race of gods who framed us knew that we would show a lack of restraint with regard to food and drink, and would consume them greedily beyond due measure or necessity. So, to prevent our rapid destruction through diseases, and avoid the immediate demise of the still immature race of mortals, they anticipated these problems and put in place the receptacle we call the abdomen to retain the excess food and drink. They twisted the structure of the entrails around inside this so that food would not pass through so rapidly that it would immediately compel the body to need food once again, thus producing insatiable desire and rendering our entire race unphilosophic and uncultured due to gluttony, heedless of our most divine part.

ὅθεν πληρούμενος τῶν ἀποκαθαιρομένων μέγας καὶ ὕπουλος αὐξάνεται, καὶ πάλιν, ὅταν καθαρῇ τὸ σῶμα, ταπεινούμενος εἰς ταῦτόν συνίζει. τὰ μὲν οὖν περὶ ψυχῆς, ὅσον θνητὸν ἔχει καὶ ὅσον θεῖον, καὶ ὅπη καὶ μεθ' ὧν καὶ δι' ἃ χωρὶς ὠκίσθη, τὸ μὲν ἀληθὲς ὡς εἴρηται, θεοῦ

συμφήσαντος τότε ἂν οὕτως μόνως δισχυριζοίμεθα τό γε μὴν εἰκὸς ἡμῖν εἰρῆσθαι, καὶ νῦν καὶ ἔτι μᾶλλον ἀνασκοποῦσι διακινδυνευτέον τὸ φάναι καὶ πεφάσθω. τὸ δ' ἐξῆς δὴ τούτοιςιν κατὰ ταῦτά μεταδιωκτέον· ἦν δὲ τὸ τοῦ σώματος ἐπίλοιπον ἧ γέγονεν. ἐκ δὴ λογισμοῦ τοιοῦδε συνίστασθαι μάλιστ' ἂν αὐτὸ πάντων πρόποι. ΤΙ. τὴν ἐσομένην ἐν ἡμῖν ποτῶν καὶ ἐδεστῶν ἀκολασίαν ἥδεσαν οἱ συντιθέντες ἡμῶν τὸ γένος, καὶ ὅτι τοῦ μετρίου καὶ ἀναγκαίου διὰ μαργότητα πολλῶ χρησοίμεθα πλέονι· ἴν' οὖν μὴ φθορὰ διὰ νόσους ὀξεῖα γίγνοιτο καὶ ἀτελεῖς τὸ γένος εὐθύς τὸ θνητὸν τελευτῶ, ταῦτα προορώμενοι τῇ τοῦ περιγενησομένου πώματος ἐδέσματος τε ἔξει τὴν ὀνομαζομένην κάτω κοιλίαν ὑποδοχὴν ἔθεσαν, εἰλιζάν τε πέριξ τὴν τῶν ἐντέρων γένεσιν, ὅπως μὴ ταχὺ διεκπερῶσα ἡ τροφή ταχὺ πάλιν τροφῆς ἐτέρας δεῖσθαι τὸ σῶμα ἀναγκάζοι, καὶ παρέχουσα ἀπλησίαν, διὰ γαστριμαργίαν ἀφιλόσοφον καὶ ἄμουςον πᾶν ἀποτελεῖ τὸ γένος, ἀνυπήκοον τοῦ θειοτάτου τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν.

73b

T: In relation to bones, flesh and any substances of this sort, the following account applies. The origin of all these is the production of marrow, for whilst the soul is conjoined with the body, the bonds of life, bound fast in marrow, are the secure roots of the mortal race. And yet the marrow itself has come into being from other materials. For the god separated out those primary triangles that were unwarped and smooth and best able to produce fire, water, air and earth in a precise manner, and set each of these apart from their own kinds. Having mixed these with one another in due proportion, he devised a universal seed-mixture for the entire mortal race by fashioning marrow from them, and after that he planted therein the various kinds of soul and bound them fast. In his initial allocation, he divided the marrow immediately into shapes corresponding in number and type to the shapes that were to belong to the particular forms of soul. He moulded into a complete sphere the portion of marrow that was about to receive the divine seed into itself, as if it were ploughed land, and this he called the brain, implying that the head²⁷ was going to become

the container for the brain once the construction of each living creature had been completed. Furthermore, he divided the portion of marrow that was to retain the remaining part of soul, the mortal part, into shapes that were both round and elongated at the same time, and yet he referred to them all as marrow. He also cast out fetters of the entire soul from these as if they were being thrown from anchors, and then fashioned all of this body of ours around the marrow after he had constructed a complete covering of bone to surround it.

τὸ δὲ ὁστῶν καὶ σαρκῶν καὶ τῆς τοιαύτης φύσεως πέρι πάσης ὧδε ἔσχεν. τούτοις σύμπασιν ἀρχὴ μὲν ἡ τοῦ μυελοῦ γένεσις· οἱ γὰρ τοῦ βίου δεσμοί, τῆς ψυχῆς τῷ σώματι συνδουμένης, ἐν τούτῳ διαδούμενοι κατερρίζουν τὸ θνητὸν γένος· αὐτὸς δὲ ὁ μυελὸς γέγονεν ἐξ ἄλλων. τῶν γὰρ τριγώνων ὅσα πρῶτα ἀστραβῇ καὶ λεῖα ὄντα πῦρ τε καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ ἀέρα καὶ γῆν δι' ἀκριβείας μάλιστα ἦν παρασχεῖν δυνατά, ταῦτα ὁ θεὸς ἀπὸ τῶν ἑαυτῶν ἕκαστα γενῶν χωρὶς ἀποκρίνων, μειγνὺς δὲ ἀλλήλοις σύμμετρα, πανσπερμίαν παντὶ θνητῷ γένει μηχανώμενος, τὸν μυελὸν ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπηργάσατο, καὶ μετὰ ταῦτα δὴ φυτεύων ἐν αὐτῷ κατέδει ταῦ τῶν ψυχῶν γένη, σχημάτων τε ὅσα ἔμελλεν αὐτῷ σχῆσιν οἷά τε καθ' ἕκαστα εἶδη, τὸν μυελὸν αὐτὸν τοσαῦτα καὶ τοιαῦτα διηρεῖτο σχήματα εὐθύς ἐν τῇ διανομῇ τῇ κατ' ἀρχάς. καὶ τὴν μὲν τὸ θεῖον σπέρμα οἷον ἄρουραν μέλλουσαν ἔξιν ἐν αὐτῇ περιφερῇ πανταχῇ πλάσας ἐπωνόμασεν τοῦ μυελοῦ ταύτην τὴν μοῖραν ἐγκέφαλον, ὡς ἀποτελεσθέντος ἐκάστου ζώου τὸ περὶ τοῦτ' ἀγγεῖον κεφαλὴν γεννησόμενον· ὃ δ' αὖ τὸ λοιπὸν καὶ θνητὸν τῆς ψυχῆς ἔμελλε καθεξείν, ἅμα στρογγύλα καὶ προμήκη διηρεῖτο σχήματα, μυελὸν δὲ πάντα ἐπεφήμισεν, καὶ καθάπερ ἐξ ἀγκυρῶν βαλλόμενος ἐκ τούτων πάσης ψυχῆς δεσμοὺς περὶ τοῦτο σύμπαν ἤδη τὸ σῶμα ἡμῶν ἀπηργάζετο, στέγασμα μὲν αὐτῷ πρῶτον συμπηγνὺς περὶ

73e

T: He constructed bone as follows. He sifted out earth that was pure and smooth, kneaded it, soaked it in marrow, then placed it in fire, and after that he plunged it into water, again into fire, and then into water once more. So, by constantly transferring it in this way from one

medium to the other, it was rendered indissoluble by either of them. Making use of this, he turned a sphere of bone around the brain of the creature and he left a narrow opening in the sphere. He also moulded vertebrae out of bone to surround the marrow that runs through the neck and down the spine, arranging them vertically like pivots beginning from the head and running down the whole trunk. And so they preserved the entire seed by fencing it about with a stone-like enclosure, creating joints and making use of the quality of difference within these as an intermediate power, introduced for the sake of motion and flexibility.

ὅλον ὀστέινον. τὸ δὲ ὀστοῦν συνίστησιν ὧδε. γῆν διαττήσας καθαρὰν καὶ λείαν ἐφύρασε καὶ ἔδευσεν μυελῷ, καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο εἰς πῦρ αὐτὸ ἐντίθησιν, μετ' ἐκεῖνο δὲ εἰς ὕδωρ βάπτει, πάλιν δὲ εἰς πῦρ, αὐθὶς τε εἰς ὕδωρ· μεταφέρων δ' οὕτω πολλάκις εἰς ἑκάτερον ὑπ' ἀμφοῖν ἄτηκτον ἀπηργάσατο. Τί. καταχρώμενος δὴ τούτῳ περὶ μὲν τὸν ἐγκέφαλον αὐτοῦ σφαῖραν περιετόρνευσεν ὀστέϊνην, ταύτη δὲ στενὴν διέξοδον

74a

T: Furthermore, he recognised the tendency of the bony material to be more brittle and inflexible than it should be, prone to become inflamed and then cool down again, thus developing gangrene and bringing rapid destruction to the seed within. On account of these tendencies, he devised the sinews and the flesh so that sinews would bind all the limbs together and would enable the body to bend and stretch by contracting and relaxing about the pivots, while the flesh was to be a barrier against heat and a protection against cold, and against falls too, because it would yield softly and gently to objects, just like garments of felt. It also contains warm moisture within itself that breaks out in sweat, providing a coolness of its own to the entire body by moistening it on the outside in the summer. Then again, in winter it uses this same fire to provide a measure of defence against the onslaught of the prevailing frost that surrounds it. Bearing this in mind, he who shaped us mixed water, fire and earth together, harmonised them, and compounded a ferment from acid and brine

which he added to the mix, thus producing soft, succulent flesh. And he compounded the sinews from a blend of bone and unfermented flesh, a single substance with qualities intermediate between the two, to which he added a yellow colour. Hence, the sinews acquired the quality of being tighter and tougher than flesh but softer and more moist than bone. The god enclosed the bones and the marrow within these sinews, used them to bind the bones together, and then placed a covering of flesh over them all.

κατελείπετο· καὶ περὶ τὸν διαυχένιον ἅμα καὶ νωτιαῖον μυελὸν ἐξ αὐτοῦ σφονδύλους πλάσας ὑπέτεινεν οἷον στρόφιγγας, ἀρξάμενος ἀπὸ τῆς κεφαλῆς, διὰ παντὸς τοῦ κύτους. καὶ τὸ πᾶν δὴ σπέρμα διασώζων οὕτως λιθοειδεῖ περιβόλῳ συνέφραξεν, ἐμποιῶν ἄρθρα, τῇ θατέρου προσχρώμενος ἐν αὐτοῖς ὡς μέση ἐνισταμένη δυνάμει, κινήσεως καὶ κάμψεως ἔνεκα. τὴν δ' αὖ τῆς ὀστεῖνης φύσεως ἕξιν ἡγησάμενος τοῦ δέοντος κραυροτέραν εἶναι καὶ ἀκαμπτοτέραν, διάπυρόν τ' αὖ γιγνομένην καὶ πάλιν ψυχομένην σφακελίσασαν ταχὺ διαφθερεῖν τὸ σπέρμα ἐντὸς αὐτῆς, διὰ ταῦτα οὕτω τὸ τῶν νεύρων καὶ τὸ τῆς σαρκὸς γένος ἐμηχανᾶτο, ἵνα τῷ μὲν πάντα τὰ μέλη συνδήσας ἐπιτεινομένῳ καὶ ἀνιεμένῳ περὶ τοὺς στρόφιγγας καμπτόμενον τὸ σῶμα καὶ ἐκτεινόμενον παρέχοι, τὴν δὲ σάρκα προβολὴν μὲν καυμάτων, πρόβλημα δὲ χειμῶνων, ἔτι δὲ πτωμάτων οἷον τὰ πιλητὰ ἔσσεσθαι κτήματα, σώμασιν μαλακῶς καὶ πράως ὑπέικουσαν, θερμὴν δὲ νοτίδα ἐντὸς ἑαυτῆς ἔχουσαν θέρους μὲν ἀνιδίουσαν καὶ νοτιζομένην ἕξωθεν ψυχὸς κατὰ πᾶν τὸ σῶμα παρέξιν οἰκεῖον, διὰ χειμῶνος δὲ πάλιν αὐτοῦ τούτῳ τῷ πυρὶ τὸν προσφερόμενον ἕξωθεν καὶ περιστάμενον πάγον ἀμυνεῖσθαι μετρίως. ταῦτα ἡμῶν διανοηθεὶς ὁ κηροπλάστης, ὕδατι μὲν καὶ πυρὶ καὶ γῇ συμμείξας καὶ συναρμόσας, ἐξ ὀξέος καὶ ἄλμυροῦ συνθεὶς ζύμμα ὑπομείξας αὐτοῖς, σάρκα ἔγχυμον καὶ μαλακὴν συνέστησεν· τὴν δὲ τῶν νεύρων φύσιν ἐξ ὁστοῦ καὶ σαρκὸς ἀζύμου κράσεως μίαν ἐξ ἀμφοῖν μέσσην δυνάμει συνεκράσατο, ξανθῷ χρώματι προσχρώμενος. ὅθεν συντονωτέραν μὲν καὶ γλισχροτέραν σαρκῶν, μαλακωτέραν δὲ ὁστῶν ὑγροτέραν τε ἐκτίησας δύναμιν νεῦρα οἷς

συμπεριλαβὼν ὁ θεὸς ὅστ᾽ αἰ καὶ μυελόν, δῆσας πρὸς ἄλληλα νεύροις, μετὰ ταῦτα σαρξίν

74e

T: Now, whatever bones were most possessed of soul he fenced about with the least amount of flesh, while those that had least soul received most flesh, and that was extremely dense. And, indeed, he caused very little flesh to grow at the joining of the bones unless reason indicated some necessity that it be there. This was to prevent flesh from acting as an impediment to the bending of the joints, thus making the body stiff and hard to move. Furthermore, lots of dense and extremely compressed flesh would be so hard that it would make perception difficult and render the mental faculties unretentive and dull. Because of this, the thighs and shins are fully endowed with flesh, and so is the area around the hips and the region of the upper arms and forearms, any other unjointed parts of our bodies, and any internal bones that are deficient in intelligence due to the paucity of soul in their marrow. The parts possessing intelligence are less endowed, except when he somehow fashioned flesh just for the sake of perception itself, like the structure of the tongue, but in most cases it is as I have said. Indeed, the nature that arises from necessity and develops along with it does not in any way allow dense bone and lots of flesh to be simultaneous with keen sense perception. For if these two qualities were actually willing to occur simultaneously, it would be best of all for the structure of the head to possess them, so that the human race, bearing upon itself a fleshy, sinewy and strong head, could attain a life twice or many times as long as the present one, healthier too, and more free from pain.

πάντα αὐτὰ κατεσκίασεν ἄνωθεν. ὅσα μὲν οὖν ἐμψυχότατα τῶν ὁσῶν ἦν, ὀλιγίσταις συνέφραττε σαρξίν, ἃ δ' ἀψυχότατα ἐντός, πλείσταις καὶ πυκνοτάταις, καὶ δὴ κατὰ τὰς συμβολὰς τῶν ὁσῶν, ὅπη μήτινα ἀνάγκην ὁ λόγος ἀπέφαινε δεῖν αὐτὰς εἶναι, βραχεῖαν σάρκα ἔφυσεν, ἵνα μήτε ἐμποδὼν ταῖς καμπαῖσιν οὔσαι δύσφορα τὰ σώματα ἀπεργάζοιντο, ἅτε δυσκίνητα γιγνόμενα, μήτ' αὖ πολλὰ καὶ πυκνὰ σφόδρα τε ἐν ἀλλήλαις ἐμπεπλημέναι, διὰ στερεότητα ἀναισθησίαν

ἐμποιοῦσαι, δυσμνημονευτότερα καὶ κωφότερα τὰ περὶ τὴν διάνοιαν ποιοῖεν. ΤΙ. διὸ δὴ τό τε τῶν μηρῶν καὶ κνημῶν καὶ τὸ περὶ τὴν τῶν ἰσχύων φύσιν τά τε περὶ τὰ τῶν βραχιόνων ὅστ'α καὶ τὰ τῶν πῆχων, καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα ἡμῶν ἀναρθρα, ὅσα τε ἐντὸς ὅστ'α δι' ὀλιγότητα ψυχῆς ἐν μυελῷ κενά ἐστιν φρονήσεως, ταῦτα πάντα συμπεπλήρωται σαρκίν· ὅσα δὲ ἔμφρονα, ἤττον—εἰ μὴ πού τινα αὐτὴν καθ' αὐτὴν αἰσθήσεων ἕνεκα σάρκα οὕτω συνέστησεν, οἷον τὸ τῆς γλώττης εἶδος— τὰ δὲ πλεῖστα ἐκείνως· ἡ γὰρ ἐξ ἀνάγκης γιγνομένη καὶ

75b

T: But it so happened that the artificers responsible for bringing us into existence, deliberating on whether they should produce a long-lived inferior race or a short-lived superior race, decided that the shorter, better life should be chosen unreservedly for everyone, in preference to the longer and inferior life. Accordingly, they covered the head completely with thin bones, but not with flesh or with sinews either, since it does not possess any joints. So, based on all these considerations, a more perceptive, more intelligent, but much weaker head was placed upon the body of every person. For these reasons, the god situated the sinews at the base of the head in a circle around the neck and glued them on by means of uniformity, and to these he attached the extremities of the jaws under the structure of the face. The rest of the sinews he distributed among all of the limbs, connecting them together joint by joint. And indeed, those who brought order to the features of our mouth arranged it as it now is, fitting it with teeth, a tongue and lips for the sake of all that is necessary and all that is most exalted, thus devising an inward passage with a view to the necessary, and outward passage with a view to the most exalted. Indeed, all that passes in bringing nourishment to the body is necessary, while the stream of words flowing outwards in the service of understanding is the most beautiful and exalted of all streams.

συντρεφομένη φύσις οὐδαμῇ προσδέχεται πυκνὸν ὄστουν καὶ σάρκα πολλὴν ἅμα τε αὐτοῖς ὀξυήκοον αἴσθησιν. μάλιστα γὰρ ἂν αὐτὰ πάντων

ἔσχεν ἡ περὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν σύστασις, εἴπερ ἅμα συμπίπτειν ἠθελήσατῃν, καὶ τὸ τῶν ἀνθρώπων γένος σαρκώδη ἔχον ἐφ' ἑαυτῷ καὶ νευρώδη κρατερὰν τε κεφαλὴν βίον ἂν διπλοῦν καὶ πολλαπλοῦν καὶ ὑγιεινότερον καὶ ἀλυπότερον τοῦ νῦν κατεκτῆσατο. νῦν δὲ τοῖς περὶ τὴν ἡμετέραν γένεσιν δημιουργοῖς, ἀναλογιζομένοις πότερον πολυχρονιώτερον χεῖρον ἢ βραχυχρονιώτερον βέλτιον ἀπεργάσαιτο γένος, συνέδοξεν τοῦ πλείονος βίου, φαυλοτέρου δέ, τὸν ἐλάττονα ἀμείνονα ὄντα παντὶ πάντως αἰρετέον· ὅθεν δὴ μανῶ μὲν ὅστῳ, σαρξὶν δὲ καὶ νεύροις κεφαλὴν, ἅτε οὐδὲ καμπὰς ἔχουσιν, οὐ συνεστέγασαν. κατὰ πάντα οὖν ταῦτα εὐαίσθητοτέρα μὲν καὶ φρονιμωτέρα, πολὺ δὲ ἀσθενεστέρα παντὸς ἀνδρὸς προσετέθη κεφαλὴ σώματι. τὰ δὲ νεῦρα διὰ

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T: Furthermore, due to the excesses of the various seasons, it was not possible to leave the head only as bare bone, or, on the other hand, to let it become dull and unperceptive because it was overborne by a mass of flesh. So, from the fleshy material that was not dried up, an excessively loose film was separated out which we now refer to as skin. Because of the moisture around the brain, this skin combined with itself, grew in a circle and completely enveloped the head. Then the moisture emerging from the sutures watered it and closed it in at the crown, drawing it all together into a kind of knot, and the structure of these sutures became variegated due to the effect of the inner orbits and of the nutriment; the greater the conflict between the two orbits, the more sutures there were, the lesser the conflict, the fewer the sutures.

ταῦτα καὶ οὕτως ὁ θεὸς ἐπ' ἐσχάτην τὴν κεφαλὴν περιστήσας κύκλῳ περὶ τὸν τράχηλον ἐκόλλησεν ὁμοιότητι, καὶ τὰς σιαγόνας ἄκρας αὐτοῖς συνέδησεν ὑπὸ τὴν φύσιν τοῦ προσώπου· τὰ δ' ἄλλα εἰς ἅπαντα τὰ μέλη διέσπειρε, συνάπτων ἄρθρον ἄρθρῳ. τὴν δὲ δὴ τοῦ στόματος ἡμῶν δύναμιν ὁδοῦσιν καὶ γλώττῃ καὶ χεῖλεσιν ἔνεκα τῶν ἀναγκαίων καὶ τῶν ἀρίστων διεκόσμησεν οἱ διακοσμοῦντες ἧ νῦν διατέτακται, τὴν μὲν εἴσοδον τῶν ἀναγκαίων μηχανώμενοι χάριν, τὴν δ' ἔξοδον τῶν

ἀρίστων· ἀναγκαῖον μὲν γὰρ πᾶν ὅσον εἰσέρχεται τροφήν διδόν τῷ σώματι, τὸ δὲ λόγων νᾶμα ἔξω ῥέον καὶ ὑπηρετοῦν φρονήσει κάλλιστον καὶ ἄριστον πάντων ναμάτων. ΤΙ. τὴν δ' αὖ κεφαλὴν οὔτε μόνον ὁστεΐνην ψιλὴν δυνατὸν ἔαν ἦν διὰ τὴν ἐν ταῖς ὥραις ἐφ' ἐκάτερον ὑπερβολὴν, οὔτ' αὖ συσκιασθεῖσαν κωφὴν καὶ ἀναίσθητον διὰ τὸν τῶν σαρκῶν ὄχλον περιδεῖν γιγνομένην· τῆς δὲ σαρκοειδοῦς φύσεως οὐ καταξηρανομένης λέμμα μείζον περιγιγνόμενον ἐχωρίζετο, δέρμα τὸ νῦν λεγόμενον. τοῦτο δὲ διὰ τὴν περὶ τὸν ἐγκέφαλον νοτίδα συνιὸν αὐτὸ πρὸς αὐτὸ καὶ βλαστάνον κύκλῳ περιημφιέννυνεν τὴν κεφαλὴν· ἡ δὲ νοτις ὑπὸ τὰς ῥαφὰς ἀνιούσα ἦρδε καὶ συνέκλεισεν αὐτὸ ἐπὶ τὴν κορυφὴν, οἷον ἄμμα συναγαγοῦσα, τὸ δὲ τῶν ῥαφῶν παντοδαπὸν εἶδος γέγονε διὰ τὴν τῶν περιόδων δύναμιν καὶ τῆς τροφῆς, μᾶλλον μὲν ἀλλήλοις μαχομένων τούτων πλείους,

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T: Now, the divine part²⁸ pierced this skin all around, and once it had been perforated, any pure moisture and pure heat in the liquid that emerged from it evaporated, while the mixed substance that the skin was also made from rose up on account of the movement, and stretched out at some length. It was as fine as the tiny piercings, yet because it was slow moving it was pushed back under the skin again by the external air that surrounded it, coiled around itself, and took root. So the hair grew on the skin due to these effects, kindred thereto because it was fibrous, yet harder and more dense due to the solidification that derived from the cooling process which cooled and compressed each hair as it separated from the skin. With this, our maker made the head woolly by making use of the factors we have described, intending that hair, rather than flesh, should be the cover for the area around the brain to ensure its safety, still providing sufficient shade in summer and shelter in winter without becoming an impediment that would prevent proper perception.

ἦττον δὲ ἐλάττους. τοῦτο δὲ πᾶν τὸ δέρμα κύκλῳ κατεκέντει πυρὶ τὸ θεῖον, τρηθέντος δὲ καὶ τῆς ἱκμάδος ἔξω δι' αὐτοῦ φερομένης τὸ μὲν ὑγρὸν καὶ θερμὸν ὅσον εἰλικρινὲς ἀπῆειν, τὸ δὲ μεικτὸν ἐξ ὧν καὶ τὸ

δέρμα ἦν, αἰρόμενον μὲν ὑπὸ τῆς φορᾶς ἔξω μακρὸν ἐτείνετο, λεπτότητα ἴσην ἔχον τῷ κατακεντήματι, διὰ δὲ βραδυτήτα ἀπωθούμενον ὑπὸ τοῦ περιστώτος ἔξωθεν πνεύματος πάλιν ἐντὸς ὑπὸ τὸ δέρμα εἰλλόμενον κατερριζοῦτο· καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα δὴ τὰ πάθη τὸ τριχῶν γένος ἐν τῷ δέρματι πέφυκεν, συγγενὲς μὲν ἱμαντῶδες ὃν αὐτοῦ, σκληρότερον δὲ καὶ πυκνότερον τῇ πιλήσει τῆς ψύξεως, ἦν ἀποχωριζομένη δέρματος ἐκάστη θριξ ψυχθεῖσα συνεπιλήθη. τούτῳ δὴ λασίαν ἡμῶν ἀπηργάσατο τὴν κεφαλὴν ὁ ποιῶν, χρώμενος μὲν αἰτίοις τοῖς εἰρημένοις, διανοούμενος δὲ ἀντὶ σαρκὸς αὐτὸ δεῖν εἶναι στέγασμα τῆς

76d

T: From the combination of sinew, skin and bone, dried out to form a single substance from all three, a hard skin developed, twined around the end of the fingers. Although it was produced by these three subsidiary causes, it was wrought nevertheless by an ultimate intentional cause with a view to subsequent generations, for those who framed us knew that at some stage women and the beasts would arise from men, and they also understood that many of the animals would require the use of claws or talons for numerous purposes. Therefore, as soon as humans came into existence, they gave them traces of the structure of claws. So, based on this reasoning, and with these motives, they caused skin, hair and nails to grow at the extremities of the limbs.

περὶ τὸν ἐγκέφαλον ἔνεκα ἀσφαλείας κοῦφον καὶ θέρους χειμῶνός τε ἱκανὸν σκιὰν καὶ σκέπην παρέχειν, εὐαισθησίας δὲ οὐδὲν διακώλυμα ἐμποδὼν γενησόμενον. τὸ δ' ἐν τῇ περὶ τοὺς δακτύλους καταπλοκῇ τοῦ νεύρου καὶ τοῦ δέρματος ὁστοῦ τε, συμμειχθὲν ἐκ τριῶν, ἀποξηρανθὲν ἐν κοινὸν συμπάντων σκληρὸν γέγονεν δέρμα, τοῖς μὲν συναιτίοις τούτοις δημιουργηθέν, τῇ δὲ αἰτιωτάτῃ διανοίᾳ τῶν ἔπειτα ἐσομένων ἔνεκα εἰργασμένον. ὥς γάρ ποτε ἐξ ἀνδρῶν γυναῖκες καὶ τᾶλλα θηρία γενήσονται, ἠπίσταντο οἱ συνιστάντες ἡμᾶς, καὶ δὴ καὶ τῆς τῶν ὀνύχων χρείας ὅτι πολλὰ τῶν θρεμμάτων καὶ ἐπὶ πολλὰ δεήσοιτο ἥδεσαν, ὅθεν ἐν ἀνθρώποις εὐθὺς γιγνομένοις ὑπετυπώσαντο τὴν τῶν ὀνύχων γένεσιν. τούτῳ δὴ τῷ λόγῳ καὶ ταῖς προφάσεσιν ταύταις δέρμα τρίχας

ὄνυχάς τε ἐπ' ἄκροις τοῖς κώλοις ἔφυσαν. ΤΙ. ἐπειδὴ δὲ πάντ' ἦν τὰ τοῦ θνητοῦ ζώου συμπεφυκότα

77a

T: Once all the parts and limbs of the mortal creature had developed into a natural unity, and it proved necessary for such creatures to spend their lives exposed to wind and fire, be wasted and depleted by these and perish as a result, the gods devised a means of helping them. By mixing various characteristics and kinds of perception, they brought about the development of a nature akin to human nature, a living being of a different sort. These are the domesticated trees, plants and seeds that have been trained by husbandry into the cultivated forms that we possess. Before that, there were only the uncultivated forms which are older than our cultivated varieties. Indeed, anything that partakes of life may justifiably and correctly be described as a living being,²⁹ yet that which we are speaking of now partakes of the third form of soul, the form that our account situated between the midriff and the navel, the form that has no involvement with opinion, reasoning or nous, but only with pleasant and painful sensations and their accompanying desires. For it is always completely passive, and its origin has not given it the natural ability to reflect upon and discern any aspects of itself by turning inwards, being concerned with itself, shunning external motion and having recourse to its own motion. So it is alive, and although it is a living creature it is stationary, rooted to the spot, stuck because it is bereft of motion of its own.

μέρη καὶ μέλη, τὴν δὲ ζωὴν ἐν πυρὶ καὶ πνεύματι συνέβαινεν ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἔχειν αὐτῷ, καὶ διὰ ταῦτα ὑπὸ τούτων τηκόμενον κενούμενόν τ' ἔφθινεν, βοήθειαν αὐτῷ θεοὶ μηχανῶνται. τῆς γὰρ ἀνθρωπίνης συγγενῇ φύσεως φύσιν ἄλλαις ιδέαις καὶ αἰσθήσεσιν κεραννύντες, ὥσθ' ἕτερον ζῶον εἶναι, φυτεύουσιν· ἃ δὴ νῦν ἡμερὰ δένδρα καὶ φυτὰ καὶ σπέρματα παιδευθέντα ὑπὸ γεωργίας τιθαῶς πρὸς ἡμᾶς ἔσχεν, πρὶν δὲ ἦν μόνα τὰ τῶν ἀγρίων γένη, πρεσβύτερα τῶν ἡμέρων ὄντα. πᾶν γὰρ οὗν ὅτιπερ ἂν μετὰσχη τοῦ ζῆν, ζῶον μὲν ἂν ἐν δίκη λέγοιτο ὀρθότατα· μετέχει γε μὴν τοῦτο ὃ νῦν λέγομεν τοῦ τρίτου ψυχῆς

εἶδους, ὃ μεταξὺ φρενῶν ὀμφαλοῦ τε ἰδρῦσθαι λόγος, ᾧ δόξης μὲν λογισμοῦ τε καὶ νοῦ μέτεστιν τὸ μηδέν, αἰσθήσεως δὲ ἡδεΐας καὶ ἀλγεινῆς μετὰ ἐπιθυμιῶν. πάσχον γὰρ διατελεῖ πάντα, στραφέντι δ' αὐτῷ ἐν ἑαυτῷ περὶ ἑαυτό, τήν

77c

T: Now, once the superior beings had caused everything of this sort to grow as nutriment for us lesser creatures, they made conduits through the body itself, as if they were cutting channels in gardens, so that it would be watered by a sort of incoming stream. In the first place, seeing that the body has a twofold structure with a left side and right side, they cut two veins along the back to act as channels hidden beneath the conjunction of the skin with the flesh. They also brought these down along the spine, enclosing the reproductive marrow between them so that this would flourish to the greatest extent possible, and so that the influx of liquid that flowed so easily from there because of the downward course would provide uniform irrigation to the other regions. Then, having split apart the veins around the head, they intertwined them and sent them in opposite directions, so that those on the left were bent to the right side of the body, those on the right, to the left. This, along with the skin, was to act as a bond between the head and the body since there were no sinews all around the crown of the head. What's more, it would also enable the experience of the sense impressions coming from either of the two sides to be fully revealed to the entire body.

μὲν ἔξωθεν ἀπωσαμένῳ κίνησιν, τῇ δ' οἰκείᾳ χρησαμένῳ, τῶν αὐτοῦ τι λογίσασθαι κατιδόντι φύσει οὐ παραδέδωκεν ἡ γένεσις. διὸ δὴ ζῆ μὲν ἔστιν τε οὐχ ἕτερον ζῶου, μόνιμον δὲ καὶ κατερριζωμένον πέπηγεν διὰ τὸ τῆς ὑφ' ἑαυτοῦ κινήσεως ἑστερῆσθαι. ταῦτα δὴ τὰ γένη πάντα φυτεύσαντες οἱ κρείττους τοῖς ἥττοσιν ἡμῖν τροφήν, τὸ σῶμα αὐτὸ ἡμῶν διωχέτευσαν τέμνοντες οἷον ἐν κήποις ὀχετούς, ἵνα ὥσπερ ἐκ νάματος ἐπιόντος ἄρδοιτο. καὶ πρῶτον μὲν ὀχετούς κρυφαίους ὑπὸ τὴν σύμφυσιν τοῦ δέρματος καὶ τῆς σαρκὸς δύο φλέβας ἔτεμον νωτιαίας, δίδυμον ὡς τὸ σῶμα ἐτύγχανεν δεξιῶς τε καὶ ἀριστεροῖς ὄν· ταύτας δὲ

καθῆκαν παρὰ τὴν ῥάχιν, καὶ τὸν γόνιμον μεταξὺ λαβόντες μυελόν, ἵνα οὗτός τε ὅτι μάλιστα θάλλοι, καὶ ἐπὶ τᾶλλα εὖρους ἐντεῦθεν ἄτε ἐπὶ κάταντες ἢ ἐπίχυσις γιγνομένη παρέχοι τὴν ὑδρεῖαν ὁμαλήν. μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα σχίσαντες περὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν τὰς φλέβας καὶ δι'

77e

T: At that stage they facilitated the transport of liquid in the manner we shall now describe, but it will be easier to see this once we have first come to an agreement on the following point. Anything composed of smaller particles repels the larger particles, while those composed of larger particles are unable to repel the smaller particles. Fire consists of the smallest particles of them all, so it passes through water, earth, air, and anything composed of these, and nothing is able to repel it. Well, we should bear the same principle in mind in relation to our own abdomen; it retains any food or drink that falls into it, yet it is unable to retain air or fire because these consist of particles that are smaller than its own structure. Therefore, the god made use of air and fire for the distribution of moisture from the abdomen to the veins by weaving a mesh, like a fish trap, having two ducts at its entrance, one of which he proceeded to weave once more into a forked structure. Then he extended cords of some sort from the ducts in a circle throughout the entire mesh as far as its extremities. He constructed everything within the mesh from fire; the ducts and the vessel he constructed from air.

ἀλλήλων ἐναντίας πλέξαντες διεῖσαν, τὰς μὲν ἐκ τῶν δεξιῶν ἐπὶ τὰριστερὰ τοῦ σώματος, τὰς δ' ἐκ τῶν ἀριστερῶν ἐπὶ τὰ δεξιὰ κλίναντες, ὅπως δεσμός ἅμα τῇ κεφαλῇ πρὸς τὸ σῶμα εἴη μετὰ τοῦ δέρματος, ἐπειδὴ νεύροις οὐκ ἦν κύκλω κατὰ κορυφὴν περιειλημμένη, καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ τῶν αἰσθήσεων πάθος ἴν' ἀφ' ἐκατέρων τῶν μερῶν εἰς ἅπαν τὸ σῶμα εἴη διάδηλον. TI. τὸ δ' ἐντεῦθεν ἤδη τὴν ὑδραγωγίαν παρεσκεύασαν τρόπῳ τινὶ τοιῷδε, ὃν κατοψόμεθα ῥᾶον προδιομολογησάμενοι τὸ τοιόνδε, ὅτι πάντα ὅσα ἐξ ἐλαττόνων συνίσταται στέγει τὰ μείζω, τὰ δὲ ἐκ μειζόνων τὰ σμικρότερα οὐ δύναται, πῦρ δὲ πάντων γενῶν σμικρομερέστατον, ὅθεν δι' ὕδατος καὶ

γῆς ἀέρος τε καὶ ὅσα ἐκ τούτων συνίσταται διαχωρεῖ καὶ στέγειν οὐδὲν αὐτὸ δύναται. ταῦτὸν δὴ καὶ περὶ τῆς παρ' ἡμῖν κοιλίας διανοητέον, ὅτι σιτία μὲν καὶ ποτὰ ὅταν εἰς αὐτὴν ἐμπέσῃ, στέγει, πνεῦμα δὲ καὶ πῦρ σμικρομερέστερα ὄντα τῆς αὐτῆς συστάσεως οὐ δύναται. τούτοις οὖν κατεχρήσατο ὁ θεὸς εἰς τὴν ἐκ τῆς κοιλίας ἐπὶ τὰς φλέβας ὑδρεῖαν, πλέγμα ἐξ ἀέρος καὶ πυρὸς οἷον οἱ κύρτοι συνυφηνάμενος, διπλᾶ κατὰ τὴν εἴσοδον ἐγκύρτια ἔχον, ὧν θάτερον αὖ πάλιν διέπλεξεν δίκρουν· καὶ ἀπὸ τῶν ἐγκυρτίων δὴ διετείνετο οἷον σχοίνους κύκλῳ διὰ παντὸς πρὸς τὰ ἔσχατα τοῦ πλέγματος. τὰ μὲν

78c

T: He then took this structure and positioned it around the creature he had fashioned, in some such manner as follows. He let the part consisting of funnels down into the mouth, and since it had a twofold structure, he lowered one part into the lungs by way of the windpipe, and the other alongside the windpipe into the abdomen. He divided the first of these in two and gave each part alike an entrance through the channels of the nose, so that when the other channel through the mouth was not working, all of its streams would be filled up from this one. He caused the rest of the vessel that constitutes the fish trap to grow around the hollow part of the body and made it all flow together gently into the ducts, since these were made of air. And then he made the ducts flow back out again. Because the body is porous, the mesh sinks into it and emerges once more, while the rays of fire bound fast within it follow both movements of the air, and this does not cease as long as the mortal creature holds together. And we say that the name-giver has called it inhalation and exhalation. And indeed, the overall process and its effect acts as a source of nourishment and life to our bodies by irrigating and cooling them. For whenever the breath passes in or out, the inner fire connected to it follows along, and as it continually moves back and forth it passes into the abdomen, seizes upon the food and drink, dissolves them, divides them into tiny particles, draws them through the passages in the same direction it is proceeding, pours them into the veins like water going from a spring

into channels, and sets the currents of the veins flowing through the body as if they were flowing through a pipe.

οὖν ἔνδον ἐκ πυρὸς συνεστήσατο τοῦ πλοκάνου ἅπαντα, τὰ δ' ἐγκύρτια καὶ τὸ κύτος ἀεροειδῆ, καὶ λαβὼν αὐτὸ περιέστησεν τῷ πλασθέντι ζῳῷ τρόπον τοιόνδε. τὸ μὲν τῶν ἐγκυρτίων εἰς τὸ στόμα μεθῆκεν· διπλοῦ δὲ ὄντος αὐτοῦ κατὰ μὲν τὰς ἀρτηρίας εἰς τὸν πλεύμονα καθῆκεν θάτερον, τὸ δ' εἰς τὴν κοιλίαν παρὰ τὰς ἀρτηρίας· τὸ δ' ἕτερον σχίσας τὸ μέρος ἐκάτερον κατὰ τοὺς ὀχετοὺς τῆς ῥινὸς ἀφῆκεν κοινόν, ὥσθ' ὅτε μὴ κατὰ στόμα ἴοι θάτερον, ἐκ τούτου πάντα καὶ τὰ ἐκείνου ρεύματα ἀναπληροῦσθαι. τὸ δὲ ἄλλο κύτος τοῦ κύρτου περὶ τὸ σῶμα ὅσον κοῖλον ἡμῶν περιέφυσεν, καὶ πᾶν δὴ τοῦτο τοτὲ μὲν εἰς τὰ ἐγκύρτια συρρεῖν μαλακῶς, ἅτε ἀέρα ὄντα, ἐποίησεν, τοτὲ δὲ ἀναρρεῖν μὲν τὰ ἐγκύρτια, τὸ δὲ πλέγμα, ὡς ὄντος τοῦ σώματος μανοῦ, δύεσθαι εἴσω δι' αὐτοῦ καὶ πάλιν ἔξω, τὰς δὲ ἐντὸς τοῦ πυρὸς ἀκτῖνας διαδεδεμένας ἀκολουθεῖν ἐφ' ἐκάτερα ἰόντος τοῦ ἀέρος, καὶ τοῦτο, ἕωσπερ ἂν τὸ θνητὸν συνεστήκη ζῶον, μὴ διαπαύεσθαι γιγνόμενον· τούτῳ δὲ δὴ τῷ γένει τὸν τὰς ἐπωνυμίας θέμενον ἀναπνοὴν καὶ ἐκπνοὴν λέγομεν θέσθαι τοῦνομα. πᾶν δὲ δὴ τό τ' ἔργον καὶ τὸ πάθος τοῦθ' ἡμῶν τῷ σώματι γέγονεν ἀρδομένῳ καὶ ἀναψυχομένῳ τρέφεσθαι καὶ ζῆν· ΤΙ. ὁπόταν γὰρ εἴσω καὶ ἔξω τῆς ἀναπνοῆς ἰούσης τὸ πῦρ ἐντὸς συνημμένον ἔπηται, διαιωρούμενον δὲ αἰεὶ διὰ τῆς κοιλίας εἰσελθὼν τὰ

79a

T: But we should look again at the process of respiration and the reason why this occurs as it now does. It is as follows. Since there is no void into which any moving body would be able to enter, yet the breath does come out of our body, one consequence is surely evident to everyone. It does not emerge into a void but displaces whatever is adjacent from its position. But whatever is displaced continually drives out whatever is adjacent to itself, and on the basis of this cycle of necessity, everything is driven around again to the position from which the breath emerged, enters in, and fills it. Because there is no void, this all happens at the same time, like the revolving of a wheel. Therefore, once the chest and lungs exhale the breath, they are filled

up once more by the air surrounding the body which is driven around and sinks in because the flesh is so soft. Then again, when the air is turned in the other direction and is coming out through the body, it pushes the breath around and inwards by way of the passage of the mouth and the nostrils.

σιτία καὶ ποτὰ λάβῃ, τήκει δὴ, καὶ κατὰ σμικρὰ διαιροῦν, διὰ τῶν ἐξόδων ἥπερ πορεύεται διάγον, οἶον ἐκ κρήνης ἐπ' ὀχετοὺς ἐπὶ τὰς φλέβας ἀντλοῦν αὐτά, ῥεῖν ὥσπερ αὐλῶνος διὰ τοῦ σώματος τὰ τῶν φλεβῶν ποιεῖ ῥεύματα. πάλιν δὲ τὸ τῆς ἀναπνοῆς ἴδωμεν πάθος, αἷς χρώμενον αἰτίαις τοιοῦτον γέγονεν οἷόνπερ τὰ νῦν ἐστιν. ὧδ' οὖν. ἐπειδὴ κενὸν οὐδέν ἐστιν εἰς ὃ τῶν φερομένων δύναιτ' ἂν εἰσελθεῖν τι, τὸ δὲ πνεῦμα φέρεται παρ' ἡμῶν ἔξω, τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο ἤδη παντὶ δῆλον ὡς οὐκ εἰς κενόν, ἀλλὰ τὸ πλησίον ἐκ τῆς ἔδρας ὠθεῖ· τὸ δ' ὠθούμενον ἐξελαύνει τὸ πλησίον αἰεῖ, καὶ κατὰ ταύτην τὴν ἀνάγκην πᾶν περιελαυνόμενον εἰς τὴν ἔδραν ὅθεν ἐξῆλθεν τὸ πνεῦμα, εἰσὶν ἐκεῖσε καὶ ἀναπληροῦν αὐτὴν συνέπεται τῷ πνεύματι, καὶ τοῦτο ἅμα πᾶν οἶον τροχοῦ περιαγομένου γίγνεται διὰ τὸ κενὸν μηδὲν εἶναι. διὸ δὴ τὸ τῶν στηθῶν καὶ τὸ τοῦ πλευμονος ἔξω μεθιέν τὸ πνεῦμα πάλιν ὑπὸ τοῦ περὶ τὸ σῶμα ἀέρος, εἴσω διὰ μανῶν τῶν σαρκῶν δυομένου καὶ περιελαυνόμενου, γίγνεται πλήρες· αὐθις δὲ ἀποτρεπόμενος ὁ ἀήρ καὶ διὰ τοῦ σώματος ἔξω ἰὼν εἴσω τὴν ἀναπνοὴν περιωθεῖ κατὰ τὴν τοῦ στόματος καὶ τὴν τῶν μυκτῆρων δίοδον. τὴν δ' αἰτίαν τῆς ἀρχῆς αὐτῶν θετέον

79d

T: We should presume that what is responsible for initiating these processes is this. In every living creature, the warmest of its internal parts are situated close to the blood and the veins which are like a fountain of fire residing within. This, of course, we likened to the mesh of the fish-trap, extending through the middle thereof and woven entirely from fire, while everything outside of that was made of air. Now we must accept that heat naturally proceeds outwards to its own region and towards its kindred. But there are two ways out, one emerging by way of the body, the other by way of the mouth and

nostrils, so whenever it rushes one way it pushes the air around the other way, and when this is pushed around and falls into the fire it is warmed, but when it travels outwards it is cooled. Now, when the heat is changing its location and the air currents proceeding by one of the exits become warmer, the warmer air tends to go back by way of that exit once more and travels towards its own kind, pushing the air using the other exit and driving it around. The same effect and the same response keep recurring, thus setting up a cycle that oscillates back and forth and brings about inhalation and exhalation.

τήνδε. πᾶν ζῶον αὐτοῦ τάντος περὶ τὸ αἷμα καὶ τὰς φλέβας θερμότατα ἔχει, οἷον ἐν ἑαυτῷ πηγὴν τινα ἐνοῦσαν πυρός· ὃ δὴ καὶ προσηκάζομεν τῷ τοῦ κύρτου πλέγματι, κατὰ μέσον διατεταμένον ἐκ πυρὸς πεπλέχθαι πᾶν, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα ὅσα ἔξωθεν, ἀέρος. τὸ θερμὸν δὴ κατὰ φύσιν εἰς τὴν αὐτοῦ χώραν ἔξω πρὸς τὸ συγγενὲς ὁμολογητέον ἵεναι· δυοῖν δὲ τοῖν διεξόδοιν οὔσαι, τῆς μὲν κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἔξω, τῆς δὲ αὖ κατὰ τὸ στόμα καὶ τὰς ῥίνας, ὅταν μὲν ἐπὶ θάτερα ὀρμήσῃ, θάτερα περιωθεῖ, τὸ δὲ περιωσθὲν εἰς τὸ πῦρ ἐμπίπτον θερμαίνεται, τὸ δ' ἐξίον ψύχεται. μεταβαλλούσης δὲ τῆς θερμότητος καὶ τῶν κατὰ τὴν ἐτέραν ἔξοδον θερμότερων γιγνομένων πάλιν ἐκείνῃ ῥέπον αὖ τὸ θερμότερον μᾶλλον, πρὸς τὴν αὐτοῦ φύσιν φερόμενον, περιωθεῖ τὸ κατὰ θάτερα· τὸ δὲ τὰ αὐτὰ πᾶσχον καὶ τὰ αὐτὰ ἀνταποδιδὸν αἰεὶ, κύκλον οὕτω σαλευόμενον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα ἀπειργασμένον ὑπ' ἀμφοτέρων τὴν ἀναπνοὴν καὶ ἐκπνοὴν γίγνεσθαι παρέχεται. ΤΙ. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ τῶν περὶ τὰς ἱατρικὰς σικύας παθημάτων

80a

T: What's more, this is how we should also go about explaining the effects of medical cupping instruments, the causes of swallowing, and the behaviour of projectiles that are discharged into the air and those that travel along the ground, also any sounds that are rapid or slow, and therefore appear sharp or dull, sometimes discordant in their movement due to the lack of uniformity of the motion they produce in us, sometimes concordant due to its uniformity. Indeed, the slower motions overtake the more rapid motions that precede them, as the

rapid motions are coming to a halt and have already attained uniformity with those which the slower motions impart to them when they arrive later. As the slower overtake the quicker, they do not impose another motion and cause disturbance. Rather, they initiate a slower motion based upon the faster motion which is dying away, introducing uniformity and blending together a single experience consisting of sharpness and dullness. Consequently, while these provide some pleasure to the dimwitted, they delight the enlightened folk because they provide an imitation of divine harmony arising amidst the movements of mortal beings. And consider, in particular, all the flowings of water, the descent of thunderbolts and the wondrous drawing power of amber and lodestones. In none of these cases is there any attractive force. Rather, it will be evident to anyone who investigates them methodically that there is no void, that these entities push themselves around into one another, and while they are all being divided up and combined together, each changes its position and moves towards its own region, and by interweaving these processes with one another we get those wonderful phenomena.

αἴτια καὶ τὰ τῆς καταπόσεως τὰ τε τῶν ῥιπτουμένων, ὅσα ἀφεθέντα μετέωρα καὶ ὅσα ἐπὶ γῆς φέρεται, ταύτη διωκτέον, καὶ ὅσοι φθόγγοι ταχεῖς τε καὶ βραδεῖς ὀξεῖς τε καὶ βαρεῖς φαίνονται, τοτὲ μὲν ἀνάρμοστοι φερόμενοι δι' ἀνομοιότητα τῆς ἐν ἡμῖν ὑπ' αὐτῶν κινήσεως, τοτὲ δὲ σύμφωνοι δι' ὁμοιότητα. τὰς γὰρ τῶν προτέρων καὶ θαττόνων οἱ βραδύτεροι κινήσεις ἀποπαυομένας ἤδη τε εἰς ὅμοιον ἐληλυθυίας, αἷς ὕστερον αὐτοὶ προσφερόμενοι κινουῖσιν ἐκείνας, καταλαμβάνουσιν, καταλαμβάνοντες δὲ οὐκ ἄλλην ἐπεμβάλλοντες ἀνετάραξαν κίνησιν, ἀλλ' ἀρχὴν βραδυτέρας φορᾶς κατὰ τὴν τῆς θάττονος, ἀπολιγούσης δέ, ὁμοιότητα προσάψαντες, μίαν ἐξ ὀξείας καὶ βαρείας συνεκεράσαντο πάθην· ὅθεν ἡδονὴν μὲν τοῖς ἄφροσιν, εὐφροσύνην δὲ τοῖς ἔμφροσιν διὰ τὴν τῆς θείας ἀρμονίας μίμησιν ἐν θνηταῖς γενομένην φοραῖς παρέσχον. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ τῶν ὑδάτων πάντα ῥεύματα, ἔτι δὲ τὰ τῶν κεραυνῶν πτώματα καὶ τὰ θαυμαζόμενα ἠλέκτρων περὶ τῆς ἔλξεως καὶ τῶν Ἡρακλείων λίθων, πάντων τούτων

ὅληκῃ μὲν οὐκ ἔστιν οὐδενί ποτε, τὸ δὲ κενὸν εἶναι μηδὲν περιωθεῖν τε αὐτὰ ταῦτα εἰς ἄλληλα, τό τε διακρινόμενα καὶ συγκρινόμενα πρὸς τὴν αὐτῶν διαμειβόμενα ἔδραν ἕκαστα ἰέναι πάντα, τούτοις τοῖς παθήμασιν πρὸς ἄλληλα συμπλεχθεῖσιν τεθυματουργημένα τῷ κατὰ τρόπον ζητοῦντι φανήσεται.

80d

T: As for the effect of respiration from which our account digressed, this has arisen on the basis of these principles and through those processes. As the fire cuts up the food by rising up inside us, following along with the breath, it fills up the veins from the abdomen by the rising process which floods them with the minute particles from there. And so it is that the streams of nutriment have been set flowing throughout the whole body of every creature. The newly formed particles come from kindred substances, from fruits and vegetables, which the god caused to grow for our particular benefit to nourish us. These have taken on a variety of colours due to the commingling, yet the colour red is predominant throughout, a quality brought about by the cutting effect of fire and the impression it makes on liquid. Hence, the stream flowing through the body, the one we call blood, has the colour we have described. It is pasture for flesh and for the entire body, and each part draws liquid from there and replenishes any place that has been depleted. The process of replenishment and depletion takes place in the same way that the motion of everything in the Universe takes place, a motion that draws everything towards its own kindred. Of course, our external surroundings continually cut us up and break us apart, dispatching each form towards its own kind, while the contents of the blood, for their part, having been cut up inside us into small pieces and being surrounded by the structure of each creature as though by an enveloping Heaven, are compelled to imitate the universal motion. So each of the particles within the blood, being borne towards its kindred, replenishes once more the space that has been left empty.

καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ τῆς ἀναπνοῆς, ὅθεν ὁ λόγος ὥρμησεν, κατὰ ταῦτα καὶ διὰ τούτων γέγονεν, ὥσπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν εἴρηται, τέμνοντος μὲν τὰ σιτία τοῦ πυρός, αἰωρουμένου δὲ ἐντὸς τῷ πνεύματι συνεπομένου, τὰς φλέβας τε ἐκ τῆς κοιλίας τῇ συναιωρήσει πληροῦντος τῷ τὰ τετμημένα αὐτόθεν ἐπαντλεῖν· καὶ διὰ ταῦτα δὴ καθ' ὅλον τὸ σῶμα πᾶσιν τοῖς ζώοις τὰ τῆς τροφῆς νάματα οὕτως ἐπίρρυτα γέγονεν. νεότμητα δὲ καὶ ἀπὸ συγγενῶν ὄντα, τὰ μὲν καρπῶν, τὰ δὲ χλόης, ἃ θεὸς ἐπ' αὐτὸ τοῦθ' ἡμῖν ἐφύτευσεν, εἶναι τροφήν, παντοδαπὰ μὲν χρώματα ἴσχει διὰ τὴν σύμμιξιν, ἡ δ' ἐρυθρὰ πλείστη περὶ αὐτὰ χροὰ διαθεῖ, τῆς τοῦ πυρὸς τομῆς τε καὶ ἐξομόρξεως ἐν ὑγρῷ δεδημιουργημένη φύσις. ΤΙ. ὅθεν τοῦ κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ῥέοντος τὸ χρῶμα ἔσχεν οἶαν ὄψιν διεληλύθαμεν ὁ καλοῦμεν αἷμα, νομὴν σαρκῶν καὶ σύμπαντος τοῦ σώματος, ὅθεν ὑδρευόμενα ἕκαστα πληροῖ τὴν τοῦ κενουμένου βάσιν· ὁ δὲ τρόπος τῆς πληρώσεως ἀποχωρήσεώς τε γίγνεται καθάπερ ἐν τῷ παντὶ παντὸς ἡ φορὰ γέγονεν, ἣν τὸ συγγενὲς πᾶν φέρεται πρὸς ἑαυτό. τὰ μὲν γὰρ δὴ περιστῶτα ἐκτὸς ἡμᾶς τήκει τε αἰεὶ καὶ διανέμει πρὸς ἕκαστον εἶδος τὸ ὁμόφυλον ἀποπέμποντα, τὰ δὲ ἔναιμα αὖ, κερματισθέντα ἐντὸς παρ' ἡμῖν καὶ περιειλημμένα ὥσπερ ὑπ'

81b

T: Now, whenever more is going out than is coming in, all things decay, but when less is going out they grow. So when the entire structure is young and the elemental triangles of its constituents are still new, like fresh wood, the bond holding them together is strong, and yet the overall construction is soft since it has been newly formed from marrow and nourished with milk. So when the surrounding triangles come into it from outside, the ones that the food and drink are made from, these are older and weaker than its own triangles, so it overpowers these older triangles with the new ones, cuts them up, and makes the creature grow large by nourishing it with an abundance of substances similar to its own. However, when the root of the triangles is slackened because of numerous such contests fought against many opponents over a long period of time, they are no longer able to cut the entering triangles and assimilate them to themselves. On the other

hand, they themselves are easily split apart by those triangles that are coming in from outside. Every creature in this situation is overpowered and decays and the condition is called old age. And in the end, once the conjoining bonds of the triangles around the marrow endure no longer under the strain and are split apart, they in turn release the bonds of the soul, and once it is set free in accordance with nature, it flies away with pleasure. Indeed, everything contrary to nature is painful, while anything that arises naturally is pleasant. The same goes for death. When it happens as a result of disease or injury it is painful and violent, but when it comes with old age, an ending that accords with nature, it is the least painful of deaths, attended more by pleasure than by pain.

οὐρανοῦ συνεστῶτος ἐκάστου τοῦ ζώου, τὴν τοῦ παντὸς ἀναγκάζεται μιμεῖσθαι φορὰν· πρὸς τὸ συγγενὲς οὖν φερόμενον ἕκαστον τῶν ἐντὸς μερισθέντων τὸ κενωθὲν τότε ἄλιν ἀνεπλήρωσεν. ὅταν μὲν δὴ πλέον τοῦ ἐπιρρέοντος ἀπίη, φθίνει πᾶν, ὅταν δὲ ἔλαττον, αὐξάνεται. νέα μὲν οὖν σύστασις τοῦ παντὸς ζώου, καινὰ τὰ τρίγωνα οἷον ἐκ δρυόχων ἔτι ἔχουσα τῶν γενῶν, ἰσχυρὰν μὲν τὴν σύγκλεισιν αὐτῶν πρὸς ἄλληλα κέκτῃται, συμπέπηγεν δὲ ὁ πᾶς ὄγκος αὐτῆς ἀπαλός, ἅτ' ἐκ μυελοῦ μὲν νεωστὶ γεγонуίας, τεθραμμένης δὲ ἐν γάλακτι· τὰ δὲ περιλαμβανόμενα ἐν αὐτῇ τρίγωνα ἔξωθεν ἐπεισελθόντα, ἐξ ὧν ἂν ἦ τὰ τε σιτία καὶ ποτά, τῶν ἑαυτῆς τριγώνων παλαιότερα ὄντα καὶ ἀσθενέστερα καινοῖς ἐπικρατεῖ τέμνουσα, καὶ μέγα ἀπεργάζεται τὸ ζῶον τρέφουσα ἐκ πολλῶν ὁμοίων. ὅταν δ' ἡ ρίζα τῶν τριγώνων χαλᾷ διὰ τὸ πολλοὺς ἀγῶνας ἐν πολλῷ χρόνῳ πρὸς πολλὰ ἡγωνίσθαι, τὰ μὲν τῆς τροφῆς εἰσιόντα οὐκέτι δύναται τέμνειν εἰς ὁμοιότητα ἑαυτοῖς, αὐτὰ δὲ ὑπὸ τῶν ἔξωθεν ἐπεισιόντων εὐπετῶς διαιρεῖται· φθίνει δὴ πᾶν ζῶον ἐν τούτῳ κρατούμενον, γῆρας τε ὀνομάζεται τὸ πάθος. τέλος δέ, ἐπειδὴ τῶν περὶ τὸν μυελὸν τριγώνων οἱ συναρμοσθέντες μηκέτι ἀντέχωσιν δεσμοὶ τῷ πόνῳ διιστάμενοι, μεθίσσιν τοὺς τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτοῦ δεσμούς, ἡ δὲ λυθεῖσα κατὰ φύσιν μεθ' ἡδονῆς ἐξέπτατο· πᾶν γὰρ τὸ μὲν παρὰ φύσιν ἀλγαινόν, τὸ δ' ἡ πέφυκεν γιγνόμενον ἡδύ. καὶ θάνατος δὴ κατὰ ταῦτα ὁ μὲν κατὰ νόσους καὶ ὑπὸ τραυμάτων γιγνόμενος ἀλγαινὸς καὶ βίαιος, ὁ

δὲ μετὰ γήρως ἰὼν ἐπὶ τέλος κατὰ φύσιν ἀπονώτατος τῶν θανάτων καὶ μᾶλλον μεθ' ἡδονῆς γιγνόμενος ἢ λύπης. TI. τὸ δὲ τῶν νόσων ὅθεν συνίσταται, δῆλόν που καὶ παντί.

82a

T: The origin of diseases is presumably obvious to everyone. For since the body has been constructed from four constituents – earth, fire, water and air – any unnatural excess or deficiency or any removal from their own place to somewhere alien causes disorder and disease. Furthermore, since there is more than one kind of fire and of the other constituents, the acquisition by the body of an inappropriate variety, and all phenomena of this sort, have the same effect. For when any of these arises or changes its location unnaturally, anything that was previously being cooled is warmed, what was dry becomes moist, the same goes for light and heavy, and everything changes in all sorts of ways. In fact, I maintain that only the addition or removal of same from same, on the same basis and in due proportion, will allow something to remain the same as itself, sound and healthy, while anything entering or leaving that strikes a discordant note by transgressing any of these requirements will engender a whole variety of alterations and countless diseases and corruptions.

τεττάρων γὰρ ὄντων γενῶν ἐξ ὧν συμπέπηγεν τὸ σῶμα, γῆς πυρὸς ὕδατός τε καὶ ἀέρος, τούτων ἢ παρὰ φύσιν πλεονεξία καὶ ἔνδεια καὶ τῆς χώρας μετάστασις ἐξ οἰκείας ἐπ' ἄλλοτρίαν γιγνομένη, πυρός τε αὖ καὶ τῶν ἐτέρων ἐπειδὴ γένη πλείονα ἐνὸς ὄντα τυγχάνει, τὸ μὴ προσήκον ἕκαστον ἑαυτῷ προσλαμβάνειν, καὶ πάνθ' ὅσα τοιαῦτα, στάσεις καὶ νόσους παρέχει παρὰ φύσιν γὰρ ἐκάστου γιγνομένου καὶ μεθισταμένου θερμαίνεται μὲν ὅσα ἂν πρότερον ψύχεται, ζηρὰ δὲ ὄντα εἰς ὕστερον γίγνεται νοτερά, καὶ κοῦφα δὴ καὶ βαρέα, καὶ πάσας πάντη μεταβολὰς δέχεται. μόνως γὰρ δὴ, φαμέν, ταῦτ' ὅντα κατὰ ταῦτ' ὅντα καὶ ὡσαύτως καὶ ἀνὰ λόγον προσγιγνόμενον καὶ ἀπογιγνόμενον ἑάσει ταῦτ' ὄντα αὐτῷ ὧν καὶ ὑγιὲς μένειν· ὃ δ' ἂν πλημμελήσῃ τι τούτων ἐκτὸς ἀπὸν ἢ προσίον, ἀλλοιότητος παμποικίλας καὶ νόσους φθοράς τε ἀπείρους παρέξεται. δευτέρων δὲ συστάσεων αὖ κατὰ φύσιν συνεστηκυῶν,

82c

T: Furthermore, since secondary structures have been established in the course of nature, a second means of considering diseases arises for someone who wishes to contemplate them. For marrow, bone, flesh and sinew have been compounded from those four constituents, and blood has arisen from them too but in a different way, and the majority of diseases arise from the same causes we just mentioned. However, the most grievous diseases come about when the generation of these substances proceeds in reverse and they then undergo decay. For in the course of nature, flesh and sinew arise from blood, sinew from its fibres because it is akin to these, and flesh from the solidified material that forms when fibre is removed from blood. What's more, the sticky oily material that emerges from the sinews and flesh glues the flesh to the structure of the bones and also nourishes the very bone that surrounds the marrow and makes it grow.

δευτέρα κατανόησις νοσημάτων τῷ βουλομένῳ γίνεται συννοῆσαι. μυελοῦ γὰρ ἐξ ἐκείνων ὅστοῦ τε καὶ σαρκὸς καὶ νεύρου συμπαγέντος, ἔτι τε αἵματος ἄλλον μὲν τρόπον, ἐκ δὲ τῶν αὐτῶν γεγονότος, τῶν μὲν ἄλλων τὰ πλεῖστα ἥπερ τὰ πρόσθεν, τὰ δὲ μέγιστα τῶν νοσημάτων τῇδε χαλεπὰ συμπέπτωκεν· ὅταν ἀνάπαλιν ἡ γένεσις τούτων πορεύηται, τότε ταῦτα διαφθείρεται. κατὰ φύσιν γὰρ σάρκες μὲν καὶ νεῦρα ἐξ αἵματος γίνονται, νεῦρον μὲν ἐξ ἰνῶν διὰ τὴν συγγένειαν,

82d

T: What's more, because of the density of bone, whatever is filtered through it consists of the purest kind of triangles, and being extremely smooth and oily, it pours drop by drop from the bones and waters the marrow. And when each of these substances comes into being based on these processes, the consequence for the most part is health, but when they are reversed, the result is disease. For whenever flesh is decomposed and releases decomposed matter back into the veins once more, then a lot of variegated blood, mixed with air, adopts multifarious colours and bitterness, as well as acidic and saline properties, and retains all sorts of bile, serum and phlegm. Once these

substances have become perverted and corrupted, they first destroy the blood itself, and although they themselves do not provide any nourishment at all to the body, they are borne in all directions through the veins, no longer holding to the natural arrangement of the cycles, at enmity towards themselves because they afford no advantage to themselves, and hostile to any part of the body that stands firm and holds its position. This they destroy and corrupt.

σάρκες δὲ ἀπὸ τοῦ παγέντος ὃ πήγνυται χωριζόμενον ἰνῶν· τὸ δὲ ἀπὸ τῶν νεύρων καὶ σαρκῶν ἀπὸν αὖ γλίσχρον καὶ λιπαρὸν ἅμα μὲν τὴν σάρκα κολλᾷ πρὸς τὴν τῶν ὀστέων φύσιν αὐτό τε τὸ περὶ τὸν μυελὸν ὀστοῦν τρέφον αὔξει, τὸ δ' αὖ διὰ τὴν πυκνότητα τῶν ὀστέων διηθούμενον καθαρώτατον γένος τῶν τριγώνων λειότατόν τε καὶ λιπαρώτατον, λειβόμενον ἀπὸ τῶν ὀστέων καὶ στάζον, ἄρδει τὸν μυελόν. καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα μὲν γιγνομένων ἐκάστων ὑγίεια συμβαίνει τὰ πολλά· νόσοι δέ, ὅταν ἐναντίως. ὅταν γὰρ τηκομένη σὰρξ ἀνάπαλιν εἰς τὰς φλέβας τὴν τηκεδόνα ἐξιῇ, τότε μετὰ πνεύματος αἷμα πολὺ τε καὶ παντοδαπὸν ἐν ταῖς φλεψὶ χρώμασι καὶ πικρότησι ποικιλλόμενον, ἔτι δὲ ὀξείαις καὶ ἀλμυραῖς δυνάμεσι, χολὰς καὶ ἰχῶρας καὶ φλέγματα παντοῖα ἴσχει· ΤΙ. παλιναίρετα γὰρ πάντα γεγονότα καὶ διεφθαρμένα τό τε αἷμα αὐτὸ πρῶτον διόλλυσι, καὶ αὐτὰ οὐδεμίαν

83a

T: Now, when any extremely old flesh is corrupted, it is difficult to assimilate, is blackened by the prolonged burning process, and being bitter due to the overall corrosion, it most grievously assaults any part of the body that has not yet been corrupted. Yet, on occasion, once the bitter substance has been diluted to some extent, the black-coloured substance takes on acidity rather than bitterness. At other times, when the bitterness has for its part been immersed in blood, it adopts a redder colour, and when the black colour is mixed with this, it goes yellow. And the yellow colour, in turn, mixes with the bitterness whenever the flesh that is decomposed by the flame around the fire is new flesh.

τροφὴν ἔτι τῷ σώματι παρέχοντα φέρεται πάντῃ διὰ τῶν φλεβῶν, τάξιν τῶν κατὰ φύσιν οὐκέτ' ἴσχοντα περιόδων, ἐχθρὰ μὲν αὐτὰ αὐτοῖς διὰ τὸ μηδεμίαν ἀπόλαυσιν ἑαυτῶν ἔχειν, τῷ συνεστῶτι δὲ τοῦ σώματος καὶ μένοντι κατὰ χώραν πολέμια, διολλύντα καὶ τήκοντα. ὅσον μὲν οὖν ἂν παλαιότατον ὃν τῆς σαρκὸς τακῇ, δύσπεπτον γιγνόμενον μελαίνει μὲν ὑπὸ παλαιᾶς συγκαύσεως, διὰ δὲ τὸ πάντῃ διαβεβρωσθαι πικρὸν ὃν παντὶ χαλεπὸν προσπίπτει τοῦ σώματος ὅσον ἂν μήπω διεφθαρμένον ἦ, καὶ τοτὲ μὲν ἀντὶ τῆς πικρότητος ὀξύτητα ἔσχεν τὸ μέλαν χρῶμα, ἀπολεπτυνθέντος μᾶλλον τοῦ πικροῦ, τοτὲ δὲ ἡ πικρότης αὖ βαφεῖσα αἵματι χρῶμα ἔσχεν ἐρυθρότερον, τοῦ δὲ μέλανος τούτῳ συγκεραννυμένου χλοῶδες· ἔτι δὲ συμμείγνυται ξανθὸν χρῶμα μετὰ τῆς πικρότητος, ὅταν νέα συντακῇ σὰρξ ὑπὸ τοῦ περὶ τὴν φλόγα πυρός. καὶ τὸ μὲν κοινὸν ὄνομα πᾶσιν τούτοις ἢ τινες

83c

T: The shared name, bile, has been assigned to all these, presumably by some physicians or even by someone capable of looking at numerous dissimilar entities and discerning among them a single internal category that deserves to be given a name, while any other forms of bile we mention have a description of their own, based in each case upon their colour. Serum is mild when it is a whey-like product of blood, but aggressive when it comes from black acid bile that is combined with a saline quality by the action of heat, a type called acid phlegm. There is also the decomposition product formed from young tender flesh in the presence of air. This can be filled up with air and enveloped in moisture, producing bubbles in the process. These are not visible individually since they are too small, but they combine together to produce a mass that is visible and has a white colour due to the generation of foam. This entire decomposition process by which soft flesh is compounded with air, we refer to as white phlegm. Of newly formed phlegm there is, in turn, a whey-like part – sweat, tears and any other substances of this sort that flow from the body every day to purify it. And yet these actually become instruments of disease whenever blood is not replenished from food and drink in accordance

with nature, but contrary to the natural order, acquires its mass from opposites instead.

ιατρῶν που χολὴν ἐπωνόμασαν, ἢ καὶ τις ὦν δυνατὸς εἰς πολλὰ μὲν καὶ ἀνόμοια βλέπειν, ὁρᾷν δὲ ἐν αὐτοῖς ἐν γένος ἐνὸν ἄξιον ἐπωνυμίας πᾶσιν· τὰ δ' ἄλλα ὅσα χολῆς εἶδη λέγεται, κατὰ τὴν χρόαν ἔσχεν λόγον αὐτῶν ἕκαστον ἴδιον. ἰχώρ δέ, ὁ μὲν αἵματος ὁρὸς πρῶτος, ὁ δὲ μελαίνης χολῆς ὀξείας τε ἄγριος, ὅταν συμμειγνύηται διὰ θερμότητα ἀλμυρᾷ δυνάμει· καλεῖται δὲ ὀξὺ φλέγμα τὸ τοιοῦτον. τὸ δ' αὖ μετ' ἄερος τηκόμενον ἐκ νέας καὶ ἀπαλῆς σαρκός, τούτου δὲ ἀνεμωθέντος καὶ συμπεριληφθέντος ὑπὸ ὑγρότητος, καὶ πομφολύγων συστασῶν ἐκ τοῦ πάθους τούτου καθ' ἑκάστην μὲν ἀοράτων διὰ σμικρότητα, συναπασῶν δὲ τὸν ὄγκον παρεχομένων ὁρατόν, χρῶμα ἐχουσῶν διὰ τὴν τοῦ ἀφροῦ γένεσιν ἰδεῖν λευκόν, ταύτην πᾶσαν τηκεδὸνα ἀπαλῆς σαρκός μετὰ πνεύματος συμπλακεῖσαν λευκὸν εἶναι φλέγμα φαμέν. φλέγματος δὲ αὖ νέου συνισταμένου ὁρὸς ἰδρῶς καὶ δάκρυον,

83e

T: Now, when the flesh in the various regions is being assailed by diseases, yet the foundations still remain in place, their affliction is only half as strong, for an easy recovery can still be achieved. However, when the material that binds flesh to bone gets diseased and no longer nourishes the bone, nor acts as a bond between flesh and bone because it is separating off from both of these and from the sinews too,³⁰ and instead of being oily and smooth and sticky it becomes rough and saline, parched by a degenerate lifestyle, then any kind of material that suffers these effects crumbles away beneath the flesh and the sinews, separates from the bones along with the flesh which falls away at its roots, and leaves the sinews exposed and full of brine. The flesh then falls back into the blood-stream making the diseases we mentioned earlier more intense.

ὅσα τε ἄλλα τοιαῦτα σώματα τὸ καθ' ἡμέραν χεῖται καθαιρόμενα· καὶ ταῦτα μὲν δὴ πάντα νόσων ὄργανα γέγονεν, ὅταν αἷμα μὴ ἐκ τῶν σιτίων καὶ ποτῶν πληθύσῃ κατὰ φύσιν, ἀλλ' ἐξ ἐναντίων τὸν ὄγκον

παρὰ τοὺς τῆς φύσεως λαμβάνη νόμους. ΤΙ. διακρινομένης μὲν οὖν ὑπὸ νόσων τῆς σαρκὸς ἐκάστης, μενόντων δὲ τῶν πυθμένων αὐταῖς ἡμίσεια τῆς συμφορᾶς ἢ δύναμις—ἀνάληψιν γὰρ ἔτι μετ’ εὐπετείας ἴσχει—

84a

T: Although these are grievous afflictions of the body, those affecting the more basic parts are even worse. These occur when bone does not breathe in properly because of the density of the flesh, heats up on account of the mouldiness, decays, does not assimilate nutriment but proceeds instead in the opposite direction, and is disintegrated into that nutriment once more. That passes into flesh, and the flesh, falling into the blood-stream, renders all the diseases more severe than those described previously. And the most extreme case of all occurs when the substance of the marrow becomes diseased on account of some deficiency or excess. This brings about the most powerful and formidably fatal diseases, in which the entire nature of the body flows of necessity in the opposite direction.

τὸ δὲ δὴ σάρκας ὅστοις συνδοῦν ὅπότε ἂν νοσήσῃ, καὶ μηκέτι αὐτὸ ἐξ ἰνῶν αἷμα καὶ νεύρων ἀποχωριζόμενον ὅστῳ μὲν τροφή, σαρκὶ δὲ πρὸς ὅστουν γίγνηται δεσμός, ἀλλ’ ἐκ λιπαροῦ καὶ λείου καὶ γλίσχρου τραχὺ καὶ ἀλμυρὸν ἀυχμησαν ὑπὸ κακῆς διαίτης γένηται, τότε ταῦτα πάσχον πᾶν τὸ τοιοῦτον καταψήχεται μὲν αὐτὸ πάλιν ὑπὸ τὰς σάρκας καὶ τὰ νεῦρα, ἀφιστάμενον ἀπὸ τῶν ὀστέων, αἱ δ’ ἐκ τῶν ῥιζῶν συνεκπίπτουσαι τὰ τε νεῦρα γυμνὰ καταλείπουσι καὶ μεστὰ ἄλμης· αὐταὶ δὲ πάλιν εἰς τὴν αἵματος φορὰν ἐμπεσοῦσαι τὰ πρόσθεν ῥηθέντα νοσήματα πλείω ποιοῦσιν. χαλεπῶν δὲ τούτων περὶ τὰ σώματα παθημάτων γιγνομένων μείζω ἔτι γίγνεται τὰ πρὸ τούτων, ὅταν ὅστουν διὰ πυκνότητα σαρκὸς ἀναπνοὴν μὴ λαμβάνον ἱκανήν, ὑπ’ εὐρῶτος θερμαινόμενον, σφακελίσαν μήτε τὴν τροφὴν καταδέχεται

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T: There is also a third form of these diseases which should be regarded as arising in three ways – from breath, from phlegm or from bile. For whenever the lungs, the dispensers of breaths to the body, are fenced

in by some flux or other, the breath, being unable to go in one direction, goes in another direction in greater volume than appropriate. Then the parts that do not receive breath's cooling effect become corrupted, while it proceeds to force itself into the veins, contorts them and dissolves the body, stopping at the barrier at its centre where it gets closed in. These processes cause a huge number of painful diseases, often accompanied by copious sweating. And on occasion, when flesh breaks down within the body, breath is produced but is unable to make its way out, and therefore causes the same travails as the breath that comes from outside. These are at their worst when the breath surrounding the sinews and small veins there swells up, and in the process stretches backwards the tendons and the sinews attached to them. Indeed, it is from the tense condition arising from there that the diseases have come to be referred to as tetanus and opisthotonos.³¹ These are difficult to cure. In fact, when such diseases arise, fever offers the most relief. The white phlegm is troublesome when confined within because of the air in its bubbles, but it is milder when it finds passage to the outer part of the body, where it produces a variety of colours and white markings and engenders the diseases related thereto. When combined with black bile, it can spread over the orbits that are in the head and throw them into confusion. Now, if this comes to us in sleep it is quite mild. However, if it visits us whilst awake it is harder to get rid of, and being a disease of a sacred substance, it is quite rightly referred to as 'the sacred disease'.³² Phlegm that is acidic and salty is the wellspring of all diseases that produce catarrh, and because the flow takes place from a variety of locations, they have acquired all sorts of names.

πάλιν τε αὐτὸ εἰς ἐκείνην ἐναντίως ἢ ψυχόμενον, ἢ δ' εἰς σάρκα, σὰρξ δὲ εἰς αἷμα ἐμπίπτουσα τραχύτερα πάντα τῶν πρόσθεν τὰ νοσήματα ἀπεργάζεται· τὸ δ' ἔσχατον πάντων, ὅταν ἡ τοῦ μυελοῦ φύσις ἀπ' ἐνδείας ἢ τινος ὑπερβολῆς νοσήσῃ, τὰ μέγιστα καὶ κυριώτατα πρὸς θάνατον τῶν νοσημάτων ἀποτελεῖ, πάσης ἀνάπαλιν τῆς τοῦ σώματος φύσεως ἐξ ἀνάγκης ρυείσης. τρίτον δ' αὖ νοσημάτων εἶδος τριχῇ δεῖ

διανοεῖσθαι γιγνόμενον, τὸ μὲν ὑπὸ πνεύματος, τὸ δὲ φλέγματος, τὸ δὲ χολῆς. ὅταν μὲν γὰρ ὁ τῶν πνευμάτων τῷ σώματι ταμίας πλεύμων μὴ καθαρὰς παρέχῃ τὰς διεξόδους ὑπὸ ρευμάτων φραχθεῖς, ἔνθα μὲν οὐκ ἰόν, ἔνθα δὲ πλεῖον ἢ τὸ προσήκον πνεῦμα εἰσὶν τὰ μὲν οὐ τυγχάνοντα ἀναψυχῆς σῆπει, τὰ δὲ τῶν φλεβῶν διαβιαζόμενον καὶ συνεπιστρέφον αὐτὰ τῆκόν τε τὸ σῶμα εἰς τὸ μέσον αὐτοῦ διάφραγμα τ' ἴσχον ἐναπολαμβάνεται, καὶ μυρία δὴ νοσήματα ἐκ τούτων ἀλγεῖνὰ μετὰ πλήθους ἰδρώτος πολλάκις ἀπείργασται. πολλάκις δ' ἐν τῷ σώματι διακριθείσης σαρκὸς πνεῦμα ἐγγενόμενον καὶ ἀδυνατοῦν ἔξω πορευθῆναι τὰς αὐτὰς τοῖς ἐπεισεληλυθόσιν ὥδινās παρέσχεν, μεγίστας δέ, ὅταν περὶ τὰ νεῦρα καὶ τὰ ταύτῃ φλέβια περιστὰν καὶ ἀνοιδῆσαν τοὺς τε ἐπιτόνους καὶ τὰ συνεχῇ νεῦρα οὕτως εἰς τὸ ἐξόπισθεν κατατείνῃ τούτοις· ἃ δὴ καὶ ἀπ' αὐτοῦ τῆς συντονίας τοῦ παθήματος τὰ νοσήματα τέτανοί τε καὶ ὀπισθότονοι προσερρήθησαν. ΤΙ. ὦν καὶ τὸ φάρμακον χαλεπόν· πυρετοὶ γὰρ οὖν δὴ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐπιγιγνόμενοι μάλιστα λύουσιν. τὸ δὲ λευκὸν φλέγμα διὰ τὸ τῶν πομφολύγων πνεῦμα χαλεπὸν ἀποληφθέν, ἔξω δὲ τοῦ σώματος ἀναπνοᾶς ἴσχον ἡπιώτερον μὲν, καταποικίλλει δὲ τὸ σῶμα λεύκας ἀλφούς τε καὶ τὰ τούτων συγγενῇ νοσήματα ἀποτίκτον. μετὰ χολῆς δὲ μελαίνης κερασθὲν ἐπὶ τὰς περιόδους τε τὰς ἐν τῇ κεφαλῇ θειοτάτας οὓσας ἐπισκεδαννύμενον καὶ συνταράττον αὐτάς, καθ' ὕπνον μὲν ἰὸν πρᾶϋτερον,

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T: Whatever parts of the body are said to be inflamed due to burning and inflammation have all become so on account of bile. Now, if the bile finds an external vent, it boils and sends forth all sorts of growths. However, if it is confined within, it engenders numerous inflammatory diseases. The worst of these occurs when bile is mixed together with pure blood and prevents the blood fibres from exercising their assigned role. For these have been dispersed in the bloodstream so that it may retain a balanced measure of thickness and thinness, and neither flow out through the pores of the body because it is liquefied by the heat, nor on the other hand, have difficulty in circulating

through the veins because it is dense and immobile. The fibres by their natural structure preserve a balance of these qualities, but when someone dies and their blood is cooling down, the rest of the blood is liquefied once the fibres coagulate together. However, if the fibres are left as they are, they act in consort with the cool surroundings and quickly congeal the blood. Now, since fibres have this capacity in relation to blood, when bile, which is a natural product of old blood, dissolves from the flesh back into the blood once more, the warm, moist bile gradually solidifies when it first falls into the blood because of the capacity of the fibres, and as it congeals and is forcibly extinguished it produces cold and shivering within. But when it flows in more voluminously, it boils up, and the heat it possesses overpowers the fibres and shakes them into disorder. And if there is so much bile that it becomes completely dominant, it passes through to the substance of the marrow, immediately undoes the 'ship's cables' of the soul by burning them, and sets it free. If there is less of it and the body resists the process of dissolution, the bile itself is overpowered and is expelled over the entire body surface, or compressed through the veins into the lower or upper abdomen, and is expelled from the body like fugitive elements from a city beset by faction. This produces diarrhoea, dysentery, and a whole range of similar diseases.

ἐγρηγοροσίν δὲ ἐπιτιθέμενον δυσαπαλλακτότερον νόσημα δὲ ἱεράς ὃν φύσεως ἐνδικώτατα ἱερὸν λέγεται. φλέγμα δ' ὃξὺ καὶ ἄλμυρόν πηγὴ πάντων νοσημάτων ὅσα γίγνεται καταρροϊκὰ διὰ δὲ τοὺς τόπους εἰς οὓς ῥεῖ παντοδαποὺς ὄντας παντοῖα ὀνόματα εἴληφεν. ὅσα δὲ φλεγμαίνειν λέγεται τοῦ σώματος, ἀπὸ τοῦ κάεσθαί τε καὶ φλέγεσθαι, διὰ χολὴν γέγονε πάντα. λαμβάνουσα μὲν οὖν ἀναπνοὴν ἔξω παντοῖα ἀναπέμπει φύματα ζέουσα, καθειργνυμένα δ' ἐντὸς πυρίκαυτα νοσήματα πολλὰ ἐμποιεῖ, μέγιστον δέ, ὅταν αἷματι καθαρῷ συγκερασθεῖσα τὸ τῶν ἰνῶν γένος ἐκ τῆς ἐαυτῶν διαφορῇ τάξεως, αἱ διεσπάρησαν μὲν εἰς αἷμα, ἵνα συμμέτρως λεπτότητος ἴσχοι καὶ πάχους καὶ μήτε διὰ θερμότητα ὡς ὕγρὸν ἐκ μανοῦ τοῦ σώματος ἐκρέοι, μήτ' αὖ πυκνότερον δυσκίνητον ὃν μόλις ἀναστρέφοιτο ἐν ταῖς φλεψίν.

καιρὸν δὴ τούτων ἵνες τῇ τῆς φύσεως γενέσει φυλάττουσιν ὥς ὅταν τις καὶ τεθνεῶτος αἵματος ἐν ψύξει τε ὄντος πρὸς ἀλλήλας συναγάγη, διαχεῖται πᾶν τὸ λοιπὸν αἷμα, ἐαθεῖσαι δὲ ταχὺ μετὰ τοῦ περιεστῶτος αὐτὸ ψύχους συμπηγνύσιν. ταύτην δὴ τὴν δύναμιν ἐχουσῶν ἰνῶν ἐν αἵματι χολὴ φύσει παλαιὸν αἷμα γεγονυῖα καὶ πάλιν ἐκ τῶν σαρκῶν εἰς τοῦτο τετηκυῖα, θερμὴ καὶ ὑγρὰ κατ' ὀλίγον τὸ πρῶτον ἐμπίπτουσα πηγνυται διὰ τὴν τῶν ἰνῶν δύναμιν, πηγνυμένη δὲ καὶ βίᾳ κατασβεννυμένη χειμῶνα καὶ τρόμον ἐντὸς παρέχει. ΤΙ. πλείων δ' ἐπιρρέουσα, τῇ παρ' αὐτῆς θερμότητι κρατήσασα τὰς ἵνας εἰς ἀταξίαν ζέσασα διέσεισεν· καὶ ἐὰν μὲν ἱκανὴ διὰ τέλους κρατῆσαι γένηται, πρὸς τὸ τοῦ μυελοῦ διαπεράσασα γένος κάουσα ἔλυσεν τὰ τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτόθεν οἷον νεῶς πείσματα μεθῆκέν τε ἐλευθέραν, ὅταν δ' ἐλάττων ἢ τό τε σῶμα ἀντίσχη τηκόμενον, αὐτὴ κρατηθεῖσα ἢ κατὰ πᾶν τὸ σῶμα ἐξέπεσεν, ἢ διὰ τῶν φλεβῶν εἰς τὴν κάτω συνωσθεῖσα ἢ τὴν ἄνω κοιλίαν, οἷον φυγὰς ἐκ πόλεως στασιασάσης ἐκ

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T: When the body is diseased, mainly due to excess fire, continuous high-temperatures and fever are induced; when it is due to excess air, the fevers are quotidian; when due to water they are tertian because water is more sluggish than air or fire; when it is due to earth, the fourth most sluggish of these four, it takes four times as long to purge away and produces quartan fevers that are hard to shake off.

τοῦ σώματος ἐκπίπτουσα, διαρροίας καὶ δυσεντερίας καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα νοσήματα πάντα παρέσχετο. τὸ μὲν οὖν ἐκ πυρὸς ὑπερβολῆς μάλιστα νοσήσαν σῶμα συνεχῇ καύματα καὶ πυρετοὺς ἀπεργάζεται, τὸ δ' ἐξ ἀέρος ἀμφημερινούς, τριταίους δ' ὕδατος διὰ τὸ νωθέστερον ἀέρος καὶ πυρὸς αὐτὸ εἶναι· τὸ δὲ γῆς, τετάρτως ὃν νωθέστατον τούτων, ἐν τετραπλασίαις περιόδοις χρόνου καθαιρόμενον, τεταρταίους πυρετοὺς ποιῆσαν ἀπαλλάττεται μόλις.

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T: So, the diseases of the body come about in this way, while diseases of the soul, due to the condition of the body, come about in the following way. We must agree that mindlessness is a disease of the soul. However,

there are two kinds of mindlessness – madness and stupidity. Therefore, any experience that a person undergoes in which either of these two qualities is involved should be referred to as a disease, and excessive pleasure or pain should be ranked as the most powerful diseases of the soul. For when a person is elated, or indeed is experiencing the opposite condition because he is in pain, he hastens in an untimely manner to grasp the one and flee from the other, and is unable either to see or to hear aright. He is raving, and in that moment he is least capable of exercising reason. And when the seed associated with the marrow becomes plentiful and free-flowing, and is just like a tree that is fruitful beyond its natural measure, numerous recurrent pangs and just as many pleasures are his lot, born of desires and the consequences thereof. For most of his life he is driven mad by the greatest pleasures and pains; his soul is kept diseased and senseless by the body, yet he gets a reputation for being deliberately degenerate rather than being a sick man. But in truth, lack of sexual restraint is, for the most part, a disease of the soul arising from an abundant and fluid condition of a single substance in the body due to porosity in the bones. And, indeed, almost all those who are unrestrained with respect to pleasure, and are said to be blameworthy because they are willingly bad, are censured unjustly. For no one is willingly bad, rather the bad become bad because of some degenerate condition of the body and the lack of an educated upbringing, both of which are afflictions that come to any person against his will.

καὶ τὰ μὲν περὶ τὸ σῶμα νοσήματα ταύτῃ συμβαίνει γινόμενα, τὰ δὲ περὶ ψυχὴν διὰ σώματος ἔξιν τῇδε. νόσον μὲν δὴ ψυχῆς ἄνοιαν συγχωρητέον, δύο δ' ἀνοίας γένη, τὸ μὲν μανίαν, τὸ δὲ ἀμαθίαν. πᾶν οὖν ὅτι πάσχων τις πάθος ὁπότερον αὐτῶν ἴσχει, νόσον προσρητέον, ἡδονὰς δὲ καὶ λύπας ὑπερβαλλούσας τῶν νόσων μεγίστας θετέον τῇ ψυχῇ· περιχαρὴς γὰρ ἄνθρωπος ὢν ἢ καὶ τάναντία ὑπὸ λύπης πάσχων, σπεύδων τὸ μὲν ἐλεῖν ἀκαίρως, τὸ δὲ φυγεῖν, οὔθ' ὅρᾳ οὔτε ἀκούειν ὀρθὸν οὐδὲν δύναται, λυττᾷ δὲ καὶ λογισμοῦ μετασχεῖν ἥκιστα τότε δὴ δυνατός. τὸ δὲ σπέρμα ὅτῳ πολὺ καὶ ῥυῶδες περὶ τὸν μυελὸν γίγνεται

καὶ καθαπερὲι δένδρον πολυκαρπότερον τοῦ συμμετρου πεφυκὸς ἦ, πολλὰς μὲν καθ' ἕκαστον ὠδῖνας, πολλὰς δ' ἡδονὰς κτώμενος ἐν ταῖς ἐπιθυμίαις καὶ τοῖς περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα τόκοις, ἐμμανὴς τὸ πλεῖστον γιγνόμενος τοῦ βίου διὰ τὰς μεγίστας ἡδονὰς καὶ λύπας, νοσοῦσαν καὶ ἄφρονα ἴσχων ὑπὸ τοῦ σώματος τὴν ψυχὴν, οὐχ ὡς νοσῶν ἀλλ' ὡς ἐκὼν κακὸς δοξάζεται· τὸ δὲ ἀληθὲς ἡ περὶ τὰ ἀφροδίσια ἀκολασία κατὰ τὸ πολὺ μέρος διὰ τὴν ἐνὸς γένους ἕξιν ὑπὸ μανότητος ὁστῶν ἐν σώματι ῥυώδη καὶ ὑγραίνουσιν νόσος ψυχῆς γέγονεν. καὶ σχεδὸν δὴ πάντα ὅποσα ἡδονῶν ἀκράτεια καὶ ὄνειδος ὡς ἐκόντων λέγεται τῶν κακῶν, οὐκ ὀρθῶς ὀνειδίζεται· κακὸς μὲν γὰρ ἐκὼν οὐδεὶς, διὰ δὲ πονηρὰν ἕξιν τινὰ τοῦ σώματος καὶ ἀπαίδευτον τροφὴν ὁ κακὸς γίγνεται κακός, παντὶ δὲ ταῦτα ἐχθρὰ καὶ ἄκοντι προσγίγνεται. καὶ πάλιν δὴ τὸ περὶ τὰς λύπας ἡ ψυχὴ κατὰ ταῦτα διὰ σῶμα πολλὴν ἴσχει κακίαν. TI. ὅτου γὰρ ἂν ἡ τῶν ὀξέων καὶ τῶν ἀλυκῶν φλεγμάτων καὶ ὅσοι πικροὶ καὶ χολώδεις χυμοὶ κατὰ τὸ σῶμα πλανηθέντες ἕξω μὲν μὴ λάβωσιν ἀναπνοήν, ἐντὸς δὲ εἰλλόμενοι

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T: Then again, in the case of pain, and based upon the same factors, the soul derives a great deal of its degeneracy from the body. For when acidic or saline phlegm, or any bitter and bilious humours that go wandering about the body, are unable to find a vent to the outside and are trapped inside, they blend their own vapour together with the motion of the soul and get them both mixed up. These engender a whole variety of diseases in the soul, some more intense, some less so, some more extensive, some less so, which are then borne towards the three regions of the soul. Depending upon the region they assail, they produce multifarious forms of ill-temper and despondency in one case, rashness and cowardice in another, and sometimes a combination of forgetfulness and dullness.

τὴν ἀφ' αὐτῶν ἀτμίδα τῇ τῆς ψυχῆς φορᾷ συμμερίζαντες ἀνακερασθῶσι, παντοδαπὰ νοσήματα ψυχῆς ἐμποιοῦσι μᾶλλον καὶ ἥττον καὶ ἐλάττω καὶ πλεῖω, πρὸς τε τοὺς τρεῖς τόπους ἐνεχθέντα τῆς ψυχῆς, πρὸς δὲ ἂν ἕκαστ' αὐτῶν προσπίπτῃ, ποικίλλει μὲν εἶδη δυσκολίας καὶ δυσθυμίας

παντοδαπά, ποικίλλει δὲ θρασυτήτός τε καὶ δειλίας, ἔτι δὲ λήθης ἅμα καὶ δυσμαθίας. πρὸς δὲ τούτοις, ὅταν οὕτως

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T: What's more, when men set in such bad ways dwell in cities with bad forms of government, and public and private discourse accords therewith, and yet from childhood upwards they learn nothing to cure these ills, that's how the bad among us become bad, due to these two involuntary factors. For these we should blame the begetters rather than the begotten, and the nurturers rather than those who are nurtured. However, we should be eager in any way we can, through nurture, through activity, and through learning, to flee from badness and embrace its opposite, although these topics obviously belong to discussions of a different sort.

κακῶς παγέντων πολιτεῖαι κακαὶ καὶ λόγοι κατὰ πόλεις ἰδίᾳ τε καὶ δημοσίᾳ λεχθῶσιν, ἔτι δὲ μαθήματα μηδαμῇ τούτων ἰατικά ἐκ νέων μανθάνηται, ταύτῃ κακοὶ πάντες οἱ κακοὶ διὰ δύο ἀκουσιώτατα γιγνόμεθα· ὧν αἰτιατέον μὲν τοὺς φυτεύοντας ἀεὶ τῶν φυτευομένων μᾶλλον καὶ τοὺς τρέφοντας τῶν τρεφομένων, προθυμητέον μὲν, ὅπη τις δύναται, καὶ διὰ τροφῆς καὶ δι' ἐπιτηδευμάτων μαθημάτων τε φυγεῖν μὲν κακίαν, τούναντίον δὲ ἐλεῖν. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν δὴ τρόπος ἄλλος λόγων.

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T: However, it is reasonable and appropriate to present an exposition, the counterpart of these, setting out, in turn, the treatment that will preserve our bodies and our thinking processes in good health. Indeed, it is preferable that our discussion holds to the theme of what is good rather than what is bad. Now, all that is good is beautiful, and beauty is not devoid of measure, so a living being that is to exhibit such qualities must be well proportioned. But when it comes to proportions, we notice the minor ones and take them into account, while the most significant and important never enter our reckoning. Indeed, in the case of health and disease, virtue and vice, no single proportion or disproportion is more important than the relation of soul itself to

body itself. In the case of these two, we neither observe nor recognise that whenever a weaker, lesser frame supports a soul that is strong and great in every respect, or, indeed, when the two are conjoined as opposites, the living being, as a whole, is not beautiful because the proportion it lacks is the most important proportion, while the alternative arrangement is the most beautiful and beloved sight of all to those who are able to behold it.

τὸ δὲ τούτων ἀντίστροφον αὖ, τὸ περὶ τὰς τῶν σωμάτων καὶ διανοήσεων θεραπείας αἷς αἰτίαις σφύζεται, πάλιν εἰκὸς καὶ πρέπον ἀνταποδοῦναι· δικαιότερον γὰρ τῶν ἀγαθῶν πέρι μᾶλλον ἢ τῶν κακῶν ἴσχειν λόγον. πᾶν δὴ τὸ ἀγαθὸν καλόν, τὸ δὲ καλὸν οὐκ ἄμετρον· καὶ ζῶον οὖν τὸ τοιοῦτον ἐσόμενον σύμμετρον θετέον. συμμετριῶν δὲ τὰ μὲν σμικρὰ διαισθανόμενοι συλλογιζόμεθα, τὰ δὲ κυριώτατα καὶ μέγιστα ἀλογίστως ἔχομεν. πρὸς γὰρ ὑγείας καὶ νόσους ἀρετὰς τε καὶ κακίας οὐδεμία συμμετρία καὶ ἀμετρία μείζων ἢ ψυχῆς αὐτῆς πρὸς σῶμα αὐτό· ὣν οὐδὲν σκοποῦμεν οὐδ' ἐννοοῦμεν, ὅτι ψυχὴν ἰσχυρὰν καὶ πάντῃ μεγάλῃν ἀσθενέστερον καὶ ἔλαττον εἶδος ὅταν ὀχῇ, καὶ ὅταν αὖ τοῦναντίον συμπαγῆτον τούτῳ, οὐ καλὸν ὅλον τὸ ζῶον—ἀσύμμετρον γὰρ ταῖς μεγίσταις συμμετρίαις—τὸ δὲ ἐναντίως ἔχον πάντων θεαμάτων τῷ δυναμένῳ καθορᾶν κάλλιστον καὶ ἐρασιμώτατον.

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T: For instance, a body whose legs are too long, or is out of proportion with itself because of some other excessive tendency, is also inclined to be ugly, prone to much fatigue when it partakes in any exertions, and to a lot of awkwardness and falls, causing a whole range of difficulties to itself because of its abnormal movements. Well, we should also think about the twofold combination that we refer to as a living being in the same way. Indeed, whenever the soul within it is more powerful than the body and becomes passionate, it shakes up the entire body and fills it up with diseases from within, and when it embarks upon some intense study or enquiry it wears out the body. And again, when engaging in teaching and verbal disputation, both in public and in

private, it makes the body feverish and troubled due to the strife that is generated and the associated thirst for victory, bringing on rheums and deceiving most so-called physicians into attributing the blame to the wrong cause.

οἷον οὖν ὑπερσκελὲς ἢ καὶ τινα ἑτέραν ὑπέρεξιν ἄμετρον ἑαυτῷ τι σῶμα ὃν ἅμα μὲν αἰσχρόν, ἅμα δ' ἐν τῇ κοινωνίᾳ τῶν πόνων πολλοὺς μὲν κόπους, πολλὰ δὲ σπᾶσματα καὶ διὰ τὴν παραφορότητα πτώματα παρέχον μυρίων κακῶν αἴτιον ἑαυτῷ, ΤΙ. ταῦτόν δὴ διανοητέον καὶ περὶ τοῦ συναμφοτέρου, ζῶον ὃ καλοῦμεν, ὡς ὅταν τε ἐν αὐτῷ ψυχὴ κρείττων

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T: In contrast, whenever a large body that is too strong for the soul is conjoined with a small weak mind, the activities of the stronger dominate and strengthen their own desire. Now, there are two desires naturally associated with human beings – nutriment for our body, and understanding for our most divine part. So, activities of the body make the soul dull, slow to learn and unretentive, and engender within its the worst possible disease, stupidity. Now, there is a single safeguard against these two tendencies – neither to set the soul moving without moving the body, nor body without soul – so that both are protected and become balanced and healthy. Accordingly, a person who engages in mathematics or some other intense study involving the mind should also give the body its due measure of activity through recourse to gymnastics, while the person who is careful about shaping his body should, in turn, impart a corresponding level of activity to the soul through recourse to music and philosophy in general, if he really intends to be referred to as noble and good in the proper sense.

οὗσα σώματος περιθύμως ἰσχυρῇ, διασειούσα πᾶν αὐτὸ ἔνδοθεν νόσων ἐμπίμπλησι, καὶ ὅταν εἷς τινας μαθήσεις καὶ ζητήσεις συντόνως ἦη, κατατῆκει, διδασκὰς τ' αὖ καὶ μάχας ἐν λόγοις ποιουμένη δημοσίᾳ καὶ ἰδίᾳ δι' ἐρίδων καὶ φιλονικίας γιγνομένων διάπυρον αὐτὸ ποιοῦσα σαλεύει, καὶ ῥεύματα ἐπάγουσα, τῶν λεγομένων ἱατρῶν ἀπατῶσα τοὺς

πλείστους, τἀνάιται αἰτιᾶσθαι ποιεῖ σῶμά τε ὅταν αὖ μέγα καὶ ὑπέρψυχον σμικρᾷ συμφυῆς ἀσθενεῖ τε διανοίᾳ γένηται, διττῶν ἐπιθυμιῶν οὐσῶν φύσει κατ' ἀνθρώπους, διὰ σῶμα μὲν τροφῆς, διὰ δὲ τὸ θεϊότατον τῶν ἐν ἡμῖν φρονήσεως, αἱ τοῦ κρείττονος κινήσεις κρατοῦσαι καὶ τὸ μὲν σφέτερον αὔξουσai, τὸ δὲ τῆς ψυχῆς κωφὸν καὶ δυσμαθὲς ἀμνημόν τε ποιοῦσαι, τὴν μεγίστην νόσον ἀμαθίαν ἐναπεργάζονται. μία δὲ σωτηρία πρὸς ἅμφω, μήτε τὴν ψυχὴν ἄνευ σώματος κινεῖν μήτε σῶμα ἄνευ ψυχῆς, ἵνα ἀμυνομένῳ γίγνησθον ἰσορρόπῳ καὶ ὑγιῇ. τὸν δὲ μαθηματικὸν ἢ τινα ἄλλην σφόδρα μελέτην διανοίᾳ κατεργαζόμενον καὶ τὴν τοῦ σώματος ἀποδοτέον κίνησιν, γυμναστικῇ προσομιλοῦντα, τόν τε αὖ σῶμα ἐπιμελῶς πλάττοντα τὰς τῆς ψυχῆς ἀνταποδοτέον κινήσεις, μουσικῇ καὶ πάσῃ φιλοσοφίᾳ προσχρῶμενον, εἰ μέλλει δικαίως τις ἅμα μὲν καλός, ἅμα δὲ ἀγαθὸς ὀρθῶς κεκληῖσθαι. κατὰ δὲ ταῦτα ταῦτα καὶ τὰ μέρη θεραπευτέον, τὸ τοῦ παντὸς

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T: The parts of the body and soul should also be cared for on the same basis, in imitation of the frame of the Universe. For the body is warmed and cooled internally by whatever enters into it, and, again, is dried out and moistened by whatever is outside it, and suffers any consequences derived from both processes. So whenever someone remains at rest and submits his body to these processes, it is overpowered and destroyed. But if, on the other hand, someone imitates the nurturer and nurse of the Universe, as we call it, he would never allow his body to remain completely still but would move it, and by continually creating certain vibrations in it, maintain a constant, natural balance between the internal and external movements. By this measured shaking, he would order the affections and particles that wander about the body in accordance with their mutual affinity, into a mutual arrangement that reflects the description of the Universe we gave earlier, not allowing enemies to be placed side by side to engender strife and disease in the body, but ensuring the production of health by placing friend alongside friend.

ἀπομιμούμενον εἶδος. τοῦ γὰρ σώματος ὑπὸ τῶν εἰσιόντων καομένου τε ἐντὸς καὶ ψυχομένου, καὶ πάλιν ὑπὸ τῶν ἔξωθεν ξηραινομένου καὶ ὑγραινομένου καὶ τὰ τούτοις ἀκόλουθα πάσχοντος ὑπ' ἀμφοτέρων τῶν κινήσεων, ὅταν μὲν τις ἡσυχίαν ἄγον τὸ σῶμα παραδιδῷ ταῖς κινήσεσι, κρατηθὲν διώλετο, ἐὰν δὲ ἦν τε τροφὸν καὶ τιθήνην τοῦ παντὸς προσείπομεν μιμηταί τις, καὶ τὸ σῶμα μάλιστα μὲν μηδέποτε ἡσυχίαν ἄγειν ἔῤ, κινῇ δὲ καὶ σεισμούς ἀεί τινας ἐμποιῶν αὐτῷ διὰ παντὸς τὰς ἐντὸς καὶ ἐκτὸς ἀμύνηται κατὰ φύσιν κινήσεις, καὶ μετρίως σείων τὰ τε περὶ τὸ σῶμα πλανώμενα παθήματα καὶ μέρη κατὰ συγγενείας εἰς τάξιν κατακοσμῇ πρὸς ἄλληλα, κατὰ τὸν πρόσθεν λόγον ὃν περὶ τοῦ παντὸς ἐλέγομεν, οὐκ ἔχθρον παρ' ἔχθρον τιθέμενον ἐάσει πολέμους ἐντίκτειν τῷ σώματι καὶ νόσους, ἀλλὰ φίλον παρὰ φίλον τεθὲν ὑγίειαν

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T: Now, when it comes to movements, the best movement is in oneself, by oneself, for this has most kinship with the movement of thought and of the Universe. Being moved by another is an inferior form of movement, but the worst form involves moving the body, part by part, by means of various agents, while it is lying still. Accordingly, the best way of purging or restoring the body is through gymnastic exercises, second is through the swaying motion of ships and any other means of carriage that do not induce tiredness. There is a third form of motion, useful in cases of extreme necessity, which should not be accepted under any other circumstances by anyone possessed of intelligence – the use of purgative drugs for medical purposes. For diseases that do not pose a huge threat should not be incited with drugs. Indeed, in a way, the structure of any disease resembles the nature of a living being. In fact, the constitution of these beings involves an assigned span of life applicable to the species as a whole, and each particular creature is born with its own allotted life span, in the absence of the intervention of necessity. For the triangles belonging to each individual are constructed, from the very outset, with the capacity to endure for a certain period of time, and no creature could ever live beyond that limit. Now, the same tendency applies to the constitution of diseases.

Whenever someone ignores their allotted time span and destroys them with drugs, minor diseases are inclined to become major, few to become many. Therefore, we should manage everything of this sort through our lifestyle insofar as leisure allows, and not irritate a troublesome malady through the use of drugs.

ἀπεργαζόμενον παρέξει. ΤΙ. τῶν δ' αὖ κινήσεων ἢ ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὅφ' αὐτοῦ ἀρίστη κινήσις—μάλιστα γὰρ τῇ διανοητικῇ καὶ τῇ τοῦ παντός κινήσει συγγενής—ἡ δὲ ὑπ' ἄλλου χείρων· χειρίστη δὲ ἡ κειμένου τοῦ σώματος καὶ ἄγοντος ἡσυχίαν δι' ἐτέρων αὐτὸ κατὰ μέρη κινούσα. διὸ δὴ τῶν καθάρσεων καὶ συστάσεων τοῦ σώματος ἡ μὲν διὰ τῶν γυμνασίων ἀρίστη, δευτέρα δὲ ἡ διὰ τῶν αἰωρήσεων κατὰ τε τοὺς πλοῦς καὶ ὀπηπερ ἂν ὀχήσεις ἄκοποι γίνωνται· τρίτον δὲ εἶδος κινήσεως σφόδρα ποτὲ ἀναγκαζομένῳ χρήσιμον, ἄλλως δὲ οὐδαμῶς τῷ νοῦν ἔχοντι προσδεκτέον, τὸ τῆς φαρμακευτικῆς καθάρσεως γιγνόμενον ἱατρικόν. τὰ γὰρ νοσήματα, ὅσα μὴ μεγάλους ἔχει κινδύνους, οὐκ ἐρεθιστέον φαρμακείαις. πᾶσα γὰρ σύστασις νόσων τρόπον τινὰ τῇ τῶν ζῶων φύσει προσέοικε. καὶ γὰρ ἡ τούτων σύνοδος ἔχουσα τεταγμένους τοῦ βίου γίγνεται χρόνους τοῦ τε γένους σύμπαντος, καὶ καθ' αὐτὸ τὸ ζῶον εἰμαρμένον ἕκαστον ἔχον τὸν βίον φύεται, χωρὶς τῶν ἐξ ἀνάγκης παθημάτων· τὰ γὰρ τρίγωνα εὐθὺς κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐκάστου δύναμιν ἔχοντα συνίσταται μέχρι τινὸς χρόνου δυνατὰ ἐξαρκεῖν, οὗ βίον οὐκ ἂν ποτέ τις εἰς τὸ πέραν ἔτι βιώῃ. τρόπος οὖν ὁ αὐτὸς καὶ τῆς περὶ τὰ νοσήματα συστάσεως· ἦν ὅταν τις παρὰ τὴν εἰμαρμένην τοῦ χρόνου φθείρῃ φαρμακείαις, ἅμα ἐκ σμικρῶν μεγάλα καὶ πολλὰ ἐξ ὀλίγων νοσήματα φιλεῖ γίνεσθαι. διὸ παιδαγωγεῖν δεῖ διαίταις πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα, καθ' ὅσον ἂν ᾗ τῇ σχολῇ,

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T: That's enough said about the living creature as a whole and its bodily parts, and how a person may live in accord with reason, guiding and being guided by himself. But first and most importantly, we must somehow arrange for the part that will guide us to be as beautiful and excellent as possible for its guiding role. Now, to elaborate upon these matters in detail would constitute a task in its own right, yet we would

not go much astray if we were to conclude our account by adding a secondary topic in accord with what has gone before, by considering the issue as follows. As we have stated on numerous occasions, there are three forms of soul dwelling in three regions within us, each possessing movements of its own. Accordingly, we should now declare as briefly as possible, and on the same basis as before, that any form which continues in idleness and keeps quiet its own movements necessarily becomes weaker, while any that are exercised become stronger. Therefore, we should be careful that these movements retain a due proportion with respect to one another.

ἀλλ' οὐ φαρμακεύοντα κακὸν δύσκολον ἐρεθιστέον. καὶ περὶ μὲν τοῦ κοινοῦ ζώου καὶ τοῦ κατὰ τὸ σῶμα αὐτοῦ μέρους, ἧ τις ἂν καὶ διαπαιδαγωγῶν καὶ διαπαιδαγωγούμενος ὑφ' αὐτοῦ μάλιστα ἂν κατὰ λόγον ζῶη, ταύτη λελέχθω· τὸ δὲ δὴ παιδαγωγῆσον αὐτὸ μᾶλλον που καὶ πρότερον παρασκευαστέον εἰς δύναμιν ὅτι κάλλιστον καὶ ἄριστον εἰς τὴν παιδαγωγίαν εἶναι. δι' ἀκριβείας μὲν οὖν περὶ τούτων διελθεῖν ἱκανὸν ἂν γένοιτο αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ μόνον ἔργον· τὸ δ' ἐν παρέργῳ κατὰ τὰ πρόσθεν ἐπόμενος ἂν τις οὐκ ἄπο τρόπου τῆδε σκοπῶν ὧδε τῷ λόγῳ διαπεράναιτ' ἂν. ΤΙ. καθάπερ εἵπομεν πολλάκις, ὅτι τρία τριχῇ ψυχῆς ἐν ἡμῖν εἶδη κατῴκισται, τυγχάνει δὲ ἕκαστον κινήσεις ἔχον, οὕτω κατὰ ταῦτά καὶ νῦν ὡς διὰ βραχυτάτων ῥητέον ὅτι τὸ μὲν αὐτῶν ἐν ἀργίᾳ διάγον καὶ τῶν ἑαυτοῦ κινήσεων ἡσυχίαν ἄγον ἀσθενέστατον ἀνάγκη γίγνεσθαι, τὸ δ' ἐν γυμνασίοις ἐρρωμενέστατον·

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T: As for the most lordly form of our soul, we should think of it in this way. It is as a daimon given to each of us by God, and it is said to dwell at the very pinnacle of our bodies to raise us up from Earth to our kindred in Heaven, we who are, properly speaking, a plant not of the Earth but of Heaven. Indeed, it is from there, the place from which soul first had her birth, that the divine agency suspends our head and root, making straight the entire body.

διὸ φυλακτέον ὅπως ἂν ἔχωσιν τὰς κινήσεις πρὸς ἄλληλα συμμέτρους. τὸ δὲ δὴ περὶ τοῦ κυριωτάτου παρ' ἡμῖν ψυχῆς εἶδους διανοεῖσθαι δεῖ τῆδε, ὥς ἄρα αὐτὸ δαίμονα θεὸς ἐκάστω δέδωκεν, τοῦτο ὃ δὴ φαμεν οἰκεῖν μὲν ἡμῶν ἐπ' ἄκρῳ τῷ σώματι, πρὸς δὲ τὴν ἐν οὐρανῷ συγγένειαν ἀπὸ γῆς ἡμᾶς αἶρειν ὥς ὄντας φυτὸν οὐκ ἔγγειον ἀλλὰ οὐράνιον, ὀρθότατα λέγοντες· ἐκεῖθεν γάρ, ὅθεν ἡ πρώτη τῆς ψυχῆς γένεσις ἔφυ, τὸ θεῖον τὴν κεφαλὴν καὶ ρίζαν ἡμῶν

90b

T: Now, it is inevitable that in someone who is busy with desires and ambitions, and who labours intensely at these, all the opinions he forms are mortal, and insofar as it is possible for a person to become mortal, he takes on its full measure since he has swollen that part of himself. On the other hand, it is completely inevitable, I presume, that someone who has taken seriously to the love of learning and to true understanding, and has exercised these faculties within himself most of all, will think immortal and divine thoughts if he should actually attain truth. Furthermore, insofar as human nature is allowed to partake of immortality, he will obtain its full measure, and since he is constantly caring for the divine, and preserving the particular daimon associated with himself in good order, he will be especially blessed. But, of course, the one and only way of caring for everything is to bestow the nutriment and movement appropriate to each, and in the case of our divine part, the kindred movements are the thoughts and revolutions of the Universe. So, by adhering closely to these, setting aright the orbits in our head which were corrupted around the time we were born, by coming to an understanding of the harmonies and revolutions of the Universe, each of us should bring our observing part into the likeness of what is observed in accord with the ancient nature, and in that likeness, finally attain the very best life prescribed by the gods for humanity with a view to time present and time future.

ἀνακρεμαννὺν ὀρθοῖ πᾶν τὸ σῶμα. τῷ μὲν οὖν περὶ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας ἡ περὶ φιλονικίας τετευτακότη καὶ ταῦτα διαπονοῦντι σφόδρα πάντα τὰ δόγματα ἀνάγκη θνητὰ ἐγγεγονέναι, καὶ παντάπασιν καθ' ὅσον μάλιστα

δυνατὸν θνητῷ γίγνεσθαι, τούτου μηδὲ σμικρὸν ἑλλείπειν, ἅτε τὸ τοιοῦτον ἡϋξηκότι· τῷ δὲ περὶ φιλομαθίαν καὶ περὶ τὰς ἀληθεῖς φρονήσεις ἐσπουδακότι καὶ ταῦτα μάλιστα τῶν αὐτοῦ γεγυμνασμένῳ φρονεῖν μὲν ἀθάνατα καὶ θεῖα, ἄνπερ ἀληθείας ἐφάπτεται, πᾶσα ἀνάγκη που, καθ' ὅσον δ' αὖ μετασχεῖν ἀνθρωπίνῃ φύσει ἀθανασίας ἐνδέχεται, τούτου μηδὲν μέρος ἀπολείπειν, ἅτε δὲ αἰεὶ θεραπεύοντα τὸ θεῖον ἔχοντά τε αὐτὸν εὖ κεκοσμημένον τὸν δαίμονα σύνοικον ἑαυτῷ, διαφερόντως εὐδαίμονα εἶναι. θεραπεία δὲ δὴ παντὶ παντὸς μία, τὰς οἰκείας ἐκάστῳ τροφὰς καὶ κινήσεις ἀποδιδόναι. τῷ δ' ἐν ἡμῖν θεῖῳ συγγενεῖς εἰσιν κινήσεις αἱ τοῦ παντὸς διανοήσεις καὶ περιφοραί· ταύταις δὴ συνεπόμενον ἕκαστον δεῖ, τὰς περὶ τὴν γένεσιν ἐν τῇ κεφαλῇ διεφθαρμένας ἡμῶν περιόδους ἐξορθοῦντα διὰ τὸ καταμανθάνειν τὰς τοῦ παντὸς ἀρμονίας τε καὶ περιφοράς, τῷ κατανοομένῳ τὸ κατανοοῦν ἐξομοιωῖσαι κατὰ τὴν ἀρχαίαν φύσιν, ὁμοιώσαντα δὲ τέλος ἔχειν τοῦ προτεθέντος ἀνθρώποις ὑπὸ θεῶν ἀρίστου βίου πρὸς τε τὸν παρόντα καὶ τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον.

90e

T: And so today's initial assignment, to give a detailed account of the Universe as far as the birth of humanity, almost seems to have reached a conclusion. Of course, we must make brief mention of the manner in which the other living beings, for their part, came into existence, but it is not necessary to lengthen this. For in this way we may think ourselves to be more measured in our discussion of these matters. So let's discuss this as follows. According to the likely account, those who had been born as men and proved cowards, or lived their lives in an unjust manner, were changed in nature to women at their second birth. That's why the god framed the passion of intercourse at that time, fashioning one ensouled living being in us, another in women. Each of the two was made in the following way. They extended the exit passage of drink at the place where it receives the liquid that arrives by the lungs, through the kidneys into the bladder, and expels it along with the air that exerts the pressure. They carried this passage through into the marrow that has been fashioned to run from the

head, down the neck and through the spine. Indeed, we said in our previous discussions that this is seed. And since this is ensouled and has a way of getting out at the place we mentioned, it engenders therein a lively desire to flow outwards, and produces the passion of procreation. So, it is that the sexual organ in men has become disobedient and self-willed, like a living creature with no regard for reason who attempts to dominate everything because of its raging desires.

καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ νῦν ἡμῖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς παραγγελθέντα διεξελεῖν περὶ τοῦ παντός μέχρι γενέσεως ἀνθρωπίνης σχεδὸν ἔοικε τέλος ἔχειν. τὰ γὰρ ἄλλα ζῶα ἢ γέγονεν αὐτῷ, διὰ βραχέων ἐπιμνηστέον, ὃ μὴ τις ἀνάγκη μηκύνειν· οὕτω γὰρ ἐμμετρότερός τις ἂν αὐτῷ δόξειεν περὶ τοὺς τούτων λόγους εἶναι. τῇδ' οὖν τὸ τοιοῦτον ἔστω λεγόμενον. ΤΙ. τῶν γενομένων ἀνδρῶν ὅσοι δειλοὶ καὶ τὸν βίον ἀδίκως διήλθον, κατὰ λόγον τὸν εἰκότα γυναῖκες μετεφύοντο ἐν τῇ δευτέρᾳ γενέσει· καὶ κατ' ἐκεῖνον δὴ τὸν χρόνον διὰ ταῦτα θεοὶ τὸν τῆς συνουσίας ἔρωτα ἐτεκτίναντο, ζῶον τὸ μὲν ἐν ἡμῖν, τὸ δ' ἐν ταῖς γυναῖξιν συστήσαντες ἔμψυχον, τοιῷδε τρόπῳ ποιήσαντες ἐκάτερον. τὴν τοῦ ποτοῦ διέξοδον, ἢ διὰ τοῦ πλεύμονος τὸ πῶμα ὑπὸ τοὺς νεφροὺς εἰς τὴν κύστιν ἐλθὼν καὶ τῷ πνεύματι θλιφθὲν συνεκπέμπει δεχομένη, συνέτρησαν εἰς τὸν ἐκ τῆς κεφαλῆς κατὰ τὸν αὐχένα καὶ διὰ τῆς ῥάχεως μυελὸν συμπεπηγότα, ὃν δὴ σπέρμα ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν λόγοις εἵπομεν· ὁ δέ, ἅτ' ἔμψυχος ὢν καὶ λαβὼν ἀναπνοήν, τοῦθ' ἥπερ ἀνέπνευσεν, τῆς ἐκροῆς ζωτικὴν ἐπιθυμίαν ἐμποίησας αὐτῷ, τοῦ γεννᾶν ἔρωτα ἀπετέλεσεν. διὸ δὴ τῶν μὲν ἀνδρῶν τὸ περὶ τὴν τῶν αἰδοίων φύσιν ἀπειθές τε καὶ αὐτοκρατὲς γεγονός, οἷον ζῶον ἀνυπήκοον τοῦ λόγου, πάντων δι' ἐπιθυμίας οἰστροῦδεις ἐπιχειρεῖ κρατεῖν· αἱ δ' ἐν

91c

T: In women, for their part, the so-called matrix or womb is a living being within them, desirous of begetting children. Whenever this has become barren for a long time beyond its due season, it becomes troublesome and discontented. It wanders about the body in all directions, blocks up the exit passages of the breath, and by preventing respiration inflicts extreme distress and brings on a whole variety of

other diseases until her desire and the male passion brings them together, and, as if stripping fruit from trees, sows the ploughed land of the womb with living beings, as yet unformed and so small that they are invisible, gives them distinctness once more, nurtures them within to a great size, and thereafter leads them into the light and completes the process of generating living creatures. So this is how women and all that is female came into being.

ταῖς γυναῖξιν αὖ μητραί τε καὶ ὑστέραι λεγόμεναι διὰ τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτα, ζῶον ἐπιθυμητικὸν ἐνὸν τῆς παιδοποιίας, ὅταν ἄκαρπον παρὰ τὴν ὥραν χρόνον πολὺν γίγνηται, χαλεπῶς ἀγανακτοῦν φέρει, καὶ πλανώμενον πάντῃ κατὰ τὸ σῶμα, τὰς τοῦ πνεύματος διεξόδους ἀποφράττον, ἀναπνεῖν οὐκ ἔῶν εἰς ἀπορίας τὰς ἐσχάτας ἐμβάλλει καὶ νόσους παντοδαπὰς ἄλλας παρέχει, μέχριπερ ἂν ἐκατέρων ἡ ἐπιθυμία καὶ ὁ

91d

T: Birds, as a class, were formed in a different way. Growing feathers rather than hair, they came from men who were harmless but unsubstantial, who studied the upper regions, but believed, due to their simple-mindedness, that the most definitive evidence concerning them comes from sight. The wild land animals, for their part, arose from those who had no recourse to philosophy or any awareness at all of the nature of the Heaven, because they did not make use of the revolutions in the head but followed the lead of the parts of the soul in the region of the chest. So, as a result of living in this way, they extended their forward limbs and their heads to the earth due to their kinship therewith, and settled there, having acquired elongated heads of all varieties, corresponding to the way in which their own revolutions had been pressed together on account of idleness. So that is the reason why this type of creature developed as four-footed or many footed; God placed more supports under those who were more mindless so that they would be more drawn to the earth. The most mindless among them, in whom the entire body is stretched out upon the earth, no longer needed feet, so the gods made them without feet, to crawl in the dust of the earth. The fourth type arose in water from

the completely unintelligent and unlearned. Those who fashioned them, deeming them no longer worthy to breathe pure air because they had an impure soul due to all-pervasive error, forced them to breathe the murky depths of water rather than fine, pure air. Hence, the race of fishes, of shellfish, and all the creatures that have come into being in water, have been assigned an extreme dwelling place as a penalty for their extreme stupidity.

ἔρως συναγαγόντες, οἷον ἀπὸ δένδρων καρπὸν καταδρέψαντες, ὡς εἰς ἄρουραν τὴν μήτραν ἀόρατα ὑπὸ σμικρότητος καὶ ἀδιάπλαστα ζῶα κατασπείραντες καὶ πάλιν διακρίναντες μεγάλα ἐντὸς ἐκθρέψονται καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο εἰς φῶς ἀγαγόντες ζῶων ἀποτελέσωσι γένεσιν. γυναιῖκες μὲν οὖν καὶ τὸ θῆλυ πᾶν οὕτω γέγονεν· τὸ δὲ τῶν ὀρνέων φύλον μετερρυθμίζετο, ἀντὶ τριχῶν πτερὰ φύον, ἐκ τῶν ἀκάκων ἀνδρῶν, κούφων δέ, καὶ μετεωρολογικῶν μὲν, ἡγουμένων δὲ δι' ὄψεως τὰς περὶ τούτων ἀποδείξεις βεβαιωτάτας εἶναι δι' εὐθήθειαν. τὸ δ' αὖ πεζὸν καὶ θηριῶδες γέγονεν ἐκ τῶν μηδὲν προσχρωμένων φιλοσοφία μηδὲ ἀθρούντων τῆς περὶ τὸν οὐρανὸν φύσεως περὶ μηδέν, διὰ τὸ μηκέτι ταῖς ἐν τῇ κεφαλῇ χρῆσθαι περιόδοις, ἀλλὰ τοῖς περὶ τὰ στήθη τῆς ψυχῆς ἡγεμόσιν ἔπεσθαι μέρεσιν. ΤΙ. ἐκ τούτων οὖν τῶν ἐπιτηδευμάτων τά τ' ἐμπρόσθια κῶλα καὶ τὰς κεφαλὰς εἰς γῆν ἐλκόμενα ὑπὸ συγγενείας ἤρρισαν, προμήκεις τε καὶ παντοίας ἔσχον τὰς κορυφάς, ὅπη συνεθλίφθησαν ὑπὸ ἀργίας ἐκάστων αἱ περιφοραί· τετράπουν τε τὸ γένος αὐτῶν ἐκ ταύτης ἐφύετο καὶ πολύπουν τῆς προφάσεως, θεοῦ βάσεις ὑποτιθέντος πλείους τοῖς μᾶλλον ἄφροσιν, ὡς μᾶλλον ἐπὶ γῆν ἔλκοιντο. τοῖς δ' ἀφρονεστάτοις αὐτῶν τούτων καὶ παντάπασιν πρὸς γῆν πᾶν τὸ σῶμα κατατεινομένοις ὡς οὐδὲν ἔτι ποδῶν χρειᾶς οὔσης, ἄποδα αὐτὰ καὶ ἰλυσπώμενα ἐπὶ γῆς ἐγέννησαν. τὸ δὲ τέταρτον γένος ἔνυδρον γέγονεν ἐκ τῶν μάλιστα ἀνοητοτάτων καὶ ἀμαθεστάτων, οὓς οὐδ' ἀναπνοῆς καθαρᾶς ἔτι ἠξίωσαν οἱ μεταπλάττοντες, ὡς τὴν ψυχὴν ὑπὸ πλημμελείας πάσης ἀκαθάρτως ἔχόντων, ἀλλ' ἀντὶ λεπτῆς καὶ καθαρᾶς ἀναπνοῆς ἀέρος εἰς ὕδατος θολερὰν καὶ βαθεῖαν ἔωσαν ἀνάπνευσιν· ὅθεν ἰχθύων ἔθνος καὶ τὸ τῶν

ὁστρέων συναπάντων τε ὅσα ἔνυδρα γέγονεν, δίκην ἀμαθίας ἐσχάτης ἐσχάτας οἰκήσεις

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T: And it is on the basis of these principles that all living creatures, then and now, are transformed into one another; they are changed through the acquisition or loss of nous or stupidity. So, we may now declare that our discourse concerning the Universe has at last come to an end. This Universe has received mortal and immortal living beings and has been filled with them, and, accordingly, has become a visible, living being encompassing all that is visible, an image of whatever is known by nous, a perceptible god, supreme, excellent, sublime and perfect, this Heaven, only begotten and one.

εἰληχότων. καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα δὴ πάντα τότε καὶ νῦν διαμείβεται τὰ ζῶα εἰς ἄλληλα, νοῦ καὶ ἀνοίας ἀποβολῇ καὶ κτήσει μεταβαλλόμενα. καὶ δὴ καὶ τέλος περὶ τοῦ παντὸς νῦν ἤδη τὸν λόγον ἡμῖν φῶμεν ἔχειν· θνητὰ γὰρ καὶ ἀθάνατα ζῶα λαβὼν καὶ συμπληρωθεὶς ὅδε ὁ κόσμος οὕτω, ζῶον ὁρατὸν τὰ ὁρατὰ περιέχον, εἰκὼν τοῦ νοητοῦ θεὸς αἰσθητός, μέγιστος καὶ ἄριστος κάλλιστός τε καὶ τελεώτατος γέγονεν εἰς οὐρανὸς ὅδε μονογενὴς ὢν.

Notes

¹ The gathering 'yesterday' was apparently that described in the Republic. There is much speculation as to the identity of the fourth, missing interlocutor.

² Solon was the most famous early Athenian lawgiver, whose constitutional reforms in the 6th century brought an end to the great strife in the city.

³ The goddess in question is Athena. The reference to her festival is an indication that the discussion is taking place during the Panathenaea, which was held every year in Athens in honour of the patron goddess.

⁴ Apaturia were festivals held annually around the Greek world. In Athens, the Panathenaea was an opportunity for the Attic clans to meet to discuss various issues.

⁵ Deucalion and his wife Pyrrha were reputed to have been the only survivors of a cataclysmic flood sent by Zeus.

⁶ This is a reference to the Straits of Gibraltar.

⁷ (a) 2:4 :: 4:8 and (b) 8:4 :: 4:2, so (c) 4:8 :: 2:4. In (a) they are first/middle/last. In (b) the last has become first and the first last. In (c) the middle has become first and last and the last and first both middle. Hence, any of the three can become first, last or middle and so in that sense they are the same.

⁸ F:A :: A:W / A:W :: W:E, so there are now two middle terms, air and water in this example.

⁹ The circular motion by revolving on its own axis is assigned to the all. It alone involves no movement away from a fixed position and is thus termed 'un-wandering'.

¹⁰ The three mixtures are intermediate types of being, same and other, each formed by mixing their indivisible kinds with their divisible kinds.

¹¹ The first mean is a harmonic mean, e.g. between 6 and 12 it is 8, which is $\frac{1}{3}$ greater than 6 and $\frac{1}{3}$ less than 12. The second mean is an arithmetic mean, e.g. in the case of 6 and 12 it is 9, which exceeds 6 by 3 and is 3 less than 12.

¹² The Greek word for planets means wanderers, and refers to their irregular motion as compared to the 'fixed' stars.

¹³ This is a reference to the dawn-bearer (Venus).

¹⁴ This is Mercury.

¹⁵ Hence, the stars/gods rotate on their own axes and are also carried uniformly across the sky. These are the two assigned motions, the latter of which can be observed in the night sky.

¹⁶ The seven motions are rotation on an axis, movement to the right, left, up, down, forward and backward. Only the first two are exhibited by the stars/gods.

¹⁷ A connection is implied here between the Greek word for 'sensations' (aisthêseis) and the word for 'shaking' (aïssein).

¹⁸ This is a very close paraphrase of Euripides' *Phoenician Women*, 1762.

¹⁹ This sentence is evidence for equating nous with the Demiurge. The phrase 'with few exceptions' probably refers to the section on the mechanism of vision (45b-c).

²⁰ Omitting *pur* at 49d6, following Cornford.

²¹ The former is the right-angled isosceles triangle. The latter is the right-angled scalene triangle.

²² This simply means that the three 60° angles that meet at the corner of a tetrahedron add up to 180° , which is not an obtuse angle but next after the most obtuse angle.

²³ This refers to a tetrahedron inscribed within a sphere.

²⁴ That is, a square.

²⁵ This refers to the dodecahedron, which is the closest of all the solids to the spherical shape of the universe.

²⁶ The reference here seems to be to a supposed connection between the Greek words for 'heat' and for 'cutting into pieces'.

²⁷ The Greek word for brain translates literally as 'in the head'.

²⁸ This is the brain itself.

²⁹ The Greek word for living things, *zoa*, is often applied to animals. The point here is that plants, given that they are living things, have just as much right as animals to be called *zoa*.

³⁰ The text is corrupt here. This translation follows Waterfield and Zeyl.

³¹ *Opisthotonos* is a spasm of the muscles around the neck and back often caused by severe tetanus, a bacterial disease that causes muscle rigidity.

³² Epilepsy was referred to as the sacred disease.